

Romeo and Juliet

William Shakespeare · 1597

Standard Ebooks edition (modern text drawing on the 1599 Second Quarto and the 1623 First Folio)

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

Common Core edition (standards shown for this framework only)

27 scene lessons plus 2 seminar day(s), a test day and an essay day: 28 class days of 90 minutes, 5 a week (block schedule), 6 weeks
Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

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Cover: Jean-Honoré Fragonard, A Young Girl Reading (c. 1770). Public domain (Wikimedia Commons).

Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–27), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Unit test (eleven rigor versions) with answer keys and scoring guides
6. Final paper
7. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: Romeo and Juliet was first printed in a short quarto in 1597 and in a fuller Second Quarto in 1599; modern texts are based mainly on the Second Quarto. The reading text is the Standard Ebooks edition, divided into the conventional 24 scenes plus the two Choruses and the cast list. The year shown is the first printing; the play was probably written around 1595. Cite act, scene and line from this edition.

Content note for teachers: Street violence and on-stage deaths, sexual wordplay (I.i, II.i, II.iv, the Nurse), a father's verbal abuse, the marriage of a thirteen-year-old, and suicide (the ending, plus Romeo's attempt in III.iii, Juliet's despair in III.ii, III.v and IV.iii, and Romeo's purchase of poison in V.i). See the scene notes and the 988 safe-messaging script.

Grades: Grades 9–10 (scales to graduate via rigor levels). Scaffolded-support track (grade-9 floor): students work from teacher-selected passages with scaffolds, sentence starters and partial-credit probes. **Weeks:** 6. **Class days:** 28 × 90 minutes (27 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does Romeo and Juliet suggest about love and desire?
- What does Romeo and Juliet suggest about fate and choice?
- What does Romeo and Juliet suggest about violence and the feud?
- What does Romeo and Juliet suggest about youth and age?
- What does Romeo and Juliet suggest about time and haste?

Objectives

- Students will cite at least 2 quotations, with locations, to support each written claim about what the text says explicitly and implicitly (scored on the writing-prompt rubric).
- Students will trace one theme across at least 3 sections of the play in the final paper, earning at least 70 of 100 rubric points.
- Students will explain how characters, setting and point of view interact in at least 3 exit tickets, each meeting the claim-evidence-reasoning criteria.

- Students will determine the in-context meaning of taught vocabulary, scoring at least 80% on the vocabulary items of the scene quizzes.
- Students will write an argument with a clear claim, reasons and relevant evidence, scoring at least 80% on the unit test's short-answer scoring guides.

Standards: Common Core

RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.9-10.5, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.4, RL.11-12.5, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, L.9-10.4, L.11-12.4

Common Core State Standards (ELA-Literacy), thecorestandards.org

Assessments: Daily scene quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-book test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Scaffolded support through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Scene lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	I do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Week	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	*Introduction: author, context and reception* Dramatis Personae (20-minute preview) and Prologue (20-minute preview) and Act I, Scene I Act I, Scene II Act I, Scene III Act I, Scene IV	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*love and desire* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Introduction: author, context and reception • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
2	Act I, Scene V *Socratic seminar on love and desire* Act II, Prologue (20-minute preview) and Act II, Scene I Act II, Scene II Act II, Scene III	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*fate and choice* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Socratic seminar on love and desire • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
3	Act II, Scene IV Act II, Scene V Act II, Scene VI Act III, Scene I Act III, Scene II	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*violence and the feud* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
4	Act III, Scene III Act III, Scene IV *Socratic seminar on fate and choice* Act III, Scene V Act IV, Scene I	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*youth and age* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Socratic seminar on fate and choice • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
5	Act IV, Scene II Act IV, Scene III Act IV, Scene IV (20-minute preview) and Act IV, Scene V	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*time and haste* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do,	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt

	Act V, Scene I Act V, Scene II (20-minute preview) and Act V, Scene III		discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	
6	*Whole-book test (90 minutes)* *Final paper writing workshop (drafting in class; finish the draft as homework)* *Final paper: peer review, revision and submission*	3 × 90 min (270 min)	*love and desire* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Whole-book test (90 minutes) • Final paper writing workshop (drafting in class; finish the draft as homework) • Final paper: peer review, revision and submission • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Whole-book test and final essay

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: Introduction to Romeo and Juliet

Objective: Students will explain, in a 3-sentence exit ticket, how one fact about William Shakespeare's life or times connects to love and desire in “Romeo and Juliet”, and will set up a reading journal with a prediction and a question for each of 3 themes (love and desire, fate and choice, violence and the feud).

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2

Author biography

William Shakespeare was baptized in Stratford-upon-Avon on 26 April 1564, the son of John Shakespeare, a glover and town official, and Mary Arden. He probably attended Stratford's grammar school, married Anne Hathaway in 1582, and had three children: Susanna and the twins Hamnet and Judith (Hamnet died aged eleven in 1596). By the early 1590s he was an actor and playwright in London; from 1594 he was a sharer in the Lord Chamberlain's Men, who built the Globe theatre in 1599 and became the King's Men when James VI of Scotland became James I of England in 1603. He wrote or co-wrote about 38 plays and the Sonnets, and died in Stratford on 23 April 1616. Seven years later his fellow actors John Heminges and Henry Condell published 36 of his plays in the First Folio (1623).

Historical and cultural context

Romeo and Juliet was probably written around 1595, in the same years as A Midsummer Night's Dream, when Shakespeare was writing for the Lord Chamberlain's Men. The story was already well known in English: Arthur Brooke's long poem The Tragicall Historye of Romeus and Juliet (1562), based on a French version by Pierre Boaistuau of an Italian playla by Matteo Bandello (who drew on Luigi da Porto), was Shakespeare's main source. Shakespeare compressed Brooke's nine months into about four days, made Juliet younger (thirteen, "not fourteen"; Brooke's Juliet is sixteen) and greatly expanded Mercutio. In Elizabethan England fathers usually arranged the marriages of propertied daughters, and duelling and street brawls between rival retinues were a real worry to authorities. The play's love poetry draws on the fashion for sonnets in the 1590s: the lovers' first exchange is itself a sonnet.

Publication and reception, then and now

The play was printed in 1597 in a short First Quarto (sometimes called a "bad quarto") and in 1599 in a fuller Second Quarto "newly corrected, augmented, and amended," which is the basis of most modern texts; it was reprinted in the First Folio (1623). Modern editions, including the reading text here, combine readings from these early printings.

Then: The play was popular in Shakespeare's lifetime, judging by its four quarto printings before the Folio. After the Restoration it fared less well: Samuel Pepys saw it on 1 March 1661/2 (1 March 1662 by modern reckoning) and called it "the worst that ever I heard in my life," and Thomas Otway turned it into a Roman play, Caius Marius (1679). David Garrick's version (1748) let Juliet wake before Romeo dies and held the stage for about a century.

Now: It is one of the most performed and adapted of all plays and has been taught in American high schools for generations. Adaptations include Leonard Bernstein and Arthur Laurents's musical West Side Story (1957), Franco Zeffirelli's film (1968) and Baz Luhrmann's Romeo + Juliet (1996). Modern readers debate whether the play is about fate, about youthful impulsiveness, or about a violent society that destroys its children.

Overview (spoiler-free)

In Verona two great families, the Montagues and the Capulets, are locked in a feud so old that no one remembers its cause. Romeo, a Montague, slips into a Capulet party and meets Juliet, the Capulets' only daughter. The Prologue tells us at once how their story ends; the play shows how it gets there, in about four days.

Main themes

- love and desire: love at first sight, infatuation (Rosaline) and the love that makes Juliet "boundless"; ask what kind of love the play actually shows.
- fate and choice: "star-cross'd" lovers; are they doomed, or do people make choices that doom them?
- violence and the feud: a city where young men fight over a bitten thumb; who is responsible for the deaths?
- youth and age: parents, the Nurse and the Friar advise, command and fail the young.
- time and haste: a story compressed into four days; watch how speed shapes every decision.

Why it matters

Romeo and Juliet is the story of first love that the English-speaking world tells itself, and it is also a study of how a community's hatreds land on its young people. Students meet questions about loyalty to family, impulsive decisions, adults who fail to listen, and violence that escalates from words, all in some of the most famous poetry in English.

Spoilers · teacher only

Romeo and Juliet marry secretly with the help of Friar Laurence and the Nurse. The next day Tybalt kills Mercutio and Romeo kills Tybalt, and the Prince banishes Romeo to Mantua. Capulet, not knowing of the marriage, insists Juliet marry Paris. The Friar gives her a potion that makes her seem dead; his letter to Romeo is stopped by a plague quarantine. Romeo hears she is dead, buys poison, kills Paris at the tomb and dies beside Juliet; she wakes, finds him dead and stabs herself. The families are reconciled over their children's bodies.

Lesson plan (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Content note before we start: Today's introduction briefly mentions suicide. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.
Before we open Romeo and Juliet: Have you ever been told you could not be friends with someone because of a family or group rivalry? Write for five minutes about where such rivalries come from and whether they are fair.
Prompt: Before we open Romeo and Juliet: Have you ever been told you could not be friends with someone because of a family or group rivalry? Write for five minutes about where such rivalries come from and whether they are fair.

8–18 min · Key terms · I do (10 min)
Key literary terms for the unit.
tragedy (a play in which the main characters are destroyed, often through choices and circumstances); prologue (an opening speech that introduces the story); sonnet (a fourteen-line poem; the Prologue is a Shakespearean sonnet); foil (a character who contrasts with another); dramatic irony (the audience knows what characters do not); pun (a play on two meanings of a word); feud (a long, bitter quarrel between families).

18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)

Mini-lecture on the author, the historical context and the reception (read or adapt the script).

About the author. William Shakespeare was baptized in Stratford-upon-Avon on 26 April 1564, the son of John Shakespeare, a glover and town official, and Mary Arden. He probably attended Stratford's grammar school, married Anne Hathaway in 1582, and had three children: Susanna and the twins Hamnet and Judith (Hamnet died aged eleven in 1596). By the early 1590s he was an actor and playwright in London; from 1594 he was a sharer in the Lord Chamberlain's Men, who built the Globe theatre in 1599 and became the King's Men when James VI of Scotland became James I of England in 1603. He wrote or co-wrote about 38 plays and the Sonnets, and died in Stratford on 23 April 1616. Seven years later his fellow actors John Heminges and Henry Condell published 36 of his plays in the First Folio (1623). The world of the book. Romeo and Juliet was probably written around 1595, in the same years as A Midsummer Night's Dream, when Shakespeare was writing for the Lord Chamberlain's Men. The story was already well known in English: Arthur Brooke's long poem The Tragicall Historye of Romeus and Juliet (1562), based on a French version by Pierre Boaistuau of an Italian playla by Matteo Bandello (who drew on Luigi da Porto), was Shakespeare's main source. Shakespeare compressed Brooke's nine months into about four days, made Juliet younger (thirteen, "not fourteen"; Brooke's Juliet is sixteen) and greatly expanded Mercutio. In Elizabethan England fathers usually arranged the marriages of propertied daughters, and duelling and street brawls between rival retinues were a real worry to authorities. The play's love poetry draws on the fashion for sonnets in the 1590s: the lovers' first exchange is itself a sonnet. Publication and reception. The play was printed in 1597 in a short First Quarto (sometimes called a "bad quarto") and in 1599 in a fuller Second Quarto "newly corrected, augmented, and amended," which is the basis of most modern texts; it was reprinted in the First Folio (1623). Modern editions, including the reading text here, combine readings from these early printings. Then: The play was popular in Shakespeare's lifetime, judging by its four quarto printings before the Folio. After the Restoration it fared less well: Samuel Pepys saw it on 1 March 1661/2 (1 March 1662 by modern reckoning) and called it "the worst that ever I heard in my life," and Thomas Otway turned it into a Roman play, Caius Marius (1679). David Garrick's version (1748) let Juliet wake before Romeo dies and held the stage for about a century. Now: It is one of the most performed and adapted of all plays and has been taught in American high schools for generations. Adaptations include Leonard Bernstein and Arthur Laurents's musical West Side Story (1957), Franco Zeffirelli's film (1968) and Baz Luhrmann's Romeo + Juliet (1996). Modern readers debate whether the play is about fate, about youthful impulsiveness, or about a violent society that destroys its children.

28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)
Model a close reading of one passage using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "A pair of star-cross'd lovers take their life" slowly and put it in my own words: The Chorus announces that a pair of lovers, crossed by the stars, will take their lives. Next, craft. I notice the sonnet form, a love-poem shape used to announce a tragedy, and "take their life," which means both "are born" and "kill themselves." The strongest word is "star-cross'd": it means thwarted by the stars, so fate seems to be against them from the start. Then, effect. What does the Prologue tell us before the play begins? My answer: Shakespeare tells us the ending first, so we watch not to learn what happens but how and why; the line raises the play's question of whether fate or the characters' choices cause the deaths. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.

> *A pair of star-cross'd lovers take their life (Prologue)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "A pair of star-cross'd lovers take their life" slowly and put it in my own words: The Chorus announces that a pair of lovers, crossed by the stars, will take their lives. Next, craft. I notice the sonnet form, a love-poem shape used to announce a tragedy, and "take their life," which means both "are born" and "kill themselves." The strongest word is "star-cross'd": it means thwarted by the stars, so fate seems to be against them from the start. Then, effect. What does the Prologue tell us before the play begins? My answer: Shakespeare tells us the ending first, so we watch not to learn what happens but how and why; the line raises the play's question of whether fate or the characters' choices cause the deaths.

40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)
Read the spoiler-free overview together and name the themes to track.
What the book is about (no spoilers): In Verona two great families, the Montagues and the Capulets, are locked in a feud so old that no one remembers its cause. Romeo, a Montague, slips into a Capulet party and meets Juliet, the Capulets' only daughter. The Prologue tells us at once how their story ends; the play shows how it gets there, in about four days. Themes to track: love and desire: love at first sight, infatuation (Rosaline) and the love that makes Juliet "boundless"; ask what kind of love the play actually shows. fate and choice: "star-cross'd" lovers; are they doomed, or do people make choices that doom them? violence and the feud: a city where young men fight over a bitten thumb; who is responsible for the deaths? youth and age: parents, the Nurse and the Friar advise, command and fail the young. time and haste: a story compressed into four days; watch how speed shapes every decision.

55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme, with a prediction and a question (example given).
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question. Theme page "fate and choice": Prediction: something will go wrong because the lovers act too quickly. Question: if the Prologue says they are "star-cross'd," can they be blamed for what happens?
Task: Set up a reading journal for Romeo and Juliet: one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.
Exemplar: Theme page "fate and choice": Prediction: something will go wrong because the lovers act too quickly. Question: if the Prologue says they are "star-cross'd," can they be blamed for what happens?

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Whole-class discussion: why the book is still taught.
Why does Romeo and Juliet still matter? Romeo and Juliet is the story of first love that the English-speaking world tells itself, and it is also a study of how a community's hatreds land on its young people. Students meet questions about loyalty to family, impulsive decisions, adults who fail to listen, and violence that escalates from words, all in some of the most famous poetry in English.
Anchor question: Why might Romeo and Juliet still be taught today?
Facilitation: Romeo and Juliet is the story of first love that the English-speaking world tells itself, and it is also a study of how a community's hatreds land on its young people. Students meet questions about loyalty to family, impulsive decisions, adults who fail to listen, and violence that escalates from words, all in some of the most famous poetry in English.

80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)
Exit ticket on the author and context (answer given).
Shakespeare wrote Romeo and Juliet around 1595, adapting Arthur Brooke's 1562 poem, for audiences who believed in astrology and expected parents to arrange marriages. How might that context shape the play? Answer: Accept answers such as: belief in the stars made "star-crossed" meaningful; arranged marriage explains Capulet's anger at Juliet's refusal; Shakespeare turned a moral warning poem into a sympathetic tragedy.
Exit ticket: Shakespeare wrote Romeo and Juliet around 1595, adapting Arthur Brooke's 1562 poem, for audiences who believed in astrology and expected parents to arrange marriages. How might that context shape the play?
Answer: Accept answers such as: belief in the stars made "star-crossed" meaningful; arranged marriage explains Capulet's anger at Juliet's refusal; Shakespeare turned a moral warning poem into a sympathetic tragedy.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Preview the first reading.
Tomorrow we begin reading: Dramatis Personae.

Teacher notes · sources: Folger Shakespeare Library, "Shakespeare's life" (https://www.folger.edu/explore/shakespeares-life/); Shakespeare Birthplace Trust, "William Shakespeare" (https://www.shakespeare.org.uk/explore-shakespeare/shakespedia/william-shakespeare/); Folger Shakespeare Library, "Romeo and Juliet" (https://www.folger.edu/explore/shakespeares-works/romeo-and-juliet/); Royal Shakespeare Company, "Romeo and Juliet: about the play" (https://www.rsc.org.uk/romeo-and-juliet/about-the-play); British Library, "Romeo and Juliet: the First Quarto (1597)" (https://www.bl.uk/collection-items/the-first-quarto-of-romeo-and-juliet-1597); Arthur Brooke, The Tragicall Historye of Romeus and Juliet (1562) (https://www.gutenberg.org/); Samuel Pepys, Diary, 1 March 1662 (https://www.pepysdiary.com/diary/1662/03/01/)

Flags (verify before teaching):

- The date "around 1595" is a scholarly inference (style, the 1597 quarto, the Nurse's "'tis since the earthquake now eleven years"); no record fixes it.
- Pepys's verdict is from his diary entry for 1 March 1661/2; check the wording against the edition you cite.

- Juliet's age ("she's not fourteen") is stated in Act I, Scene III; Brooke's Juliet is sixteen. Discuss early marriage in its historical context: most Elizabethan women married in their twenties.

Lesson 2: Dramatis Personae

Focus: the divided world of Verona

Objective: Students will identify at least 5 characters from the cast list and explain, in one sentence each, how each is related to the play's central family or court.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3

Teacher only · spoilers

The cast list divides Verona into the Prince's family (Escalus, his kinsmen Paris and Mercutio), the house of Montague (Montague, Lady Montague, Romeo, Benvolio and servants) and the house of Capulet (Capulet, Lady Capulet, Juliet, Tybalt, the Nurse and servants), with two Franciscan friars and an apothecary outside both. The scenes are Verona and Mantua.

Background: Verona and Mantua were real cities in northern Italy; Italy was, for English audiences of the 1590s, a place of passion, feuds and fashionable duelling. The story came to Shakespeare through Arthur Brooke's English poem of 1562.

Significance: Reading the cast first lets students see the feud's structure: two houses 'at variance', each with servants who fight for them, and a few figures (the Prince's kin, the Friar) who might bridge or break the divide.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Have you ever belonged to a group that had a rival group? How did that rivalry affect friendships? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to violence and the feud because....*
> **Prompt:** Have you ever belonged to a group that had a rival group? How did that rivalry affect friendships?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to violence and the feud because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: servants are listed by house; the quarrel reaches down to every household member.

> **8–16 min · Background and context · I do (8 min)**
> Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
> *Verona and Mantua were real cities in northern Italy; Italy was, for English audiences of the 1590s, a place of passion, feuds and fashionable duelling. The story came to Shakespeare through Arthur Brooke's English poem of 1562. Reading the cast first lets students see the feud's structure: two houses 'at variance', each with servants who fight for them, and a few figures (the Prince's kin, the Friar) who might bridge or break the divide. Characterization: The list sorts Verona into the Prince's family (Escalus, Paris, Mercutio), the Montagues and the Capulets. Mercutio and Paris belong to neither house, which matters when the fighting starts. Setting: "Verona; Mantua": the city of the feud and the city of exile. Conflict: "heads of houses at variance with each other": the feud is in the cast list before any line is spoken. Watch for the two houses: "Montague" and "Capulet" are names before they are people; the play will test whether a name can be set aside (names and identity).*

> **16–20 min · Closure · I do (4 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes the divided world of Verona. Key takeaway: servants are listed by house; the quarrel reaches down to every household member.*

Total: 20 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** The list sorts Verona into the Prince's family (Escalus, Paris, Mercutio), the Montagues and the Capulets. Mercutio and Paris belong to neither house, which matters when the fighting starts.
- **Setting:** "Verona; Mantua": the city of the feud and the city of exile.
- **Conflict:** "heads of houses at variance with each other": the feud is in the cast list before any line is spoken.

Themes and how they develop

- **violence and the feud:** servants are listed by house; the quarrel reaches down to every household member.

Symbols and motifs

- **the two houses:** "Montague" and "Capulet" are names before they are people; the play will test whether a name can be set aside (names and identity).
- **Verona and Mantua:** the city of the feud and the city of exile; leaving Verona will feel like leaving the world.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at variance with each other” (Dramatis Personae) The conflict is built into the cast list.

- “Mercutio, kinsman to the prince, and friend to Romeo” (Dramatis Personae) Mercutio stands between the Prince's family and the Montagues.
- “Tybalt, nephew to Lady Capulet” (Dramatis Personae) Tybalt's tie to Lady Capulet explains her later grief and demand for revenge.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The cast list shows a city divided into camps, with only the Prince's kin standing outside the feud.
Evidence: “Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at variance with each other” (Dramatis Personae)
Reasoning: "Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at variance" are paired as enemies, while Mercutio is "kinsman to the prince, and friend to Romeo": a neutral who will be pulled into the fight.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
maskers (noun)	people in masks and costume who join a party	*Citizens of Verona; several men and women, relations to both houses; maskers, guards, watchmen, and attendants*	
nobleman (noun)	a man of noble rank	*Paris, a young nobleman, kinsman to the prince*	
kinsman (noun)	a male relative	*Paris, a young nobleman, kinsman to the prince*	
attendants (noun)	servants who wait on a person of rank	*Citizens of Verona; several men and women, relations to both houses; maskers, guards, watchmen, and attendants*	“attendants”: Origin of “attendant”: Old French attendant. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/attendant#Etymology)
variance (noun)	a state of quarrel or disagreement	*Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at variance with each other*	“variance”: Origin: Old French variance; earlier Latin variaunce. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/variance#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. Have you ever belonged to a group that had a rival group? How did that rivalry affect friendships?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with love and desire?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20,

21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Which characters belong to neither the Montague nor the Capulet house? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Escalus, Paris, Mercutio, the two friars, the apothecary and the citizens.
2. Who is the prince of Verona? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Escalus
3. Whose son is Romeo? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Montague's
4. Whose nephew is Tybalt? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Lady Capulet's
5. In which two places is the play set? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Verona and Mantua
6. What is Mercutio's relation to the Prince? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Kinsman
7. Retell the three most important events of "Dramatis Personae" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The cast list divides Verona into the Prince's family (Escalus, his kinsmen Paris and Mercutio), the house of Montague (Montague, Lady Montague, Romeo, Benvolio and servants) and the house of Capulet (Capulet, Lady Capulet, Juliet, Tybalt, the Nurse and servants), with two Franciscan friars and an apothecary outside both. The scenes are Verona and Mantua.
8. Who is on stage in "Dramatis Personae", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Dramatis Personae" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Citizens of Verona; several men and women, relations to both houses; maskers, guards, watchmen, and attendants" What does "maskers" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: maskers: people in masks and costume who join a party.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why might it matter that Mercutio and Paris are related to the Prince? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: They are outsiders to the feud, so their deaths implicate the Prince's family and the city.
2. What does "Dramatis Personae" suggest about the divided world of Verona? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Reading the cast first lets students see the feud's structure: two houses 'at variance', each with servants who fight for them, and a few figures (the Prince's kin, the Friar) who might bridge or break the divide.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the setting in this scene shape what we understand about the divided world of Verona? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a city divided into camps, with only

the Prince's kin standing outside the feud. Useful evidence: “Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at variance with each other” (Dramatis Personae): The conflict is built into the cast list. On setting: "Verona; Mantua": the city of the feud and the city of exile. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “Escalus, prince of Verona”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Dramatis Personae”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: The cast list divides Verona into the Prince's family (Escalus, his kinsmen Paris and Mercutio), the house of Montague (Montague, Lady Montague, Romeo, Benvolio and servants) and the house of Capulet (Capulet, Lady Capulet, Juliet, Tybalt, the Nurse and servants), with two Franciscan friars and an…
7. As the opening scene, what does “Dramatis Personae” set up that the rest of Romeo and Juliet will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a city divided into camps, with only the Prince's kin standing outside the feud. Useful evidence: “Mercutio, kinsman to the prince, and friend to Romeo” (Dramatis Personae): Mercutio stands between the Prince's family and the Montagues. Theme link: servants are listed by house; the quarrel reaches down to every household member. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a city divided into camps, with only the Prince's kin standing outside the feud. Useful evidence: “Tybalt, nephew to Lady Capulet” (Dramatis Personae): Tybalt's tie to Lady Capulet explains her later grief and demand for revenge. On characterization: The list sorts Verona into the Prince's family (Escalus, Paris, Mercutio), the Montagues and the Capulets. Mercutio and Paris belong to neither house, which matters when the fighting starts. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Have you ever belonged to a group that had a rival group? How did that rivalry affect friendships?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does conflict appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with love and desire? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a city divided into camps, with only the Prince's kin standing outside the feud. Useful evidence: “Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at variance with each other” (Dramatis Personae): The conflict is built into the cast list. On conflict: "heads of houses at variance with each other": the feud is in the cast list before any line is spoken. Credit any position

that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is it fair that servants are drawn into their masters' feud? What does the cast list suggest about loyalty? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Servants are defined by 'servant to'; their loyalty is assigned, not chosen.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a city divided into camps, with only the Prince's kin standing outside the feud. Useful evidence: “Mercutio, kinsman to the prince, and friend to Romeo” (Dramatis Personae): Mercutio stands between the Prince's family and the Montagues. Theme link: servants are listed by house; the quarrel reaches down to every household member. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Reading the cast first lets students see the feud's structure: two houses 'at variance', each with servants who fight for them, and a few figures (the Prince's kin, the Friar) who might bridge or break the divide.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a city divided into camps, with only the Prince's kin standing outside the feud. Useful evidence: “Tybalt, nephew to Lady Capulet” (Dramatis Personae): Tybalt's tie to Lady Capulet explains her later grief and demand for revenge. Theme link: servants are listed by house; the quarrel reaches down to every household member. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a city divided into camps, with only the Prince's kin standing outside the feud. Useful evidence: “Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at variance with each other” (Dramatis Personae): The conflict is built into the cast list. On characterization: The list sorts Verona into the Prince's family (Escalus, Paris, Mercutio), the Montagues and the Capulets. Mercutio and Paris belong to neither house, which matters when the fighting starts. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Dramatis Personae”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the divided world of Verona. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a city divided into camps, with only the Prince's kin standing outside the feud. Useful evidence: “Mercutio, kinsman to the prince, and friend to Romeo” (Dramatis Personae): Mercutio stands between the Prince's family and the Montagues. Theme link: servants are listed by house; the quarrel reaches down to every household member. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Dramatis Personae”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a city divided into camps, with only the Prince's kin standing outside the feud. Useful evidence: “Tybalt, nephew to Lady Capulet” (Dramatis Personae): Tybalt's tie to Lady Capulet explains her later grief and demand for revenge. Theme link: servants are listed by house; the quarrel reaches down to every household member. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to fate and choice: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a city divided into camps, with only the Prince's kin standing outside the feud. Useful evidence: “Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at variance with each other” (Dramatis Personae): The conflict is built into the cast list. Theme link: servants are listed by house; the quarrel reaches down to every household member. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a city divided into camps, with only the Prince's kin standing outside the feud. Useful evidence: “Mercutio, kinsman to the prince, and friend to Romeo” (Dramatis Personae): Mercutio stands between the Prince's family and the Montagues. On characterization: The list sorts Verona into the Prince's family (Escalus, Paris, Mercutio), the Montagues and the Capulets. Mercutio and Paris belong to neither house, which matters when the fighting starts. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Dramatis Personae” treats the divided world of Verona with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a city divided into camps, with only the Prince's kin standing outside the feud. Useful evidence: “Tybalt, nephew to Lady Capulet” (Dramatis Personae): Tybalt's tie to Lady Capulet explains her later grief and demand for revenge. Theme link: servants are listed by house; the quarrel reaches down to every household member. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Prologue” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a city divided into camps, with only the Prince's kin standing outside the feud. Useful evidence: “Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at variance with each other” (Dramatis Personae): The conflict is built into the cast list. Theme link: servants

are listed by house; the quarrel reaches down to every household member. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the divided world of Verona? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a city divided into camps, with only the Prince's kin standing outside the feud. Useful evidence: “Mercutio, kinsman to the prince, and friend to Romeo” (Dramatis Personae): Mercutio stands between the Prince's family and the Montagues. Theme link: servants are listed by house; the quarrel reaches down to every household member. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at _____ with each other” Word bank: variance, kinsman, maskers, nobleman
    Key: variance
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Dramatis Personae: “_____ and Capulet, heads of houses at variance with each other”
    Key: Montague
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who is the prince of Verona?
    A. Escalus
    B. Paris
    C. Capulet
    D. Mercutio

    Key: A (Escalus)
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What is Mercutio's relation to the Prince?
    A. Enemy
    B. Son
    C. Kinsman
    D. Servant

    Key: C (Kinsman)
5. [short · recall · DOK 1] Which characters belong to neither the Montague nor the Capulet house?
    Sample answer: Escalus, Paris, Mercutio, the two friars, the apothecary and the citizens.

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Citizens of Verona; several men and women, relations to both houses; maskers, guards, watchmen, and attendants”, what does “maskers” most nearly mean?

   A. prayers

   B. people in masks and costume who join a party

   C. it seems to me

   D. fitting; proper

   Key: B (people in masks and costume who join a party)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In which two places is the play set?

   A. Verona and Florence

   B. Padua and Milan

   C. Verona and Mantua

   D. Venice and Rome

   Key: C (Verona and Mantua)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Citizens of Verona; several men and women, relations to both houses; maskers, guards, watchmen, and attendants”, what does “attendants” most nearly mean?

   A. commands

   B. bringing to fullness

   C. servants who wait on a person of rank

   D. lying; being untrue

   Key: C (servants who wait on a person of rank)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Whose son is Romeo?

   A. Capulet's

   B. Montague's

   C. The Prince's

   D. Friar Laurence's

   Key: B (Montague's)

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Mercutio, kinsman to the prince, and friend to Romeo” (Dramatis Personae)

    A. The potion's effect.

    B. Juliet's solitude.

    C. Mercutio stands between the Prince's family and the Montagues.

    D. Capulet asks Paris to wait.

    Key: C (Mercutio stands between the Prince's family and the Montagues.)

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Tybalt, nephew to Lady Capulet” (Dramatis Personae)

    A. Juliet urges the sun's horses to bring night.

    B. Benvolio predicts Romeo will find someone more beautiful than Rosaline.

    C. Household detail.

    D. Tybalt's tie to Lady Capulet explains her later grief and demand for revenge.

Key: D (Tybalt's tie to Lady Capulet explains her later grief and demand for revenge.)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Mercutio, kinsman to the prince, and friend to Romeo” (Dramatis Personae) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Mercutio stands between the Prince's family and the Montagues.
13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at variance with each other” (Dramatis Personae) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The conflict is built into the cast list.
14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Tybalt, nephew to Lady Capulet” (Dramatis Personae). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Tybalt's tie to Lady Capulet explains her later grief and demand for revenge.
15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The cast list shows a city divided into camps, with only the Prince's kin standing outside the feud. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at variance with each other” (Dramatis Personae).
    Sample answer: "Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at variance" are paired as enemies, while Mercutio is "kinsman to the prince, and friend to Romeo": a neutral who will be pulled into the fight.
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The cast list shows a city divided into camps, with only the Prince's kin standing outside the feud.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: "Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at variance" are paired as enemies, while Mercutio is "kinsman to the prince, and friend to Romeo": a neutral who will be pulled into the fight.
17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Dramatis Personae: “_____, kinsman to the prince, and friend to Romeo”
    Key: Mercutio
18. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why might it matter that Mercutio and Paris are related to the Prince?
    Sample answer: They are outsiders to the feud, so their deaths implicate the Prince's family and the city.
19. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Dramatis Personae”?
    A. The secret wedding
    B. The divided world of Verona
    C. Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation
    D. The undelivered letter

    Key: B (The divided world of Verona)
20. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Dramatis Personae”? "Verona; Mantua": the city of the feud and the city of exile.
    A. Setting
    B. Allusion
    C. Simile
    D. Foreshadowing

    Key: A (Setting)
21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Servants are listed by house; the quarrel reaches down to every household member.
    A. Love and desire

B. Violence and the feud

C. Fate and choice

D. Youth and age

Key: B (Violence and the feud)

22. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Paris, a young nobleman, kinsman to the prince”, what does “kinsman” most nearly mean?

A. fine spider threads floating in the air

B. a male relative

C. exchanging blows or words

D. join into one body

Key: B (a male relative)

23. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at variance with each other” (Dramatis Personae)

A. Romeo resolves to die.

B. Romeo's oxymorons link love and the feud in one phrase.

C. Romeo's defiance.

D. The conflict is built into the cast list.

Key: D (The conflict is built into the cast list.)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Dramatis Personae”? The list sorts Verona into the Prince's family (Escalus, Paris, Mercutio), the Montagues and the Capulets. Mercutio and Paris belong to neither house, which matters when the fighting starts.

A. Point of view

B. Characterization

C. Simile

D. Structure

Key: B (Characterization)

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at variance with each other” (Dramatis Personae) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: The conflict is built into the cast list.

26. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Whose nephew is Tybalt?

A. Montague's

B. The Prince's

C. Lady Capulet's

D. Lady Montague's

Key: C (Lady Capulet's)

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Paris, a young nobleman, kinsman to the prince”, what does “nobleman” most nearly mean?

A. families, including their servants and dependents

B. weeping noisily

C. having sworn to give something up

D. a man of noble rank

Key: D (a man of noble rank)

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how violence and the feud develops from an earlier scene to "Dramatis Personae". Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: servants are listed by house; the quarrel reaches down to every household member.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Mercutio, kinsman to the prince, and friend to Romeo" (Dramatis Personae) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Mercutio stands between the Prince's family and the Montagues.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is it fair that servants are drawn into their masters' feud? What does the cast list suggest about loyalty?

    Sample answer: Servants are defined by 'servant to'; their loyalty is assigned, not chosen.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	8, 17, 6, 9, 2, 4, 5, 1, 12, 18, 19, 10, 15, 20, 21, 16	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	8, 22, 6, 17, 9, 2, 23, 12, 10, 19, 11, 21, 14, 24, 25, 16	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	1, 26, 5, 2, 27, 23, 13, 12, 10, 19, 20, 24, 14, 21, 28, 29	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	2, 1, 26, 22, 23, 19, 18, 12, 10, 14, 20, 24, 15, 30, 25, 28	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	1, 2, 4, 11, 23, 19, 18, 20, 15, 14, 21, 24, 25, 16, 30, 28	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	1, 2, 7, 11, 12, 10, 18, 14, 24, 21, 20, 15, 29, 28, 16, 30	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	1, 2, 18, 13, 19, 10, 24, 20, 14, 15, 21, 28, 25, 30, 16, 29	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	2, 1, 13, 12, 11, 19, 14, 20, 24, 21, 15, 28, 30, 25, 16, 29	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Senior	1, 2, 13, 19, 12, 10, 14, 21, 15, 20, 24, 25, 30, 28, 29, 16	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	1, 2, 13, 18, 11, 10, 21, 24, 14, 20, 15, 28, 25, 30, 16, 29	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Dramatis Personae," how does Shakespeare show the divided world of Verona? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Dramatis Personae, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the divided world of Verona? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Dramatis Personae develops the idea of the divided world of Verona. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual

evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Dramatis Personae (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of the divided world of Verona. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Dramatis Personae suggests about the divided world of Verona. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and setting), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Dramatis Personae to complicate the reader's understanding of the divided world of Verona. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Dramatis Personae within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the divided world of Verona responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Dramatis Personae alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the divided world of Verona follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Dramatis Personae and its treatment of the divided world of Verona. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and setting, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Dramatis Personae as evidence for a larger claim about the divided world of Verona in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Dramatis Personae as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the divided world of Verona. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

SAT-style questions

1. *Citizens of Verona; several men and women, relations to both houses; maskers, guards, watchmen, and attendants*

   As used in the text, what does the word "maskers" most nearly mean?

   A. a state of quarrel or disagreement
   B. people in masks and costume who join a party
   C. a male relative
   D. servants who wait on a person of rank

2. *Escalus, prince of Verona*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Dramatis Personae"?

   A. The second Chorus
   B. Romeo hears of Juliet's death
   C. Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard
   D. The divided world of Verona

SAT key: 1. B (people in masks and costume who join a party); 2. D (The divided world of Verona)

Lesson 3: Prologue

Focus: the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold

Objective: Students will summarize what happens in Prologue (the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold) in 2 sentences and, in a 3-sentence warm-up response, explain how one quoted line from the scene sets up the scene that follows.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1

Critical voice: "Yet, instead of unity of action, I should greatly prefer the more appropriate, though scholastic and uncouth, words homogeneity, proportionateness, and totality of interest,--expressions, which involve the distinction, or rather the essential difference, betwixt the shaping skill of mechanical talent, and the creative, productive, life-power of inspired genius." (Samuel Taylor Coleridge, poet and critic, *Notes on Romeo and Juliet, in The Literary Remains of Samuel Taylor Coleridge, Vol. 2 (1836), "Romeo and Juliet" (opening)*; public domain). Structure: the Prologue tells the ending. How does foreknowledge create "totality of interest" instead of spoiling the play? *Objective:* Analyze how the Prologue's sonnet and the play's unified design shape tragic effect. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.5

Content note (suicide (mentioned in lesson text)): This lesson mentions suicide or self-harm. Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol.
Student preview: This lesson mentions suicide.
Suggested language:
Safe messaging: Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this chapter is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

The Chorus speaks a sonnet: two households of equal rank in Verona break out in new violence from an old grudge; from them come a pair of 'star-cross'd lovers' whose deaths end their parents' strife. The play, the Chorus says, will show 'the two hours' traffic of our stage.'

Background: Elizabethan plays sometimes opened with a Chorus or Prologue. The sonnet was the fashionable love-poem form of the 1590s; Shakespeare's own sonnets were circulating among friends by 1598.

Significance: Telling the ending first turns the play from a story of what happens into a study of how and why, and makes every hopeful moment dramatically ironic.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
If you knew how a story would end, would you still want to read it? Why? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and choice because.... If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.
Prompt: If you knew how a story would end, would you still want to read it? Why?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and choice because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: "star-cross'd" and "death-mark'd" suggest fate; ask whether the rest of the play agrees.

8–16 min · Background and context · I do (8 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Elizabethan plays sometimes opened with a Chorus or Prologue. The sonnet was the fashionable love-poem form of the 1590s; Shakespeare's own sonnets were circulating among friends by 1598. Telling the ending first turns the play from a story of what happens into a study of how and why, and makes every hopeful moment dramatically ironic. Structure: The Prologue is a sonnet (fourteen lines, abab cdcd efef gg) spoken by the Chorus: the play opens with a love poem about death. Foreshadowing: It tells the whole ending: the lovers "take their life" and their deaths "bury their parents' strife." Diction / vocabulary: "civil blood makes civil hands unclean": the repeated word turns "civil" (of citizens; polite) against itself. Watch for haste and time: Everything happens too fast: a four-day action, a marriage the day after meeting, a wedding moved up a day; Friar Laurence warns "they stumble that run fast." In this scene: "their children's end, nought could remove, / Is now the two hours' traffic of our stage; / The which if you with patient ears" (Prologue).

16–20 min · Closure · I do (4 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how structure shapes the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold. Key takeaway: "star-cross'd" and "death-mark'd" suggest fate; ask whether the rest of the play agrees.

Total: 20 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Structure:** The Prologue is a sonnet (fourteen lines, abab cdcd efef gg) spoken by the Chorus: the play opens with a love poem about death.
- **Foreshadowing:** It tells the whole ending: the lovers "take their life" and their deaths "bury their parents' strife."
- **Diction / vocabulary:** "civil blood makes civil hands unclean": the repeated word turns "civil" (of citizens; polite) against itself.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and choice:** "star-cross'd" and "death-mark'd" suggest fate; ask whether the rest of the play agrees.

Symbols and motifs

- **haste and time:** Everything happens too fast: a four-day action, a marriage the day after meeting, a wedding moved up a day; Friar Laurence warns "they stumble that run fast." In this scene: “their children’s end, nought could remove, / Is now the two hours’ traffic of our stage; / The which if you with patient ears” (Prologue).
- **death as bridegroom:** Death is repeatedly imagined as Juliet's husband or lover, long before she lies in the tomb. In this scene: “take their life; / Whose misadventured piteous overthrows / Do with their death bury their parents’ strife. / The fearful passage of their death-mark’d love” (Prologue).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Where civil blood makes civil hands unclean” (Prologue) Citizens stain their hands with the blood of fellow citizens.
- “A pair of star-cross’d lovers take their life” (Prologue) The lovers are thwarted by the stars; "take their life" means both "are born" and "kill themselves."
- “Do with their death bury their parents’ strife” (Prologue) The deaths end the feud: the tragedy has a purpose.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: By revealing the ending at the start, the Prologue shifts the audience's attention from what happens to why and how.
Evidence: “A pair of star-cross’d lovers take their life” (Prologue)
Reasoning: The Chorus announces that the "star-cross'd lovers take their life" and that their deaths "bury their parents' strife," so suspense comes from watching choices we know are fatal.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
overthrows (noun)	downfalls; ruinous defeats	*From forth the fatal loins of these two foes A pair of star-cross’d lovers take their life; Whose misadventured piteous overthrows Do with their death bury their parents’ strife.*	“overthrows”: Origin of “overthrow”: an English formation from over- + throw. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/overthrow#Etymology)
households (noun)	families, including their servants and dependents	*Two households, both alike in dignity, In fair Verona, where we lay our scene, From ancient grudge break to new mutiny, Where civil blood makes civil hands unclean.*	

dignity (noun)	high rank and standing in society	*Two households, both alike in dignity, In fair Verona, where we lay our scene, From ancient grudge break to new mutiny, Where civil blood makes civil hands unclean.*	
unclean (adjective)	stained, here with the blood of fellow citizens	*Two households, both alike in dignity, In fair Verona, where we lay our scene, From ancient grudge break to new mutiny, Where civil blood makes civil hands unclean.*	"unclean": Origin: an English formation from un- + clean. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/unclean#Etymology)
piteous (adjective)	deserving pity; pitiful	*From forth the fatal loins of these two foes A pair of star-cross'd lovers take their life; Whose misadventured piteous overthrows Do with their death bury their parents' strife.*	

Discussion questions

1. If you knew how a story would end, would you still want to read it? Why?
2. Where does structure appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate and choice?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does 'star-cross'd' mean? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Thwarted or opposed by the stars, that is, by fate.
2. What form does the Prologue take? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A sonnet
3. Where is the play set? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Fair Verona
4. What does the Prologue say will end the parents' strife? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The lovers' death
5. How does the Prologue describe the two households? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Both alike in dignity
6. How long does the Chorus say the play will last? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Two hours

7. Retell the three most important events of “Prologue” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The Chorus speaks a sonnet: two households of equal rank in Verona break out in new violence from an old grudge; from them come a pair of 'star-cross'd lovers' whose deaths end their parents' strife. The play, the Chorus says, will show 'the two hours' traffic of our stage.'
8. Who is on stage in “Prologue”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Prologue” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “From forth the fatal loins of these two foes A pair of star-cross’d lovers take their life; Whose misadventured piteous overthrows Do with their death bury their parents’ strife.” What does “overthrows” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: overthrows: downfalls; ruinous defeats.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does the Prologue repeat the word 'civil'? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Citizens kill citizens; 'civil' also means polite, so violence makes the civilized unclean.
2. What does “Prologue” suggest about the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Telling the ending first turns the play from a story of what happens into a study of how and why, and makes every hopeful moment dramatically ironic.
3. Find one example of structure in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.
4. How does the foreshadowing in this scene shape what we understand about the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: By revealing the ending at the start, the Prologue shifts the audience's attention from what happens to why and how. Useful evidence: “Where civil blood makes civil hands unclean” (Prologue): Citizens stain their hands with the blood of fellow citizens. On foreshadowing: It tells the whole ending: the lovers "take their life" and their deaths "bury their parents' strife." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Two households, both alike in dignity, In fair Verona, where we lay our scene, From ancient grudge break to new mutiny, Where civil blood makes civil hands unclean.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Prologue”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: The Chorus speaks a sonnet: two households of equal rank in Verona break out in new violence from an old grudge; from them come a pair of 'star-cross'd lovers' whose deaths end their parents' strife. The play, the Chorus says, will show 'the two hours' traffic of our stage.'
7. How does “Prologue” build on “Dramatis Personae”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the

previous scene.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: By revealing the ending at the start, the Prologue shifts the audience's attention from what happens to why and how. Useful evidence: “A pair of star-cross’d lovers take their life” (Prologue): The lovers are thwarted by the stars; "take their life" means both "are born" and "kill themselves." On structure: The Prologue is a sonnet (fourteen lines, abab cdcd efef gg) spoken by the Chorus: the play opens with a love poem about death. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: By revealing the ending at the start, the Prologue shifts the audience's attention from what happens to why and how. Useful evidence: “Do with their death bury their parents’ strife” (Prologue): The deaths end the feud: the tragedy has a purpose. Theme link: "star-cross'd" and "death-mark'd" suggest fate; ask whether the rest of the play agrees. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “If you knew how a story would end, would you still want to read it? Why?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

10. Where does diction / vocabulary appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with fate and choice? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for precise or unusual word choices and their connotations.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: By revealing the ending at the start, the Prologue shifts the audience's attention from what happens to why and how. Useful evidence: “Where civil blood makes civil hands unclean” (Prologue): Citizens stain their hands with the blood of fellow citizens. On diction / vocabulary: "civil blood makes civil hands unclean": the repeated word turns "civil" (of citizens; polite) against itself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Does the Prologue make the lovers victims of fate or of their families? Argue from its wording. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned reading of 'star-cross'd' and 'parents' rage' and 'strife'.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: By revealing the ending at the start, the Prologue shifts the audience's attention from what happens to why and how. Useful evidence: “A pair of star-cross’d lovers take their life” (Prologue): The lovers are thwarted by the stars; "take their life" means both "are born" and "kill themselves." Theme link: "star-cross'd" and "death-mark'd" suggest fate; ask whether the rest of the play agrees. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “Telling the ending first turns the play from a story of what happens into a study of how and why, and makes every hopeful moment dramatically ironic.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: By revealing the ending at the start, the Prologue shifts

the audience's attention from what happens to why and how. Useful evidence: “Do with their death bury their parents’ strife” (Prologue): The deaths end the feud: the tragedy has a purpose. Theme link: "star-cross'd" and "death-mark'd" suggest fate; ask whether the rest of the play agrees. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: By revealing the ending at the start, the Prologue shifts the audience's attention from what happens to why and how. Useful evidence: “Where civil blood makes civil hands unclean” (Prologue): Citizens stain their hands with the blood of fellow citizens. Theme link: "star-cross'd" and "death-mark'd" suggest fate; ask whether the rest of the play agrees. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Prologue”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: By revealing the ending at the start, the Prologue shifts the audience's attention from what happens to why and how. Useful evidence: “A pair of star-cross’d lovers take their life” (Prologue): The lovers are thwarted by the stars; "take their life" means both "are born" and "kill themselves." On structure: The Prologue is a sonnet (fourteen lines, abab cdcd efef gg) spoken by the Chorus: the play opens with a love poem about death. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Prologue”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: By revealing the ending at the start, the Prologue shifts the audience's attention from what happens to why and how. Useful evidence: “Do with their death bury their parents’ strife” (Prologue): The deaths end the feud: the tragedy has a purpose. Theme link: "star-cross'd" and "death-mark'd" suggest fate; ask whether the rest of the play agrees. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to violence and the feud: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: By revealing the ending at the start, the Prologue shifts the audience's attention from what happens to why and how. Useful evidence: “Where civil blood makes civil hands unclean” (Prologue): Citizens stain their hands with the blood of fellow citizens. Theme link: "star-cross'd" and "death-mark'd" suggest fate; ask whether the rest of the play agrees. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the structure in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: By revealing the ending at the start, the Prologue shifts

the audience's attention from what happens to why and how. Useful evidence: “A pair of star-cross’d lovers take their life” (Prologue): The lovers are thwarted by the stars; "take their life" means both "are born" and "kill themselves." On structure: The Prologue is a sonnet (fourteen lines, abab cdcd efef gg) spoken by the Chorus: the play opens with a love poem about death. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Prologue” treats the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: By revealing the ending at the start, the Prologue shifts the audience's attention from what happens to why and how. Useful evidence: “Do with their death bury their parents’ strife” (Prologue): The deaths end the feud: the tragedy has a purpose. Theme link: "star-cross'd" and "death-mark'd" suggest fate; ask whether the rest of the play agrees. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act I, Scene I” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: By revealing the ending at the start, the Prologue shifts the audience's attention from what happens to why and how. Useful evidence: “Where civil blood makes civil hands unclean” (Prologue): Citizens stain their hands with the blood of fellow citizens. On foreshadowing: It tells the whole ending: the lovers "take their life" and their deaths "bury their parents' strife." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: By revealing the ending at the start, the Prologue shifts the audience's attention from what happens to why and how. Useful evidence: “A pair of star-cross’d lovers take their life” (Prologue): The lovers are thwarted by the stars; "take their life" means both "are born" and "kill themselves." Theme link: "star-cross'd" and "death-mark'd" suggest fate; ask whether the rest of the play agrees. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Structure:** look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events
- Also notice **Diction / vocabulary**: precise or unusual word choices and their connotations

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does the Prologue describe the two households?

   A. Both alike in dignity

   B. One rich, one poor

C. Newly arrived

D. Old friends

Key: A (Both alike in dignity)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “From forth the fatal loins of these two foes A pair of star-cross’d lovers take their life; Whose misadventured piteous overthrows Do with their death bury their parents’ strife.”, what does “overthrows” most nearly mean?

   A. a person who trains and flies hawks

   B. telling one's sins to a priest

   C. downfalls; ruinous defeats

   D. having sworn to give something up

   Key: C (downfalls; ruinous defeats)

3. [short · recall · DOK 1] What does 'star-cross'd' mean?

   Sample answer: Thwarted or opposed by the stars, that is, by fate.

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where is the play set?

   A. Rome

   B. Mantua alone

   C. London

   D. Fair Verona

   Key: D (Fair Verona)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Two households, both alike in dignity, In fair Verona, where we lay our scene, From ancient grudge break to new mutiny, Where civil blood makes civil hands unclean.”, what does “dignity” most nearly mean?

   A. high rank and standing in society

   B. a man of noble rank

   C. plots; works together

   D. lands; domains

   Key: A (high rank and standing in society)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Prologue: “A pair of star-cross’d _____ take their life”

   Key: lovers

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How long does the Chorus say the play will last?

   A. Three hours

   B. Two hours

   C. An evening and a morning

   D. One day

   Key: B (Two hours)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What form does the Prologue take?

   A. A sonnet

   B. A letter

   C. A song in prose

   D. A ballad

Key: A (A sonnet)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Prologue: “Do with their death bury their _____’ strife”

   Key: parents

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Prologue”?

    A. The Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold

    B. Capulet sets the wedding to Paris

    C. Friar Laurence agrees to marry them

    D. The second Chorus

    Key: A (The Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold)

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “A pair of star-cross’d lovers take their life” (Prologue)

    A. The lovers are thwarted by the stars; "take their life" means both "are born" and "kill themselves."

    B. Juliet's sharp answer to Paris.

    C. Lady Capulet's book metaphor for a husband.

    D. Juliet discovers Romeo is a Montague.

    Key: A (The lovers are thwarted by the stars; "take their life" means both "are born" and "kill themselves.")

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Where civil blood makes civil hands unclean” (Prologue)

    A. The conflict is built into the cast list.

    B. Citizens stain their hands with the blood of fellow citizens.

    C. Romeo's premonition.

    D. Capulet asks Paris to wait.

    Key: B (Citizens stain their hands with the blood of fellow citizens.)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “A pair of star-cross’d lovers take their life” (Prologue) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The lovers are thwarted by the stars; "take their life" means both "are born" and "kill themselves."

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Do with their death bury their parents’ strife” (Prologue). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: The deaths end the feud: the tragedy has a purpose.

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Prologue”? The Prologue is a sonnet (fourteen lines, abab cdcd efef gg) spoken by the Chorus: the play opens with a love poem about death.

    A. Setting

    B. Structure

    C. Imagery

    D. Personification

    Key: B (Structure)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how fate and choice develops from an earlier scene to “Prologue”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: "star-cross'd" and "death-mark'd" suggest fate; ask whether the rest of the play agrees.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Two households, both alike in dignity, In fair Verona, where we lay our scene, From ancient grudge break to new mutiny, Where civil blood makes civil hands unclean.”, what does “unclean” most nearly mean?

    A. fills with doubt and foreboding

    B. stained, here with the blood of fellow citizens

    C. weeping noisily

    D. a place of suffering before heaven

    Key: B (stained, here with the blood of fellow citizens)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Prologue: “Where civil blood makes civil hands _____”

    Key: unclean

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Two households, both alike in dignity, In fair Verona, where we lay our scene, From ancient grudge break to new mutiny, Where civil blood makes civil hands unclean.”, what does “households” most nearly mean?

    A. wandering about idly

    B. a soft dressing applied to soothe pain

    C. whims; also quarter notes in music

    D. families, including their servants and dependents

    Key: D (families, including their servants and dependents)

20. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does the Prologue repeat the word 'civil'?

    Sample answer: Citizens kill citizens; 'civil' also means polite, so violence makes the civilized unclean.

21. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Where civil blood makes civil hands unclean” (Prologue) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Citizens stain their hands with the blood of fellow citizens.

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? "star-cross'd" and "death-mark'd" suggest fate; ask whether the rest of the play agrees.

    A. Violence and the feud

    B. Love and desire

    C. Youth and age

    D. Fate and choice

    Key: D (Fate and choice)

23. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Does the Prologue make the lovers victims of fate or of their families? Argue from its wording.

    Sample answer: A reasoned reading of 'star-cross'd' and 'parents' rage' and 'strife'.

24. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “From forth the fatal loins of these two foes A pair of star-cross’d lovers take their life; Whose misadventured _____ overthrows Do with their death bury their parents’ strife.” Word bank: dignity, piteous, households, overthrows

    Key: piteous

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does the Prologue say will end the parents' strife?

    A. A marriage treaty

    B. A duel

    C. The Prince's law

D. The lovers' death

Key: D (The lovers' death)

26. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Do with their death bury their parents’ strife” (Prologue)

A. The deaths end the feud: the tragedy has a purpose.

B. Oxymorons express shock at Romeo's act.

C. Capulet offers Juliet impulsively.

D. Juliet's sharp answer to Paris.

Key: A (The deaths end the feud: the tragedy has a purpose.)

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: By revealing the ending at the start, the Prologue shifts the audience's attention from what happens to why and how. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “A pair of star-cross’d lovers take their life” (Prologue).

Sample answer: The Chorus announces that the "star-cross'd lovers take their life" and that their deaths "bury their parents' strife," so suspense comes from watching choices we know are fatal.

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Prologue”? It tells the whole ending: the lovers "take their life" and their deaths "bury their parents' strife."

A. Personification

B. Point of view

C. Foreshadowing

D. Theme

Key: C (Foreshadowing)

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Where civil blood makes civil hands unclean” (Prologue) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Citizens stain their hands with the blood of fellow citizens.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “By revealing the ending at the start, the Prologue shifts the audience's attention from what happens to why and how.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: The Chorus announces that the "star-cross'd lovers take their life" and that their deaths "bury their parents' strife," so suspense comes from watching choices we know are fatal.

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “A pair of star-cross’d lovers take their life” (Prologue) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: The lovers are thwarted by the stars; "take their life" means both "are born" and "kill themselves."

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	4, 1, 6, 5, 17, 18, 2, 19, 13, 11, 20, 21, 14, 22, 15, 23	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	5, 18, 19, 24, 8, 25, 21, 20, 12, 26, 13, 27, 28, 22, 23, 29	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	24, 18, 19, 25, 4, 12, 13, 20, 10, 21, 15, 22, 27, 14, 29, 30	

		recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	25, 6, 24, 3, 26, 21, 20, 12, 10, 28, 22, 14, 27, 29, 23, 16	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	24, 18, 17, 13, 11, 21, 20, 27, 15, 14, 22, 28, 30, 16, 23, 29	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	24, 18, 25, 20, 11, 21, 10, 15, 27, 28, 14, 22, 29, 16, 31, 30	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	24, 18, 12, 11, 13, 20, 15, 22, 27, 14, 28, 31, 23, 16, 29, 30	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	24, 18, 11, 21, 10, 12, 14, 15, 22, 27, 28, 23, 29, 31, 16, 30	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Senior	9, 24, 12, 26, 20, 10, 22, 27, 28, 14, 15, 23, 29, 16, 31, 30	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	6, 24, 10, 20, 12, 11, 22, 28, 14, 27, 15, 23, 31, 16, 29, 30	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Prologue,” how does Shakespeare show the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the structure you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In Prologue, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the structure in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Prologue develops the idea of the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Prologue (where it begins, turns and ends) and its structure shape the reader's understanding of the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Prologue suggests about the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's structure and foreshadowing), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses structure in Prologue to complicate the reader's understanding of the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Prologue within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Prologue alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold follows or bends those conventions, using the structure as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Prologue and its treatment of the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's structure and foreshadowing, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Prologue as evidence for a larger claim about the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Prologue as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

SAT-style questions

1. *From forth the fatal loins of these two foes A pair of star-cross'd lovers take their life; Whose misadventured piteous overthrows Do with their death bury their parents' strife.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "overthrows" most nearly mean?

   A. deserving pity; pitiful

   B. high rank and standing in society

   C. stained, here with the blood of fellow citizens

   D. downfalls; ruinous defeats

2. *Two households, both alike in dignity, In fair Verona, where we lay our scene, From ancient grudge break to new mutiny, Where civil blood makes civil hands unclean. From forth the fatal loins of these two foes A pair of star-cross'd lovers take their life; Whose misadventured piteous overthrows Do with their death bury their parents' strife. The fearful passage of their death-mark'd love, And the continuance of their parents' rage,*

Which, but their children's end, nought could remove, Is now the two hours' traffic of our stage; The which if you with patient ears attend, What here shall miss, our toil shall strive to mend.

Which choice best states a central concern of "Prologue"?

A. The Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold

B. Wedding preparations

C. The divided world of Verona

D. The undelivered letter

SAT key: 1. D (downfalls; ruinous defeats); 2. A (The Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold)

Lesson 4: Act I, Scene I

Focus: the street brawl and lovesick Romeo

Objective: Students will analyze how conflict develops in "Act I, Scene I" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Critical voice: "Rosaline was a mere creation of his fancy; and we should remark the boastful positiveness of Romeo in a love of his own making, which is never shown where love is really near the heart." (Samuel Taylor Coleridge, poet and critic, *Notes on Romeo and Juliet, in The Literary Remains of Samuel Taylor Coleridge, Vol. 2 (1836), note on Act I*; public domain). Compare Romeo's oxymorons in I.i with his language at the feast in I.v. Which sounds like "a love of his own making"? *Objective:* Analyze lovesick Romeo and his love for Rosaline. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.3

Content note (sexual innuendo, street violence): Sampson and Gregory open with sexual puns about Montague women, then a street brawl. Gloss the puns briefly as threats of violence; do not have students perform them.
Student preview: The scene opens with crude jokes and a street fight.
Suggested language: "What do the servants' jokes show about how the feud treats women?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Capulet servants Sampson and Gregory provoke Montague servants; Benvolio tries to part them, Tybalt attacks him, and a general brawl draws in citizens and the old heads of both houses. Prince Escalus stops it and decrees death for the next disturbance. Benvolio then finds Romeo moping: he loves Rosaline, who has sworn to stay chaste.

Background: Elizabethan London had laws against brawling and carrying weapons in the streets; 'biting the thumb' was an insulting gesture. Petrarchan love poetry (after the Italian poet Petrarch) described a lover suffering for a cold, unattainable lady, exactly Romeo's pose.

Significance: The scene establishes the feud's absurd energy, the Prince's death sentence that will make Romeo's later fight fatal, and Romeo's habit of falling in love with language as much as with a person.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What makes small insults turn into big fights? Think of an example from school or the news. Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to violence and the feud because.... Content note before we start: The scene opens with crude jokes and a street fight.
Prompt: What makes small insults turn into big fights? Think of an example from school or the news.
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to violence and the feud because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the Prince's death threat makes the next brawl a capital matter.

8–13 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (5 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: colliers — coal-sellers, a byword for dirty, insulted men; assailing — attacking, here with admiring looks; propagate — increase; make (grief) multiply; partisans — long-handled spears with broad blades; bucklers — small round shields. "colliers": Origin of "collier": an English formation from coal + -ier. "bucklers": Origin of "buckler": Old French bocler; earlier Latin buccula ("boss").
Words: colliers: coal-sellers, a byword for dirty, insulted men · assailing: attacking, here with admiring looks · propagate: increase; make (grief) multiply · partisans: long-handled spears with broad blades · bucklers: small round shields

13–18 min · Background and context · I do (5 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Elizabethan London had laws against brawling and carrying weapons in the streets; 'biting the thumb' was an insulting gesture. Petrarchan love poetry (after the Italian poet Petrarch) described a lover suffering for a cold, unattainable lady, exactly Romeo's pose. The scene establishes the feud's absurd energy, the Prince's death sentence that will make Romeo's later fight fatal, and Romeo's habit of falling in love with language as much as with a person. Conflict: A servants' quarrel over a bitten thumb becomes a street brawl involving the masters, the citizens and finally the Prince. Characterization: Benvolio tries to keep the peace; Tybalt, asked to keep the peace, says "I hate the word, / As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee"; Romeo is lovesick for Rosaline. Diction / vocabulary: Romeo's oxymorons ("O brawling love! O loving hate!") show a lover in love with the language of love. Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "Madam, an hour before the worshipp'd sun / Peer'd forth the golden window of the east, / A troubled mind" (Act I, Scene I, Benvolio).

18–25 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (7 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "I hate the word, / As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee" slowly and put it in my own words: Drawing his sword on Benvolio, who is trying to keep the peace, Tybalt says he hates the word peace as he hates hell, all Montagues and Benvolio. Next, craft. I notice the list of three hated things, building from a word to a whole family to one man. The strongest word is "hate": it is repeated, which shows that hatred defines him. Then, effect. What does Tybalt's line show about him and the feud? My answer: Tybalt is the feud's most violent voice; he rejects peace itself, so we see that he will be the spark that turns the lovers' story to tragedy.

> *I hate the word, / As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee* (Act I, Scene I, Tybalt)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "I hate the word, / As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee" slowly and put it in my own words: Drawing his sword on Benvolio, who is trying to keep the peace, Tybalt says he hates the word peace as he hates hell, all Montagues and Benvolio. Next, craft. I notice the list of three hated things, building from a word to a whole family to one man. The strongest word is "hate": it is repeated, which shows that hatred defines him. Then, effect. What does Tybalt's line show about him and the feud? My answer: Tybalt is the feud's most violent voice; he rejects peace itself, so we see that he will be the spark that turns the lovers' story to tragedy.

25–30 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (5 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: An oxymoron joins opposites ("loving hate"). Romeo's love for Rosaline is confused and showy, and the opposites echo the brawl he has just missed. Expected link: love and desire. Ask: How does this line connect to violence and the feud? Expected: The Prince's death threat makes the next brawl a capital matter. (Romeo's oxymorons link love and the feud in one phrase.)

> *O brawling love! O loving hate* (Act I, Scene I, Romeo)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: An oxymoron joins opposites ("loving hate"). Romeo's love for Rosaline is confused and showy, and the opposites echo the brawl he has just missed. Expected link: love and desire.
Ask: How does this line connect to violence and the feud?
Expected answer: The Prince's death threat makes the next brawl a capital matter. (Romeo's oxymorons link love and the feud in one phrase.)

30–35 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (5 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for conflict, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the street brawl and lovesick Romeo? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene I develops the idea of the street brawl and lovesick Romeo. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause. When the text says “If ever you disturb our streets again, / Your lives shall pay the forfeit of the peace” (Act I, Scene I, Prince), it shows this directly. The fight begins with a bitten thumb, and Tybalt says he hates "peace" "As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee," while the Prince warns that "Your lives shall pay the forfeit of the peace."
Task: Annotate the scene for conflict, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the street brawl and lovesick Romeo? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene I develops the idea of the street brawl and lovesick Romeo. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause. When the text says “If ever you disturb our streets again, / Your lives shall pay the forfeit of the peace” (Act I, Scene I, Prince), it shows this directly. The fight begins with a bitten thumb, and Tybalt says he hates "peace" "As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee," while the Prince warns that "Your lives shall pay the forfeit of the peace."

35–40 min · Discussion · We do (5 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What makes small insults turn into big fights? Think of an example from school or the news. Ask: who is most responsible for the brawl? Have students rank the participants and defend their order.
Anchor question: What makes small insults turn into big fights? Think of an example from school or the news.
Facilitation: Ask: who is most responsible for the brawl? Have students rank the participants and defend their order.

40–47 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the street brawl and lovesick Romeo? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause. ("If ever you disturb our streets again, / Your lives shall pay the forfeit of the peace", Act I, Scene I, Prince). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the street brawl and lovesick Romeo? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause. ("If ever you disturb our streets again, / Your lives shall pay the forfeit of the peace", Act I, Scene I, Prince). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

47–50 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how conflict shapes the street brawl and lovesick Romeo. Key takeaway: the Prince's death threat makes the next brawl a capital matter.

Total: 50 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Conflict:** A servants' quarrel over a bitten thumb becomes a street brawl involving the masters, the citizens and finally the Prince.
- **Characterization:** Benvolio tries to keep the peace; Tybalt, asked to keep the peace, says "I hate the word, / As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee"; Romeo is lovesick for Rosaline.
- **Diction / vocabulary:** Romeo's oxymorons ("O brawling love! O loving hate!") show a lover in love with the language of love.

Themes and how they develop

- **violence and the feud:** the Prince's death threat makes the next brawl a capital matter.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “Madam, an hour before the worshipp’d sun / Peer’d forth the golden window of the east, / A troubled mind” (Act I, Scene I, Benvolio).
- **haste and time:** Everything happens too fast: a four-day action, a marriage the day after meeting, a wedding moved up a day; Friar Laurence warns "they stumble that run fast." In this scene: “Madam, an hour before the worshipp’d sun / Peer’d forth the golden window of the” (Act I, Scene I, Benvolio).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “I hate the word, / As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee” (Act I, Scene I, Tybalt) Tybalt's first speech: hatred for its own sake.
- “If ever you disturb our streets again, / Your lives shall pay the forfeit of the peace” (Act I, Scene I, Prince) The Prince's law: the next fight will cost lives.
- “O brawling love! O loving hate” (Act I, Scene I, Romeo) Romeo's oxymorons link love and the feud in one phrase.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause.
Evidence: “If ever you disturb our streets again, / Your lives shall pay the forfeit of the peace” (Act I, Scene I, Prince)
Reasoning: The fight begins with a bitten thumb, and Tybalt says he hates "peace" "As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee," while the Prince warns that "Your lives shall pay the forfeit of the peace."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
colliers (noun)	coal-sellers, a byword for dirty, insulted men	*No, for then we should be colliers.*	“colliers”: Origin of “collier”: an English formation from coal + -ier. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/collier#Etymology)
assailing (adjective)	attacking, here with admiring looks	*She will not stay the siege of loving terms, Nor bide the encounter of assailing eyes, Nor ope her lap to saint-seducing gold: O, she is rich in beauty, only poor, That when she dies with beauty dies her store.*	
propagate (verb)	increase; make (grief) multiply	*Griefs of mine own lie heavy in my breast, Which thou wilt propagate, to have it prest With more of thine: this love that thou hast shown Doth add more grief to too much of mine own.*	

partisans (noun)	long-handled spears with broad blades	*Clubs, bills, and partisans! strike! beat them down!*	
bucklers (noun)	small round shields	*Enter Sampson and Gregory, of the house of Capulet, armed with swords and bucklers.*	"bucklers": Origin of "buckler": Old French bocler; earlier Latin buccula ("boss"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/buckler#Etymology)
flourishes (verb)	waves (a weapon) about in a showy way	*Old Montague is come, And flourishes his blade in spite of me.*	
grievance (noun)	the cause of his complaint or sorrow	*See, where he comes: so please you, step aside; I'll know his grievance, or be much denied.*	
valiant (adjective)	brave; courageous	*To move is to stir; and to be valiant is to stand: therefore, if thou art moved, thou runn'st away.*	"valiant": Origin: Anglo-Norman vaillaunt; earlier Latin valēre ("to have value"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/valiant#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. What makes small insults turn into big fights? Think of an example from school or the news.
2. Where does conflict appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with violence and the feud?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Who first draws on Benvolio? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Tybalt, who says he hates peace as he hates hell.
2. Which house do Sampson and Gregory serve? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Capulet
3. What insulting gesture starts the quarrel? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Biting the thumb
4. What does the Prince decree for the next brawl? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Death

5. Who tries to keep the peace? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Benvolio
6. Whom does Romeo love at the start? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Rosaline
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act I, Scene I" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Capulet servants Sampson and Gregory provoke Montague servants; Benvolio tries to part them, Tybalt attacks him, and a general brawl draws in citizens and the old heads of both houses. Prince Escalus stops it and decrees death for the next disturbance. Benvolio then finds Romeo moping: he loves Rosaline, who has sworn to stay chaste.
8. Who is on stage in "Act I, Scene I", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act I, Scene I" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "No, for then we should be colliers." What does "colliers" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: colliers: coal-sellers, a byword for dirty, insulted men.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Shakespeare open with servants and puns before the masters appear? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: To show the feud filtering down to every level and to mix comedy with menace.
2. What does "Act I, Scene I" suggest about the street brawl and lovesick Romeo? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The scene establishes the feud's absurd energy, the Prince's death sentence that will make Romeo's later fight fatal, and Romeo's habit of falling in love with language as much as with a person.
3. Find one example of conflict in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the street brawl and lovesick Romeo? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause. Useful evidence: "I hate the word, / As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee" (Act I, Scene I, Tybalt): Tybalt's first speech: hatred for its own sake. On characterization: Benvolio tries to keep the peace; Tybalt, asked to keep the peace, says "I hate the word, / As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee"; Romeo is lovesick for Rosaline. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "Why, such is love's transgression.", why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "Act I, Scene I", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Capulet servants Sampson and Gregory provoke Montague

servants; Benvolio tries to part them, Tybalt attacks him, and a general brawl draws in citizens and the old heads of both houses. Prince Escalus stops it and decrees death for the next disturbance. Benvolio then finds Romeo moping: he loves…

7. How does “Act I, Scene I” build on “Prologue”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause. Useful evidence: “If ever you disturb our streets again, / Your lives shall pay the forfeit of the peace” (Act I, Scene I, Prince): The Prince's law: the next fight will cost lives. Theme link: the Prince's death threat makes the next brawl a capital matter. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause. Useful evidence: “O brawling love! O loving hate” (Act I, Scene I, Romeo): Romeo's oxymorons link love and the feud in one phrase. On characterization: Benvolio tries to keep the peace; Tybalt, asked to keep the peace, says "I hate the word, / As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee"; Romeo is lovesick for Rosaline. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “What makes small insults turn into big fights? Think of an example from school or the news.” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does diction / vocabulary appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with violence and the feud? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for precise or unusual word choices and their connotations.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause. Useful evidence: “I hate the word, / As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee” (Act I, Scene I, Tybalt): Tybalt's first speech: hatred for its own sake. On diction / vocabulary: Romeo's oxymorons ("O brawling love! O loving hate!") show a lover in love with the language of love. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Romeo's love for Rosaline real love? Use his oxymorons as evidence. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment on Petrarchan posing versus feeling.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause. Useful evidence: “If ever you disturb our streets again, / Your lives shall pay the forfeit of the peace” (Act I, Scene I, Prince): The Prince's law: the next fight will cost lives. Theme link: the Prince's death threat makes the next brawl a capital matter. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The scene establishes the feud's absurd energy, the Prince's death sentence that will make Romeo's later fight fatal, and Romeo's habit of falling in love with language as much as with a person.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 ·

fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause. Useful evidence: “O brawling love! O loving hate” (Act I, Scene I, Romeo): Romeo's oxymorons link love and the feud in one phrase. Theme link: the Prince's death threat makes the next brawl a capital matter. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause. Useful evidence: “I hate the word, / As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee” (Act I, Scene I, Tybalt): Tybalt's first speech: hatred for its own sake. On characterization: Benvolio tries to keep the peace; Tybalt, asked to keep the peace, says "I hate the word, / As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee"; Romeo is lovesick for Rosaline. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act I, Scene I”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the street brawl and lovesick Romeo. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause. Useful evidence: “If ever you disturb our streets again, / Your lives shall pay the forfeit of the peace” (Act I, Scene I, Prince): The Prince's law: the next fight will cost lives. Theme link: the Prince's death threat makes the next brawl a capital matter. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act I, Scene I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause. Useful evidence: “O brawling love! O loving hate” (Act I, Scene I, Romeo): Romeo's oxymorons link love and the feud in one phrase. Theme link: the Prince's death threat makes the next brawl a capital matter. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to youth and age: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause. Useful evidence: “I hate the word, / As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee” (Act I, Scene I, Tybalt): Tybalt's first speech: hatred for its own sake. Theme link: the Prince's death threat makes the next brawl a capital matter. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the conflict in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause. Useful evidence: "If ever you disturb our streets again, / Your lives shall pay the forfeit of the peace" (Act I, Scene I, Prince): The Prince's law: the next fight will cost lives. On conflict: A servants' quarrel over a bitten thumb becomes a street brawl involving the masters, the citizens and finally the Prince. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how "Act I, Scene I" treats the street brawl and lovesick Romeo with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause. Useful evidence: "O brawling love! O loving hate" (Act I, Scene I, Romeo): Romeo's oxymorons link love and the feud in one phrase. Theme link: the Prince's death threat makes the next brawl a capital matter. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what "Act I, Scene II" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause. Useful evidence: "I hate the word, / As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee" (Act I, Scene I, Tybalt): Tybalt's first speech: hatred for its own sake. Theme link: the Prince's death threat makes the next brawl a capital matter. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the street brawl and lovesick Romeo? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause. Useful evidence: "If ever you disturb our streets again, / Your lives shall pay the forfeit of the peace" (Act I, Scene I, Prince): The Prince's law: the next fight will cost lives. Theme link: the Prince's death threat makes the next brawl a capital matter. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Conflict:** look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Diction / vocabulary**: precise or unusual word choices and their connotations

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which house do Sampson and Gregory serve?

   A. Paris

   B. Capulet

   C. Montague

D. The Prince

Key: B (Capulet)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does the Prince decree for the next brawl?

   A. Imprisonment

   B. Banishment

   C. Death

   D. A fine

   Key: C (Death)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “To move is to stir; and to be _____ is to stand: therefore, if thou art moved, thou runn’st away.” Word bank: valiant, colliers, propagate, assailing

   Key: valiant

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “No, for then we should be colliers.”, what does “colliers” most nearly mean?

   A. coal-sellers, a byword for dirty, insulted men

   B. a mythical serpent that could kill with a look

   C. commands

   D. ask earnestly

   Key: A (coal-sellers, a byword for dirty, insulted men)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “She will not stay the siege of loving terms, Nor bide the encounter of assailing eyes, Nor ope her lap to saint-seducing gold: O, she is rich in beauty, only poor, That when she dies with beauty dies her store.”, what does “assailing” most nearly mean?

   A. draws out (as vapour)

   B. dark and threatening

   C. attacking, here with admiring looks

   D. a worthless creature

   Key: C (attacking, here with admiring looks)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Old Montague is come, And _____ his blade in spite of me.” Word bank: flourishes, propagate, colliers, assailing

   Key: flourishes

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “See, where he comes: so please you, step aside; I’ll know his _____, or be much denied.” Word bank: colliers, grievance, assailing, propagate

   Key: grievance

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Griefs of mine own lie heavy in my breast, Which thou wilt propagate, to have it prest With more of thine: this love that thou hast shown Doth add more grief to too much of mine own.”, what does “propagate” most nearly mean?

   A. the Nurse's mistake for "sentence," a wise saying

   B. full of grief; woeful

   C. increase; make (grief) multiply

   D. one who forgives sins

   Key: C (increase; make (grief) multiply)

9. [short · recall · DOK 1] Who first draws on Benvolio?
   Sample answer: Tybalt, who says he hates peace as he hates hell.
10. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does Shakespeare open with servants and puns before the masters appear?
    Sample answer: To show the feud filtering down to every level and to mix comedy with menace.
11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I hate the word, / As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee” (Act I, Scene I, Tybalt)
    A. Romeo sets the wedding plan.
    B. Tybalt's first speech: hatred for its own sake.
    C. Capulet's lament.
    D. The Nurse delivers the news.

    Key: B (Tybalt's first speech: hatred for its own sake.)
12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “O brawling love! O loving hate” (Act I, Scene I, Romeo)
    A. Romeo's oxymorons link love and the feud in one phrase.
    B. Capulet now assumes obedience.
    C. Mercutio's joke: love is blind, so it suits the night.
    D. The marriage is fixed in haste.

    Key: A (Romeo's oxymorons link love and the feud in one phrase.)
13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act I, Scene I”?
    A. The street brawl and lovesick Romeo
    B. Juliet's feigned obedience
    C. The divided world of Verona
    D. Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition

    Key: A (The street brawl and lovesick Romeo)
14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “If ever you disturb our streets again, / Your lives shall pay the forfeit of the peace” (Act I, Scene I, Prince).
    Sample answer: The fight begins with a bitten thumb, and Tybalt says he hates "peace" "As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee," while the Prince warns that "Your lives shall pay the forfeit of the peace."
15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act I, Scene I”? A servants' quarrel over a bitten thumb becomes a street brawl involving the masters, the citizens and finally the Prince.
    A. Simile
    B. Characterization
    C. Setting
    D. Conflict

    Key: D (Conflict)
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how violence and the feud develops from an earlier scene to “Act I, Scene I”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: the Prince's death threat makes the next brawl a capital matter.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene I, Tybalt: “I hate the word, / As I hate hell, all _____, and thee”

    Key: Montagues

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene I, Prince: “If ever you _____ our streets again, / Your lives shall pay the forfeit of the peace”

    Key: disturb

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Clubs, bills, and partisans! strike! beat them down!”, what does “partisans” most nearly mean?

    A. accuse

    B. happening too soon; premature

    C. long-handled spears with broad blades

    D. a mythical serpent that could kill with a look

    Key: C (long-handled spears with broad blades)

20. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene I, Romeo: “O _____ love! O loving hate”

    Key: brawling

21. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “If ever you disturb our streets again, / Your lives shall pay the forfeit of the peace” (Act I, Scene I, Prince) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The Prince's law: the next fight will cost lives.

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act I, Scene I”? Benvolio tries to keep the peace; Tybalt, asked to keep the peace, says "I hate the word, / As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee"; Romeo is lovesick for Rosaline.

    A. Tone / mood

    B. Alliteration

    C. Conflict

    D. Characterization

    Key: D (Characterization)

23. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: The fight begins with a bitten thumb, and Tybalt says he hates "peace" "As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee," while the Prince warns that "Your lives shall pay the forfeit of the peace."

24. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Enter Sampson and Gregory, of the house of Capulet, armed with swords and _____.” Word bank: assailing, colliers, bucklers, propagate

    Key: bucklers

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Whom does Romeo love at the start?

    A. Livia

    B. Juliet

    C. Helena

    D. Rosaline

    Key: D (Rosaline)

26. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “If ever you disturb our streets again, / Your lives shall pay the forfeit of the peace” (Act I, Scene I, Prince)

    A. Capulet now assumes obedience.

    B. Mercutio stands between the Prince's family and the Montagues.

    C. The Prince's law: the next fight will cost lives.

    D. Capulet's greeting.

    Key: C (The Prince's law: the next fight will cost lives.)

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “O brawling love! O loving hate” (Act I, Scene I, Romeo). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Romeo's oxymorons link love and the feud in one phrase.

28. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What insulting gesture starts the quarrel?

    A. Biting the thumb

    B. Throwing a glove

    C. Spitting

    D. Drawing a sword

    Key: A (Biting the thumb)

29. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who tries to keep the peace?

    A. Benvolio

    B. Tybalt

    C. Sampson

    D. Capulet

    Key: A (Benvolio)

30. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? The Prince's death threat makes the next brawl a capital matter.

    A. Love and desire

    B. Youth and age

    C. Violence and the feud

    D. Fate and choice

    Key: C (Violence and the feud)

31. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “I hate the word, / As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee” (Act I, Scene I, Tybalt) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Tybalt's first speech: hatred for its own sake.

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I hate the word, / As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee” (Act I, Scene I, Tybalt) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Tybalt's first speech: hatred for its own sake.

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “If ever you disturb our streets again, / Your lives shall pay the forfeit of the peace” (Act I, Scene I, Prince) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The Prince's law: the next fight will cost lives.

34. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is Romeo's love for Rosaline real love? Use his oxymorons as evidence.
    Sample answer: A judgment on Petrarchan posing versus feeling.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 18, 6, 19, 3, 2, 20, 4, 12, 13, 21, 10, 14, 22, 15, 23	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	24, 9, 25, 5, 20, 4, 13, 10, 26, 21, 12, 15, 14, 27, 23, 16	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	24, 17, 28, 19, 29, 12, 13, 21, 26, 10, 15, 30, 27, 22, 23, 16	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	24, 6, 5, 4, 11, 21, 12, 26, 31, 15, 30, 27, 14, 23, 32, 33	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	20, 9, 24, 13, 26, 21, 12, 14, 27, 30, 22, 15, 23, 16, 32, 33	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	24, 28, 20, 11, 31, 12, 26, 14, 15, 27, 30, 22, 23, 16, 33, 34	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	24, 6, 12, 21, 31, 10, 30, 27, 14, 15, 22, 32, 33, 16, 23, 34	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	24, 6, 31, 11, 12, 26, 22, 14, 30, 27, 15, 23, 34, 33, 32, 16	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Senior	17, 24, 13, 11, 31, 26, 15, 30, 14, 27, 22, 16, 33, 23, 32, 34	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	24, 6, 11, 12, 13, 21, 15, 27, 14, 30, 22, 32, 33, 16, 34, 23	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act I, Scene I,” how does Shakespeare show the street brawl and lovesick Romeo? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the conflict you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act I, Scene I, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the street brawl and lovesick Romeo? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the conflict in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act I, Scene I develops the idea of the street brawl and lovesick Romeo. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its conflict shape the reader's understanding of the street brawl and lovesick Romeo. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene I suggests about the street brawl and lovesick Romeo. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's conflict and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses conflict in Act I, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of the street brawl and lovesick Romeo. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act I, Scene I within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the street brawl and lovesick Romeo responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act I, Scene I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the street brawl and lovesick Romeo follows or bends those conventions, using the conflict as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act I, Scene I and its treatment of the street brawl and lovesick Romeo. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's conflict and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act I, Scene I as evidence for a larger claim about the street brawl and lovesick Romeo in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act I, Scene I as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the street brawl and lovesick Romeo. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

SAT-style questions

1. *Griefs of mine own lie heavy in my breast, Which thou wilt propagate, to have it prest With more of thine: this love that thou hast shown Doth add more grief to too much of mine own.*

As used in the text, what does the word "propagate" most nearly mean?

A. increase; make (grief) multiply

B. brave; courageous

C. the cause of his complaint or sorrow

D. waves (a weapon) about in a showy way

2. *Why, such is love's transgression. Griefs of mine own lie heavy in my breast, Which thou wilt propagate, to have it prest With more of thine: this love that thou hast shown Doth add more grief to too much of mine own. Love is a smoke raised with the fume of sighs; Being purged, a fire sparkling in lovers' eyes; Being vex'd, a sea nourish'd with lovers' tears: What is it else? a madness most discreet, A choking gall and a preserving sweet. Farewell, my coz.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act I, Scene I"?

A. The Friar's desperate plan

B. The street brawl and lovesick Romeo

C. Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard

D. Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition

SAT key: 1. A (increase; make (grief) multiply); 2. B (The street brawl and lovesick Romeo)

Lesson 5: Act I, Scene II

Focus: Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in “Act I, Scene II” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (alcohol): Alcohol: period drinking appears as social custom (wine at feasts, toasts or 'healths') and as a restorative (aqua vitae, i.e. brandy or spirits). Name it plainly; don't glamorize it. Peter's invitation ends 'come and crush a cup of wine'.
Student preview: This scene mentions drinking wine at a party.
Suggested language: “What does the invitation tell us about the Capulet feast?”

Teacher only · spoilers

Capulet tells Paris that Juliet is too young to marry but invites him to woo her at that night's feast; her consent will count. A servant who cannot read the guest list asks Romeo for help, and Romeo learns Rosaline will attend. Benvolio urges him to go and compare her with other beauties.

Background: In the 1590s aristocratic marriages were often arranged for property and alliance; legally, girls could marry at twelve, but most English women married in their mid-twenties. Literacy among servants was limited.

Significance: Chance (an illiterate servant) brings Romeo to the Capulet house; Capulet's stated respect for Juliet's consent sets up his later betrayal.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Should parents have a say in whom their children marry? How much? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to youth and age because.... Content note before we start: This scene mentions drinking wine at a party.
Prompt: Should parents have a say in whom their children marry? How much?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to youth and age because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Capulet says Juliet is too young ("She hath not seen the change of fourteen years"), a view he will abandon.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: plantain — a common weed whose leaf was used to treat cuts; heretics — people who abandon the true faith; here, eyes that betray their first love; falsehood — lying; being untrue; tormented — caused great suffering to; reckoning — reputation; standing. "reckoning": Origin: an English formation from reckon + -ing.
Words: plantain: a common weed whose leaf was used to treat cuts · heretics: people who abandon the true faith; here, eyes that betray their first love · falsehood: lying; being untrue · tormented: caused great suffering to · reckoning: reputation; standing

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
In the 1590s aristocratic marriages were often arranged for property and alliance; legally, girls could marry at twelve, but most English women married in their mid-twenties. Literacy among servants was limited. Chance (an illiterate servant) brings Romeo to the Capulet house; Capulet's stated respect for Juliet's consent sets up his later betrayal. Characterization: Capulet first seems a gentle father: Juliet is "the hopeful lady of my earth," and Paris must "woo her" and win her consent. Irony: The illiterate servant asks Romeo, a Montague, to read the Capulet guest list, and invites him to the feast. Foreshadowing: Benvolio promises to show Romeo a beauty who will make him think "thy swan a crow." Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "of choice / Lies my consent and fair according voice. / This night I hold an old accustom'd feast, / Whereto I have invited many" (Act I, Scene II, Capulet).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "My child is yet a stranger in the world; / She hath not seen the change of fourteen years" slowly and put it in my own words: When Paris asks for Juliet, Capulet says she is still a stranger to the world and not yet fourteen. Next, craft. I notice his gentle, protective tone, which will be the opposite of his rage in Act III. The strongest word is "stranger": it suggests she is new to the world and still a child. Then, effect. Why does Capulet tell Paris that Juliet is too young to marry? My answer: Capulet first wants Juliet to consent and wait two years; his later demand that she marry Paris at once shows how quickly the feud and grief change him.

> *My child is yet a stranger in the world; / She hath not seen the change of fourteen years* (Act I, Scene II, Capulet)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "My child is yet a stranger in the world; / She hath not seen the change of fourteen years" slowly and put it in my own words: When Paris asks for Juliet, Capulet says she is still a stranger to the world and not yet fourteen. Next, craft. I notice his gentle, protective tone, which will be the opposite of his rage in Act III. The strongest word is "stranger": it suggests she is new to the world and still a child. Then, effect. Why does Capulet tell Paris that Juliet is too young to marry? My answer: Capulet first wants Juliet to consent and wait two years; his later demand that she marry Paris at once shows how quickly the feud and grief change him.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Capulet means his wish is only part of the decision; Juliet's consent matters. Expected link: youth and age; students should predict whether he keeps this promise. Ask: How does this line connect to youth and age? Expected: Capulet says Juliet is too young ("She hath not seen the change of fourteen years"), a view he will abandon. (Capulet says Juliet's consent matters; compare Act III, Scene V.)

> *My will to her consent is but a part* *(Act I, Scene II, Capulet)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Capulet means his wish is only part of the decision; Juliet's consent matters. Expected link: youth and age; students should predict whether he keeps this promise.
Ask: How does this line connect to youth and age?
Expected answer: Capulet says Juliet is too young ("She hath not seen the change of fourteen years"), a view he will abandon. (Capulet says Juliet's consent matters; compare Act III, Scene V.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene II develops the idea of Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more shocking. When the text says “My child is yet a stranger in the world; / She hath not seen the change of fourteen years” (Act I, Scene II, Capulet), it shows this directly. Here he insists Juliet "hath not seen the change of fourteen years" and that "My will to her consent is but a part," words that set a standard he will later break.
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene II develops the idea of Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more shocking. When the text says “My child is yet a stranger in the world; / She hath not seen the change of fourteen years” (Act I, Scene II, Capulet), it shows this directly. Here he insists Juliet "hath not seen the change of fourteen years" and that "My will to her consent is but a part," words that set a standard he will later break.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Should parents have a say in whom their children marry? How much? Ask: is it chance or choice that brings Romeo to the Capulet feast?
Anchor question: Should parents have a say in whom their children marry? How much?
Facilitation: Ask: is it chance or choice that brings Romeo to the Capulet feast?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more shocking. ("My child is yet a stranger in the world; / She hath not seen the change of fourteen years", Act I, Scene II, Capulet). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more shocking. ("My child is yet a stranger in the world; / She hath not seen the change of fourteen years", Act I, Scene II, Capulet). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation. Key takeaway: Capulet says Juliet is too young ("She hath not seen the change of fourteen years"), a view he will abandon.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Capulet first seems a gentle father: Juliet is "the hopeful lady of my earth," and Paris must "woo her" and win her consent.
- **Irony:** The illiterate servant asks Romeo, a Montague, to read the Capulet guest list, and invites him to the feast.
- **Foreshadowing:** Benvolio promises to show Romeo a beauty who will make him think "thy swan a crow."

Themes and how they develop

- **youth and age:** Capulet says Juliet is too young ("She hath not seen the change of fourteen years"), a view he will abandon.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “of choice / Lies my consent and fair according voice. / This night I hold an old accustom’d feast, / Whereto I have invited many” (Act I, Scene II, Capulet).
- **fate and the stars:** From "star-cross'd" in the Prologue to Romeo's "I defy you, stars," the lovers feel steered by fortune, while the plot shows human choices and accidents. In this scene: “At my poor house look to behold this night / Earth-treading stars that make dark heaven light: / Such comfort as do lusty young” (Act I, Scene II, Capulet).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “My child is yet a stranger in the world; / She hath not seen the change of fourteen years” (Act I, Scene II, Capulet) Capulet asks Paris to wait.
- “My will to her consent is but a part” (Act I, Scene II, Capulet) Capulet says Juliet's consent matters; compare Act III, Scene V.
- “And I will make thee think thy swan a crow” (Act I, Scene II, Benvolio) Benvolio predicts Romeo will find someone more beautiful than Rosaline.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more shocking.
Evidence: “My child is yet a stranger in the world; / She hath not seen the change of fourteen years” (Act I, Scene II, Capulet)
Reasoning: Here he insists Juliet "hath not seen the change of fourteen years" and that "My will to her consent is but a part," words that set a standard he will later break.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
plantain (noun)	a common weed whose leaf was used to treat cuts	*Your plantain-leaf is excellent for that.*	
heretics (noun)	people who abandon the true faith; here, eyes that betray their first love	*When the devout religion of mine eye Maintains such falsehood, then turn tears to fires; And these, who often drown’d could never die, Transparent heretics, be burnt for liars!*	
falsehood (noun)	lying; being untrue	*When the devout religion of mine eye Maintains such falsehood, then turn tears to fires; And these, who often drown’d could never die, Transparent heretics, be burnt for liars!*	

tormented (verb)	caused great suffering to	*Not mad, but bound more than a madman is; Shut up in prison, kept without my food, Whipp'd and tormented and—God-den, good fellow.*	
reckoning (noun)	reputation; standing	*Of honourable reckoning are you both; And pity 'tis you lived at odds so long.*	"reckoning": Origin: an English formation from reckon + -ing. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/reckoning#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. Should parents have a say in whom their children marry? How much?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with youth and age?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Capulet tell Paris to do? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Woo Juliet and gain her heart; his will is only part of her consent.
2. What does Capulet say about Juliet's age? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: She is not yet fourteen
3. What does Paris want? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: To marry Juliet
4. Why does the servant ask Romeo for help? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He cannot read
5. Why does Romeo decide to go to the feast? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Rosaline will be there
6. What does Benvolio promise to show Romeo? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Women who will make Rosaline seem a crow
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act I, Scene II" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Capulet tells Paris that Juliet is too young to marry but invites him to woo her at that night's feast; her consent will count. A servant who cannot read the guest list asks Romeo for help, and Romeo learns Rosaline will attend. Benvolio urges him to go and compare her with other beauties.

8. Who is on stage in “Act I, Scene II”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act I, Scene II” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “Your plantain-leaf is excellent for that.” What does “plantain” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: plantain: a common weed whose leaf was used to treat cuts.

Inferential / analytical

1. What is ironic about Romeo reading the Capulet guest list? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: A Montague is invited by the enemy's own servant.
2. What does “Act I, Scene II” suggest about Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Chance (an illiterate servant) brings Romeo to the Capulet house; Capulet's stated respect for Juliet's consent sets up his later betrayal.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the irony in this scene shape what we understand about Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more shocking. Useful evidence: “My child is yet a stranger in the world; / She hath not seen the change of fourteen years” (Act I, Scene II, Capulet): Capulet asks Paris to wait. On irony: The illiterate servant asks Romeo, a Montague, to read the Capulet guest list, and invites him to the feast. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “When the devout religion of mine eye Maintains such falsehood, then turn tears to fires; And these, who often drown’d could never die, Transparent heretics, be burnt for liars!”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act I, Scene II”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Capulet tells Paris that Juliet is too young to marry but invites him to woo her at that night's feast; her consent will count. A servant who cannot read the guest list asks Romeo for help, and Romeo learns Rosaline will attend. Benvolio urges him to go and compare her with other beauties.
7. How does “Act I, Scene II” build on “Act I, Scene I”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more shocking. Useful evidence: “My will to her consent is but a part” (Act I, Scene II, Capulet): Capulet says Juliet's consent matters; compare Act III, Scene V. Theme link: Capulet says Juliet is too young ("She hath not seen the change of fourteen years"), a view he will abandon. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more shocking. Useful evidence: “And I will make thee think thy swan a crow” (Act I, Scene II, Benvolio): Benvolio predicts Romeo will find someone more beautiful than Rosaline. On characterization: Capulet first seems a gentle father: Juliet is "the hopeful lady of my earth," and Paris must "woo her" and win her consent. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Should parents have a say in whom their children marry? How much?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does foreshadowing appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with youth and age? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more shocking. Useful evidence: “My child is yet a stranger in the world; / She hath not seen the change of fourteen years” (Act I, Scene II, Capulet): Capulet asks Paris to wait. On foreshadowing: Benvolio promises to show Romeo a beauty who will make him think "thy swan a crow." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is the meeting of Romeo and Juliet caused by fate or chance? Debate using this scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Arguments about the servant, Benvolio's choice and Romeo's.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more shocking. Useful evidence: “My will to her consent is but a part” (Act I, Scene II, Capulet): Capulet says Juliet's consent matters; compare Act III, Scene V. Theme link: Capulet says Juliet is too young ("She hath not seen the change of fourteen years"), a view he will abandon. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Chance (an illiterate servant) brings Romeo to the Capulet house; Capulet's stated respect for Juliet's consent sets up his later betrayal.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more shocking. Useful evidence: “And I will make thee think thy swan a crow” (Act I, Scene II, Benvolio): Benvolio predicts Romeo will find someone more beautiful than Rosaline. Theme link: Capulet says Juliet is too young ("She hath not seen the change of fourteen years"), a view he will abandon. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more

shocking. Useful evidence: “My child is yet a stranger in the world; / She hath not seen the change of fourteen years” (Act I, Scene II, Capulet): Capulet asks Paris to wait. On characterization: Capulet first seems a gentle father: Juliet is "the hopeful lady of my earth," and Paris must "woo her" and win her consent. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act I, Scene II”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more shocking. Useful evidence: “My will to her consent is but a part” (Act I, Scene II, Capulet): Capulet says Juliet's consent matters; compare Act III, Scene V. Theme link: Capulet says Juliet is too young ("She hath not seen the change of fourteen years"), a view he will abandon. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act I, Scene II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more shocking. Useful evidence: “And I will make thee think thy swan a crow” (Act I, Scene II, Benvolio): Benvolio predicts Romeo will find someone more beautiful than Rosaline. Theme link: Capulet says Juliet is too young ("She hath not seen the change of fourteen years"), a view he will abandon. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to time and haste: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more shocking. Useful evidence: “My child is yet a stranger in the world; / She hath not seen the change of fourteen years” (Act I, Scene II, Capulet): Capulet asks Paris to wait. Theme link: Capulet says Juliet is too young ("She hath not seen the change of fourteen years"), a view he will abandon. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more shocking. Useful evidence: “My will to her consent is but a part” (Act I, Scene II, Capulet): Capulet says Juliet's consent matters; compare Act III, Scene V. On characterization: Capulet first seems a gentle father: Juliet is "the hopeful lady of my earth," and Paris must "woo her" and win her consent. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act I, Scene II” treats Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more

shocking. Useful evidence: “And I will make thee think thy swan a crow” (Act I, Scene II, Benvolio): Benvolio predicts Romeo will find someone more beautiful than Rosaline. Theme link: Capulet says Juliet is too young ("She hath not seen the change of fourteen years"), a view he will abandon. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act I, Scene III” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more shocking. Useful evidence: “My child is yet a stranger in the world; / She hath not seen the change of fourteen years” (Act I, Scene II, Capulet): Capulet asks Paris to wait. On foreshadowing: Benvolio promises to show Romeo a beauty who will make him think "thy swan a crow." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more shocking. Useful evidence: “My will to her consent is but a part” (Act I, Scene II, Capulet): Capulet says Juliet's consent matters; compare Act III, Scene V. Theme link: Capulet says Juliet is too young ("She hath not seen the change of fourteen years"), a view he will abandon. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Not mad, but bound more than a madman is; Shut up in prison, kept without my food, Whipp’d and tormented and—God-den, good fellow.”, what does “tormented” most nearly mean?

   A. it seems to me

   B. kept company

   C. high rank and standing in society

   D. caused great suffering to

   Key: D (caused great suffering to)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Of honourable _____ are you both; And pity ’tis you lived at odds so long.” Word bank: falsehood, reckoning, heretics, plantain

   Key: reckoning

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "When the devout religion of mine eye Maintains such falsehood, then turn tears to fires; And these, who often drown'd could never die, Transparent heretics, be burnt for liars!", what does "falsehood" most nearly mean?

   A. lying; being untrue

   B. a boaster

   C. whims; also quarter notes in music

   D. full of fear; dreadful

   Key: A (lying; being untrue)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene II, Capulet: "My will to her _____ is but a part"

   Key: consent

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Benvolio promise to show Romeo?

   A. Women who will make Rosaline seem a crow

   B. A new sword

   C. Friar Laurence

   D. A way into the Prince's court

   Key: A (Women who will make Rosaline seem a crow)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Paris want?

   A. To fight Romeo

   B. To marry Juliet

   C. A place at court

   D. To end the feud

   Key: B (To marry Juliet)

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene II, Capulet: "My child is yet a _____ in the world; / She hath not seen the change of fourteen years"

   Key: stranger

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why does Romeo decide to go to the feast?

   A. Tybalt challenges him

   B. Juliet invited him

   C. Rosaline will be there

   D. Mercutio dares him

   Key: C (Rosaline will be there)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "When the devout religion of mine eye Maintains such falsehood, then turn tears to fires; And these, who often drown'd could never die, Transparent heretics, be burnt for liars!", what does "heretics" most nearly mean?

   A. without proper regard

   B. lands; domains

   C. changeable; not faithful

   D. people who abandon the true faith; here, eyes that betray their first love

   Key: D (people who abandon the true faith; here, eyes that betray their first love)

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] What is ironic about Romeo reading the Capulet guest list?
    Sample answer: A Montague is invited by the enemy's own servant.
11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act I, Scene II”?
    A. Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation
    B. Juliet drinks the potion
    C. Romeo hears of Juliet's death
    D. The balcony scene

    Key: A (Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation)
12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “And I will make thee think thy swan a crow” (Act I, Scene II, Benvolio)
    A. Capulet's greeting.
    B. One thing can heal or kill.
    C. Benvolio predicts Romeo will find someone more beautiful than Rosaline.
    D. The Nurse delivers the news.

    Key: C (Benvolio predicts Romeo will find someone more beautiful than Rosaline.)
13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “My child is yet a stranger in the world; / She hath not seen the change of fourteen years” (Act I, Scene II, Capulet) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Capulet asks Paris to wait.
14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Capulet says Juliet is too young ("She hath not seen the change of fourteen years"), a view he will abandon.
    A. Youth and age
    B. Love and desire
    C. Fate and choice
    D. Violence and the feud

    Key: A (Youth and age)
15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “And I will make thee think thy swan a crow” (Act I, Scene II, Benvolio). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Benvolio predicts Romeo will find someone more beautiful than Rosaline.
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how youth and age develops from an earlier scene to “Act I, Scene II”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Capulet says Juliet is too young ("She hath not seen the change of fourteen years"), a view he will abandon.
17. [short · recall · DOK 1] What does Capulet tell Paris to do?
    Sample answer: Woo Juliet and gain her heart; his will is only part of her consent.
18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Capulet say about Juliet's age?
    A. She is eighteen
    B. She is twelve
    C. She is sixteen
    D. She is not yet fourteen

    Key: D (She is not yet fourteen)

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Your plantain-leaf is excellent for that.”, what does “plantain” most nearly mean?

    A. polite and respectful

    B. a reviving drink; medicine for the heart

    C. a common weed whose leaf was used to treat cuts

    D. having sworn falsely

    Key: C (a common weed whose leaf was used to treat cuts)

20. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “My will to her consent is but a part” (Act I, Scene II, Capulet)

    A. Mercutio's dying curse on the feud.

    B. Capulet says Juliet's consent matters; compare Act III, Scene V.

    C. The wedding moved up.

    D. The deaths end the feud: the tragedy has a purpose.

    Key: B (Capulet says Juliet's consent matters; compare Act III, Scene V.)

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “My child is yet a stranger in the world; / She hath not seen the change of fourteen years” (Act I, Scene II, Capulet)

    A. Capulet asks Paris to wait.

    B. The Friar's warning.

    C. Mercutio is pleased Romeo is witty again.

    D. Capulet's greeting.

    Key: A (Capulet asks Paris to wait.)

22. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “My will to her consent is but a part” (Act I, Scene II, Capulet) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Capulet says Juliet's consent matters; compare Act III, Scene V.

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more shocking. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “My child is yet a stranger in the world; / She hath not seen the change of fourteen years” (Act I, Scene II, Capulet).

    Sample answer: Here he insists Juliet "hath not seen the change of fourteen years" and that "My will to her consent is but a part," words that set a standard he will later break.

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act I, Scene II”? The illiterate servant asks Romeo, a Montague, to read the Capulet guest list, and invites him to the feast.

    A. Structure

    B. Irony

    C. Plot

    D. Conflict

    Key: B (Irony)

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “My child is yet a stranger in the world; / She hath not seen the change of fourteen years” (Act I, Scene II, Capulet) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Capulet asks Paris to wait.

26. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why does the servant ask Romeo for help?

    A. He needs money

    B. He is lost

    C. He cannot read

    D. He is afraid

    Key: C (He cannot read)

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more shocking.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: Here he insists Juliet "hath not seen the change of fourteen years" and that "My will to her consent is but a part," words that set a standard he will later break.

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act I, Scene II”? Capulet first seems a gentle father: Juliet is "the hopeful lady of my earth," and Paris must "woo her" and win her consent.

    A. Plot

    B. Allusion

    C. Characterization

    D. Irony

    Key: C (Characterization)

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “My will to her consent is but a part” (Act I, Scene II, Capulet) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Capulet says Juliet's consent matters; compare Act III, Scene V.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is the meeting of Romeo and Juliet caused by fate or chance? Debate using this scene.

    Sample answer: Arguments about the servant, Benvolio's choice and Romeo's.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	2, 8, 3, 17, 18, 1, 19, 4, 20, 21, 22, 10, 23, 24, 14, 25	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	2, 5, 19, 26, 4, 6, 11, 12, 10, 20, 22, 15, 14, 23, 27, 25	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	2, 7, 5, 8, 26, 22, 21, 10, 12, 13, 24, 23, 15, 28, 25, 27	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	2, 7, 8, 9, 11, 13, 21, 20, 10, 14, 15, 28, 23, 29, 25, 27	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	2, 7, 1, 10, 13, 21, 22, 15, 14, 23, 28, 24, 16, 30, 27, 25	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	2, 7, 1, 20, 22, 10, 12, 28, 14, 23, 24, 15, 16, 30, 29, 25	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	2, 7, 12, 13, 21, 20, 23, 14, 15, 28, 24, 25, 27, 29, 16, 30	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	2, 7, 20, 21, 12, 10, 15, 23, 14, 24, 28, 29, 16, 27, 25, 30	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Senior	2, 7, 10, 21, 12, 11, 23, 15, 24, 28, 14, 27, 16, 25, 30, 29	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	2, 7, 22, 13, 20, 21, 23, 24, 14, 28, 15, 16, 29, 25, 27, 30	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act I, Scene II,” how does Shakespeare show Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act I, Scene II, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act I, Scene II develops the idea of Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene II suggests about Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act I, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act I, Scene II within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act I, Scene II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act I, Scene II and its treatment of Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and irony, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act I, Scene II as evidence for a larger claim about Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act I, Scene II as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

SAT-style questions

1. *Your plantain-leaf is excellent for that.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "plantain" most nearly mean?

   A. reputation; standing

   B. caused great suffering to

   C. lying; being untrue

   D. a common weed whose leaf was used to treat cuts

2. *When the devout religion of mine eye Maintains such falsehood, then turn tears to fires; And these, who often drown'd could never die, Transparent heretics, be burnt for liars! One fairer than my love! the all-seeing sun Ne'er saw her match since first the world begun.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act I, Scene II"?

   A. Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation

   B. Juliet waits for the Nurse

   C. Juliet's feigned obedience

   D. Juliet hears the news

SAT key: 1. D (a common weed whose leaf was used to treat cuts); 2. A (Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation)

Lesson 6: Act I, Scene III

Focus: Juliet, her mother and the Nurse

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in “Act I, Scene III” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Critical voice: “Here you have the garrulity of age strengthened by the feelings of a long-trusted servant, whose sympathy with the mother's affections gives her privileges and rank in the household; and observe the mode of connection by accidents of time and place, and the childlike fondness of repetition in a second childhood, and also that happy, humble, ducking under, yet constant resurgence against, the check of her superiors!” (Samuel Taylor Coleridge, poet and critic, *Notes on Romeo and Juliet, in The Literary Remains of Samuel Taylor Coleridge, Vol. 2 (1836), note on Act I, Scene iii*; public domain). Annotate the Nurse's earthquake speech for "fondness of repetition" and "resurgence against the check of her superiors." *Objective:* Analyze the Nurse's characterization and her place in the household. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.3

Content note (age of a minor, early marriage, sexual innuendo): Juliet is not yet fourteen, and her mother and the Nurse press her toward marriage; the Nurse's jokes are bawdy. Name the age openly, set it against Elizabethan norms (most English brides were in their twenties), and discuss consent and family pressure critically.
Student preview: This scene discusses marrying off a thirteen-year-old and includes crude jokes.
Suggested language: “How does Juliet answer her mother, and what does that show about her choices?”

Teacher only · spoilers

Lady Capulet calls Juliet to discuss marriage; the Nurse interrupts with a long, bawdy story of Juliet's weaning and her late husband's joke. Lady Capulet describes Paris as a fine book that needs only a cover and asks if Juliet can love him. Juliet agrees to look at him, but no more than her mother allows.

Background: Wealthy families commonly employed a wet-nurse to breastfeed infants; the Nurse lost her own daughter, Susan, and nursed Juliet. The 'earthquake' she mentions has been linked by some scholars to a 1580 English earthquake.

Significance: The scene introduces the Nurse as Juliet's real confidante and Lady Capulet as distant; Juliet's careful answer shows her before love changes her.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Who do you go to for advice: a parent, a friend or someone else? Why that person? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to youth and age because.... Content note before we start: This scene discusses marrying off a thirteen-year-old and includes crude jokes.
Prompt: Who do you go to for advice: a parent, a friend or someone else? Why that person?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to youth and age because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Juliet's mother married young and expects Juliet to do the same.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: parlous — dangerous; alarming; cockerel — a young rooster; stinted — stopped (crying); beseech — beg; ask earnestly; extremity — a state of urgent crisis.
Words: parlous: dangerous; alarming · cockerel: a young rooster · stinted: stopped (crying) · beseech: beg; ask earnestly · extremity: a state of urgent crisis

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Wealthy families commonly employed a wet-nurse to breastfeed infants; the Nurse lost her own daughter, Susan, and nursed Juliet. The 'earthquake' she mentions has been linked by some scholars to a 1580 English earthquake. The scene introduces the Nurse as Juliet's real confidante and Lady Capulet as distant; Juliet's careful answer shows her before love changes her. Characterization: The Nurse rambles bawdily about Juliet's weaning; Lady Capulet is formal and distant; Juliet is obedient and guarded. Metaphor: Lady Capulet's extended metaphor makes Paris a book that lacks only "a cover." Setting: The Nurse's earthquake memory places Juliet's childhood in a world of household intimacy. Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "odd, of all days in the year, / Come Lammas-eve at night shall she be fourteen. / Susan and she—God rest all Christian souls" (Act I, Scene III, Nurse).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "She's not fourteen" slowly and put it in my own words: Lady Capulet and the Nurse confirm that Juliet is not yet fourteen, as they prepare to raise the idea of marriage. Next, craft. I notice the short, plain statement of age, the fact the whole scene turns on. The strongest word is "fourteen": the exact number reminds us how young she is. Then, effect. Why does Lady Capulet stress Juliet's age? My answer: Lady Capulet stresses Juliet's age because, at not quite fourteen, Juliet is old enough in her eyes to consider marriage; the scene shows how adults plan Juliet's life, which makes her later independence striking.

> *She's not fourteen* (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "She's not fourteen" slowly and put it in my own words: Lady Capulet and the Nurse confirm that Juliet is not yet fourteen, as they prepare to raise the idea of marriage. Next, craft. I notice the short, plain statement of age, the fact the whole scene turns on. The strongest word is "fourteen": the exact number reminds us how young she is. Then, effect. Why does Lady Capulet stress Juliet's age? My answer: Lady Capulet stresses Juliet's age because, at not quite fourteen, Juliet is old enough in her eyes to consider marriage; the scene shows how adults plan Juliet's life, which makes her later independence striking.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: She means she will look at Paris to see if she likes him, but no more than her mother permits. Expected link: youth and age; her obedience will soon change.
Ask: How does this line connect to youth and age? Expected: Juliet's mother married young and expects Juliet to do the same. (Lady Capulet's book metaphor for a husband.)

> *Read o'er the volume of young Paris' face* (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: She means she will look at Paris to see if she likes him, but no more than her mother permits. Expected link: youth and age; her obedience will soon change.
Ask: How does this line connect to youth and age?
Expected answer: Juliet's mother married young and expects Juliet to do the same. (Lady Capulet's book metaphor for a husband.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for characterization, metaphor (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Juliet, her mother and the Nurse? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene III develops the idea of Juliet, her mother and the Nurse. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and diction / vocabulary shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows. When the text says “Read o’er the volume of young Paris’ face” (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet), it shows this directly. Asked to "Read o'er the volume of young Paris' face," she answers only "I'll look to like, if looking liking move," limiting herself to her mother's consent.

Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, metaphor (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Juliet, her mother and the Nurse? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene III develops the idea of Juliet, her mother and the Nurse. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and diction / vocabulary shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows. When the text says “Read o’er the volume of young Paris’ face” (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet), it shows this directly. Asked to "Read o'er the volume of young Paris' face," she answers only "I'll look to like, if looking liking move," limiting herself to her mother's consent.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Who do you go to for advice: a parent, a friend or someone else? Why that person? Compare how the Nurse and Lady Capulet speak to Juliet. Who seems closer to her, and why?

Anchor question: Who do you go to for advice: a parent, a friend or someone else? Why that person?

Facilitation: Compare how the Nurse and Lady Capulet speak to Juliet. Who seems closer to her, and why?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Juliet, her mother and the Nurse? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows. (“Read o’er the volume of young Paris’ face”, Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Juliet, her mother and the Nurse? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows. (“Read o’er the volume of young Paris’ face”, Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes Juliet, her mother and the Nurse. Key takeaway: Juliet's mother married young and expects Juliet to do the same.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** The Nurse rambles bawdily about Juliet's weaning; Lady Capulet is formal and distant; Juliet is obedient and guarded.
- **Metaphor:** Lady Capulet's extended metaphor makes Paris a book that lacks only "a cover."
- **Setting:** The Nurse's earthquake memory places Juliet's childhood in a world of household intimacy.

Themes and how they develop

- **youth and age:** Juliet's mother married young and expects Juliet to do the same.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “odd, of all days in the year, / Come Lammas-eve at night shall she be fourteen. / Susan and she—God rest all Christian souls” (Act I, Scene III, Nurse).
- **haste and time:** Everything happens too fast: a four-day action, a marriage the day after meeting, a wedding moved up a day; Friar Laurence warns "they stumble that run fast." In this scene: “Faith, I can tell her age unto an hour” (Act I, Scene III, Nurse).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “She’s not fourteen” (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet) The Nurse establishes Juliet's age.
- “Read o’er the volume of young Paris’ face” (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet) Lady Capulet's book metaphor for a husband.
- “I’ll look to like, if looking liking move” (Act I, Scene III, Juliet) Juliet's careful, obedient answer.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows.
Evidence: “Read o’er the volume of young Paris’ face” (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet)
Reasoning: Asked to "Read o'er the volume of young Paris' face," she answers only "I'll look to like, if looking liking move," limiting herself to her mother's consent.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
parlous (adjective)	dangerous; alarming	*And yet, I warrant, it had upon its brow A bump as big as a young cockerel's stone; A parlous knock; and it cried bitterly: "Yea," quoth my husband, "fall'st upon thy face?*	
cockerel (noun)	a young rooster	*And yet, I warrant, it had upon its brow A bump as big as a young cockerel's stone; A parlous knock; and it cried bitterly: "Yea," quoth my husband, "fall'st upon thy face?*	
stinted (verb)	stopped (crying)	*I warrant, an I should live a thousand years, I never should forget it: "Wilt thou not, Jule?" quoth he; And, pretty fool, it stinted and said "Ay."*	
beseech (verb)	beg; ask earnestly	*I must hence to wait; I beseech you, follow straight.*	
extremity (noun)	a state of urgent crisis	*Madam, the guests are come, supper served up, you called, my young lady asked for, the nurse cursed in the pantry, and everything in extremity.*	

Discussion questions

1. Who do you go to for advice: a parent, a friend or someone else? Why that person?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with time and haste?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. How old was Lady Capulet when she became a mother? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: About Juliet's age; she says she was a mother at Juliet's years.
2. How old is Juliet? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Not yet fourteen
3. What did the Nurse do for Juliet as a baby? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Breastfed her
4. What does Lady Capulet compare Paris to? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A book

5. What is Juliet's answer about Paris? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: She will look to like him if looking moves liking
6. What event does the Nurse use to date Juliet's weaning? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: An earthquake
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act I, Scene III" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Lady Capulet calls Juliet to discuss marriage; the Nurse interrupts with a long, bawdy story of Juliet's weaning and her late husband's joke. Lady Capulet describes Paris as a fine book that needs only a cover and asks if Juliet can love him. Juliet agrees to look at him, but no more than her mother allows.
8. Who is on stage in "Act I, Scene III", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act I, Scene III" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "And yet, I warrant, it had upon its brow A bump as big as a young cockerel's stone; A parlous knock; and it cried bitterly: "Yea," quoth my husband, "fall'st upon thy face?" What does "parlous" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: parlous: dangerous; alarming.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does the Nurse's story reveal about her relationship with Juliet? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: She loves her like her own daughter; their bond is intimate and earthy.
2. What does "Act I, Scene III" suggest about Juliet, her mother and the Nurse? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The scene introduces the Nurse as Juliet's real confidante and Lady Capulet as distant; Juliet's careful answer shows her before love changes her.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the diction / vocabulary in this scene shape what we understand about Juliet, her mother and the Nurse? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for precise or unusual word choices and their connotations.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows. Useful evidence: "She's not fourteen" (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet): The Nurse establishes Juliet's age. Theme link: Juliet's mother married young and expects Juliet to do the same. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "Yes, madam: yet I cannot choose but laugh, To think it should leave crying and say "Ay."", why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

6. What causes the main turn in “Act I, Scene III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Lady Capulet calls Juliet to discuss marriage; the Nurse interrupts with a long, bawdy story of Juliet's weaning and her late husband's joke. Lady Capulet describes Paris as a fine book that needs only a cover and asks if Juliet can love him. Juliet agrees to look at him, but no more than her…
7. How does “Act I, Scene III” build on “Act I, Scene II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows. Useful evidence: “Read o’er the volume of young Paris’ face” (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet): Lady Capulet's book metaphor for a husband. Theme link: Juliet's mother married young and expects Juliet to do the same. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows. Useful evidence: “I’ll look to like, if looking liking move” (Act I, Scene III, Juliet): Juliet's careful, obedient answer. On characterization: The Nurse rambles bawdily about Juliet's weaning; Lady Capulet is formal and distant; Juliet is obedient and guarded. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Who do you go to for advice: a parent, a friend or someone else? Why that person?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does setting appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with time and haste? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows. Useful evidence: “She’s not fourteen” (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet): The Nurse establishes Juliet's age. On setting: The Nurse's earthquake memory places Juliet's childhood in a world of household intimacy. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Juliet's answer obedient or cleverly noncommittal? Defend your view. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reading of 'I'll look to like, if looking liking move.'

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows. Useful evidence: “Read o’er the volume of young Paris’ face” (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet): Lady Capulet's book metaphor for a husband. Theme link: Juliet's mother married young and expects Juliet to do the same. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “The scene introduces the Nurse as Juliet's real confidante and Lady Capulet as distant; Juliet's careful answer shows her before love changes her.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows. Useful evidence: “I’ll look to like, if looking liking move” (Act I, Scene III, Juliet): Juliet's careful, obedient answer. Theme link: Juliet's mother married young and expects Juliet to do the same. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows. Useful evidence: “She’s not fourteen” (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet): The Nurse establishes Juliet's age. On characterization: The Nurse rambles bawdily about Juliet's weaning; Lady Capulet is formal and distant; Juliet is obedient and guarded. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act I, Scene III”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Juliet, her mother and the Nurse. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows. Useful evidence: “Read o’er the volume of young Paris’ face” (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet): Lady Capulet's book metaphor for a husband. Theme link: Juliet's mother married young and expects Juliet to do the same. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act I, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows. Useful evidence: “I’ll look to like, if looking liking move” (Act I, Scene III, Juliet): Juliet's careful, obedient answer. Theme link: Juliet's mother married young and expects Juliet to do the same. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to love and desire: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows. Useful evidence: “She’s not fourteen” (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet): The Nurse establishes Juliet's age. Theme link: Juliet's mother married young and expects Juliet to do the same. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with

criteria and evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows. Useful evidence: “Read o’er the volume of young Paris’ face” (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet): Lady Capulet's book metaphor for a husband. On characterization: The Nurse rambles bawdily about Juliet's weaning; Lady Capulet is formal and distant; Juliet is obedient and guarded. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act I, Scene III” treats Juliet, her mother and the Nurse with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows. Useful evidence: “I’ll look to like, if looking liking move” (Act I, Scene III, Juliet): Juliet's careful, obedient answer. Theme link: Juliet's mother married young and expects Juliet to do the same. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act I, Scene IV” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows. Useful evidence: “She’s not fourteen” (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet): The Nurse establishes Juliet's age. Theme link: Juliet's mother married young and expects Juliet to do the same. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Juliet, her mother and the Nurse? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows. Useful evidence: “Read o’er the volume of young Paris’ face” (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet): Lady Capulet's book metaphor for a husband. Theme link: Juliet's mother married young and expects Juliet to do the same. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Diction / vocabulary**: precise or unusual word choices and their connotations
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “And yet, I warrant, it had upon its brow A bump as big as a young cockerel’s stone; A parlous knock; and it cried bitterly: “Yea,” quoth my husband, “fall’st upon thy face?”, what does “cockerel” most nearly mean?

   A. a young rooster

B. annoying; troublesome

C. mixtures; drugs

D. belonging; appropriate

Key: A (a young rooster)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What did the Nurse do for Juliet as a baby?

A. Taught her to read

B. Breastfed her

C. Hid her from Montagues

D. Named her

Key: B (Breastfed her)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “I must hence to wait; I beseech you, follow straight.”, what does “beseech” most nearly mean?

A. a digging tool like a pickaxe

B. brave; courageous

C. beg; ask earnestly

D. long-handled spears with broad blades

Key: C (beg; ask earnestly)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What event does the Nurse use to date Juliet's weaning?

A. A plague

B. An earthquake

C. A wedding

D. A war

Key: B (An earthquake)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene III, Juliet: “I’ll look to like, if _____ liking move”

Key: looking

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “I warrant, an I should live a thousand years, I never should forget it: “Wilt thou not, Jule?” quoth he; And, pretty fool, it stinted and said “Ay.””, what does “stinted” most nearly mean?

A. stopped (crying)

B. it seems to me

C. untimely; premature

D. decoration

Key: A (stopped (crying))

7. [short · recall · DOK 1] How old was Lady Capulet when she became a mother?

Sample answer: About Juliet's age; she says she was a mother at Juliet's years.

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What is Juliet's answer about Paris?

A. She refuses

B. She asks for time to pray

C. She will look to like him if looking moves liking

D. She loves him already

Key: C (She will look to like him if looking moves liking)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Madam, the guests are come, supper served up, you called, my young lady asked for, the nurse cursed in the pantry, and everything in _____.”
   Word bank: parlous, extremity, cockerel, stinted
   Key: extremity
10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Read o’er the volume of young Paris’ face” (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet)
    A. The Friar's warning.
    B. Lady Capulet's book metaphor for a husband.
    C. Juliet's courage.
    D. The Friar's image of Juliet.

    Key: B (Lady Capulet's book metaphor for a husband.)
11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “She’s not fourteen” (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet)
    A. The Friar's warning about haste.
    B. Mercutio's mock spell.
    C. The Nurse establishes Juliet's age.
    D. Moderation as the key to lasting love.

    Key: C (The Nurse establishes Juliet's age.)
12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I’ll look to like, if looking liking move” (Act I, Scene III, Juliet)
    A. The Prince's law: the next fight will cost lives.
    B. The letter returned.
    C. Juliet's careful, obedient answer.
    D. The apothecary's excuse.

    Key: C (Juliet's careful, obedient answer.)
13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “She’s not fourteen” (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The Nurse establishes Juliet's age.
14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Read o’er the volume of young Paris’ face” (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet).
    Sample answer: Asked to "Read o'er the volume of young Paris' face," she answers only "I'll look to like, if looking liking move," limiting herself to her mother's consent.
15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act I, Scene III”? The Nurse rambles bawdily about Juliet's weaning; Lady Capulet is formal and distant; Juliet is obedient and guarded.
    A. Personification
    B. Point of view
    C. Characterization
    D. Simile

Key: C (Characterization)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how youth and age develops from an earlier scene to “Act I, Scene III”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Juliet's mother married young and expects Juliet to do the same.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “And yet, I warrant, it had upon its brow A bump as big as a young cockerel’s stone; A parlous knock; and it cried bitterly: “Yea,” quoth my husband, “fall’st upon thy face?”, what does “parlous” most nearly mean?

    A. wretched; miserable

    B. rear guard; something following behind

    C. dangerous; alarming

    D. a fountain; a pipe of water

    Key: C (dangerous; alarming)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Lady Capulet compare Paris to?

    A. A ship

    B. A rose

    C. A star

    D. A book

    Key: D (A book)

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet: “Read o’er the _____ of young Paris’ face”

    Key: volume

20. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act I, Scene III”?

    A. Juliet, her mother and the Nurse

    B. Romeo hears of Juliet's death

    C. The undelivered letter

    D. Friar Laurence agrees to marry them

    Key: A (Juliet, her mother and the Nurse)

21. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Read o’er the volume of young Paris’ face” (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Lady Capulet's book metaphor for a husband.

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Juliet's mother married young and expects Juliet to do the same.

    A. Fate and choice

    B. Love and desire

    C. Violence and the feud

    D. Youth and age

    Key: D (Youth and age)

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act I, Scene III”? Lady Capulet's extended this device makes Paris a book that lacks only "a cover."

    A. Imagery

B. Setting

C. Personification

D. Metaphor

Key: D (Metaphor)

24. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “I’ll look to like, if looking liking move” (Act I, Scene III, Juliet). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Juliet's careful, obedient answer.
25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is Juliet's answer obedient or cleverly noncommittal? Defend your view.
    Sample answer: A reading of 'I'll look to like, if looking liking move.'
26. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How old is Juliet?

    A. Eighteen

    B. Sixteen

    C. Twelve

    D. Not yet fourteen

    Key: D (Not yet fourteen)
27. [short · inference · DOK 2] What does the Nurse's story reveal about her relationship with Juliet?
    Sample answer: She loves her like her own daughter; their bond is intimate and earthy.
28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Read o’er the volume of young Paris’ face” (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Lady Capulet's book metaphor for a husband.
29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “She’s not fourteen” (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: The Nurse establishes Juliet's age.
30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: Asked to "Read o'er the volume of young Paris' face," she answers only "I'll look to like, if looking liking move," limiting herself to her mother's consent.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	9, 17, 18, 6, 7, 1, 4, 19, 20, 11, 21, 12, 22, 23, 24, 25	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	19, 18, 8, 26, 6, 9, 12, 11, 13, 27, 21, 15, 24, 22, 28, 16	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	9, 1, 7, 19, 2, 20, 13, 12, 11, 10, 14, 24, 22, 23, 16, 29	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	9, 19, 7, 17, 27, 21, 10, 12, 20, 23, 22, 14, 24, 30, 29, 16	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	9, 19, 18, 11, 27, 12, 13, 23, 15, 22, 14, 24, 30, 28, 29, 16	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4

College Freshman	9, 19, 7, 11, 27, 21, 13, 15, 14, 22, 23, 24, 30, 16, 25, 28	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	5, 9, 13, 21, 11, 27, 14, 22, 23, 15, 24, 25, 29, 28, 30, 16	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	5, 9, 13, 11, 20, 21, 24, 14, 15, 23, 22, 25, 16, 28, 30, 29	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Senior	9, 19, 10, 27, 11, 13, 15, 22, 14, 23, 24, 16, 28, 25, 30, 29	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	9, 19, 11, 20, 13, 10, 22, 14, 23, 15, 24, 30, 29, 16, 28, 25	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act I, Scene III,” how does Shakespeare show Juliet, her mother and the Nurse? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act I, Scene III, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Juliet, her mother and the Nurse? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act I, Scene III develops the idea of Juliet, her mother and the Nurse. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and diction / vocabulary shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Juliet, her mother and the Nurse. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene III suggests about Juliet, her mother and the Nurse. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and diction / vocabulary), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act I, Scene III to complicate the reader's understanding of Juliet, her mother and the Nurse. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act I, Scene III within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Juliet, her mother and the Nurse

responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act I, Scene III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Juliet, her mother and the Nurse follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act I, Scene III and its treatment of Juliet, her mother and the Nurse. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and diction / vocabulary, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act I, Scene III as evidence for a larger claim about Juliet, her mother and the Nurse in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act I, Scene III as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Juliet, her mother and the Nurse. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

SAT-style questions

1. *And yet, I warrant, it had upon its brow A bump as big as a young cockerel's stone; A parlous knock; and it cried bitterly: "Yea," quoth my husband, "fall'st upon thy face?*

   As used in the text, what does the word "parlous" most nearly mean?

   A. beg; ask earnestly

   B. stopped (crying)

   C. a state of urgent crisis

   D. dangerous; alarming

2. *Yes, madam: yet I cannot choose but laugh, To think it should leave crying and say "Ay." And yet, I warrant, it had upon its brow A bump as big as a young cockerel's stone; A parlous knock; and it cried bitterly: "Yea," quoth my husband, "fall'st upon thy face? Thou wilt fall backward when thou comest to age; Wilt thou not, Jule?" it stinted and said "Ay."*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act I, Scene III"?

   A. Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition

   B. The Friar's desperate plan

   C. Parting at dawn and Capulet's rage

   D. Juliet, her mother and the Nurse

SAT key: 1. D (dangerous; alarming); 2. D (Juliet, her mother and the Nurse)

Lesson 7: Act I, Scene IV

Focus: Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in “Act I, Scene IV” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Critical voice: “Wit ever wakeful, fancy busy and procreative as an insect, courage, an easy mind that, without cares of its own, is at once disposed to laugh away those of others, and yet to be interested in them,--these and all congenial qualities, melting into the common 'copula' of them all, the man of rank and the gentleman, with all its excellencies and all its weaknesses, constitute the character of Mercutio!” (Samuel Taylor Coleridge, poet and critic, *Notes on Romeo and Juliet, in The Literary Remains of Samuel Taylor Coleridge, Vol. 2 (1836), note on Act I, Scene iv*; public domain). Character web: match each trait in Coleridge's list to a line from Queen Mab. *Objective:* Analyze Mercutio's Queen Mab speech and character. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.3

Content note (alcohol): Alcohol: period drinking appears as social custom (wine at feasts, toasts or 'healths') and as a restorative (aqua vitae, i.e. brandy or spirits). Name it plainly; don't glamorize it. In Queen Mab, Mercutio's soldier dreams of 'healths five-fathom deep' (heavy drinking toasts).
Student preview: A speech mentions heavy drinking.
Suggested language: “What do Mercutio's dreamers want?”

Teacher only · spoilers

Masked and carrying torches, Romeo, Mercutio and Benvolio head to the Capulet feast. Romeo, heavy-hearted, says he dreamed a dream; Mercutio answers with the Queen Mab speech about a fairy who drives through sleepers' brains and gives them dreams, ending in darker images. Romeo fears a consequence 'hanging in the stars' will begin tonight, but goes on.

Background: Masked uninvited guests at a feast were a known custom. Mab was a figure of English folklore; belief in dreams as omens was widespread.

Significance: Mercutio's speech shows wit sliding into darkness; Romeo's premonition ties the feast to the tragedy foretold.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Do you believe dreams can predict anything? Why or why not? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and choice because.... Content note before we start: A speech mentions heavy drinking.
Prompt: Do you believe dreams can predict anything? Why or why not?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and choice because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Romeo senses fate but goes anyway, trusting "He, that hath the steerage of my course."

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: misgives — fills with doubt and foreboding; boisterous — violently rough; constable — a parish officer who keeps the peace; proverb — an old saying; fearful — full of fear; dreadful. "misgives": Origin of "misgive": an English formation from mis- + give.
Words: misgives: fills with doubt and foreboding · boisterous: violently rough · constable: a parish officer who keeps the peace · proverb: an old saying · fearful: full of fear; dreadful

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Masked uninvited guests at a feast were a known custom. Mab was a figure of English folklore; belief in dreams as omens was widespread. Mercutio's speech shows wit sliding into darkness; Romeo's premonition ties the feast to the tragedy foretold. Characterization: Mercutio's Queen Mab speech spirals from fairy fancy into images of war and nightmare. Foreshadowing: Romeo fears "Some consequence yet hanging in the stars" will begin this night and end in "untimely death." Imagery: Mab drives "Athwart men's noses as they lie asleep": tiny, precise images that grow darker. Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "Give me a torch: I am not for this ambling; / Being but heavy, I will" (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "O, then, I see Queen Mab hath been with you" slowly and put it in my own words: Mercutio tells Romeo that the fairy Queen Mab must have visited him, bringing dreams. Next, craft. I notice the tiny, playful fairy details that grow wild and dark as the speech goes on. The strongest word is "Mab": she is a fairy midwife of dreams, so Mercutio mocks Romeo's faith in dreams. Then, effect. What is Mercutio mocking with his Queen Mab speech? My answer: Mercutio teases Romeo's belief in omens and romantic dreams; his speech spins out of control into bitterness, showing his restless wit and darker side.

> *O, then, I see Queen Mab hath been with you* (Act I, Scene IV, Mercutio)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "O, then, I see Queen Mab hath been with you" slowly and put it in my own words: Mercutio tells Romeo that the fairy Queen Mab must have visited him, bringing dreams. Next, craft. I notice the tiny, playful fairy details that grow wild and dark as the speech goes on. The strongest word is "Mab": she is a fairy midwife of dreams, so Mercutio mocks Romeo's faith in dreams. Then, effect. What is Mercutio mocking with his Queen Mab speech? My answer: Mercutio teases Romeo's belief in omens and romantic dreams; his speech spins out of control into bitterness, showing his restless wit and darker side.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Romeo's premonition. Look at the craft: Romeo fears "Some consequence yet hanging in the stars" will begin this night and end in "untimely death." Ask: How does this line connect to fate and choice? Expected: Romeo senses fate but goes anyway, trusting "He, that hath the steerage of my course." (Romeo's premonition.)

> *Some consequence yet hanging in the stars / Shall bitterly begin his fearful date / With this night's revels (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Romeo's premonition. Look at the craft: Romeo fears "Some consequence yet hanging in the stars" will begin this night and end in "untimely death."
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and choice?
Expected answer: Romeo senses fate but goes anyway, trusting "He, that hath the steerage of my course." (Romeo's premonition.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene IV develops the idea of Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but chooses to go on. When the text says "Some consequence yet hanging in the stars / Shall bitterly begin his fearful date / With this night's revels" (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo), it shows this directly. He fears "Some consequence yet hanging in the stars" will begin "With this night's revels," yet he says "He, that hath the steerage of my course, / Direct my sail" and follows his friends.
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene IV develops the idea of Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but chooses to go on. When the text says "Some consequence yet hanging in the stars / Shall bitterly begin his fearful date / With this night's revels" (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo), it shows this directly. He fears "Some consequence yet hanging in the stars" will begin "With this night's revels," yet he says "He, that hath the steerage of my course, / Direct my sail" and follows his friends.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Do you believe dreams can predict anything? Why or why not? Ask: what does the Queen Mab speech reveal about Mercutio? Is he joking, or is something darker under the wit?
Anchor question: Do you believe dreams can predict anything? Why or why not?
Facilitation: Ask: what does the Queen Mab speech reveal about Mercutio? Is he joking, or is something darker under the wit?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but chooses to go on. ("Some consequence yet hanging in the stars / Shall bitterly begin his fearful date / With this night's revels", Act I, Scene IV, Romeo). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but chooses to go on. ("Some consequence yet hanging in the stars / Shall bitterly begin his fearful date / With this night's revels", Act I, Scene IV, Romeo). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition. Key takeaway: Romeo senses fate but goes anyway, trusting "He, that hath the steerage of my course."

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Mercutio's Queen Mab speech spirals from fairy fancy into images of war and nightmare.
- **Foreshadowing:** Romeo fears "Some consequence yet hanging in the stars" will begin this night and end in "untimely death."
- **Imagery:** Mab drives "Athwart men's noses as they lie asleep": tiny, precise images that grow darker.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and choice:** Romeo senses fate but goes anyway, trusting "He, that hath the steerage of my course."

Symbols and motifs

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “Give me a torch: I am not for this ambling; / Being but heavy, I will” (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo).
- **fate and the stars:** From "star-cross'd" in the Prologue to Romeo's "I defy you, stars," the lovers feel steered by fortune, while the plot shows human choices and accidents. In this scene: “for my mind misgives / Some consequence yet hanging in the stars / Shall bitterly begin his fearful date / With this night’s revels and” (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “O, then, I see Queen Mab hath been with you” (Act I, Scene IV, Mercutio) Mercutio mocks dreams as the work of a fairy.
- “Some consequence yet hanging in the stars / Shall bitterly begin his fearful date / With this night’s revels” (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo) Romeo's premonition.
- “But He, that hath the steerage of my course, / Direct my sail” (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo) Romeo hands his course to God or fate.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but chooses to go on.
Evidence: “Some consequence yet hanging in the stars / Shall bitterly begin his fearful date / With this night’s revels” (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo)
Reasoning: He fears "Some consequence yet hanging in the stars" will begin "With this night's revels," yet he says "He, that hath the steerage of my course, / Direct my sail" and follows his friends.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
misgives (verb)	fills with doubt and foreboding	*I fear, too early: for my mind misgives Some consequence yet hanging in the stars Shall bitterly begin his fearful date With this night’s revels and expire the term Of a despised life closed in my breast By some vile forfeit of untimely death.*	“misgives”: Origin of “misgive”: an English formation from mis- + give. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/misgive#Etymology)
boisterous (adjective)	violently rough	*Is love a tender thing? it is too rough, Too rude, too boisterous, and it pricks like thorn.*	
constable (noun)	a parish officer who keeps the peace	*Tut, dun’s the mouse, the constable’s own word: If thou art dun, we’ll draw thee from the mire Of this sir-reverence love, wherein thou stick’st Up to the ears.*	
proverb (noun)	an old saying	*A torch for me: let wantons light of heart Tickle the senseless rushes with their heels,*	

		For I am proverb'd with a grandsire phrase; I'll be a candle-holder, and look on.	
fearful (adjective)	full of fear; dreadful	*I fear, too early: for my mind misgives Some consequence yet hanging in the stars Shall bitterly begin his fearful date With this night's revels and expire the term Of a despised life closed in my breast By some vile forfeit of untimely death.*	
wantons (noun)	carefree, playful people	*A torch for me: let wantons light of heart Tickle the senseless rushes with their heels, For I am proverb'd with a grandsire phrase; I'll be a candle-holder, and look on.*	
steerage (noun)	steering; control over a course	*But He, that hath the steerage of my course, Direct my sail!*	
ambling (noun)	leisurely dancing or walking	*Give me a torch: I am not for this ambling; Being but heavy, I will bear the light.*	
grandsire (noun)	grandfather; an old man	*A torch for me: let wantons light of heart Tickle the senseless rushes with their heels, For I am proverb'd with a grandsire phrase; I'll be a candle-holder, and look on.*	
untimely (adjective)	happening too soon; premature	*I fear, too early: for my mind misgives Some consequence yet hanging in the stars Shall bitterly begin his fearful date With this night's revels and expire the term Of a despised life closed in my breast By some vile forfeit of untimely death.*	

Discussion questions

1. Do you believe dreams can predict anything? Why or why not?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with love and desire?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Romeo say about his dream? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He dreamed a dream tonight; he says dreamers often lie.
2. What are the friends going to? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The Capulet feast
3. Who is Queen Mab? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A fairy who brings dreams
4. What does Romeo fear? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A consequence hanging in the stars
5. What do the friends carry? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Torches
6. Who delivers the Queen Mab speech? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Mercutio
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act I, Scene IV" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Masked and carrying torches, Romeo, Mercutio and Benvolio head to the Capulet feast. Romeo, heavy-hearted, says he dreamed a dream; Mercutio answers with the Queen Mab speech about a fairy who drives through sleepers' brains and gives them dreams, ending in darker images. Romeo fears a consequence 'hanging in the stars' will begin tonight, but goes on.
8. Who is on stage in "Act I, Scene IV", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act I, Scene IV" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "I fear, too early: for my mind misgives Some consequence yet hanging in the stars Shall bitterly begin his fearful date With this night's revels and expire the term Of a despised life closed in my breast By some vile…" What does "misgives" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: misgives: fills with doubt and foreboding.

Inferential / analytical

1. How does the Queen Mab speech change as it goes on? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: It moves from playful fairy detail to violence, nightmares and a soldier dreaming of cutting throats.
2. What does "Act I, Scene IV" suggest about Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Mercutio's speech shows wit sliding into darkness; Romeo's premonition ties the feast to the tragedy foretold.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the imagery in this scene shape what we understand about Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but

chooses to go on. Useful evidence: “O, then, I see Queen Mab hath been with you” (Act I, Scene IV, Mercutio): Mercutio mocks dreams as the work of a fairy. On imagery: Mab drives "Athwart men's noses as they lie asleep": tiny, precise images that grow darker. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “A torch for me: let wantons light of heart Tickle the senseless rushes with their heels, For I am proverb’d with a grandsire phrase; I’ll be a candle-holder, and look on.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act I, Scene IV”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Masked and carrying torches, Romeo, Mercutio and Benvolio head to the Capulet feast. Romeo, heavy-hearted, says he dreamed a dream; Mercutio answers with the Queen Mab speech about a fairy who drives through sleepers' brains and gives them dreams, ending in darker images. Romeo fears a consequence…
7. How does “Act I, Scene IV” build on “Act I, Scene III”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but chooses to go on. Useful evidence: “Some consequence yet hanging in the stars / Shall bitterly begin his fearful date / With this night’s revels” (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo): Romeo's premonition. Theme link: Romeo senses fate but goes anyway, trusting "He, that hath the steerage of my course." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but chooses to go on. Useful evidence: “But He, that hath the steerage of my course, / Direct my sail” (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo): Romeo hands his course to God or fate. On characterization: Mercutio's Queen Mab speech spirals from fairy fancy into images of war and nightmare. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Do you believe dreams can predict anything? Why or why not?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does foreshadowing appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with love and desire? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but chooses to go on. Useful evidence: “O, then, I see Queen Mab hath been with you” (Act I, Scene IV, Mercutio): Mercutio mocks dreams as the work of a fairy. On foreshadowing: Romeo fears "Some consequence yet hanging in the stars" will begin this night and end in "untimely death." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Does Romeo's premonition make him more or less responsible for what follows? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment weighing foreknowledge and choice.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but chooses to go on. Useful evidence: “Some consequence yet hanging in the stars / Shall bitterly begin his fearful date / With this night’s revels” (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo): Romeo's premonition. Theme link: Romeo senses fate but goes anyway, trusting "He, that hath the steerage of my course." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Mercutio's speech shows wit sliding into darkness; Romeo's premonition ties the feast to the tragedy foretold.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but chooses to go on. Useful evidence: “But He, that hath the steerage of my course, / Direct my sail” (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo): Romeo hands his course to God or fate. Theme link: Romeo senses fate but goes anyway, trusting "He, that hath the steerage of my course." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but chooses to go on. Useful evidence: “O, then, I see Queen Mab hath been with you” (Act I, Scene IV, Mercutio): Mercutio mocks dreams as the work of a fairy. On characterization: Mercutio's Queen Mab speech spirals from fairy fancy into images of war and nightmare. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act I, Scene IV”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but chooses to go on. Useful evidence: “Some consequence yet hanging in the stars / Shall bitterly begin his fearful date / With this night’s revels” (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo): Romeo's premonition. Theme link: Romeo senses fate but goes anyway, trusting "He, that hath the steerage of my course." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act I, Scene IV”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but chooses to go on. Useful evidence: “But He, that hath the steerage of my course, / Direct my sail” (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo): Romeo hands his course to God or fate. Theme link: Romeo senses fate but goes anyway, trusting "He, that hath the steerage of my course." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to fate and choice: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but chooses to go on. Useful evidence: “O, then, I see Queen Mab hath been with you” (Act I, Scene IV, Mercutio): Mercutio mocks dreams as the work of a fairy. Theme link: Romeo senses fate but goes anyway, trusting "He, that hath the steerage of my course." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but chooses to go on. Useful evidence: “Some consequence yet hanging in the stars / Shall bitterly begin his fearful date / With this night’s revels” (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo): Romeo's premonition. On characterization: Mercutio's Queen Mab speech spirals from fairy fancy into images of war and nightmare. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act I, Scene IV” treats Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but chooses to go on. Useful evidence: “But He, that hath the steerage of my course, / Direct my sail” (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo): Romeo hands his course to God or fate. Theme link: Romeo senses fate but goes anyway, trusting "He, that hath the steerage of my course." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act I, Scene V” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but chooses to go on. Useful evidence: “O, then, I see Queen Mab hath been with you” (Act I, Scene IV, Mercutio): Mercutio mocks dreams as the work of a fairy. On foreshadowing: Romeo fears "Some consequence yet hanging in the stars" will begin this night and end in "untimely death." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but chooses to go on. Useful evidence: “Some consequence yet hanging in the stars / Shall bitterly begin his fearful date / With this night’s revels” (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo): Romeo's premonition. Theme link: Romeo senses fate but goes anyway, trusting "He, that hath the steerage of my course." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who delivers the Queen Mab speech?

   A. Tybalt

   B. Benvolio

   C. Mercutio

   D. Romeo

   Key: C (Mercutio)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene IV, Romeo: "Some _____ yet hanging in the stars / Shall bitterly begin his fearful date / With this night's revels"

   Key: consequence

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who is Queen Mab?

   A. A queen of Verona

   B. A fairy who brings dreams

   C. Rosaline's mother

   D. Juliet's nurse

   Key: B (A fairy who brings dreams)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene IV, Romeo: "But He, that hath the _____ of my course, / Direct my sail"

   Key: steerage

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Romeo fear?

   A. Losing Rosaline

   B. Tybalt's sword

   C. Being caught by the Prince

   D. A consequence hanging in the stars

   Key: D (A consequence hanging in the stars)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What are the friends going to?

   A. Church

   B. A duel

   C. Mantua

   D. The Capulet feast

   Key: D (The Capulet feast)

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "A torch for me: let _____ light of heart Tickle the senseless rushes with their heels, For I am proverb'd with a grandsire phrase; I'll be a

candle-holder, and look on." Word bank: boisterous, wantons, misgives, constable

Key: wantons

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "I fear, too early: for my mind misgives Some consequence yet hanging in the stars Shall bitterly begin his fearful date With this night's revels and expire the term Of a despised life closed in my breast By some vile…", what does "misgives" most nearly mean?

   A. unmanly, in the period's prejudice; tearful

   B. a mythical serpent that could kill with a look

   C. fills with doubt and foreboding

   D. people in masks and costume who join a party

   Key: C (fills with doubt and foreboding)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Give me a torch: I am not for this _____; Being but heavy, I will bear the light." Word bank: boisterous, constable, ambling, misgives

   Key: ambling

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? "But He, that hath the steerage of my course, / Direct my sail" (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo)

    A. Wedding turns to funeral.

    B. Romeo hands his course to God or fate.

    C. The Prince blames the feud.

    D. Romeo sets the wedding plan.

    Key: B (Romeo hands his course to God or fate.)

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? "O, then, I see Queen Mab hath been with you" (Act I, Scene IV, Mercutio)

    A. The Friar's warning about haste.

    B. One thing can heal or kill.

    C. Mercutio mocks dreams as the work of a fairy.

    D. Juliet as light in darkness.

    Key: C (Mercutio mocks dreams as the work of a fairy.)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? "Some consequence yet hanging in the stars / Shall bitterly begin his fearful date / With this night's revels" (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo)

    A. Citizens stain their hands with the blood of fellow citizens.

    B. Juliet discovers Romeo is a Montague.

    C. Romeo's premonition.

    D. Romeo's defiance.

    Key: C (Romeo's premonition.)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Act I, Scene IV"?

    A. The Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold

    B. Mercutio's death and Tybalt's

    C. Juliet hears the news

    D. Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition

    Key: D (Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition)

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but chooses to go on. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Some consequence yet hanging in the stars / Shall bitterly begin his fearful date / With this night’s revels” (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo).
    Sample answer: He fears "Some consequence yet hanging in the stars" will begin "With this night's revels," yet he says "He, that hath the steerage of my course, / Direct my sail" and follows his friends.
15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “But He, that hath the steerage of my course, / Direct my sail” (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Romeo hands his course to God or fate.
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Does Romeo's premonition make him more or less responsible for what follows?
    Sample answer: A judgment weighing foreknowledge and choice.
17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What do the friends carry?

    A. Lanterns

    B. Torches

    C. Swords only

    D. Flowers

    Key: B (Torches)
18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Is love a tender thing? it is too rough, Too rude, too boisterous, and it pricks like thorn.”, what does “boisterous” most nearly mean?

    A. those who start something

    B. kept company

    C. without careful thought; rash

    D. violently rough

    Key: D (violently rough)
19. [short · recall · DOK 1] What does Romeo say about his dream?
    Sample answer: He dreamed a dream tonight; he says dreamers often lie.
20. [short · inference · DOK 2] How does the Queen Mab speech change as it goes on?
    Sample answer: It moves from playful fairy detail to violence, nightmares and a soldier dreaming of cutting throats.
21. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “O, then, I see Queen Mab hath been with you” (Act I, Scene IV, Mercutio) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Mercutio mocks dreams as the work of a fairy.
22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Romeo senses fate but goes anyway, trusting "He, that hath the steerage of my course."

    A. Fate and choice

    B. Love and desire

    C. Youth and age

    D. Violence and the feud

    Key: A (Fate and choice)
23. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how fate and choice develops from an earlier scene to “Act I, Scene IV”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Romeo senses fate but goes anyway, trusting "He, that hath the steerage of my course."

24. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “A torch for me: let wantons light of heart Tickle the senseless rushes with their heels, For I am proverb’d with a grandsire phrase; I’ll be a candle-holder, and look on.”, what does “proverb” most nearly mean?

    A. pleading on another's behalf

    B. an old saying

    C. weeping noisily

    D. delay; neglect

    Key: B (an old saying)

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Tut, dun’s the mouse, the constable’s own word: If thou art dun, we’ll draw thee from the mire Of this sir-reverence love, wherein thou stick’st Up to the ears.”, what does “constable” most nearly mean?

    A. stained, here with the blood of fellow citizens

    B. foretell

    C. a parish officer who keeps the peace

    D. forcing oneself in where one is not wanted

    Key: C (a parish officer who keeps the peace)

26. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Some consequence yet hanging in the stars / Shall bitterly begin his fearful date / With this night’s revels” (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Romeo's premonition.

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act I, Scene IV”? Romeo fears "Some consequence yet hanging in the stars" will begin this night and end in "untimely death."

    A. Plot

    B. Metaphor

    C. Hyperbole

    D. Foreshadowing

    Key: D (Foreshadowing)

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but chooses to go on.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: He fears "Some consequence yet hanging in the stars" will begin "With this night's revels," yet he says "He, that hath the steerage of my course, / Direct my sail" and follows his friends.

29. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I fear, too early: for my mind misgives Some consequence yet hanging in the stars Shall bitterly begin his _____ date With this night’s revels and expire the term Of a despised life closed in my breast By some vile forfeit of untimely death.”

    Word bank: misgives, boisterous, fearful, constable

    Key: fearful

30. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act I, Scene IV”? Mercutio's Queen Mab speech spirals from fairy fancy into images of war and nightmare.

    A. Alliteration

    B. Imagery

C. Characterization

D. Theme

Key: C (Characterization)

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Some consequence yet hanging in the stars / Shall bitterly begin his fearful date / With this night's revels" (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Romeo's premonition.
32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "O, then, I see Queen Mab hath been with you" (Act I, Scene IV, Mercutio) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Mercutio mocks dreams as the work of a fairy.
33. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "But He, that hath the _____ of my course, Direct my sail!" Word bank: misgives, boisterous, steerage, constable
    Key: steerage

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 3, 18, 9, 1, 4, 8, 19, 12, 20, 21, 11, 15, 14, 22, 23	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	6, 1, 4, 24, 2, 25, 10, 11, 13, 26, 12, 22, 14, 27, 28, 16	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	19, 8, 2, 9, 17, 21, 26, 12, 11, 13, 14, 15, 27, 22, 28, 23	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	29, 1, 24, 7, 13, 21, 12, 11, 26, 30, 14, 22, 27, 31, 32, 16	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	2, 29, 18, 11, 12, 13, 10, 22, 30, 27, 15, 14, 23, 28, 16, 31	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	29, 33, 19, 20, 12, 13, 11, 14, 15, 27, 22, 30, 28, 16, 31, 32	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	33, 29, 10, 21, 11, 12, 30, 14, 15, 22, 27, 16, 23, 28, 31, 32	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	7, 29, 21, 10, 20, 11, 14, 27, 15, 22, 30, 32, 31, 23, 28, 16	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Senior	29, 7, 20, 21, 12, 10, 22, 30, 14, 27, 15, 32, 23, 31, 28, 16	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	33, 29, 11, 21, 20, 13, 14, 30, 27, 22, 15, 31, 28, 23, 32, 16	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act I, Scene IV," how does Shakespeare show Queen Mab and Romeo's

premonition? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act I, Scene IV, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act I, Scene IV develops the idea of Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene IV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene IV suggests about Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act I, Scene IV to complicate the reader's understanding of Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act I, Scene IV within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act I, Scene IV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act I, Scene IV and its treatment of Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and imagery, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act I, Scene IV as evidence for a larger claim about Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act I, Scene IV as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

SAT-style questions

1. *Tut, dun's the mouse, the constable's own word: If thou art dun, we'll draw thee from the mire Of this sir-reverence love, wherein thou stick'st Up to the ears.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "constable" most nearly mean?

   A. a parish officer who keeps the peace

   B. grandfather; an old man

   C. happening too soon; premature

   D. leisurely dancing or walking

2. *A torch for me: let wantons light of heart Tickle the senseless rushes with their heels, For I am proverb'd with a grandsire phrase; I'll be a candle-holder, and look on. The game was ne'er so fair, and I am done.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act I, Scene IV"?

   A. Juliet's feigned obedience

   B. Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition

   C. The divided world of Verona

   D. Parting at dawn and Capulet's rage

SAT key: 1. A (a parish officer who keeps the peace); 2. B (Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition)

Lesson 8: Act I, Scene V

Focus: love at first sight at the Capulet feast

Objective: Students will analyze how imagery develops in "Act I, Scene V" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

At the feast Romeo sees Juliet and forgets Rosaline. Tybalt recognizes Romeo's voice and wants to fight; Capulet forbids it. Romeo and Juliet speak a shared sonnet and kiss twice. Each learns from the Nurse who the other is.

Background: Feasts with dancing and masks were grand social occasions. The lovers' sonnet uses the language of pilgrims and saints; religious imagery in love poetry was a convention.

Significance: The meeting fuses love and hate: Tybalt's vow of revenge and the lovers' discovery of each other's names come in the same scene.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What makes a first impression powerful? Can it be trusted? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to love and desire because....
Prompt: What makes a first impression powerful? Can it be trusted?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to love and desire because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: love at first sight, expressed in religious language that makes the kiss a prayer.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: marchpane — marzipan, a sweet almond paste; forswear — deny under oath; take back; palmers — pilgrims who carried a palm leaf from the Holy Land; trooping — going along with a crowd; loathed — hated. "palmers": Origin of "palmer": Anglo-Norman palmer.
Words: marchpane: marzipan, a sweet almond paste · forswear: deny under oath; take back · palmers: pilgrims who carried a palm leaf from the Holy Land · trooping: going along with a crowd · loathed: hated

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Feasts with dancing and masks were grand social occasions. The lovers' sonnet uses the language of pilgrims and saints; religious imagery in love poetry was a convention. The meeting fuses love and hate: Tybalt's vow of revenge and the lovers' discovery of each other's names come in the same scene. Structure: Romeo and Juliet's first fourteen lines together form a shared sonnet about pilgrims, saints and kisses. Imagery: Romeo's first sight of Juliet is all light: "O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright!" Dramatic irony: Each learns the other's name only after falling in love; Tybalt has already recognized Romeo. Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "come near ye now? / Welcome, gentlemen! I have seen the day / That I have worn a visor and could tell / A whispering" (Act I, Scene V, Capulet).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright" slowly and put it in my own words: Seeing Juliet at the feast, Romeo says she teaches the torches to burn bright. Next, craft. I notice the hyperbole, light imagery that makes her brighter than fire. The strongest word is "torches": they are the party's lights, which she outshines. Then, effect. What does Romeo's first sight of Juliet do to his language? My answer: Romeo's love for Rosaline vanishes in an instant; his new, vivid light imagery shows his sudden, intense passion for Juliet.

> *O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright* (Act I, Scene V, Romeo)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright" slowly and put it in my own words: Seeing Juliet at the feast, Romeo says she teaches the torches to burn bright. Next, craft. I notice the hyperbole, light imagery that makes her brighter than fire. The strongest word is "torches": they are the party's lights, which she outshines. Then, effect. What does Romeo's first sight of Juliet do to his language? My answer: Romeo's love for Rosaline vanishes in an instant; his new, vivid light imagery shows his sudden, intense passion for Juliet.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Juliet's line balances "only love" against "only hate": the one person she loves is from the one family she must hate. Expected link: love and the feud. Ask: How does this line connect to love and desire? Expected: Love at first sight, expressed in religious language that makes the kiss a prayer. (Juliet discovers Romeo is a Montague.)

> *My only love sprung from my only hate* (Act I, Scene V, Juliet)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Juliet's line balances "only love" against "only hate": the one person she loves is from the one family she must hate. Expected link: love and the feud.
Ask: How does this line connect to love and desire?
Expected answer: Love at first sight, expressed in religious language that makes the kiss a prayer. (Juliet discovers Romeo is a Montague.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for structure, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about love at first sight at the Capulet feast? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene V develops the idea of love at first sight at the Capulet feast. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from the start. When the text says "O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright" (Act I, Scene V, Romeo), it shows this directly. Romeo's "O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright" is followed at once by Tybalt's rage, and Juliet's discovery ends the scene with "My only love sprung from my only hate."
Task: Annotate the scene for structure, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about love at first sight at the Capulet feast? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene V develops the idea of love at first sight at the Capulet feast. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from the start. When the text says "O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright" (Act I, Scene V, Romeo), it shows this directly. Romeo's "O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright" is followed at once by Tybalt's rage, and Juliet's discovery ends the scene with "My only love sprung from my only hate."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What makes a first impression powerful? Can it be trusted? Have students find the shared sonnet and mark who speaks each quatrain. What does sharing a sonnet suggest about the two?
Anchor question: What makes a first impression powerful? Can it be trusted?
Facilitation: Have students find the shared sonnet and mark who speaks each quatrain. What does sharing a sonnet suggest about the two?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about love at first sight at the Capulet feast? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from the start. ("O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright", Act I, Scene V, Romeo). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about love at first sight at the Capulet feast? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from the start. ("O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright", Act I, Scene V, Romeo). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how structure shapes love at first sight at the Capulet feast. Key takeaway: love at first sight, expressed in religious language that makes the kiss a prayer.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Structure:** Romeo and Juliet's first fourteen lines together form a shared sonnet about pilgrims, saints and kisses.
- **Imagery:** Romeo's first sight of Juliet is all light: "O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright!"
- **Dramatic irony:** Each learns the other's name only after falling in love; Tybalt has already recognized Romeo.

Themes and how they develop

- **love and desire:** love at first sight, expressed in religious language that makes the kiss a prayer.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “come near ye now? / Welcome, gentlemen! I have seen the day / That I have worn a visor and could tell / A whispering” (Act I, Scene V, Capulet).
- **death as bridegroom:** Death is repeatedly imagined as Juliet's husband or lover, long before she lies in the tomb. In this scene: “Go ask his name: if he be married, / My grave is like to be my wedding bed” (Act I, Scene V, Juliet).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright” (Act I, Scene V, Romeo) Juliet as light in darkness.
- “Did my heart love till now? forswear it, sight” (Act I, Scene V, Romeo) Romeo forgets Rosaline in a line.
- “My only love sprung from my only hate” (Act I, Scene V, Juliet) Juliet discovers Romeo is a Montague.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from the start.
Evidence: “O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright” (Act I, Scene V, Romeo)
Reasoning: Romeo's "O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright" is followed at once by Tybalt's rage, and Juliet's discovery ends the scene with "My only love sprung from my only hate."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
marchpane (noun)	marzipan, a sweet almond paste	*Good thou, save me a piece of marchpane; and, as thou lovest me, let the porter let in Susan Grindstone and Nell.*	
forswear (verb)	deny under oath; take back	*Did my heart love till now? forswear it, sight!*	
palmers (noun)	pilgrims who carried a palm leaf from the Holy Land	*Good pilgrim, you do wrong your hand too much, Which mannerly devotion shows in this; For saints have hands that pilgrims' hands do touch, And palm to palm is holy palmers' kiss.*	"palmers": Origin of "palmer": Anglo-Norman palmer. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/palmer#Etymology)
trooping (verb)	going along with a crowd	*So shows a snowy dove trooping with crows, As yonder lady o'er her fellows shows.*	
loathed (adjective)	hated	*Prodigious birth of love it is to me, That I must love a loathed enemy.*	
mannerly (adjective)	polite; well-mannered	*Good pilgrim, you do wrong your hand too much, Which mannerly devotion shows in this; For saints have hands that pilgrims' hands do touch, And palm to palm is holy palmers' kiss.*	"mannerly": Origin: an English formation from manner + -ly. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/mannerly#Etymology)
trencher (noun)	a wooden plate	*He shift a trencher? he scrape a trencher!*	
intrusion (noun)	forcing oneself in where one is not wanted	*I will withdraw: but this intrusion shall Now seeming sweet convert to bitter gall.*	"intrusion": Origin: Old French intrusion. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/intrusion#Etymology)
nuptials (noun)	a wedding	*What, man! 'tis not so much, 'tis not so much: 'Tis since the nuptials of Lucentio, Come Pentecost as quickly as it will, Some five and twenty years; and then we mask'd.*	"nuptials": Origin of "nuptial": Latin nūptiālis ("pertaining to marriage"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/nuptial#Etymology)
devotion (noun)	religious worship	*Good pilgrim, you do wrong your hand too much, Which mannerly devotion shows in this; For saints have hands that pilgrims' hands do touch, And palm to palm is holy palmers' kiss.*	"devotion": Origin: Old French devocion; earlier Latin dēvōtiō. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/devotion#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. What makes a first impression powerful? Can it be trusted?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate and choice?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Tybalt vow when Capulet stops him? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: That this intrusion shall convert to bitter gall.
2. What does Romeo compare Juliet to? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A rich jewel in an Ethiop's ear and a light teaching torches
3. Who recognizes Romeo? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Tybalt
4. Why does Capulet stop Tybalt? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He does not want a fight at his feast and Romeo is well spoken of
5. What form does the lovers' first conversation take? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A sonnet
6. How does Juliet learn Romeo's identity? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: From the Nurse
7. Retell the three most important events of “Act I, Scene V” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: At the feast Romeo sees Juliet and forgets Rosaline. Tybalt recognizes Romeo's voice and wants to fight; Capulet forbids it. Romeo and Juliet speak a shared sonnet and kiss twice. Each learns from the Nurse who the other is.
8. Who is on stage in “Act I, Scene V”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act I, Scene V” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “Good thou, save me a piece of marchpane; and, as thou lovest me, let the porter let in Susan Grindstone and Nell.” What does “marchpane” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: marchpane: marzipan, a sweet almond paste.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why do the lovers use religious words (saints, pilgrims, sin)? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: They make love sacred and make the kiss a prayer.

2. What does “Act I, Scene V” suggest about love at first sight at the Capulet feast? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The meeting fuses love and hate: Tybalt's vow of revenge and the lovers' discovery of each other's names come in the same scene.
3. Find one example of imagery in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about love at first sight at the Capulet feast? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from the start. Useful evidence: “O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright” (Act I, Scene V, Romeo): Juliet as light in darkness. Theme link: love at first sight, expressed in religious language that makes the kiss a prayer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright!”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act I, Scene V”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: At the feast Romeo sees Juliet and forgets Rosaline. Tybalt recognizes Romeo's voice and wants to fight; Capulet forbids it. Romeo and Juliet speak a shared sonnet and kiss twice. Each learns from the Nurse who the other is.
7. How does “Act I, Scene V” build on “Act I, Scene IV”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from the start. Useful evidence: “Did my heart love till now? forswear it, sight” (Act I, Scene V, Romeo): Romeo forgets Rosaline in a line. On structure: Romeo and Juliet's first fourteen lines together form a shared sonnet about pilgrims, saints and kisses. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from the start. Useful evidence: “My only love sprung from my only hate” (Act I, Scene V, Juliet): Juliet discovers Romeo is a Montague. Theme link: love at first sight, expressed in religious language that makes the kiss a prayer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “What makes a first impression powerful? Can it be trusted?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does irony appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with fate and choice? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from the start. Useful evidence: “O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright” (Act I, Scene V, Romeo): Juliet as light in darkness. Theme link: love at first sight, expressed in religious language that makes the kiss a prayer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is love at first sight believable in this scene? Defend your view with lines. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment using the sonnet and Romeo's light images.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from the start. Useful evidence: “Did my heart love till now? forswear it, sight” (Act I, Scene V, Romeo): Romeo forgets Rosaline in a line. Theme link: love at first sight, expressed in religious language that makes the kiss a prayer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The meeting fuses love and hate: Tybalt's vow of revenge and the lovers' discovery of each other's names come in the same scene.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from the start. Useful evidence: “My only love sprung from my only hate” (Act I, Scene V, Juliet): Juliet discovers Romeo is a Montague. Theme link: love at first sight, expressed in religious language that makes the kiss a prayer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from the start. Useful evidence: “O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright” (Act I, Scene V, Romeo): Juliet as light in darkness. Theme link: love at first sight, expressed in religious language that makes the kiss a prayer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act I, Scene V”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of love at first sight at the Capulet feast. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from the start. Useful evidence: “Did my heart love till now? forswear it, sight” (Act I, Scene V, Romeo): Romeo forgets Rosaline in a line. On structure: Romeo and Juliet's first fourteen lines together form a shared sonnet about pilgrims, saints and kisses. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act I, Scene V”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from

the start. Useful evidence: “My only love sprung from my only hate” (Act I, Scene V, Juliet): Juliet discovers Romeo is a Montague. Theme link: love at first sight, expressed in religious language that makes the kiss a prayer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to violence and the feud: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from the start. Useful evidence: “O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright” (Act I, Scene V, Romeo): Juliet as light in darkness. Theme link: love at first sight, expressed in religious language that makes the kiss a prayer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the imagery in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from the start. Useful evidence: “Did my heart love till now? forswear it, sight” (Act I, Scene V, Romeo): Romeo forgets Rosaline in a line. On imagery: Romeo's first sight of Juliet is all light: "O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright!" Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act I, Scene V” treats love at first sight at the Capulet feast with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from the start. Useful evidence: “My only love sprung from my only hate” (Act I, Scene V, Juliet): Juliet discovers Romeo is a Montague. Theme link: love at first sight, expressed in religious language that makes the kiss a prayer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act II, Prologue” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from the start. Useful evidence: “O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright” (Act I, Scene V, Romeo): Juliet as light in darkness. Theme link: love at first sight, expressed in religious language that makes the kiss a prayer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about love at first sight at the Capulet feast? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from the start. Useful evidence: “Did my heart love till now? forswear it, sight” (Act I, Scene V, Romeo): Romeo forgets Rosaline in a line. Theme link: love at first sight, expressed in religious language that makes the kiss

a prayer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "I will withdraw: but this _____ shall Now seeming sweet convert to bitter gall." Word bank: marchpane, intrusion, forswear, palmers
   Key: intrusion
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Good pilgrim, you do wrong your hand too much, Which mannerly devotion shows in this; For saints have hands that pilgrims' hands do touch, And palm to palm is holy palmers' kiss.", what does "palmers" most nearly mean?
   A. whims; also quarter notes in music
   B. pilgrims who carried a palm leaf from the Holy Land
   C. bringing to fullness
   D. increase; make (grief) multiply

   Key: B (pilgrims who carried a palm leaf from the Holy Land)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "So shows a snowy dove trooping with crows, As yonder lady o'er her fellows shows.", what does "trooping" most nearly mean?
   A. going along with a crowd
   B. a soft dressing applied to soothe pain
   C. supplies of food and drink
   D. those who start something

   Key: A (going along with a crowd)
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Prodigious birth of love it is to me, That I must love a _____ enemy." Word bank: loathed, marchpane, palmers, forswear
   Key: loathed
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does Juliet learn Romeo's identity?
   A. From her mother
   B. From the Nurse
   C. From Romeo
   D. From Tybalt

   Key: B (From the Nurse)
6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Romeo compare Juliet to?
   A. A song
   B. A red rose

C. The moon

D. A rich jewel in an Ethiop's ear and a light teaching torches

Key: D (A rich jewel in an Ethiop's ear and a light teaching torches)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why does Capulet stop Tybalt?

   A. He is afraid of Romeo

   B. He wants Juliet to dance

   C. He does not want a fight at his feast and Romeo is well spoken of

   D. He likes Montagues

   Key: C (He does not want a fight at his feast and Romeo is well spoken of)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Good pilgrim, you do wrong your hand too much, Which _____ devotion shows in this; For saints have hands that pilgrims’ hands do touch, And palm to palm is holy palmers’ kiss.” Word bank: forswear, marchpane, mannerly, palmers

   Key: mannerly

9. [short · recall · DOK 1] What does Tybalt vow when Capulet stops him?

   Sample answer: That this intrusion shall convert to bitter gall.

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why do the lovers use religious words (saints, pilgrims, sin)?

    Sample answer: They make love sacred and make the kiss a prayer.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “My only love sprung from my only hate” (Act I, Scene V, Juliet)

    A. Oxymorons express shock at Romeo's act.

    B. Juliet discovers Romeo is a Montague.

    C. Lady Capulet's book metaphor for a husband.

    D. Juliet's loyalty shifts to Romeo.

    Key: B (Juliet discovers Romeo is a Montague.)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright” (Act I, Scene V, Romeo)

    A. Both are bewitched by appearance.

    B. Juliet as light in darkness.

    C. Capulet's lament.

    D. Capulet asks Paris to wait.

    Key: B (Juliet as light in darkness.)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Did my heart love till now? forswear it, sight” (Act I, Scene V, Romeo) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Romeo forgets Rosaline in a line.

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from the start. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright” (Act I, Scene V, Romeo).

    Sample answer: Romeo's "O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright" is followed at once by Tybalt's rage, and Juliet's discovery ends the scene with "My only love sprung from my only hate."

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Love at first sight, expressed in religious language that makes the kiss a prayer.

    A. Youth and age

    B. Violence and the feud

    C. Fate and choice

    D. Love and desire

    Key: D (Love and desire)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright" (Act I, Scene V, Romeo) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Juliet as light in darkness.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who recognizes Romeo?

    A. Capulet

    B. The Nurse

    C. Paris

    D. Tybalt

    Key: D (Tybalt)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene V, Juliet: "My only love _____ from my only hate"

    Key: sprung

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Good thou, save me a piece of marchpane; and, as thou lovest me, let the porter let in Susan Grindstone and Nell.", what does "marchpane" most nearly mean?

    A. fitting; proper

    B. messengers who announce news

    C. a good-for-nothing girl

    D. marzipan, a sweet almond paste

    Key: D (marzipan, a sweet almond paste)

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What form does the lovers' first conversation take?

    A. A song

    B. A riddle

    C. A sonnet

    D. A letter

    Key: C (A sonnet)

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Act I, Scene V"?

    A. Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell

    B. Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation

    C. Friar Laurence agrees to marry them

    D. Love at first sight at the Capulet feast

    Key: D (Love at first sight at the Capulet feast)

22. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright” (Act I, Scene V, Romeo) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Juliet as light in darkness.

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act I, Scene V”? Romeo and Juliet's first fourteen lines together form a shared sonnet about pilgrims, saints and kisses.
    A. Structure
    B. Tone / mood
    C. Allusion
    D. Characterization
    Key: A (Structure)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act I, Scene V”? Romeo's first sight of Juliet is all light: "O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright!"
    A. Metaphor
    B. Allusion
    C. Imagery
    D. Characterization
    Key: C (Imagery)

25. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “He shift a _____? he scrape a trencher!” Word bank: trencher, forswear, marchpane, palmers
    Key: trencher

26. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Did my heart love till now? forswear it, sight” (Act I, Scene V, Romeo)
    A. The Prince blames the feud.
    B. Romeo forgets Rosaline in a line.
    C. The potion's effect.
    D. Romeo resolves to die.
    Key: B (Romeo forgets Rosaline in a line.)

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “My only love sprung from my only hate” (Act I, Scene V, Juliet). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Juliet discovers Romeo is a Montague.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is love at first sight believable in this scene? Defend your view with lines.
    Sample answer: A judgment using the sonnet and Romeo's light images.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how love and desire develops from an earlier scene to “Act I, Scene V”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: love at first sight, expressed in religious language that makes the kiss a prayer.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Did my heart love till now? forswear it, sight” (Act I, Scene V, Romeo) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Romeo forgets Rosaline in a line.

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from the start.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: Romeo's "O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright" is followed at once by Tybalt's rage, and Juliet's discovery ends the scene with "My only love sprung from my only hate."

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene V, Romeo: "Did my heart love till now? _____ it, sight"

    Key: forswear

33. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Did my heart love till now? forswear it, sight!", what does "forswear" most nearly mean?

    A. deny under oath; take back

    B. marzipan, a sweet almond paste

    C. going along with a crowd

    D. pilgrims who carried a palm leaf from the Holy Land

    Key: A (deny under oath; take back)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	2, 17, 5, 18, 4, 8, 19, 20, 21, 10, 13, 22, 23, 14, 24, 16	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	3, 1, 2, 25, 9, 8, 21, 10, 11, 26, 12, 27, 14, 23, 28, 29	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	3, 8, 17, 18, 7, 10, 11, 12, 22, 13, 15, 14, 23, 27, 30, 31	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	19, 7, 18, 4, 13, 21, 26, 22, 12, 14, 27, 23, 15, 31, 16, 28	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	32, 33, 25, 12, 22, 11, 13, 15, 24, 14, 23, 27, 30, 31, 29, 28	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	4, 8, 17, 10, 21, 22, 26, 14, 27, 23, 15, 24, 31, 28, 29, 16	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	32, 4, 13, 12, 22, 26, 27, 14, 24, 15, 23, 29, 28, 31, 16, 30	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	8, 4, 10, 22, 26, 21, 15, 24, 27, 23, 14, 30, 31, 29, 16, 28	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Senior	4, 8, 11, 13, 26, 12, 24, 15, 27, 23, 14, 28, 30, 16, 31, 29	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	32, 4, 13, 11, 21, 12, 23, 15, 24, 14, 27, 16, 28, 30, 31, 29	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act I, Scene V," how does Shakespeare show love at first sight at the Capulet

feast? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Act I, Scene V, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of love at first sight at the Capulet feast? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act I, Scene V develops the idea of love at first sight at the Capulet feast. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene V (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of love at first sight at the Capulet feast. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene V suggests about love at first sight at the Capulet feast. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses imagery in Act I, Scene V to complicate the reader's understanding of love at first sight at the Capulet feast. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act I, Scene V within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of love at first sight at the Capulet feast responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act I, Scene V alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of love at first sight at the Capulet feast follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act I, Scene V and its treatment of love at first sight at the Capulet feast. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's imagery and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act I, Scene V as evidence for a larger claim about love at first sight at the Capulet feast in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act I, Scene V as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of love at first sight at the Capulet feast. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

SAT-style questions

1. *Good pilgrim, you do wrong your hand too much, Which mannerly devotion shows in this; For saints have hands that pilgrims' hands do touch, And palm to palm is holy palmers' kiss.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "palmers" most nearly mean?

   A. forcing oneself in where one is not wanted

   B. a wedding

   C. pilgrims who carried a palm leaf from the Holy Land

   D. religious worship

2. *O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright! It seems she hangs upon the cheek of night Like a rich jewel in an Ethiope's ear; Beauty too rich for use, for earth too dear! So shows a snowy dove trooping with crows, As yonder lady o'er her fellows shows. The measure done, I'll watch her place of stand, And, touching hers, make blessed my rude hand. Did my heart love till now? forswear it, sight! For I ne'er saw true beauty till this night.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act I, Scene V"?

   A. The secret wedding

   B. Capulet sets the wedding to Paris

   C. Mercutio's death and Tybalt's

   D. Love at first sight at the Capulet feast

SAT key: 1. C (pilgrims who carried a palm leaf from the Holy Land); 2. D (Love at first sight at the Capulet feast)

Lesson 9: Act II, Prologue

Focus: the second Chorus

Objective: Students will summarize what happens in Act II, Prologue (the second Chorus) in 2 sentences and, in a 3-sentence warm-up response, explain how one quoted line from the scene sets up the scene that follows.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1

Critical voice: "The use of this chorus is not easily discovered, it conduces nothing to the progress of the play, but relates what is already known or what the next scenes will shew; and relates it without adding the improvement of any moral sentiment." (Samuel Johnson, critic and lexicographer, *Notes to Romeo and Juliet, The Plays of William Shakespeare (1765), in Preface to Shakespeare, together with selected notes on some of the plays, note on Act II, Prologue (Act I, Chorus)*; public domain). Defend or cut: directors often drop this Chorus. Students argue for keeping it, against Johnson. *Objective:* Evaluate the function of the Act II Chorus. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.5

Teacher only · spoilers

The Chorus reports that Romeo's old love has died and a new one replaced it; both lovers are bewitched by looks. As enemies they cannot meet freely, but passion gives them the power and time the means.

Background: Choruses between acts were less common in English plays than in classical drama; this is the only one between acts in the play.

Significance: It frames the next act and invites the audience to judge the speed of Romeo's change.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How fast can someone fall out of love and into a new one? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to love and desire because....
Prompt: How fast can someone fall out of love and into a new one?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to love and desire because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the Chorus questions how fast Romeo's love moved from Rosaline to Juliet.

8–16 min · Background and context · I do (8 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Choruses between acts were less common in English plays than in classical drama; this is the only one between acts in the play. It frames the next act and invites the audience to judge the speed of Romeo's change. Structure: A second sonnet-Chorus summarizes the change in Romeo and the obstacles ahead. Diction / vocabulary: Balanced antitheses ("old desire" and "young affection"; "extremities" and "extreme sweet"). Irony: The Chorus notes that Rosaline, once Romeo's all, "is now not fair." Watch for bait and hooks: "love's sweet bait from fearful hooks": love as fishing, sweet but dangerous to the one who takes it.

> **16–20 min · Closure · I do (4 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how structure shapes the second Chorus. Key takeaway: the Chorus questions how fast Romeo's love moved from Rosaline to Juliet.*

Total: 20 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Structure:** A second sonnet-Chorus summarizes the change in Romeo and the obstacles ahead.
- **Diction / vocabulary:** Balanced antitheses ("old desire" and "young affection"; "extremities" and "extreme sweet").
- **Irony:** The Chorus notes that Rosaline, once Romeo's all, "is now not fair."

Themes and how they develop

- **love and desire:** the Chorus questions how fast Romeo's love moved from Rosaline to Juliet.

Symbols and motifs

- **bait and hooks:** "love's sweet bait from fearful hooks": love as fishing, sweet but dangerous to the one who takes it.
- **the deathbed:** Romeo's old love lies dying; the image of a deathbed already joins love and death (death as bridegroom).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Now old desire doth in his death-bed lie, / And young affection gapes to be his heir” (Act II, Prologue, Chorus) Romeo's love for Rosaline dies; a new one takes its place.
- “Alike betwitched by the charm of looks” (Act II, Prologue, Chorus) Both are bewitched by appearance.
- “But passion lends them power, time means, to meet” (Act II, Prologue, Chorus) Passion overcomes obstacles.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The second Chorus invites the audience to judge how quickly Romeo's affection shifts.
Evidence: “Now old desire doth in his death-bed lie, / And young affection gapes to be his heir” (Act II, Prologue, Chorus)
Reasoning: "Now old desire doth in his death-bed lie, / And young affection gapes to be his heir," and both lovers are "betwitched by the charm of looks."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history

Discussion questions

1. How fast can someone fall out of love and into a new one?
2. Where does structure appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with violence and the feud?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Who is Romeo's 'old desire'? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Rosaline.
2. What does the Chorus say has died? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Old desire
3. What has bewitched the lovers? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The charm of looks
4. What stops them meeting freely? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: They are enemies by family
5. What gives them power to meet? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Passion
6. Who speaks this passage? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The Chorus
7. Retell the three most important events of “Act II, Prologue” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The Chorus reports that Romeo's old love has died and a new one replaced it; both lovers are bewitched by looks. As enemies they cannot meet freely, but passion gives them the power and time the means.
8. Who is on stage in “Act II, Prologue”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act II, Prologue” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. In the passage that begins “Now old desire doth in his death-bed lie, And young affection gapes to be his heir; That fair for which love groan’d for and would die, With tender Juliet match’d, is now not fair.”, who is speaking or being described, and what do they say or do? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Literal paraphrase of the anchor passage.

Inferential / analytical

1. What tone does the Chorus take toward the lovers? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Sympathetic but slightly ironic about how quickly love shifted.

2. What does “Act II, Prologue” suggest about the second Chorus? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: It frames the next act and invites the audience to judge the speed of Romeo's change.
3. Find one example of structure in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.
4. How does the diction / vocabulary in this scene shape what we understand about the second Chorus? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for precise or unusual word choices and their connotations.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The second Chorus invites the audience to judge how quickly Romeo's affection shifts. Useful evidence: “Now old desire doth in his death-bed lie, / And young affection gapes to be his heir” (Act II, Prologue, Chorus): Romeo's love for Rosaline dies; a new one takes its place. On diction / vocabulary: Balanced antitheses ("old desire" and "young affection"; "extremities" and "extreme sweet"). Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Now old desire doth in his death-bed lie, And young affection gapes to be his heir; That fair for which love groan’d for and would die, With tender Juliet match’d, is now not fair.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act II, Prologue”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: The Chorus reports that Romeo's old love has died and a new one replaced it; both lovers are bewitched by looks. As enemies they cannot meet freely, but passion gives them the power and time the means.
7. How does “Act II, Prologue” build on “Act I, Scene V”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The second Chorus invites the audience to judge how quickly Romeo's affection shifts. Useful evidence: “Alike betwitched by the charm of looks” (Act II, Prologue, Chorus): Both are bewitched by appearance. On structure: A second sonnet-Chorus summarizes the change in Romeo and the obstacles ahead. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The second Chorus invites the audience to judge how quickly Romeo's affection shifts. Useful evidence: “But passion lends them power, time means, to meet” (Act II, Prologue, Chorus): Passion overcomes obstacles. Theme link: the Chorus questions how fast Romeo's love moved from Rosaline to Juliet. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “How fast can someone fall out of love and into a new one?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

10. Where does irony appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with violence and the feud? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The second Chorus invites the audience to judge how quickly Romeo's affection shifts. Useful evidence: “Now old desire doth in his death-bed lie, / And young affection gapes to be his heir” (Act II, Prologue, Chorus): Romeo's love for Rosaline dies; a new one takes its place. On irony: The Chorus notes that Rosaline, once Romeo's all, "is now not fair." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is the second Chorus needed? Argue for keeping or cutting it. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: An argument about structure and audience guidance.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The second Chorus invites the audience to judge how quickly Romeo's affection shifts. Useful evidence: “Alike betwitched by the charm of looks” (Act II, Prologue, Chorus): Both are bewitched by appearance. Theme link: the Chorus questions how fast Romeo's love moved from Rosaline to Juliet. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “It frames the next act and invites the audience to judge the speed of Romeo's change.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The second Chorus invites the audience to judge how quickly Romeo's affection shifts. Useful evidence: “But passion lends them power, time means, to meet” (Act II, Prologue, Chorus): Passion overcomes obstacles. Theme link: the Chorus questions how fast Romeo's love moved from Rosaline to Juliet. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The second Chorus invites the audience to judge how quickly Romeo's affection shifts. Useful evidence: “Now old desire doth in his death-bed lie, / And young affection gapes to be his heir” (Act II, Prologue, Chorus): Romeo's love for Rosaline dies; a new one takes its place. Theme link: the Chorus questions how fast Romeo's love moved from Rosaline to Juliet. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act II, Prologue”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the second Chorus. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The second Chorus invites the audience to judge how quickly Romeo's affection shifts. Useful evidence: “Alike betwitched by the charm of looks” (Act II, Prologue, Chorus): Both are bewitched by appearance. On structure: A second sonnet-Chorus summarizes

the change in Romeo and the obstacles ahead. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act II, Prologue”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The second Chorus invites the audience to judge how quickly Romeo's affection shifts. Useful evidence: “But passion lends them power, time means, to meet” (Act II, Prologue, Chorus): Passion overcomes obstacles. Theme link: the Chorus questions how fast Romeo's love moved from Rosaline to Juliet. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to youth and age: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The second Chorus invites the audience to judge how quickly Romeo's affection shifts. Useful evidence: “Now old desire doth in his death-bed lie, / And young affection gapes to be his heir” (Act II, Prologue, Chorus): Romeo's love for Rosaline dies; a new one takes its place. Theme link: the Chorus questions how fast Romeo's love moved from Rosaline to Juliet. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the structure in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The second Chorus invites the audience to judge how quickly Romeo's affection shifts. Useful evidence: “Alike betwitched by the charm of looks” (Act II, Prologue, Chorus): Both are bewitched by appearance. On structure: A second sonnet-Chorus summarizes the change in Romeo and the obstacles ahead. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act II, Prologue” treats the second Chorus with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The second Chorus invites the audience to judge how quickly Romeo's affection shifts. Useful evidence: “But passion lends them power, time means, to meet” (Act II, Prologue, Chorus): Passion overcomes obstacles. Theme link: the Chorus questions how fast Romeo's love moved from Rosaline to Juliet. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act II, Scene I” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The second Chorus invites the audience to judge how quickly Romeo's affection shifts. Useful evidence: “Now old desire doth in his death-bed lie, / And young affection gapes to be his heir” (Act II, Prologue, Chorus): Romeo's love for Rosaline dies; a new one takes its place. Theme link: the Chorus questions how fast Romeo's love moved from Rosaline to Juliet. Credit

any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the second Chorus? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2]
    Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The second Chorus invites the audience to judge how quickly Romeo's affection shifts. Useful evidence: “Alike betwitched by the charm of looks” (Act II, Prologue, Chorus): Both are bewitched by appearance. Theme link: the Chorus questions how fast Romeo's love moved from Rosaline to Juliet. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Structure:** look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Diction / vocabulary**: precise or unusual word choices and their connotations
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Prologue, Chorus: “Now old desire doth in his death-bed lie, / And young _____ gapes to be his heir”
   Key: affection
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What stops them meeting freely?
   A. The plague
   B. Juliet is married
   C. Romeo is banished
   D. They are enemies by family
   Key: D (They are enemies by family)
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Prologue, Chorus: “But _____ lends them power, time means, to meet”
   Key: passion
4. [short · recall · DOK 1] Who is Romeo's 'old desire'?
   Sample answer: Rosaline.
5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Prologue, Chorus: “Alike _____ by the charm of looks”
   Key: betwitched
6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What has bewitched the lovers?
   A. Letters
   B. A potion
   C. Music
   D. The charm of looks
   Key: D (The charm of looks)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does the Chorus say has died?

   A. Old desire

   B. The feud

   C. Romeo's father

   D. Tybalt

   Key: A (Old desire)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who speaks this passage?

   A. Romeo

   B. Friar Laurence

   C. The Chorus

   D. The Prince

   Key: C (The Chorus)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What gives them power to meet?

   A. The Prince

   B. Mercutio

   C. Money

   D. Passion

   Key: D (Passion)

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Act II, Prologue"?

    A. The Friar's desperate plan

    B. Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition

    C. Friar Laurence agrees to marry them

    D. The second Chorus

    Key: D (The second Chorus)

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? "Alike betwitched by the charm of looks" (Act II, Prologue, Chorus)

    A. Both are bewitched by appearance.

    B. Tybalt's first speech: hatred for its own sake.

    C. The letter returned.

    D. Citizens stain their hands with the blood of fellow citizens.

    Key: A (Both are bewitched by appearance.)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? "Now old desire doth in his death-bed lie, / And young affection gapes to be his heir" (Act II, Prologue, Chorus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Romeo's love for Rosaline dies; a new one takes its place.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What tone does the Chorus take toward the lovers?

    Sample answer: Sympathetic but slightly ironic about how quickly love shifted.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in "Act II, Prologue"? A second sonnet-Chorus summarizes the change in Romeo and the obstacles ahead.

    A. Imagery

B. Structure

C. Simile

D. Tone / mood

Key: B (Structure)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The second Chorus invites the audience to judge how quickly Romeo's affection shifts. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Now old desire doth in his death-bed lie, / And young affection gapes to be his heir” (Act II, Prologue, Chorus).
    Sample answer: "Now old desire doth in his death-bed lie, / And young affection gapes to be his heir," and both lovers are "betwitched by the charm of looks."
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The second Chorus invites the audience to judge how quickly Romeo's affection shifts.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: "Now old desire doth in his death-bed lie, / And young affection gapes to be his heir," and both lovers are "betwitched by the charm of looks."
17. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Alike betwitched by the charm of looks” (Act II, Prologue, Chorus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Both are bewitched by appearance.
18. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? The Chorus questions how fast Romeo's love moved from Rosaline to Juliet.

    A. Fate and choice

    B. Youth and age

    C. Violence and the feud

    D. Love and desire

    Key: D (Love and desire)
19. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act II, Prologue”? Balanced antitheses ("old desire" and "young affection"; "extremities" and "extreme sweet").

    A. Diction / vocabulary

    B. Point of view

    C. Setting

    D. Structure

    Key: A (Diction / vocabulary)
20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how love and desire develops from an earlier scene to “Act II, Prologue”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: the Chorus questions how fast Romeo's love moved from Rosaline to Juliet.
21. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Now old desire doth in his death-bed lie, / And young affection gapes to be his heir” (Act II, Prologue, Chorus)

    A. Juliet urges the sun's horses to bring night.

    B. Mercutio stands between the Prince's family and the Montagues.

    C. Romeo blames love for softening him.

    D. Romeo's love for Rosaline dies; a new one takes its place.

    Key: D (Romeo's love for Rosaline dies; a new one takes its place.)

22. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in "But passion lends them power, time means, to meet" (Act II, Prologue, Chorus). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Passion overcomes obstacles.
23. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? "But passion lends them power, time means, to meet" (Act II, Prologue, Chorus)
    A. Mercutio's dying curse on the feud.
    B. Love wants instant messages.
    C. Passion overcomes obstacles.
    D. Juliet as the sun.
    Key: C (Passion overcomes obstacles.)
24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Now old desire doth in his death-bed lie, / And young affection gapes to be his heir" (Act II, Prologue, Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Romeo's love for Rosaline dies; a new one takes its place.
25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Alike betwitched by the charm of looks" (Act II, Prologue, Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Both are bewitched by appearance.
26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is the second Chorus needed? Argue for keeping or cutting it.
    Sample answer: An argument about structure and audience guidance.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	9, 3, 4, 2, 8, 6, 5, 7, 17, 11, 12, 10, 18, 19, 15, 20	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	2, 1, 5, 6, 8, 9, 21, 17, 10, 13, 11, 22, 14, 19, 16, 20	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	1, 4, 8, 9, 5, 10, 23, 12, 21, 17, 18, 19, 22, 14, 20, 16	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	5, 9, 1, 7, 10, 23, 13, 12, 17, 19, 14, 22, 15, 16, 24, 20	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	5, 2, 1, 17, 10, 11, 12, 22, 15, 14, 18, 19, 20, 25, 16, 24	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	5, 1, 9, 23, 10, 17, 12, 19, 15, 14, 18, 22, 25, 24, 26, 16	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	1, 5, 12, 13, 23, 21, 14, 15, 22, 19, 18, 25, 16, 24, 26, 20	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	1, 5, 21, 17, 13, 12, 19, 15, 18, 14, 22, 24, 25, 20, 26, 16	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Senior	1, 5, 21, 17, 13, 10, 14, 15, 18, 22, 19, 20, 26, 16, 25, 24	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	5, 1, 13, 23, 12, 21, 18, 22, 14, 15, 19, 26, 16, 25, 24, 20	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act II, Prologue," how does Shakespeare show the second Chorus? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the structure you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In Act II, Prologue, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the second Chorus? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the structure in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act II, Prologue develops the idea of the second Chorus. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and diction / vocabulary shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act II, Prologue (where it begins, turns and ends) and its structure shape the reader's understanding of the second Chorus. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act II, Prologue suggests about the second Chorus. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's structure and diction / vocabulary), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses structure in Act II, Prologue to complicate the reader's understanding of the second Chorus. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act II, Prologue within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the second Chorus responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act II, Prologue alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the second Chorus follows or bends those conventions, using the structure as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act II, Prologue and its treatment of the second Chorus. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's structure and diction / vocabulary, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act II, Prologue as evidence for a larger claim about the second Chorus in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act II, Prologue as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the second Chorus. Position your reading within a

named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

SAT-style questions

1. *Now old desire doth in his death-bed lie, And young affection gapes to be his heir; That fair for which love groan'd for and would die, With tender Juliet match'd, is now not fair. Now Romeo is beloved and loves again, Alike betwitched by the charm of looks, But to his foe supposed he must complain, And she steal love's sweet bait from fearful hooks: Being held a foe, he may not have access To breathe such vows as lovers use to swear; And she as much in love, her means much less To meet her new-beloved any where: But passion lends them power, time means, to meet, Tempering extremities with extreme sweet. Exit.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act II, Prologue"?

   A. Juliet drinks the potion

   B. The second Chorus

   C. Juliet hears the news

   D. The Friar's desperate plan

SAT key: 1. B (The second Chorus)

Lesson 10: Act II, Scene I

Focus: Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in "Act II, Scene I" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (sexual innuendo): Mercutio's conjuring speech about Rosaline is openly bawdy. Summarize rather than read every line aloud; focus on how his mockery contrasts with Romeo's love.
Student preview: Mercutio makes crude jokes in this scene.
Suggested language: "How is Mercutio's view of love different from Romeo's?"

Teacher only · spoilers

After the feast Romeo hides in the Capulet orchard. Mercutio and Benvolio call for him; Mercutio mockingly conjures him by Rosaline's body parts. Benvolio says love is blind; they go home.

Background: Mercutio's bawdy jokes were part of Elizabethan comedy and appealed to all parts of the audience.

Significance: The scene contrasts friends' cynical view of love with the devotion that follows in the balcony scene.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How do friends react when someone falls in love? Why? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to love and desire because.... Content note before we start: Mercutio makes crude jokes in this scene.
Prompt: How do friends react when someone falls in love? Why?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to love and desire because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Mercutio reduces love to the body; the next scene will lift it to the stars.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: demesnes — lands; domains; truckle — a low bed on wheels kept under a larger one; consorted — kept company; conjure — call up (a spirit) by a magic spell; purblind — partly blind; dim-sighted. "conjure": Origin: Old French conjurer; earlier Latin coniūrō ("to swear together").
Words: demesnes: lands; domains · truckle: a low bed on wheels kept under a larger one · consorted: kept company · conjure: call up (a spirit) by a magic spell · purblind: partly blind; dim-sighted

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Mercutio's bawdy jokes were part of Elizabethan comedy and appealed to all parts of the audience. The scene contrasts friends' cynical view of love with the devotion that follows in the balcony scene. Characterization: Mercutio's bawdy conjuring of Rosaline contrasts with Romeo's new seriousness. Irony: Mercutio calls for Romeo by Rosaline's name, not knowing she no longer matters. Diction / vocabulary: "He jests at scars that never felt a wound" (the first line of the next scene) answers Mercutio's mockery. Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "himself among these trees, / To be consorted with the humorous night: / Blind is his love and best befits the dark" (Act II, Scene I, Benvolio).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "I conjure thee by Rosaline's bright eyes" slowly and put it in my own words: Mercutio, not knowing Romeo loves Juliet, mockingly conjures Romeo to appear by Rosaline's bright eyes. Next, craft. I notice the mock-magic "conjure," as if he were summoning a spirit. The strongest word is "conjure": it is a word for raising spirits, making fun of lovesick Romeo. Then, effect. What is Mercutio doing when he calls on Rosaline's eyes? My answer: When Mercutio calls on Rosaline's eyes, he is mockingly conjuring Romeo like a spirit, teasing him as Rosaline's lover; he does not know Romeo has fallen for Juliet, which sets up the seriousness of the balcony scene.

> *I conjure thee by Rosaline's bright eyes (Act II, Scene I, Mercutio)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "I conjure thee by Rosaline's bright eyes" slowly and put it in my own words: Mercutio, not knowing Romeo loves Juliet, mockingly conjures Romeo to appear by Rosaline's bright eyes. Next, craft. I notice the mock-magic "conjure," as if he were summoning a spirit. The strongest word is "conjure": it is a word for raising spirits, making fun of lovesick Romeo. Then, effect. What is Mercutio doing when he calls on Rosaline's eyes? My answer: When Mercutio calls on Rosaline's eyes, he is mockingly conjuring Romeo like a spirit, teasing him as Rosaline's lover; he does not know Romeo has fallen for Juliet, which sets up the seriousness of the balcony scene.

40–50 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (10 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Mercutio mocks love as blind and fit for darkness; ironically, Romeo's real love will live in the dark. Expected link: love and desire. Ask: How does this line connect to love and desire? Expected: Mercutio reduces love to the body; the next scene will lift it to the stars. (Mercutio's joke: love is blind, so it suits the night.)

> *Blind is his love and best befits the dark* (Act II, Scene I, Benvolio)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Mercutio mocks love as blind and fit for darkness; ironically, Romeo's real love will live in the dark. Expected link: love and desire.
Ask: How does this line connect to love and desire?
Expected answer: Mercutio reduces love to the body; the next scene will lift it to the stars. (Mercutio's joke: love is blind, so it suits the night.)

50–55 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (5 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene I develops the idea of Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see love as a joke or a bodily urge. When the text says "Blind is his love and best befits the dark" (Act II, Scene I, Benvolio), it shows this directly. He conjures Romeo "by Rosaline's bright eyes" and jokes that "Blind is his love and best befits the dark," not knowing Romeo has already left Rosaline behind.
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene I develops the idea of Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see love as a joke or a bodily urge. When the text says "Blind is his love and best befits the dark" (Act II, Scene I, Benvolio), it shows this directly. He conjures Romeo "by Rosaline's bright eyes" and jokes that "Blind is his love and best befits the dark," not knowing Romeo has already left Rosaline behind.

55–60 min · Discussion · We do (5 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: How do friends react when someone falls in love? Why? Ask: is Mercutio a good friend to Romeo? What does he understand, and what does he miss?
Anchor question: How do friends react when someone falls in love? Why?
Facilitation: Ask: is Mercutio a good friend to Romeo? What does he understand, and what does he miss?

60–67 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see love as a joke or a bodily urge. ("Blind is his love and best befits the dark", Act II, Scene I, Benvolio). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see love as a joke or a bodily urge. ("Blind is his love and best befits the dark", Act II, Scene I, Benvolio). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

67–70 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard. Key takeaway: Mercutio reduces love to the body; the next scene will lift it to the stars.

Total: 70 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Mercutio's bawdy conjuring of Rosaline contrasts with Romeo's new seriousness.
- **Irony:** Mercutio calls for Romeo by Rosaline's name, not knowing she no longer matters.
- **Diction / vocabulary:** "He jests at scars that never felt a wound" (the first line of the next scene) answers Mercutio's mockery.

Themes and how they develop

- **love and desire:** Mercutio reduces love to the body; the next scene will lift it to the stars.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "himself among these trees, / To be consorted with the humorous night: / Blind is his love and best befits the dark" (Act II, Scene I, Benvolio).
- **names and identity:** Names carry the feud ("Montague," "Capulet"); Juliet wishes a name were only a word. In this scene: "my invocation / Is fair and honest, and in his mistress' name / I conjure only but to raise up him" (Act II, Scene I, Mercutio).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "I conjure thee by Rosaline's bright eyes" (Act II, Scene I, Mercutio) Mercutio's mock spell.

- “Blind is his love and best befits the dark” (Act II, Scene I, Benvolio) Mercutio's joke: love is blind, so it suits the night.
- “Romeo, good night: I’ll to my truckle-bed” (Act II, Scene I, Mercutio) Mercutio gives up and goes home.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see love as a joke or a bodily urge.
Evidence: “Blind is his love and best befits the dark” (Act II, Scene I, Benvolio)
Reasoning: He conjures Romeo "by Rosaline's bright eyes" and jokes that "Blind is his love and best befits the dark," not knowing Romeo has already left Rosaline behind.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
demesnes (noun)	lands; domains	*I conjure thee by Rosaline’s bright eyes, By her high forehead and her scarlet lip, By her fine foot, straight leg and quivering thigh And the demesnes that there adjacent lie, That in thy likeness thou appear to us!*	
truckle (noun)	a low bed on wheels kept under a larger one	*Romeo, good night: I’ll to my truckle-bed; This field-bed is too cold for me to sleep: Come, shall we go?*	
consorted (verb)	kept company	*Come, he hath hid himself among these trees, To be consorted with the humorous night: Blind is his love and best befits the dark.*	
conjure (verb)	call up (a spirit) by a magic spell	*He heareth not, he stirreth not, he moveth not; The ape is dead, and I must conjure him.*	“conjure”: Origin: Old French conjurer; earlier Latin coniūrō (“to swear together”). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/conjure#Etymology)
purblind (adjective)	partly blind; dim-sighted	*Speak to my gossip Venus one fair word, One nick-name for her purblind son and heir, Young Adam Cupid, he that shot so trim, When King Cophetua loved the beggar-maid!*	
humorous (adjective)	damp; also moody, ruled by humours	*Come, he hath hid himself among these trees, To be consorted with the humorous night: Blind is his love and best befits the dark.*	“humorous”: Origin: either an English formation from humor + -ous or Medieval Latin hūmōrōsus; sources differ. (Liber et

			Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/humorous#Etymology)
orchard (noun)	an enclosed garden of fruit trees	*A lane by the wall of Capulet's orchard.*	

Discussion questions

1. How do friends react when someone falls in love? Why?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with youth and age?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Why can't Mercutio find Romeo? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Romeo has leaped the orchard wall to be near Juliet.
2. Where does Romeo hide? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: In the Capulet orchard
3. Whose name does Mercutio use to conjure Romeo? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Rosaline's
4. What does Mercutio say about love? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: It is blind
5. Who goes home with Mercutio? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Benvolio
6. What tone does Mercutio's speech have? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Mocking and bawdy
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act II, Scene I" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: After the feast Romeo hides in the Capulet orchard. Mercutio and Benvolio call for him; Mercutio mockingly conjures him by Rosaline's body parts. Benvolio says love is blind; they go home.
8. Who is on stage in "Act II, Scene I", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act II, Scene I" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.

10. Reread: “I conjure thee by Rosaline’s bright eyes, By her high forehead and her scarlet lip, By her fine foot, straight leg and quivering thigh And the demesnes that there adjacent lie, That in thy likeness thou appear to us!” What does “demesnes” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: demesnes: lands; domains.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does the irony of Mercutio invoking Rosaline reveal? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: His friends don't know Romeo has changed; Romeo now hides his life from them.
2. What does “Act II, Scene I” suggest about Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The scene contrasts friends' cynical view of love with the devotion that follows in the balcony scene.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the irony in this scene shape what we understand about Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see love as a joke or a bodily urge. Useful evidence: “I conjure thee by Rosaline’s bright eyes” (Act II, Scene I, Mercutio): Mercutio's mock spell. On irony: Mercutio calls for Romeo by Rosaline's name, not knowing she no longer matters. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Nay, I’ll conjure too.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act II, Scene I”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: After the feast Romeo hides in the Capulet orchard. Mercutio and Benvolio call for him; Mercutio mockingly conjures him by Rosaline's body parts. Benvolio says love is blind; they go home.
7. How does “Act II, Scene I” build on “Act II, Prologue”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see love as a joke or a bodily urge. Useful evidence: “Blind is his love and best befits the dark” (Act II, Scene I, Benvolio): Mercutio's joke: love is blind, so it suits the night. Theme link: Mercutio reduces love to the body; the next scene will lift it to the stars. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see love as a joke or a bodily urge. Useful evidence: “Romeo, good night: I’ll to my truckle-bed” (Act II, Scene I, Mercutio): Mercutio gives up and goes home. On characterization: Mercutio's bawdy conjuring of

Rosaline contrasts with Romeo's new seriousness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “How do friends react when someone falls in love? Why?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does diction / vocabulary appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with youth and age? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for precise or unusual word choices and their connotations.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see love as a joke or a bodily urge. Useful evidence: “I conjure thee by Rosaline’s bright eyes” (Act II, Scene I, Mercutio): Mercutio's mock spell. On diction / vocabulary: "He jests at scars that never felt a wound" (the first line of the next scene) answers Mercutio's mockery. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Mercutio's mockery cruel or affectionate? Support your view. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: An argument using his tone and Benvolio's response.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see love as a joke or a bodily urge. Useful evidence: “Blind is his love and best befits the dark” (Act II, Scene I, Benvolio): Mercutio's joke: love is blind, so it suits the night. Theme link: Mercutio reduces love to the body; the next scene will lift it to the stars. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The scene contrasts friends' cynical view of love with the devotion that follows in the balcony scene.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see love as a joke or a bodily urge. Useful evidence: “Romeo, good night: I’ll to my truckle-bed” (Act II, Scene I, Mercutio): Mercutio gives up and goes home. Theme link: Mercutio reduces love to the body; the next scene will lift it to the stars. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see love as a joke or a bodily urge. Useful evidence: “I conjure thee by Rosaline’s bright eyes” (Act II, Scene I, Mercutio): Mercutio's mock spell. On characterization: Mercutio's bawdy conjuring of Rosaline contrasts with Romeo's new seriousness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act II, Scene I”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see

love as a joke or a bodily urge. Useful evidence: “Blind is his love and best befits the dark” (Act II, Scene I, Benvolio): Mercutio's joke: love is blind, so it suits the night. Theme link: Mercutio reduces love to the body; the next scene will lift it to the stars. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act II, Scene I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see love as a joke or a bodily urge. Useful evidence: “Romeo, good night: I’ll to my truckle-bed” (Act II, Scene I, Mercutio): Mercutio gives up and goes home. Theme link: Mercutio reduces love to the body; the next scene will lift it to the stars. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to time and haste: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see love as a joke or a bodily urge. Useful evidence: “I conjure thee by Rosaline’s bright eyes” (Act II, Scene I, Mercutio): Mercutio's mock spell. Theme link: Mercutio reduces love to the body; the next scene will lift it to the stars. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see love as a joke or a bodily urge. Useful evidence: “Blind is his love and best befits the dark” (Act II, Scene I, Benvolio): Mercutio's joke: love is blind, so it suits the night. On characterization: Mercutio's bawdy conjuring of Rosaline contrasts with Romeo's new seriousness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act II, Scene I” treats Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see love as a joke or a bodily urge. Useful evidence: “Romeo, good night: I’ll to my truckle-bed” (Act II, Scene I, Mercutio): Mercutio gives up and goes home. Theme link: Mercutio reduces love to the body; the next scene will lift it to the stars. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act II, Scene II” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see love as a joke or a bodily urge. Useful evidence: “I conjure thee by Rosaline’s bright eyes” (Act II, Scene I, Mercutio): Mercutio's mock spell. Theme link: Mercutio reduces love to the body; the next scene will lift it

to the stars. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see love as a joke or a bodily urge. Useful evidence: “Blind is his love and best befits the dark” (Act II, Scene I, Benvolio): Mercutio's joke: love is blind, so it suits the night. Theme link: Mercutio reduces love to the body; the next scene will lift it to the stars. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Diction / vocabulary**: precise or unusual word choices and their connotations

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “He heareth not, he stirreth not, he moveth not; The ape is dead, and I must conjure him.”, what does “conjure” most nearly mean?
    A. puzzling; speaking in riddles
    B. call up (a spirit) by a magic spell
    C. a young rooster
    D. accuse

    Key: B (call up (a spirit) by a magic spell)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Romeo, good night: I'll to my truckle-bed; This field-bed is too cold for me to sleep: Come, shall we go?”, what does “truckle” most nearly mean?
    A. a low bed on wheels kept under a larger one
    B. fine spider threads floating in the air
    C. people in masks and costume who join a party
    D. deny under oath; take back

    Key: A (a low bed on wheels kept under a larger one)
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Come, he hath hid himself among these trees, To be consorted with the _____ night: Blind is his love and best befits the dark.” Word bank: humorous, consorted, demesnes, truckle

    Key: humorous
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene I, Mercutio: “I conjure thee by _____'s bright eyes”

    Key: Rosaline

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Come, he hath hid himself among these trees, To be consorted with the humorous night: Blind is his love and best befits the dark.”, what does “consorted” most nearly mean?

   A. kept company

   B. full of fear; dreadful

   C. a marriage settlement for a bride

   D. an old saying

   Key: A (kept company)

6. [short · recall · DOK 1] Why can't Mercutio find Romeo?

   Sample answer: Romeo has leaped the orchard wall to be near Juliet.

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Speak to my gossip Venus one fair word, One nick-name for her _____ son and heir, Young Adam Cupid, he that shot so trim, When King Cophetua loved the beggar-maid!” Word bank: truckle, demesnes, consorted, purblind

   Key: purblind

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where does Romeo hide?

   A. In church

   B. In the Capulet orchard

   C. At home

   D. In Mantua

   Key: B (In the Capulet orchard)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What tone does Mercutio's speech have?

   A. Grieving

   B. Fearful

   C. Mocking and bawdy

   D. Formal

   Key: C (Mocking and bawdy)

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] What does the irony of Mercutio invoking Rosaline reveal?

    Sample answer: His friends don't know Romeo has changed; Romeo now hides his life from them.

11. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “I conjure thee by Rosaline’s bright eyes” (Act II, Scene I, Mercutio) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Mercutio's mock spell.

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I conjure thee by Rosaline’s bright eyes” (Act II, Scene I, Mercutio)

    A. Mercutio's nickname for Tybalt (Tybalt is a cat's name in fables).

    B. Romeo's oxymorons link love and the feud in one phrase.

    C. The Friar's doubt about Romeo's love.

    D. Mercutio's mock spell.

    Key: D (Mercutio's mock spell.)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Blind is his love and best befits the dark” (Act II, Scene I, Benvolio) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Mercutio's joke: love is blind, so it suits the night.

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see love as a joke or a bodily urge. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Blind is his love and best befits the dark” (Act II, Scene I, Benvolio).
    Sample answer: He conjures Romeo "by Rosaline's bright eyes" and jokes that "Blind is his love and best befits the dark," not knowing Romeo has already left Rosaline behind.
15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Romeo, good night: I’ll to my truckle-bed” (Act II, Scene I, Mercutio). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Mercutio gives up and goes home.
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I conjure thee by Rosaline’s bright eyes” (Act II, Scene I, Mercutio) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Mercutio's mock spell.
17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene I, Benvolio: “Blind is his love and best _____ the dark”
    Key: befits
18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Mercutio say about love?
    A. It is holy
    B. It is dangerous
    C. It is eternal
    D. It is blind

    Key: D (It is blind)
19. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene I, Mercutio: “Romeo, good night: I’ll to my _____-bed”
    Key: truckle
20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Whose name does Mercutio use to conjure Romeo?
    A. Juliet's
    B. Tybalt's
    C. Rosaline's
    D. The Nurse's

    Key: C (Rosaline's)
21. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Blind is his love and best befits the dark” (Act II, Scene I, Benvolio)
    A. Mercutio's joke: love is blind, so it suits the night.
    B. Romeo resolves to die.
    C. The quarantine.
    D. Juliet's premonition.

    Key: A (Mercutio's joke: love is blind, so it suits the night.)
22. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act II, Scene I”?
    A. Romeo hears of Juliet's death
    B. Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard
    C. The household mourns
    D. The undelivered letter

Key: B (Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard)

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act II, Scene I”? Mercutio's bawdy conjuring of Rosaline contrasts with Romeo's new seriousness.
    A. Alliteration
    B. Setting
    C. Characterization
    D. Structure

    Key: C (Characterization)

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Romeo, good night: I'll to my truckle-bed” (Act II, Scene I, Mercutio)
    A. Juliet's warning about haste.
    B. Mercutio is pleased Romeo is witty again.
    C. Mercutio gives up and goes home.
    D. Capulet's greeting.

    Key: C (Mercutio gives up and goes home.)

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act II, Scene I”? Mercutio calls for Romeo by Rosaline's name, not knowing she no longer matters.
    A. Symbolism
    B. Diction / vocabulary
    C. Theme
    D. Irony

    Key: D (Irony)

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see love as a joke or a bodily urge.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: He conjures Romeo "by Rosaline's bright eyes" and jokes that "Blind is his love and best befits the dark," not knowing Romeo has already left Rosaline behind.

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how love and desire develops from an earlier scene to “Act II, Scene I”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Mercutio reduces love to the body; the next scene will lift it to the stars.

28. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who goes home with Mercutio?
    A. Benvolio
    B. Balthasar
    C. Tybalt
    D. Paris

    Key: A (Benvolio)

29. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Mercutio reduces love to the body; the next scene will lift it to the stars.
    A. Love and desire
    B. Fate and choice

C. Youth and age

D. Violence and the feud

Key: A (Love and desire)

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is Mercutio's mockery cruel or affectionate? Support your view.
Sample answer: An argument using his tone and Benvolio's response.

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Blind is his love and best befits the dark" (Act II, Scene I, Benvolio) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: Mercutio's joke: love is blind, so it suits the night.

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "A lane by the wall of Capulet's _____." Word bank: demesnes, consorted, orchard, truckle
Key: orchard

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	8, 17, 2, 18, 19, 7, 9, 20, 11, 21, 12, 22, 15, 23, 14, 16	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	4, 2, 19, 8, 6, 1, 24, 11, 10, 13, 12, 25, 14, 23, 26, 27	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	7, 19, 1, 28, 18, 21, 22, 10, 13, 24, 23, 15, 25, 29, 27, 26	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	3, 8, 2, 7, 10, 12, 21, 24, 22, 23, 29, 15, 25, 26, 30, 31	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	7, 18, 32, 22, 21, 11, 10, 23, 25, 14, 15, 29, 16, 27, 30, 26	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	28, 7, 4, 12, 21, 24, 22, 29, 23, 25, 15, 14, 30, 16, 27, 26	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	32, 7, 21, 22, 11, 12, 15, 25, 23, 14, 29, 27, 31, 16, 26, 30	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	3, 19, 12, 11, 24, 21, 14, 25, 15, 23, 29, 27, 30, 26, 31, 16	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Senior	7, 3, 12, 13, 22, 21, 23, 29, 25, 15, 14, 27, 16, 31, 30, 26	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	7, 3, 13, 10, 21, 22, 23, 15, 29, 25, 14, 27, 31, 26, 16, 30	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act II, Scene I," how does Shakespeare show Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act II, Scene I, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act II, Scene I develops the idea of Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act II, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act II, Scene I suggests about Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act II, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act II, Scene I within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act II, Scene I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act II, Scene I and its treatment of Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and irony, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act II, Scene I as evidence for a larger claim about Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act II, Scene I as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard. Position

your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

SAT-style questions

1. *Come, he hath hid himself among these trees, To be consorted with the humorous night: Blind is his love and best befits the dark.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "consorted" most nearly mean?

   A. kept company

   B. partly blind; dim-sighted

   C. an enclosed garden of fruit trees

   D. damp; also moody, ruled by humours

2. *Nay, I'll conjure too. Romeo! humours! madman! passion! lover! Appear thou in the likeness of a sigh: Speak but one rhyme, and I am satisfied; Cry but "Ay me!" pronounce but "love" and "dove;" Speak to my gossip Venus one fair word, One nick-name for her purblind son and heir, Young Adam Cupid, he that shot so trim, When King Cophetua loved the beggar-maid! He heareth not, he stirreth not, he moveth not; The ape is dead, and I must conjure him. I conjure thee by Rosaline's bright eyes, By her high forehead and her scarlet lip, By her fine foot, straight leg and quivering thigh And the demesnes that there adjacent lie, That in thy likeness thou appear to us!*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act II, Scene I"?

   A. The tomb

   B. Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard

   C. Juliet hears the news

   D. Juliet's feigned obedience

SAT key: 1. A (kept company); 2. B (Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard)

Lesson 11: Act II, Scene II

Focus: the balcony scene

Objective: Students will analyze how imagery develops in "Act II, Scene II" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Critical voice: "Romeo and Juliet are in love, but they are not love-sick. Everything speaks the very soul of pleasure, the high and healthy pulse of the passions: the heart beats, the blood circulates and mantles throughout." (William Hazlitt, essayist and critic, *Characters of Shakespear's Plays (1817), "Romeo and Juliet"*, *"Romeo and Juliet"*; public domain). Contrast with II.i: does the balcony language feel "healthy" or excessive? Point to imagery. *Objective:* Analyze the language of love in the balcony scene. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.4

Content note (alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): This section mentions drinking or a drug ("…tten, I would tear the word. My ears have not yet drunk a hundred words Of that tongue's uttera…"). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: This section mentions drinking or a drug.
Suggested language: "What does this detail add to the scene?"

Teacher only · spoilers

From the orchard Romeo sees Juliet at her window and calls her the sun. Unaware of him, she wishes he were not a Montague. He speaks; she fears for his life, worries he will think her too forward, and asks him not to swear by the inconstant moon. They exchange vows; Juliet proposes he send word tomorrow of when and where they will marry.

Background: Elizabethan noble daughters had little freedom; a secret engagement without parental consent was serious but could be binding. Falconry gave Juliet her image of calling back a tassel-gentle.

Significance: The scene sets the lovers' language of light and their speed; Juliet's practicality balances Romeo's rapture.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What does it mean to really know someone? Can you know someone after one evening? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to love and desire because.... Content note before we start: This section mentions drinking or a drug.
Prompt: What does it mean to really know someone? Can you know someone after one evening?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to love and desire because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the lovers move from secret confession to a marriage plan in one night.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: falconer — a person who trains and flies hawks; ripening — bringing to fullness; idolatry — worship of an idol; merchandise — goods to be traded; a precious cargo; entreat — ask earnestly.
Words: falconer: a person who trains and flies hawks · ripening: bringing to fullness · idolatry: worship of an idol · merchandise: goods to be traded; a precious cargo · entreat: ask earnestly

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Elizabethan noble daughters had little freedom; a secret engagement without parental consent was serious but could be binding. Falconry gave Juliet her image of calling back a tassel-gentle. The scene sets the lovers' language of light and their speed; Juliet's practicality balances Romeo's rapture. Imagery: Light imagery: Juliet is the sun, her eyes stars; she fears the "lightning" speed of their contract. Characterization: Juliet is the practical one: she asks how Romeo got in, warns him of danger and proposes marriage. Symbolism: The name "Montague" stands for the feud; Juliet argues a name is only a word. Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "wound. Juliet appears above at a window. / But, soft! what light through yonder window breaks? / It is the east, and Juliet is" (Act II, Scene II, Romeo).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "But, soft! what light through yonder window breaks? / It is the east, and Juliet is the sun" slowly and put it in my own words: In the garden, Romeo sees a light at Juliet's window and says she is the east and Juliet is the sun. Next, craft. I notice the metaphor, light in darkness, which recurs through the play. The strongest word is "sun": it makes her the center of his world, giving life and light. Then, effect. What does Romeo's comparison of Juliet to the sun show? My answer: Romeo's love makes Juliet radiant and essential to him; the light imagery prepares the play's pattern of lovers who meet in darkness.

> *But, soft! what light through yonder window breaks? / It is the east, and Juliet is the sun* (Act II, Scene II, Romeo)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "But, soft! what light through yonder window breaks? / It is the east, and Juliet is the sun" slowly and put it in my own words: In the garden, Romeo sees a light at Juliet's window and says she is the east and Juliet is the sun. Next, craft. I notice the metaphor, light in darkness, which recurs through the play. The strongest word is "sun": it makes her the center of his world, giving life and light. Then, effect. What does Romeo's comparison of Juliet to the sun show? My answer: Romeo's love makes Juliet radiant and essential to him; the light imagery prepares the play's pattern of lovers who meet in darkness.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Juliet means a rose's scent does not depend on its name, so Romeo would be the same without "Montague." Expected link: names and identity. Ask: How does this line connect to love and desire? Expected: The lovers move from secret confession to a marriage plan in one night. (Names do not change essence.)

> *What's in a name? that which we call a rose / By any other name would smell as sweet* (Act II, Scene II, Juliet)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Juliet means a rose's scent does not depend on its name, so Romeo would be the same without "Montague." Expected link: names and identity.
Ask: How does this line connect to love and desire?
Expected answer: The lovers move from secret confession to a marriage plan in one night. (Names do not change essence.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for imagery, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the balcony scene? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene II develops the idea of the balcony scene. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene. When the text says "What's in a name? that which we call a rose / By any other name would smell as sweet" (Act II, Scene II, Juliet), it shows this directly. She sees that their vow "is too rash, too unadvised, too sudden; / Too like the lightning," and she reasons that "that which we call a rose / By any other name would smell as sweet," while Romeo speaks in raptures.
Task: Annotate the scene for imagery, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the balcony scene? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene II develops the idea of the balcony scene. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene. When the text says "What's in a name? that which we call a rose / By any other name would smell as sweet" (Act II, Scene II, Juliet), it shows this directly. She sees that their vow "is too rash, too unadvised, too sudden; / Too like the lightning," and she reasons that "that which we call a rose / By any other name would smell as sweet," while Romeo speaks in raptures.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What does it mean to really know someone? Can you know someone after one evening? Ask: who leads in this scene, Romeo or Juliet? Use two lines for each side.
Anchor question: What does it mean to really know someone? Can you know someone after one evening?
Facilitation: Ask: who leads in this scene, Romeo or Juliet? Use two lines for each side.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the balcony scene? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene. ("What's in a name? that which we call a rose / By any other name would smell as sweet", Act II, Scene II, Juliet). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the balcony scene? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene. ("What's in a name? that which we call a rose / By any other name would smell as sweet", Act II, Scene II, Juliet). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how imagery shapes the balcony scene. Key takeaway: the lovers move from secret confession to a marriage plan in one night.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Imagery:** Light imagery: Juliet is the sun, her eyes stars; she fears the "lightning" speed of their contract.
- **Characterization:** Juliet is the practical one: she asks how Romeo got in, warns him of danger and proposes marriage.
- **Symbolism:** The name "Montague" stands for the feud; Juliet argues a name is only a word.

Themes and how they develop

- **love and desire:** the lovers move from secret confession to a marriage plan in one night.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "wound. Juliet appears above at a window. / But, soft! what light through yonder window breaks? / It is the east, and Juliet is" (Act II, Scene II, Romeo).

- **fate and the stars:** From "star-cross'd" in the Prologue to Romeo's "I defy you, stars," the lovers feel steered by fortune, while the plot shows human choices and accidents. In this scene: “tis not to me she speaks: / Two of the fairest stars in all the heaven, / Having some business, do entreat her eyes” (Act II, Scene II, Romeo).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “But, soft! what light through yonder window breaks? / It is the east, and Juliet is the sun” (Act II, Scene II, Romeo) Juliet as the sun.
- “What’s in a name? that which we call a rose / By any other name would smell as sweet” (Act II, Scene II, Juliet) Names do not change essence.
- “It is too rash, too unadvised, too sudden; / Too like the lightning” (Act II, Scene II, Juliet) Juliet's warning about haste.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene.
Evidence: “What’s in a name? that which we call a rose / By any other name would smell as sweet” (Act II, Scene II, Juliet)
Reasoning: She sees that their vow "is too rash, too unadvised, too sudden; / Too like the lightning," and she reasons that "that which we call a rose / By any other name would smell as sweet," while Romeo speaks in raptures.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
falconer (noun)	a person who trains and flies hawks	*O, for a falconer’s voice, To lure this tassel-gentle back again!*	
ripening (adjective)	bringing to fullness	*This bud of love, by summer’s ripening breath, May prove a beauteous flower when next we meet.*	
idolatry (noun)	worship of an idol	*Do not swear at all; Or, if thou wilt, swear by thy gracious self, Which is the god of my idolatry, And I’ll believe thee.*	
merchandise (noun)	goods to be traded; a precious cargo	*I am no pilot; yet, wert thou as far As that vast shore wash’d with the farthest sea, I would adventure for such merchandise.*	
entreat (verb)	ask earnestly	*I am too bold, ’tis not to me she speaks: Two of the fairest stars in all the heaven, Having some business, do entreat her eyes To twinkle in their spheres till they return.*	

unadvised (adjective)	without careful thought; rash	*Well, do not swear: although I joy in thee, I have no joy of this contract to-night: It is too rash, too unadvised, too sudden; Too like the lightning, which doth cease to be Ere one can say "It lightens."*	"unadvised": Origin: an English formation from un- + advised. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/unadvised#Etymology)
inconstant (adjective)	changeable; not faithful	*O, swear not by the moon, the inconstant moon, That monthly changes in her circled orb, Lest that thy love prove likewise variable.*	"inconstant": Origin: Middle French inconstant; earlier Latin incōnstāns. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/inconstant#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. What does it mean to really know someone? Can you know someone after one evening?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with time and haste?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. At what hour does Juliet say she will send to Romeo? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: By nine o'clock in the morning.
2. What does Romeo call Juliet? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The sun
3. What does Juliet wish? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: That Romeo had a different name
4. Why does Juliet tell Romeo not to swear by the moon? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: It is inconstant
5. Who first speaks of marriage? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Juliet
6. What does Juliet fear about the vow? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: It is too rash and sudden
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act II, Scene II" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: From the orchard Romeo sees Juliet at her window and calls her the sun. Unaware of him, she wishes he were not a Montague. He speaks; she fears for his life, worries he will think her too forward, and asks him not to swear by the inconstant moon. They exchange vows; Juliet proposes he send word tomorrow of when and where they will marry.

8. Who is on stage in “Act II, Scene II”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act II, Scene II” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “O, for a falconer’s voice, To lure this tassel-gentle back again!” What does “falconer” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: falconer: a person who trains and flies hawks.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Juliet say a rose would smell as sweet by any other name? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Names are labels; Romeo is himself apart from 'Montague'.
2. What does “Act II, Scene II” suggest about the balcony scene? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The scene sets the lovers' language of light and their speed; Juliet's practicality balances Romeo's rapture.
3. Find one example of imagery in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the balcony scene? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene. Useful evidence: “But, soft! what light through yonder window breaks? / It is the east, and Juliet is the sun” (Act II, Scene II, Romeo): Juliet as the sun. On characterization: Juliet is the practical one: she asks how Romeo got in, warns him of danger and proposes marriage. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “By love, who first did prompt me to inquire; He lent me counsel and I lent him eyes.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act II, Scene II”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: From the orchard Romeo sees Juliet at her window and calls her the sun. Unaware of him, she wishes he were not a Montague. He speaks; she fears for his life, worries he will think her too forward, and asks him not to swear by the inconstant moon. They exchange vows; Juliet proposes he send word…
7. How does “Act II, Scene II” build on “Act II, Scene I”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene. Useful evidence: “What’s in a name? that which we call a rose / By any other name would smell as sweet” (Act II, Scene II, Juliet): Names do not change essence. Theme link: the lovers move from secret confession to a marriage plan in one night. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene. Useful evidence: “It is too rash, too unadvised, too sudden; / Too like the lightning” (Act II, Scene II, Juliet): Juliet's warning about haste. On characterization: Juliet is the practical one: she asks how Romeo got in, warns him of danger and proposes marriage. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “What does it mean to really know someone? Can you know someone after one evening?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does symbolism appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with time and haste? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene. Useful evidence: “But, soft! what light through yonder window breaks? / It is the east, and Juliet is the sun” (Act II, Scene II, Romeo): Juliet as the sun. On symbolism: The name "Montague" stands for the feud; Juliet argues a name is only a word. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Who is wiser in this scene, Romeo or Juliet? Argue with evidence. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned comparison of their lines.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene. Useful evidence: “What’s in a name? that which we call a rose / By any other name would smell as sweet” (Act II, Scene II, Juliet): Names do not change essence. Theme link: the lovers move from secret confession to a marriage plan in one night. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The scene sets the lovers' language of light and their speed; Juliet's practicality balances Romeo's rapture.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene. Useful evidence: “It is too rash, too unadvised, too sudden; / Too like the lightning” (Act II, Scene II, Juliet): Juliet's warning about haste. Theme link: the lovers move from secret confession to a marriage plan in one night. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene. Useful evidence: “But, soft! what light through yonder window breaks? / It is the east, and Juliet is

the sun" (Act II, Scene II, Romeo): Juliet as the sun. On characterization: Juliet is the practical one: she asks how Romeo got in, warns him of danger and proposes marriage. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing "Act II, Scene II". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the balcony scene. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene. Useful evidence: "What's in a name? that which we call a rose / By any other name would smell as sweet" (Act II, Scene II, Juliet): Names do not change essence. Theme link: the lovers move from secret confession to a marriage plan in one night. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about "Act II, Scene II": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene. Useful evidence: "It is too rash, too unadvised, too sudden; / Too like the lightning" (Act II, Scene II, Juliet): Juliet's warning about haste. Theme link: the lovers move from secret confession to a marriage plan in one night. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to love and desire: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene. Useful evidence: "But, soft! what light through yonder window breaks? / It is the east, and Juliet is the sun" (Act II, Scene II, Romeo): Juliet as the sun. Theme link: the lovers move from secret confession to a marriage plan in one night. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the imagery in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene. Useful evidence: "What's in a name? that which we call a rose / By any other name would smell as sweet" (Act II, Scene II, Juliet): Names do not change essence. On imagery: Light imagery: Juliet is the sun, her eyes stars; she fears the "lightning" speed of their contract. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how "Act II, Scene II" treats the balcony scene with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene. Useful evidence: "It is too rash, too unadvised, too sudden; / Too like the lightning" (Act II, Scene II, Juliet): Juliet's warning about haste. Theme link: the lovers move from secret confession to a marriage plan in one night. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what "Act II, Scene III" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene. Useful evidence: "But, soft! what light through yonder window breaks? / It is the east, and Juliet is the sun" (Act II, Scene II, Romeo): Juliet as the sun. Theme link: the lovers move from secret confession to a marriage plan in one night. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the balcony scene? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene. Useful evidence: "What's in a name? that which we call a rose / By any other name would smell as sweet" (Act II, Scene II, Juliet): Names do not change essence. Theme link: the lovers move from secret confession to a marriage plan in one night. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "O, for a falconer's voice, To lure this tassel-gentle back again!", what does "falconer" most nearly mean?

   A. a person who trains and flies hawks

   B. a good-for-nothing girl

   C. a person who keeps changing his mind

   D. an enclosed garden of fruit trees

   Key: A (a person who trains and flies hawks)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Romeo call Juliet?

   A. A star

   B. The moon

   C. A rose

   D. The sun

   Key: D (The sun)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "This bud of love, by summer's ripening breath, May prove a beauteous flower when next we meet.", what does "ripening" most nearly mean?

   A. wandering musicians

   B. a mythical serpent that could kill with a look

C. bringing to fullness

D. a state of quarrel or disagreement

Key: C (bringing to fullness)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene II, Romeo: “But, soft! what light _____ yonder window breaks? / It is the east, and Juliet is the sun”

   Key: through

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “I am no pilot; yet, wert thou as far As that vast shore wash’d with the farthest sea, I would adventure for such merchandise.”, what does “merchandise” most nearly mean?

   A. disgusting

   B. harsh, clashing sounds; quarrels

   C. goods to be traded; a precious cargo

   D. attacking, here with admiring looks

   Key: C (goods to be traded; a precious cargo)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Well, do not swear: although I joy in thee, I have no joy of this contract to-night: It is too rash, too _____, too sudden; Too like the lightning, which doth cease to be Ere one can say “It lightens.”” Word bank: ripening, falconer, idolatry, unadvised

   Key: unadvised

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who first speaks of marriage?

   A. Juliet

   B. Friar Laurence

   C. The Nurse

   D. Romeo

   Key: A (Juliet)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Do not swear at all; Or, if thou wilt, swear by thy gracious self, Which is the god of my idolatry, And I’ll believe thee.”, what does “idolatry” most nearly mean?

   A. a parish officer who keeps the peace

   B. families, including their servants and dependents

   C. small round shields

   D. worship of an idol

   Key: D (worship of an idol)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “O, swear not by the moon, the _____ moon, That monthly changes in her circled orb, Lest that thy love prove likewise variable.” Word bank: ripening, inconstant, idolatry, falconer

   Key: inconstant

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does Juliet say a rose would smell as sweet by any other name?

    Sample answer: Names are labels; Romeo is himself apart from 'Montague'.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “What’s in a name? that which we call a rose / By any other name would smell as sweet” (Act II, Scene II, Juliet)

    A. Names do not change essence.

    B. Mercutio stands between the Prince's family and the Montagues.

C. Juliet's premonition.

D. The apothecary's excuse.

Key: A (Names do not change essence.)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “What’s in a name? that which we call a rose / By any other name would smell as sweet” (Act II, Scene II, Juliet) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Names do not change essence.

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “But, soft! what light through yonder window breaks? / It is the east, and Juliet is the sun” (Act II, Scene II, Romeo)

    A. Benvolio predicts Romeo will find someone more beautiful than Rosaline.

    B. The Friar's doubt about Romeo's love.

    C. Mercutio's joke: love is blind, so it suits the night.

    D. Juliet as the sun.

    Key: D (Juliet as the sun.)

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act II, Scene II”? Light this device: Juliet is the sun, her eyes stars; she fears the "lightning" speed of their contract.

    A. Simile

    B. Allusion

    C. Imagery

    D. Irony

    Key: C (Imagery)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “What’s in a name? that which we call a rose / By any other name would smell as sweet” (Act II, Scene II, Juliet).

    Sample answer: She sees that their vow "is too rash, too unadvised, too sudden; / Too like the lightning," and she reasons that "that which we call a rose / By any other name would smell as sweet," while Romeo speaks in raptures.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: She sees that their vow "is too rash, too unadvised, too sudden; / Too like the lightning," and she reasons that "that which we call a rose / By any other name would smell as sweet," while Romeo speaks in raptures.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene II, Juliet: “It is too rash, too _____, too sudden; / Too like the lightning”

    Key: unadvised

18. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “It is too rash, too unadvised, too sudden; / Too like the lightning” (Act II, Scene II, Juliet). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Juliet's warning about haste.

19. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “But, soft! what light through yonder window breaks? / It is the east, and Juliet is the sun” (Act II, Scene II, Romeo) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Juliet as the sun.

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Juliet wish?

    A. That Romeo had a different name

    B. That Paris would come

    C. That the feud would grow

    D. That she were a man

    Key: A (That Romeo had a different name)

21. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “But, soft! what light through yonder window breaks? / It is the east, and Juliet is the sun” (Act II, Scene II, Romeo) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Juliet as the sun.

22. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act II, Scene II”?

    A. The tomb

    B. The undelivered letter

    C. The second Chorus

    D. The balcony scene

    Key: D (The balcony scene)

23. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “It is too rash, too unadvised, too sudden; / Too like the lightning” (Act II, Scene II, Juliet)

    A. Juliet's careful, obedient answer.

    B. For Romeo, exile is the end of the world.

    C. Juliet's warning about haste.

    D. Romeo blames fortune.

    Key: C (Juliet's warning about haste.)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act II, Scene II”? Juliet is the practical one: she asks how Romeo got in, warns him of danger and proposes marriage.

    A. Irony

    B. Characterization

    C. Foreshadowing

    D. Metaphor

    Key: B (Characterization)

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “What’s in a name? that which we call a rose / By any other name would smell as sweet” (Act II, Scene II, Juliet) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Names do not change essence.

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Who is wiser in this scene, Romeo or Juliet? Argue with evidence.

    Sample answer: A reasoned comparison of their lines.

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why does Juliet tell Romeo not to swear by the moon?

    A. It is pagan

    B. It is too far

    C. It is cold

D. It is inconstant

Key: D (It is inconstant)

28. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Juliet fear about the vow?

A. It is too slow

B. It is too rash and sudden

C. It is a joke

D. It is dishonest

Key: B (It is too rash and sudden)

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how love and desire develops from an earlier scene to "Act II, Scene II". Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: the lovers move from secret confession to a marriage plan in one night.

30. [short · recall · DOK 1] At what hour does Juliet say she will send to Romeo?

Sample answer: By nine o'clock in the morning.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? The lovers move from secret confession to a marriage plan in one night.

A. Love and desire

B. Youth and age

C. Violence and the feud

D. Fate and choice

Key: A (Love and desire)

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "I am too bold, 'tis not to me she speaks: Two of the fairest stars in all the heaven, Having some business, do _____ her eyes To twinkle in their spheres till they return." Word bank: falconer, idolatry, ripening, entreat

Key: entreat

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	4, 7, 3, 17, 9, 1, 8, 5, 11, 13, 10, 12, 18, 15, 14, 19	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	4, 6, 1, 17, 20, 3, 21, 22, 10, 23, 11, 18, 15, 24, 25, 26	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	27, 6, 4, 7, 28, 13, 22, 10, 12, 23, 15, 14, 24, 18, 29, 16	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	17, 9, 8, 30, 22, 13, 21, 10, 12, 14, 31, 18, 24, 26, 19, 25	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	4, 32, 2, 23, 21, 12, 11, 24, 18, 14, 15, 31, 19, 16, 29, 25	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	6, 7, 32, 21, 22, 10, 23, 24, 15, 18, 14, 31, 16, 19, 25, 26	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4

College Sophomore	17, 32, 21, 22, 23, 12, 15, 18, 31, 24, 14, 29, 19, 25, 26, 16	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	32, 6, 23, 13, 12, 11, 15, 18, 14, 31, 24, 26, 16, 29, 19, 25	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Senior	32, 6, 12, 13, 10, 21, 31, 14, 15, 18, 24, 26, 25, 16, 29, 19	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	32, 6, 10, 22, 11, 12, 14, 18, 24, 31, 15, 16, 26, 25, 19, 29	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act II, Scene II,” how does Shakespeare show the balcony scene? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Act II, Scene II, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the balcony scene? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act II, Scene II develops the idea of the balcony scene. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act II, Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of the balcony scene. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act II, Scene II suggests about the balcony scene. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses imagery in Act II, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of the balcony scene. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act II, Scene II within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the balcony scene responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act II, Scene II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the balcony scene follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act II, Scene II and its treatment of the balcony scene. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's imagery and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act II, Scene II as evidence for a larger claim about the balcony scene in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act II, Scene II as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the balcony scene. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

SAT-style questions

1. *Do not swear at all; Or, if thou wilt, swear by thy gracious self, Which is the god of my idolatry, And I'll believe thee.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "idolatry" most nearly mean?

   A. worship of an idol

   B. without careful thought; rash

   C. ask earnestly

   D. changeable; not faithful

2. *By love, who first did prompt me to inquire; He lent me counsel and I lent him eyes. I am no pilot; yet, wert thou as far As that vast shore wash'd with the farthest sea, I would adventure for such merchandise.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act II, Scene II"?

   A. Parting at dawn and Capulet's rage

   B. Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition

   C. The tomb

   D. The balcony scene

SAT key: 1. A (worship of an idol); 2. D (The balcony scene)

Lesson 12: Act II, Scene III

Focus: Friar Laurence agrees to marry them

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in "Act II, Scene III" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): This section mentions drinking or a drug ("…ith streaks of light, And flecked darkness like a drunkard reels From forth day's path and Titan's…"). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: This section mentions drinking or a drug.
Suggested language: "What does this detail add to the scene?"

Teacher only · spoilers

At dawn Friar Laurence gathers herbs and reflects that every plant can heal or poison. Romeo arrives and asks him to marry him to Juliet. The Friar scolds his fickleness about Rosaline but agrees, hoping the marriage will end the feud.

Background: Friars were members of mendicant religious orders; Franciscans were known for herb lore and practical care. Secret marriages were legal but irregular in canon law.

Significance: The Friar's speech on plants foreshadows the potion; his political hope explains his risky help.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Is it right to do something risky for a good cause? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to time and haste because.... Content note before we start: This section mentions drinking or a drug.
Prompt: Is it right to do something risky for a good cause?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to time and haste because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the Friar warns "they stumble that run fast" and then acts quickly himself.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: predominant — dominant; ruling (an astrological term); stumble — trip; make a mistake; waverer — a person who keeps changing his mind; riddling — puzzling; speaking in riddles; intercession — pleading on another's behalf. "riddling": Origin: Middle English redel; earlier Old English rǣdels.
Words: predominant: dominant; ruling (an astrological term) · stumble: trip; make a mistake · waverer: a person who keeps changing his mind · riddling: puzzling; speaking in riddles · intercession: pleading on another's behalf

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Friars were members of mendicant religious orders; Franciscans were known for herb lore and practical care. Secret marriages were legal but irregular in canon law. The Friar's speech on plants foreshadows the potion; his political hope explains his risky help. Characterization: Friar Laurence, gathering herbs, reflects that everything can heal or harm depending on use. Foreshadowing: His knowledge of plants ("Poison hath residence and medicine power") prepares the potion. Irony: He scolds Romeo's fickleness yet agrees to marry him, hoping to end the feud. Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "The grey-eyed morn smiles on the frowning night, / Chequering the eastern clouds with streaks of light, / And flecked darkness" (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "young men's love then lies / Not truly in their hearts, but in their eyes" slowly and put it in my own words: The Friar says young men's love lies not in their hearts but in their eyes. Next, craft. I notice the rhyming couplet, a neat moral that sounds like a proverb. The strongest word is "eyes": it suggests love based on looks. Then, effect. What is Friar Laurence teasing Romeo about? My answer: The Friar doubts Romeo's sudden change from Rosaline to Juliet; he agrees to marry them hoping to end the feud, a risky choice.

> *young men's love then lies / Not truly in their hearts, but in their eyes* (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "young men's love then lies / Not truly in their hearts, but in their eyes" slowly and put it in my own words: The Friar says young men's love lies not in their hearts but in their eyes. Next, craft. I notice the rhyming couplet, a neat moral that sounds like a proverb. The strongest word is "eyes": it suggests love based on looks. Then, effect. What is Friar Laurence teasing Romeo about? My answer: The Friar doubts Romeo's sudden change from Rosaline to Juliet; he agrees to marry them hoping to end the feud, a risky choice.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: A small flower contains both poison and medicine; good and harm come from how something is used. Expected link: poison and medicine, and the Friar's role. Ask: How does this line connect to time and haste? Expected: The Friar warns "they stumble that run fast" and then acts quickly himself. (One thing can heal or kill.)

> *Within the infant rind of this small flower / Poison hath residence and medicine power (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: A small flower contains both poison and medicine; good and harm come from how something is used. Expected link: poison and medicine, and the Friar's role.
Ask: How does this line connect to time and haste?
Expected answer: The Friar warns "they stumble that run fast" and then acts quickly himself. (One thing can heal or kill.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Friar Laurence agrees to marry them? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene III develops the idea of Friar Laurence agrees to marry them. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons. When the text says “Wisely and slow; they stumble that run fast” (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence), it shows this directly. He warns "Wisely and slow; they stumble that run fast" and mocks love that lies "in their eyes," yet agrees to the marriage hoping it will turn the households' "rancour to pure love."
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Friar Laurence agrees to marry them? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene III develops the idea of Friar Laurence agrees to marry them. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons. When the text says “Wisely and slow; they stumble that run fast” (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence), it shows this directly. He warns "Wisely and slow; they stumble that run fast" and mocks love that lies "in their eyes," yet agrees to the marriage hoping it will turn the households' "rancour to pure love."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Is it right to do something risky for a good cause? Ask: is the Friar wise or reckless? Is his reason for marrying them a good one?
Anchor question: Is it right to do something risky for a good cause?
Facilitation: Ask: is the Friar wise or reckless? Is his reason for marrying them a good one?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Friar Laurence agrees to marry them? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons. ("Wisely and slow; they stumble that run fast", Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Friar Laurence agrees to marry them? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons. ("Wisely and slow; they stumble that run fast", Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes Friar Laurence agrees to marry them. Key takeaway: the Friar warns "they stumble that run fast" and then acts quickly himself.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Friar Laurence, gathering herbs, reflects that everything can heal or harm depending on use.
- **Foreshadowing:** His knowledge of plants ("Poison hath residence and medicine power") prepares the potion.
- **Irony:** He scolds Romeo's fickleness yet agrees to marry him, hoping to end the feud.

Themes and how they develop

- **time and haste:** the Friar warns "they stumble that run fast" and then acts quickly himself.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "The grey-eyed morn smiles on the frowning night, / Chequering the eastern clouds with streaks of light, / And flecked darkness" (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence).

- **fate and the stars:** From "star-cross'd" in the Prologue to Romeo's "I defy you, stars," the lovers feel steered by fortune, while the plot shows human choices and accidents. In this scene: “doth not taste! / The sun not yet thy sighs from heaven clears, / Thy old groans ring yet in my ancient ears; / Lo” (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Within the infant rind of this small flower / Poison hath residence and medicine power” (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence) One thing can heal or kill.
- “young men’s love then lies / Not truly in their hearts, but in their eyes” (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence) The Friar's doubt about Romeo's love.
- “Wisely and slow; they stumble that run fast” (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence) The Friar's warning about haste.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons.
Evidence: “Wisely and slow; they stumble that run fast” (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence)
Reasoning: He warns "Wisely and slow; they stumble that run fast" and mocks love that lies "in their eyes," yet agrees to the marriage hoping it will turn the households' "rancour to pure love."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
predominant (adjective)	dominant; ruling (an astrological term)	*Two such opposed kings encamp them still In man as well as herbs, grace and rude will; And where the worser is predominant, Full soon the canker death eats up that plant.*	
stumble (verb)	trip; make a mistake	*Wisely and slow; they stumble that run fast.*	
waverer (noun)	a person who keeps changing his mind	*But come, young waverer, come, go with me, In one respect I’ll thy assistant be; For this alliance may so happy prove, To turn your households’ rancour to pure love.*	
riddling (adjective)	puzzling; speaking in riddles	*Be plain, good son, and homely in thy drift; Riddling confession finds but riddling shrift.*	“riddling”: Origin: Middle English redel; earlier Old English rǣdels. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/riddling#Etymology)
intercession (noun)	pleading on another's behalf	*I have been feasting with mine enemy, Where on a sudden one hath wounded me, That’s by me wounded: both our remedies Within thy help and holy physic lies: I bear*	

		no hatred, blessed man, for, lo, My intercession likewise steads my foe.	
confession (noun)	telling one's sins to a priest	*Be plain, good son, and homely in thy drift; Riddling confession finds but riddling shrift.*	

Discussion questions

1. Is it right to do something risky for a good cause?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with love and desire?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Where has Romeo been all night? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Not in bed; he has been feasting with his enemy, the Capulets.
2. What is the Friar gathering? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Herbs and flowers
3. What does the Friar say plants contain? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Both poison and medicine
4. Why is the Friar surprised? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Romeo has forgotten Rosaline so quickly
5. Why does the Friar agree to help? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He hopes to end the feud
6. What does he warn about speed? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: They stumble that run fast
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act II, Scene III" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: At dawn Friar Laurence gathers herbs and reflects that every plant can heal or poison. Romeo arrives and asks him to marry him to Juliet. The Friar scolds his fickleness about Rosaline but agrees, hoping the marriage will end the feud.
8. Who is on stage in "Act II, Scene III", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act II, Scene III" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.

10. Reread: “Two such opposed kings encamp them still In man as well as herbs, grace and rude will; And where the worser is predominant, Full soon the canker death eats up that plant.” What does “predominant” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: predominant: dominant; ruling (an astrological term).

Inferential / analytical

1. How does the Friar's speech on herbs relate to the plot? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: One thing can heal or kill; love and the potion will do both.
2. What does “Act II, Scene III” suggest about Friar Laurence agrees to marry them? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The Friar's speech on plants foreshadows the potion; his political hope explains his risky help.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the foreshadowing in this scene shape what we understand about Friar Laurence agrees to marry them? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons. Useful evidence: “Within the infant rind of this small flower / Poison hath residence and medicine power” (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence): One thing can heal or kill. On foreshadowing: His knowledge of plants ("Poison hath residence and medicine power") prepares the potion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “I'll tell thee, ere thou ask it me again.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act II, Scene III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: At dawn Friar Laurence gathers herbs and reflects that every plant can heal or poison. Romeo arrives and asks him to marry him to Juliet. The Friar scolds his fickleness about Rosaline but agrees, hoping the marriage will end the feud.
7. How does “Act II, Scene III” build on “Act II, Scene II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons. Useful evidence: “young men's love then lies / Not truly in their hearts, but in their eyes” (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence): The Friar's doubt about Romeo's love. Theme link: the Friar warns "they stumble that run fast" and then acts quickly himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons. Useful evidence: “Wisely and slow; they stumble that run fast” (Act II,

Scene III, Friar Laurence): The Friar's warning about haste. On characterization: Friar Laurence, gathering herbs, reflects that everything can heal or harm depending on use. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: "Is it right to do something risky for a good cause?" Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does irony appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with love and desire? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons. Useful evidence: "Within the infant rind of this small flower / Poison hath residence and medicine power" (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence): One thing can heal or kill. On irony: He scolds Romeo's fickleness yet agrees to marry him, hoping to end the feud. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is the Friar's reason for agreeing good judgment or gamble? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment weighing peace against risk.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons. Useful evidence: "young men's love then lies / Not truly in their hearts, but in their eyes" (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence): The Friar's doubt about Romeo's love. Theme link: the Friar warns "they stumble that run fast" and then acts quickly himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: "The Friar's speech on plants foreshadows the potion; his political hope explains his risky help." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons. Useful evidence: "Wisely and slow; they stumble that run fast" (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence): The Friar's warning about haste. Theme link: the Friar warns "they stumble that run fast" and then acts quickly himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons. Useful evidence: "Within the infant rind of this small flower / Poison hath residence and medicine power" (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence): One thing can heal or kill. On characterization: Friar Laurence, gathering herbs, reflects that everything can heal or harm depending on use. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act II, Scene III”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Friar Laurence agrees to marry them. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons. Useful evidence: “young men’s love then lies / Not truly in their hearts, but in their eyes” (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence): The Friar's doubt about Romeo's love. Theme link: the Friar warns "they stumble that run fast" and then acts quickly himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act II, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons. Useful evidence: “Wisely and slow; they stumble that run fast” (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence): The Friar's warning about haste. Theme link: the Friar warns "they stumble that run fast" and then acts quickly himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to fate and choice: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons. Useful evidence: “Within the infant rind of this small flower / Poison hath residence and medicine power” (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence): One thing can heal or kill. Theme link: the Friar warns "they stumble that run fast" and then acts quickly himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons. Useful evidence: “young men’s love then lies / Not truly in their hearts, but in their eyes” (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence): The Friar's doubt about Romeo's love. On characterization: Friar Laurence, gathering herbs, reflects that everything can heal or harm depending on use. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act II, Scene III” treats Friar Laurence agrees to marry them with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons. Useful evidence: “Wisely and slow; they stumble that run fast” (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence): The Friar's warning about haste. Theme link: the Friar warns "they stumble that run fast" and then acts quickly himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act II, Scene IV” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment

justified with textual clues.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons. Useful evidence: “Within the infant rind of this small flower / Poison hath residence and medicine power” (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence): One thing can heal or kill. On foreshadowing: His knowledge of plants ("Poison hath residence and medicine power") prepares the potion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Friar Laurence agrees to marry them? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons. Useful evidence: “young men’s love then lies / Not truly in their hearts, but in their eyes” (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence): The Friar's doubt about Romeo's love. Theme link: the Friar warns "they stumble that run fast" and then acts quickly himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does the Friar say plants contain?

    A. Only beauty

    B. Prophecies

    C. Only food

    D. Both poison and medicine

    Key: D (Both poison and medicine)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence: “Wisely and slow; they _____ that run fast”

    Key: stumble

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence: “young men’s love then lies / Not truly in their _____, but in their eyes”

    Key: hearts

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why is the Friar surprised?

    A. Romeo has forgotten Rosaline so quickly

    B. Romeo is drunk

    C. Romeo is wounded

    D. Romeo is up early

    Key: A (Romeo has forgotten Rosaline so quickly)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why does the Friar agree to help?

   A. Juliet threatens him

   B. He is paid

   C. He hopes to end the feud

   D. The Prince orders it

   Key: C (He hopes to end the feud)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What is the Friar gathering?

   A. Money

   B. Firewood

   C. Herbs and flowers

   D. Letters

   Key: C (Herbs and flowers)

7. [short · recall · DOK 1] Where has Romeo been all night?

   Sample answer: Not in bed; he has been feasting with his enemy, the Capulets.

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence: “Within the infant rind of this small flower / Poison hath _____ and medicine power”

   Key: residence

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Be plain, good son, and homely in thy drift; Riddling confession finds but riddling shrift.”, what does “riddling” most nearly mean?

   A. puzzling; speaking in riddles

   B. a priest who hears confession

   C. a man of noble rank

   D. a wooden plate

   Key: A (puzzling; speaking in riddles)

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] How does the Friar's speech on herbs relate to the plot?

    Sample answer: One thing can heal or kill; love and the potion will do both.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act II, Scene III”?

    A. The undelivered letter

    B. Friar Laurence agrees to marry them

    C. Wedding preparations

    D. Parting at dawn and Capulet's rage

    Key: B (Friar Laurence agrees to marry them)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Within the infant rind of this small flower / Poison hath residence and medicine power” (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: One thing can heal or kill.

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Within the infant rind of this small flower / Poison hath residence and medicine power” (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence)

    A. One thing can heal or kill.

    B. Mercutio stands between the Prince's family and the Montagues.

C. Juliet's death.

D. Capulet offers Juliet impulsively.

Key: A (One thing can heal or kill.)

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in "Wisely and slow; they stumble that run fast" (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
Sample answer: The Friar's warning about haste.

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in "Act II, Scene III"? Friar Laurence, gathering herbs, reflects that everything can heal or harm depending on use.

A. Imagery

B. Conflict

C. Irony

D. Characterization

Key: D (Characterization)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is the Friar's reason for agreeing good judgment or gamble?
Sample answer: A judgment weighing peace against risk.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Be plain, good son, and homely in thy drift; Riddling _____ finds but riddling shrift." Word bank: stumble, confession, waverer, predominant
Key: confession

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "I have been feasting with mine enemy, Where on a sudden one hath wounded me, That's by me wounded: both our remedies Within thy help and holy physic lies: I bear no hatred, blessed man, for, lo, My _____ likewise steads my foe." Word bank: intercession, waverer, stumble, predominant
Key: intercession

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "But come, young waverer, come, go with me, In one respect I'll thy assistant be; For this alliance may so happy prove, To turn your households' rancour to pure love.", what does "waverer" most nearly mean?

A. smothered

B. plots; works together

C. the cause of his complaint or sorrow

D. a person who keeps changing his mind

Key: D (a person who keeps changing his mind)

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does he warn about speed?

A. Slow lovers lose

B. They stumble that run fast

C. Haste makes money

D. Time heals all

Key: B (They stumble that run fast)

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? "young men's love then lies / Not truly in their hearts, but in their eyes" (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence)

A. The marriage is fixed in haste.

B. The Friar's doubt about Romeo's love.

C. Moderation as the key to lasting love.

D. The Friar's image of Juliet.

Key: B (The Friar's doubt about Romeo's love.)

22. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Wisely and slow; they stumble that run fast” (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence)

A. Moderation as the key to lasting love.

B. Household detail.

C. The Friar's warning about haste.

D. Juliet's feigned repentance.

Key: C (The Friar's warning about haste.)

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? The Friar warns "they stumble that run fast" and then acts quickly himself.

A. Love and desire

B. Time and haste

C. Violence and the feud

D. Fate and choice

Key: B (Time and haste)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act II, Scene III”? His knowledge of plants ("Poison hath residence and medicine power") prepares the potion.

A. Structure

B. Metaphor

C. Foreshadowing

D. Personification

Key: C (Foreshadowing)

25. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Wisely and slow; they stumble that run fast” (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence).

Sample answer: He warns "Wisely and slow; they stumble that run fast" and mocks love that lies "in their eyes," yet agrees to the marriage hoping it will turn the households' "rancour to pure love."

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: He warns "Wisely and slow; they stumble that run fast" and mocks love that lies "in their eyes," yet agrees to the marriage hoping it will turn the households' "rancour to pure love."

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Within the infant rind of this small flower / Poison hath residence and medicine power” (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: One thing can heal or kill.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how time and haste develops from an earlier scene to “Act II, Scene III”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: the Friar warns "they stumble that run fast" and then acts quickly himself.
29. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “young men’s love then lies / Not truly in their hearts, but in their eyes” (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The Friar's doubt about Romeo's love.
30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “young men’s love then lies / Not truly in their hearts, but in their eyes” (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: The Friar's doubt about Romeo's love.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	6, 8, 7, 17, 18, 19, 20, 3, 10, 21, 22, 13, 23, 24, 25, 26	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	9, 18, 1, 5, 2, 7, 12, 11, 13, 21, 10, 15, 24, 14, 27, 28	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	7, 8, 4, 18, 9, 29, 21, 11, 22, 10, 15, 14, 24, 25, 28, 30	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	1, 17, 8, 6, 13, 22, 10, 11, 21, 24, 14, 15, 23, 30, 27, 26	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	18, 2, 6, 13, 12, 22, 29, 15, 14, 24, 23, 25, 27, 30, 26, 28	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	17, 18, 5, 13, 12, 22, 29, 14, 23, 25, 24, 15, 16, 26, 30, 27	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	18, 17, 13, 11, 21, 29, 23, 25, 15, 24, 14, 26, 16, 27, 30, 28	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	18, 17, 21, 12, 22, 29, 14, 25, 24, 23, 15, 30, 26, 27, 16, 28	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Senior	18, 17, 12, 13, 22, 11, 23, 25, 24, 15, 14, 28, 26, 30, 16, 27	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	18, 17, 10, 21, 29, 13, 15, 23, 24, 25, 14, 26, 16, 27, 30, 28	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act II, Scene III,” how does Shakespeare show Friar Laurence agrees to marry them? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act II, Scene III, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Friar Laurence agrees to marry them? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act II, Scene III develops the idea of Friar Laurence agrees to marry them. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act II, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Friar Laurence agrees to marry them. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act II, Scene III suggests about Friar Laurence agrees to marry them. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and foreshadowing), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act II, Scene III to complicate the reader's understanding of Friar Laurence agrees to marry them. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act II, Scene III within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Friar Laurence agrees to marry them responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act II, Scene III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Friar Laurence agrees to marry them follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act II, Scene III and its treatment of Friar Laurence agrees to marry them. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and foreshadowing, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act II, Scene III as evidence for a larger claim about Friar Laurence agrees to marry them in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act II, Scene III as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Friar Laurence agrees to marry them. Position your

reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

SAT-style questions

1. *But come, young waverer, come, go with me, In one respect I'll thy assistant be; For this alliance may so happy prove, To turn your households' rancour to pure love.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "waverer" most nearly mean?

   A. puzzling; speaking in riddles

   B. telling one's sins to a priest

   C. a person who keeps changing his mind

   D. pleading on another's behalf

2. *I'll tell thee, ere thou ask it me again. I have been feasting with mine enemy, Where on a sudden one hath wounded me, That's by me wounded: both our remedies Within thy help and holy physic lies: I bear no hatred, blessed man, for, lo, My intercession likewise steads my foe.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act II, Scene III"?

   A. The household mourns

   B. The Friar's desperate plan

   C. Friar Laurence agrees to marry them

   D. Juliet waits for the Nurse

SAT key: 1. C (a person who keeps changing his mind); 2. C (Friar Laurence agrees to marry them)

Lesson 13: Act II, Scene IV

Focus: wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in "Act II, Scene IV" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (sexual innuendo): Mercutio's banter with the Nurse is bawdy ('the bawdy hand of the dial is now upon the prick of noon'). Gloss briefly as crude teasing that insults the Nurse; do not have students perform it.
Student preview: This scene includes crude jokes aimed at the Nurse.
Suggested language: "How does the Nurse respond to being mocked?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Benvolio and Mercutio learn that Tybalt has sent Romeo a challenge; Mercutio mocks Tybalt's fencing. Romeo joins them and wins a battle of puns. The Nurse arrives, is mocked by Mercutio, and receives Romeo's message: Juliet should come to Friar Laurence's cell that afternoon to be married.

Background: Fencing manuals from Italy and Spain introduced strict rules (passado, punto reverso); Mercutio mocks their fashionable vocabulary. Shrift (confession) gave young women a respectable reason to visit a friar.

Significance: The comic surface hides the challenge that will lead to deaths; the marriage plan fixes the timeline.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How can humor hide tension? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to violence and the feud because.... Content note before we start: This scene includes crude jokes aimed at the Nurse.
Prompt: How can humor hide tension?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to violence and the feud because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Tybalt has sent Romeo a challenge; the comedy is shadowed by the coming duel.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: constrains — forces; rosemary — an herb symbolizing remembrance, used at weddings and funerals; prating — chattering; lisping — speaking affectedly; commend — send greetings; recommend. "rosemary": Origin: Middle English rosmarine; earlier Old French rosmarin.
Words: constrains: forces · rosemary: an herb symbolizing remembrance, used at weddings and funerals · prating: chattering · lisping: speaking affectedly · commend: send greetings; recommend

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Fencing manuals from Italy and Spain introduced strict rules (passado, punto reverso); Mercutio mocks their fashionable vocabulary. Shrift (confession) gave young women a respectable reason to visit a friar. The comic surface hides the challenge that will lead to deaths; the marriage plan fixes the timeline. Characterization: Mercutio mocks Tybalt as "prince of cats" and a master of duelling rules; he and Romeo trade puns. Diction / vocabulary: The scene is a contest of wit; Romeo is himself again, "sociable" in his friends' eyes. Plot: Romeo tells the Nurse to bring Juliet to Friar Laurence's cell that afternoon to be married. Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "your French slop. You gave us the counterfeit fairly last night" (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Why, is not this better now than groaning for love" slowly and put it in my own words: After trading puns with Romeo, Mercutio asks whether this banter is not better than groaning for love. Next, craft. I notice the playful question, a reward after a fast battle of puns that Romeo has finally matched. The strongest word is "groaning": it mocks the sighing, moping lover Romeo was in Act I. Then, effect. What does Mercutio's joke show about Romeo's mood? My answer: Romeo is witty and cheerful again; Mercutio thinks he is cured of love, not knowing Romeo is happy because he is secretly to marry Juliet.

> *Why, is not this better now than groaning for love (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Why, is not this better now than groaning for love" slowly and put it in my own words: After trading puns with Romeo, Mercutio asks whether this banter is not better than groaning for love. Next, craft. I notice the playful question, a reward after a fast battle of puns that Romeo has finally matched. The strongest word is "groaning": it mocks the sighing, moping lover Romeo was in Act I. Then, effect. What does Mercutio's joke show about Romeo's mood? My answer: Romeo is witty and cheerful again; Mercutio thinks he is cured of love, not knowing Romeo is happy because he is secretly to marry Juliet.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Tybalt shares his name with the cat in old fables, so Mercutio calls him "prince of cats." Expected link: violence and the feud: the joke is about a man with a sword. Ask: How does this line connect to violence and the feud? Expected: Tybalt has sent Romeo a challenge; the comedy is shadowed by the coming duel. (Mercutio's nickname for Tybalt (Tybalt is a cat's name in fables).)

> *More than prince of cats, I can tell you* (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Tybalt shares his name with the cat in old fables, so Mercutio calls him "prince of cats." Expected link: violence and the feud: the joke is about a man with a sword.
Ask: How does this line connect to violence and the feud?
Expected answer: Tybalt has sent Romeo a challenge; the comedy is shadowed by the coming duel. (Mercutio's nickname for Tybalt (Tybalt is a cat's name in fables).)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, diction / vocabulary (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene IV develops the idea of wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and diction / vocabulary shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it. When the text says “Bid her devise / Some means to come to shrift this afternoon” (Act II, Scene IV, Romeo), it shows this directly. Mercutio's mockery of Tybalt as "prince of cats" follows news of Tybalt's challenge, and Romeo plans the marriage ("Some means to come to shrift this afternoon") without knowing the challenge waits for him.
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, diction / vocabulary (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene IV develops the idea of wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and diction / vocabulary shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it. When the text says “Bid her devise / Some means to come to shrift this afternoon” (Act II, Scene IV, Romeo), it shows this directly. Mercutio's mockery of Tybalt as "prince of cats" follows news of Tybalt's challenge, and Romeo plans the marriage ("Some means to come to shrift this afternoon") without knowing the challenge waits for him.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: How can humor hide tension? Ask: how does the Nurse handle Mercutio's insults? What does this show about class and gender in Verona?
Anchor question: How can humor hide tension?
Facilitation: Ask: how does the Nurse handle Mercutio's insults? What does this show about class and gender in Verona?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it. ("Bid her devise / Some means to come to shrift this afternoon", Act II, Scene IV, Romeo). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it. ("Bid her devise / Some means to come to shrift this afternoon", Act II, Scene IV, Romeo). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan. Key takeaway: Tybalt has sent Romeo a challenge; the comedy is shadowed by the coming duel.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Mercutio mocks Tybalt as "prince of cats" and a master of duelling rules; he and Romeo trade puns.
- **Diction / vocabulary:** The scene is a contest of wit; Romeo is himself again, "sociable" in his friends' eyes.
- **Plot:** Romeo tells the Nurse to bring Juliet to Friar Laurence's cell that afternoon to be married.

Themes and how they develop

- **violence and the feud:** Tybalt has sent Romeo a challenge; the comedy is shadowed by the coming duel.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “your French slop. You gave us the counterfeit fairly last night” (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio).
- **fate and the stars:** From "star-cross'd" in the Prologue to Romeo's "I defy you, stars," the lovers feel steered by fortune, while the plot shows human choices and accidents. In this scene: “Now God in heaven bless thee! Hark you, sir” (Act II, Scene IV, Nurse).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “More than prince of cats, I can tell you” (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio) Mercutio's nickname for Tybalt (Tybalt is a cat's name in fables).
- “Why, is not this better now than groaning for love” (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio) Mercutio is pleased Romeo is witty again.
- “Bid her devise / Some means to come to shrift this afternoon” (Act II, Scene IV, Romeo) Romeo sets the wedding plan.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it.
Evidence: “Bid her devise / Some means to come to shrift this afternoon” (Act II, Scene IV, Romeo)
Reasoning: Mercutio's mockery of Tybalt as "prince of cats" follows news of Tybalt's challenge, and Romeo plans the marriage ("Some means to come to shrift this afternoon") without knowing the challenge waits for him.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
constrains (verb)	forces	*That’s as much as to say, such a case as yours constrains a man to bow in the hams.*	
rosemary (noun)	an herb symbolizing remembrance, used at weddings and funerals	*Doth not rosemary and Romeo begin both with a letter?*	“rosemary”: Origin: Middle English rosmarine; earlier Old French rosmarin. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/rosemary#Etymology)
prating (adjective)	chattering	*Well, sir; my mistress is the sweetest lady—Lord, Lord! when ’twas a little prating thing:—O, there is a nobleman in town, one Paris, that would fain lay knife aboard; but she, good soul, had as lief see a toad, a very toad, as see him.*	
	speaking affectedly		

lisping (adjective)		*The pox of such antic, lisping, affecting fantasticoes; these new tuners of accents!*	
commend (verb)	send greetings; recommend	*Nurse, commend me to thy lady and mistress.*	
complements (noun)	formal manners and courtesies of the duelling code	*O, he is the courageous captain of complements.*	
mongers (noun)	dealers; here, people who traffic in fashion	*Why, is not this a lamentable thing, grandsire, that we should be thus afflicted with these strange flies, these fashion-mongers, these perdona-mi's, who stand so much on the new form, that they cannot sit at ease on the old bench?*	
sententious (noun)	the Nurse's mistake for "sentence," a wise saying	*Ah, mocker! that's the dog's name; R is for the—No; I know it begins with some other letter:—and she hath the prettiest sententious of it, of you and rosemary, that it would do you good to hear it.*	"sententious": Origin: Latin sententiōsus. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/sententious#Etymology)
quivers (verb)	trembles	*Now, afore God, I am so vexed, that every part about me quivers.*	
lamentable (adjective)	full of grief; woeful	*Why, is not this a lamentable thing, grandsire, that we should be thus afflicted with these strange flies, these fashion-mongers, these perdona-mi's, who stand so much on the new form, that they cannot sit at ease on the old bench?*	"lamentable": Origin: Middle French lamentable; earlier Latin lāmentābilis ("full of sorrow"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/lamentable#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. How can humor hide tension?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate and choice?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What will Romeo's man bring the Nurse? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A rope ladder so Romeo can climb to Juliet that night.
2. What has Tybalt sent Romeo? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A challenge
3. What does Mercutio call Tybalt? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Prince of cats
4. Who carries Juliet's message? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The Nurse
5. Where are Romeo and Juliet to marry? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: At Friar Laurence's cell
6. When are they to marry? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: That afternoon
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act II, Scene IV" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Benvolio and Mercutio learn that Tybalt has sent Romeo a challenge; Mercutio mocks Tybalt's fencing. Romeo joins them and wins a battle of puns. The Nurse arrives, is mocked by Mercutio, and receives Romeo's message: Juliet should come to Friar Laurence's cell that afternoon to be married.
8. Who is on stage in "Act II, Scene IV", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act II, Scene IV" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "That's as much as to say, such a case as yours constrains a man to bow in the hams." What does "constrains" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: constrains: forces.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why is Mercutio pleased with Romeo in this scene? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Romeo is sociable and witty again, not groaning for love.
2. What does "Act II, Scene IV" suggest about wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The comic surface hides the challenge that will lead to deaths; the marriage plan fixes the timeline.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the diction / vocabulary in this scene shape what we understand about wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for precise or unusual word choices and their connotations.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it. Useful evidence: "More than prince of cats, I can tell you" (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio): Mercutio's nickname for Tybalt (Tybalt is a cat's name in fables). On diction / vocabulary: The scene is a contest of wit; Romeo is himself again, "sociable" in his friends' eyes. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “More than prince of cats, I can tell you.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act II, Scene IV”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Benvolio and Mercutio learn that Tybalt has sent Romeo a challenge; Mercutio mocks Tybalt's fencing. Romeo joins them and wins a battle of puns. The Nurse arrives, is mocked by Mercutio, and receives Romeo's message: Juliet should come to Friar Laurence's cell that afternoon to be married.
7. How does “Act II, Scene IV” build on “Act II, Scene III”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it. Useful evidence: “Why, is not this better now than groaning for love” (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio): Mercutio is pleased Romeo is witty again. Theme link: Tybalt has sent Romeo a challenge; the comedy is shadowed by the coming duel. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it. Useful evidence: “Bid her devise / Some means to come to shrift this afternoon” (Act II, Scene IV, Romeo): Romeo sets the wedding plan. On characterization: Mercutio mocks Tybalt as "prince of cats" and a master of duelling rules; he and Romeo trade puns. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “How can humor hide tension?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does plot appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with fate and choice? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for key events and the causes linking them.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it. Useful evidence: “More than prince of cats, I can tell you” (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio): Mercutio's nickname for Tybalt (Tybalt is a cat's name in fables). On plot: Romeo tells the Nurse to bring Juliet to Friar Laurence's cell that afternoon to be married. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. How does the Nurse's behavior in this scene complicate her role as Juliet's protector? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Her bawdy delight and warnings to Romeo show both care and foolishness.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it. Useful evidence: “Why, is not this better now than groaning for love” (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio): Mercutio is pleased Romeo is witty again. Theme link: Tybalt has sent Romeo a challenge; the comedy is shadowed by the coming duel. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “The comic surface hides the challenge that will lead to deaths; the marriage plan fixes the timeline.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it. Useful evidence: “Bid her devise / Some means to come to shrift this afternoon” (Act II, Scene IV, Romeo): Romeo sets the wedding plan. Theme link: Tybalt has sent Romeo a challenge; the comedy is shadowed by the coming duel. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it. Useful evidence: “More than prince of cats, I can tell you” (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio): Mercutio's nickname for Tybalt (Tybalt is a cat's name in fables). On characterization: Mercutio mocks Tybalt as "prince of cats" and a master of duelling rules; he and Romeo trade puns. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act II, Scene IV”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it. Useful evidence: “Why, is not this better now than groaning for love” (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio): Mercutio is pleased Romeo is witty again. Theme link: Tybalt has sent Romeo a challenge; the comedy is shadowed by the coming duel. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act II, Scene IV”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it. Useful evidence: “Bid her devise / Some means to come to shrift this afternoon” (Act II, Scene IV, Romeo): Romeo sets the wedding plan. Theme link: Tybalt has sent Romeo a challenge; the comedy is shadowed by the coming duel. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to violence and the feud: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it. Useful evidence: “More than prince of cats, I can tell you” (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio): Mercutio's nickname for Tybalt (Tybalt is a cat's name in fables). Theme link: Tybalt has sent Romeo a challenge; the comedy is shadowed by the coming duel. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with

criteria and evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it. Useful evidence: “Why, is not this better now than groaning for love” (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio): Mercutio is pleased Romeo is witty again. On characterization: Mercutio mocks Tybalt as "prince of cats" and a master of duelling rules; he and Romeo trade puns. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act II, Scene IV” treats wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it. Useful evidence: “Bid her devise / Some means to come to shrift this afternoon” (Act II, Scene IV, Romeo): Romeo sets the wedding plan. Theme link: Tybalt has sent Romeo a challenge; the comedy is shadowed by the coming duel. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act II, Scene V” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it. Useful evidence: “More than prince of cats, I can tell you” (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio): Mercutio's nickname for Tybalt (Tybalt is a cat's name in fables). Theme link: Tybalt has sent Romeo a challenge; the comedy is shadowed by the coming duel. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it. Useful evidence: “Why, is not this better now than groaning for love” (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio): Mercutio is pleased Romeo is witty again. Theme link: Tybalt has sent Romeo a challenge; the comedy is shadowed by the coming duel. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Diction / vocabulary**: precise or unusual word choices and their connotations
- Also notice **Plot**: key events and the causes linking them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene IV, Romeo: “Bid her devise / Some means to come to shrift this _____”

   Key: afternoon

2. [short · recall · DOK 1] What will Romeo's man bring the Nurse?

   Sample answer: A rope ladder so Romeo can climb to Juliet that night.

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "That's as much as to say, such a case as yours constrains a man to bow in the hams.", what does "constrains" most nearly mean?

   A. supplies of food and drink

   B. grandfather; an old man

   C. forces

   D. a low bed on wheels kept under a larger one

   Key: C (forces)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Why, is not this a lamentable thing, grandsire, that we should be thus afflicted with these strange flies, these fashion-_____, these perdona-mi's, who stand so much on the new form, that they cannot sit at ease on the old bench?" Word bank: prating, constrains, mongers, rosemary

   Key: mongers

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "The pox of such antic, lisping, affecting fantasticoes; these new tuners of accents!", what does "lisping" most nearly mean?

   A. speaking affectedly

   B. kill quickly

   C. cheated; tricked

   D. the body

   Key: A (speaking affectedly)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] When are they to marry?

   A. Thursday

   B. That afternoon

   C. At midnight

   D. Next week

   Key: B (That afternoon)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Mercutio call Tybalt?

   A. King of dogs

   B. A rat

   C. Lord of swords

   D. Prince of cats

   Key: D (Prince of cats)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where are Romeo and Juliet to marry?

   A. At the Capulet house

   B. In Mantua

   C. At St. Peter's Church

   D. At Friar Laurence's cell

   Key: D (At Friar Laurence's cell)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio: "More than _____ of cats, I can tell you"

   Key: prince

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act II, Scene IV”?
    A. Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition
    B. Juliet hears the news
    C. Wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan
    D. The household mourns

    Key: C (Wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan)

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “More than prince of cats, I can tell you” (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio)
    A. Romeo blames fortune.
    B. Mercutio's nickname for Tybalt (Tybalt is a cat's name in fables).
    C. The potion's effect.
    D. Juliet's impatience.

    Key: B (Mercutio's nickname for Tybalt (Tybalt is a cat's name in fables).)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Why, is not this better now than groaning for love” (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio)
    A. The Nurse delivers the news.
    B. The potion's effect.
    C. Romeo hands his course to God or fate.
    D. Mercutio is pleased Romeo is witty again.

    Key: D (Mercutio is pleased Romeo is witty again.)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “More than prince of cats, I can tell you” (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Mercutio's nickname for Tybalt (Tybalt is a cat's name in fables).

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act II, Scene IV”? Mercutio mocks Tybalt as "prince of cats" and a master of duelling rules; he and Romeo trade puns.
    A. Structure
    B. Alliteration
    C. Characterization
    D. Theme

    Key: C (Characterization)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act II, Scene IV”? The scene is a contest of wit; Romeo is himself again, "sociable" in his friends' eyes.
    A. Foreshadowing
    B. Structure
    C. Alliteration
    D. Diction / vocabulary

    Key: D (Diction / vocabulary)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how violence and the feud develops from an earlier scene to “Act II, Scene IV”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Tybalt has sent Romeo a challenge; the comedy is shadowed by the coming duel.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Doth not rosemary and Romeo begin both with a letter?”, what does “rosemary” most nearly mean?

    A. pleading on another's behalf

    B. a reviving drink; medicine for the heart

    C. left without a husband

    D. an herb symbolizing remembrance, used at weddings and funerals

    Key: D (an herb symbolizing remembrance, used at weddings and funerals)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who carries Juliet's message?

    A. Peter only

    B. Friar John

    C. The Nurse

    D. Balthasar

    Key: C (The Nurse)

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “O, he is the courageous captain of _____.” Word bank: complements, prating, rosemary, constrains

    Key: complements

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Well, sir; my mistress is the sweetest lady—Lord, Lord! when ’twas a little prating thing:—O, there is a nobleman in town, one Paris, that would fain lay knife aboard; but she, good soul, had as lief see a toad, a very…”, what does “prating” most nearly mean?

    A. increase; make (grief) multiply

    B. chattering

    C. an enclosed garden of fruit trees

    D. carefree, playful people

    Key: B (chattering)

21. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why is Mercutio pleased with Romeo in this scene?

    Sample answer: Romeo is sociable and witty again, not groaning for love.

22. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Bid her devise / Some means to come to shrift this afternoon” (Act II, Scene IV, Romeo). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Romeo sets the wedding plan.

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Bid her devise / Some means to come to shrift this afternoon” (Act II, Scene IV, Romeo).

    Sample answer: Mercutio's mockery of Tybalt as "prince of cats" follows news of Tybalt's challenge, and Romeo plans the marriage ("Some means to come to shrift this afternoon") without knowing the challenge waits for him.

24. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What has Tybalt sent Romeo?

    A. A challenge

    B. An apology

    C. A warning from the Prince

    D. A gift

    Key: A (A challenge)

25. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Nurse, _____ me to thy lady and mistress.” Word bank: prating, commend, rosemary, constrains

    Key: commend

26. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Why, is not this better now than groaning for love” (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Mercutio is pleased Romeo is witty again.

27. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Bid her devise / Some means to come to shrift this afternoon” (Act II, Scene IV, Romeo)

    A. Juliet as light in darkness.

    B. Passion overcomes obstacles.

    C. Romeo sets the wedding plan.

    D. Mercutio's mock spell.

    Key: C (Romeo sets the wedding plan.)

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Tybalt has sent Romeo a challenge; the comedy is shadowed by the coming duel.

    A. Fate and choice

    B. Violence and the feud

    C. Love and desire

    D. Youth and age

    Key: B (Violence and the feud)

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Why, is not this better now than groaning for love” (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Mercutio is pleased Romeo is witty again.

30. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio: “Why, is not this better now than _____ for love”

    Key: groaning

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: Mercutio's mockery of Tybalt as "prince of cats" follows news of Tybalt's challenge, and Romeo plans the marriage ("Some means to come to shrift this afternoon") without knowing the challenge waits for him.

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] How does the Nurse's behavior in this scene complicate her role as Juliet's protector?

    Sample answer: Her bawdy delight and warnings to Romeo show both care and foolishness.

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “More than prince of cats, I can tell you” (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Mercutio's nickname for Tybalt (Tybalt is a cat's name in fables).

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 18, 2, 1, 19, 8, 20, 4, 11, 12, 21, 10, 22, 14, 23, 16	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1

HS Sophomore	24, 4, 7, 25, 1, 19, 10, 26, 12, 27, 13, 28, 22, 14, 16, 29	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	3, 30, 1, 24, 2, 11, 13, 10, 26, 21, 22, 14, 15, 23, 29, 31	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	17, 25, 5, 4, 13, 27, 26, 10, 11, 14, 15, 23, 28, 32, 33, 16	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	4, 9, 24, 12, 10, 27, 26, 22, 15, 14, 28, 23, 31, 32, 16, 33	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	2, 19, 9, 10, 26, 13, 27, 15, 28, 22, 23, 14, 33, 31, 16, 29	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	4, 25, 12, 11, 26, 21, 28, 14, 22, 23, 15, 33, 16, 29, 32, 31	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	25, 4, 10, 12, 26, 21, 28, 14, 23, 22, 15, 32, 29, 31, 33, 16	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Senior	25, 19, 12, 10, 27, 26, 15, 28, 14, 23, 22, 31, 16, 32, 33, 29	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	19, 25, 21, 26, 10, 27, 15, 22, 23, 14, 28, 33, 29, 31, 32, 16	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act II, Scene IV,” how does Shakespeare show wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act II, Scene IV, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act II, Scene IV develops the idea of wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and diction / vocabulary shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act II, Scene IV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act II, Scene IV suggests about wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and diction / vocabulary), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act II, Scene IV to complicate the reader's understanding of wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act II, Scene IV within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act II, Scene IV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act II, Scene IV and its treatment of wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and diction / vocabulary, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act II, Scene IV as evidence for a larger claim about wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act II, Scene IV as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

SAT-style questions

1. *Well, sir; my mistress is the sweetest lady—Lord, Lord! when 'twas a little prating thing:—O, there is a nobleman in town, one Paris, that would fain lay knife aboard; but she, good soul, had as lief see a toad, a very toad, as see him.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “prating” most nearly mean?

   A. trembles

   B. full of grief; woeful

   C. the Nurse's mistake for "sentence," a wise saying

   D. chattering

2. *More than prince of cats, I can tell you. O, he is the courageous captain of complements. He fights as you sing prick-song, keeps time, distance, and proportion; rests me his minim rest, one, two, and the third in your bosom: the very butcher of a silk button, a duellist, a duellist; a gentleman of the very first house, of the first and second cause: ah, the immortal passado! the punto reverso! the hai!*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act II, Scene IV"?

A. Juliet, her mother and the Nurse

B. The second Chorus

C. Juliet's feigned obedience

D. Wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan

SAT key: 1. D (chattering); 2. D (Wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan)

Lesson 14: Act II, Scene V

Focus: Juliet waits for the Nurse

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in “Act II, Scene V” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

Juliet waits impatiently for the Nurse, who left at nine and returns at noon. The Nurse delays, complaining of aches, before telling her to go to Friar Laurence's cell, where a husband waits.

Background: Hours were marked by church bells; Juliet's counting of hours shows how slowly time moves for her.

Significance: Comic delay emphasizes the lovers' urgency.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What is waiting for important news like? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to time and haste because....
Prompt: What is waiting for important news like?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to time and haste because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Juliet counts the hours ("from nine till twelve / Is three long hours").

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: louring — dark and threatening; poultice — a soft dressing applied to soothe pain; heralds — messengers who announce news; circumstance — details; the full particulars; courteous — polite and respectful. “courteous”: Origin: Old French curteis.
Words: louring: dark and threatening · poultice: a soft dressing applied to soothe pain · heralds: messengers who announce news · circumstance: details; the full particulars · courteous: polite and respectful

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Hours were marked by church bells; Juliet's counting of hours shows how slowly time moves for her. Comic delay emphasizes the lovers' urgency. Characterization: Juliet's impatience with the slow Nurse is comic and touching. Structure: The Nurse delays the news to tease Juliet, building comic suspense. Imagery: Juliet wishes love's heralds were thoughts that "glide than the sun's beams." Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "should be thoughts, / Which ten times faster glide than the sun's beams, / Driving back shadows over louring hills: / Therefore do nimble-pinion'd doves" (Act II, Scene V, Juliet).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "love's heralds should be thoughts, / Which ten times faster glide than the sun's beams" slowly and put it in my own words: Waiting for the Nurse, Juliet says love's messengers should be thoughts, which fly ten times faster than sunbeams. Next, craft. I notice the hyperbole and the images of speed and light, set against the slow, old Nurse. The strongest word is "heralds": it means messengers, and Juliet wants hers to travel as fast as thought. Then, effect. What does Juliet's impatience for the Nurse show? My answer: Juliet is desperate for news of Romeo's wedding plans; her impatience shows how fast and intense their love is, which the Friar warns against in the next scene.

> *love's heralds should be thoughts, / Which ten times faster glide than the sun's beams* (Act II, Scene V, Juliet)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "love's heralds should be thoughts, / Which ten times faster glide than the sun's beams" slowly and put it in my own words: Waiting for the Nurse, Juliet says love's messengers should be thoughts, which fly ten times faster than sunbeams. Next, craft. I notice the hyperbole and the images of speed and light, set against the slow, old Nurse. The strongest word is "heralds": it means messengers, and Juliet wants hers to travel as fast as thought. Then, effect. What does Juliet's impatience for the Nurse show? My answer: Juliet is desperate for news of Romeo's wedding plans; her impatience shows how fast and intense their love is, which the Friar warns against in the next scene.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Heralds are messengers; Juliet wants news to move as fast as thought. Expected link: time and haste. Ask: How does this line connect to time and haste? Expected: Juliet counts the hours ("from nine till twelve / Is three long hours"). (Juliet's impatience.)

> *Is thy news good, or bad? answer to that* (Act II, Scene V, Juliet)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Heralds are messengers; Juliet wants news to move as fast as thought. Expected link: time and haste.
Ask: How does this line connect to time and haste?
Expected answer: Juliet counts the hours ("from nine till twelve / Is three long hours"). (Juliet's impatience.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Juliet waits for the Nurse? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene V develops the idea of Juliet waits for the Nurse. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and structure shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow. When the text says “Is thy news good, or bad? answer to that” (Act II, Scene V, Juliet), it shows this directly. She wishes "Love's heralds should be thoughts, / Which ten times faster glide than the sun's beams" and demands "Is thy news good, or bad?"
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Juliet waits for the Nurse? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene V develops the idea of Juliet waits for the Nurse. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and structure shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow. When the text says “Is thy news good, or bad? answer to that” (Act II, Scene V, Juliet), it shows this directly. She wishes "Love's heralds should be thoughts, / Which ten times faster glide than the sun's beams" and demands "Is thy news good, or bad?"

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What is waiting for important news like? Ask: why does the Nurse delay? Is it teasing, tiredness or something else?
Anchor question: What is waiting for important news like?
Facilitation: Ask: why does the Nurse delay? Is it teasing, tiredness or something else?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Juliet waits for the Nurse? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow. (“Is thy news good, or bad? answer to that”, Act II, Scene V, Juliet). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Juliet waits for the Nurse? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow. (“Is thy news good, or bad? answer to that”, Act II, Scene V, Juliet). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes Juliet waits for the Nurse. Key takeaway: Juliet counts the hours ("from nine till twelve / Is three long hours").*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Juliet's impatience with the slow Nurse is comic and touching.
- **Structure:** The Nurse delays the news to tease Juliet, building comic suspense.
- **Imagery:** Juliet wishes love's heralds were thoughts that "glide than the sun's beams."

Themes and how they develop

- **time and haste:** Juliet counts the hours ("from nine till twelve / Is three long hours").

Symbols and motifs

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “should be thoughts, / Which ten times faster glide than the sun’s beams, / Driving back shadows over louring hills: / Therefore do nimble-pinion’d doves” (Act II, Scene V, Juliet).
- **fate and the stars:** From "star-cross'd" in the Prologue to Romeo's "I defy you, stars," the lovers feel steered by fortune, while the plot shows human choices and accidents. In this scene: “Hie to high fortune! Honest nurse, farewell. Exeunt” (Act II, Scene V, Juliet).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “love’s heralds should be thoughts, / Which ten times faster glide than the sun’s beams” (Act II, Scene V, Juliet) Love wants instant messages.
- “Is thy news good, or bad? answer to that” (Act II, Scene V, Juliet) Juliet's impatience.
- “Then hie you hence to Friar Laurence’ cell; / There stays a husband to make you a wife” (Act II, Scene V, Nurse) The Nurse delivers the news.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow.
Evidence: “Is thy news good, or bad? answer to that” (Act II, Scene V, Juliet)
Reasoning: She wishes "Love's heralds should be thoughts, / Which ten times faster glide than the sun's beams" and demands "Is thy news good, or bad?"

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
louring (adjective)	dark and threatening	*O, she is lame! love's heralds should be thoughts, Which ten times faster glide than the sun's beams, Driving back shadows over louring hills: Therefore do nimble-pinion'd doves draw love, And therefore hath the wind-swift Cupid wings.*	
poultice (noun)	a soft dressing applied to soothe pain	*Are you so hot? marry, come up, I trow; Is this the poultice for my aching bones?*	
heralds (noun)	messengers who announce news	*O, she is lame! love's heralds should be thoughts, Which ten times faster glide than the sun's beams, Driving back shadows over louring hills: Therefore do nimble-pinion'd doves draw love, And therefore hath the wind-swift Cupid wings.*	
circumstance (noun)	details; the full particulars	*Is thy news good, or bad? answer to that; Say either, and I'll stay the circumstance: Let me be satisfied, is't good or bad?*	
courteous (adjective)	polite and respectful	*Your love says, like an honest gentleman, and a courteous, and a kind, and a handsome, and, I warrant, a virtuous— Where is your mother?*	"courteous": Origin: Old French curteis. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/courteous#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. What is waiting for important news like?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with violence and the feud?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. When did Juliet send the Nurse? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: At nine o'clock.
2. How long has the Nurse been away? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Three hours
3. What does the Nurse complain about? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Her aching bones and back
4. Where must Juliet go? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Friar Laurence's cell
5. What does Juliet wish love's heralds were? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Thoughts
6. How does the Nurse finally deliver the news? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: She tells Juliet a husband waits at the Friar's cell
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act II, Scene V" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Juliet waits impatiently for the Nurse, who left at nine and returns at noon. The Nurse delays, complaining of aches, before telling her to go to Friar Laurence's cell, where a husband waits.
8. Who is on stage in "Act II, Scene V", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act II, Scene V" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "O, she is lame! love's heralds should be thoughts, Which ten times faster glide than the sun's beams, Driving back shadows over louring hills: Therefore do nimble-pinion'd doves draw love, And therefore hath the…" What does "louring" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: louring: dark and threatening.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does the Nurse delay? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Partly teasing, partly tired, enjoying her power over Juliet.
2. What does "Act II, Scene V" suggest about Juliet waits for the Nurse? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Comic delay emphasizes the lovers' urgency.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the structure in this scene shape what we understand about Juliet waits for the Nurse? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow. Useful evidence: "love's heralds should be thoughts, / Which ten times faster glide than the sun's beams" (Act II, Scene V, Juliet): Love wants instant messages. On structure: The Nurse

delays the news to tease Juliet, building comic suspense. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “The clock struck nine when I did send the nurse; In half an hour she promised to return.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act II, Scene V”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Juliet waits impatiently for the Nurse, who left at nine and returns at noon. The Nurse delays, complaining of aches, before telling her to go to Friar Laurence's cell, where a husband waits.
7. How does “Act II, Scene V” build on “Act II, Scene IV”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow. Useful evidence: “Is thy news good, or bad? answer to that” (Act II, Scene V, Juliet): Juliet's impatience. On structure: The Nurse delays the news to tease Juliet, building comic suspense. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow. Useful evidence: “Then hie you hence to Friar Laurence’ cell; / There stays a husband to make you a wife” (Act II, Scene V, Nurse): The Nurse delivers the news. On characterization: Juliet's impatience with the slow Nurse is comic and touching. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “What is waiting for important news like?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does imagery appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with violence and the feud? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow. Useful evidence: “love’s heralds should be thoughts, / Which ten times faster glide than the sun’s beams” (Act II, Scene V, Juliet): Love wants instant messages. On imagery: Juliet wishes love's heralds were thoughts that "glide than the sun's beams." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is the Nurse a good messenger? Evaluate her role. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Weighing her affection and her unreliability.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow. Useful evidence: “Is thy news good, or bad? answer to that” (Act II, Scene V,

Juliet): Juliet's impatience. Theme link: Juliet counts the hours ("from nine till twelve / Is three long hours"). Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “Comic delay emphasizes the lovers' urgency.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow. Useful evidence: “Then hie you hence to Friar Laurence’ cell; / There stays a husband to make you a wife” (Act II, Scene V, Nurse): The Nurse delivers the news. Theme link: Juliet counts the hours ("from nine till twelve / Is three long hours"). Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow. Useful evidence: “love’s heralds should be thoughts, / Which ten times faster glide than the sun’s beams” (Act II, Scene V, Juliet): Love wants instant messages. On characterization: Juliet's impatience with the slow Nurse is comic and touching. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act II, Scene V”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Juliet waits for the Nurse. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow. Useful evidence: “Is thy news good, or bad? answer to that” (Act II, Scene V, Juliet): Juliet's impatience. On structure: The Nurse delays the news to tease Juliet, building comic suspense. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act II, Scene V”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow. Useful evidence: “Then hie you hence to Friar Laurence’ cell; / There stays a husband to make you a wife” (Act II, Scene V, Nurse): The Nurse delivers the news. Theme link: Juliet counts the hours ("from nine till twelve / Is three long hours"). Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to youth and age: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow. Useful evidence: “love’s heralds should be thoughts, / Which ten times faster glide than the sun’s beams” (Act II, Scene V, Juliet): Love wants instant messages. Theme link: Juliet counts the hours ("from nine till twelve / Is three long hours"). Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow. Useful evidence: “Is thy news good, or bad? answer to that” (Act II, Scene V, Juliet): Juliet's impatience. On characterization: Juliet's impatience with the slow Nurse is comic and touching. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act II, Scene V” treats Juliet waits for the Nurse with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow. Useful evidence: “Then hie you hence to Friar Laurence’ cell; / There stays a husband to make you a wife” (Act II, Scene V, Nurse): The Nurse delivers the news. Theme link: Juliet counts the hours ("from nine till twelve / Is three long hours"). Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act II, Scene VI” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow. Useful evidence: “love’s heralds should be thoughts, / Which ten times faster glide than the sun’s beams” (Act II, Scene V, Juliet): Love wants instant messages. Theme link: Juliet counts the hours ("from nine till twelve / Is three long hours"). Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Juliet waits for the Nurse? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow. Useful evidence: “Is thy news good, or bad? answer to that” (Act II, Scene V, Juliet): Juliet's impatience. Theme link: Juliet counts the hours ("from nine till twelve / Is three long hours"). Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where must Juliet go?

   A. The orchard

   B. Church of St. Peter

C. Friar Laurence's cell

D. Mantua

Key: C (Friar Laurence's cell)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does the Nurse complain about?

A. Her aching bones and back

B. Romeo's rudeness only

C. Tybalt

D. Paris

Key: A (Her aching bones and back)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Are you so hot? marry, come up, I trow; Is this the poultice for my aching bones?", what does "poultice" most nearly mean?

A. a soft dressing applied to soothe pain

B. formal manners and courtesies of the duelling code

C. dominant; ruling (an astrological term)

D. commands

Key: A (a soft dressing applied to soothe pain)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Your love says, like an honest gentleman, and a _____, and a kind, and a handsome, and, I warrant, a virtuous—Where is your mother?"

Word bank: courteous, louring, poultice, heralds

Key: courteous

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does the Nurse finally deliver the news?

A. She sings

B. She tells Juliet a husband waits at the Friar's cell

C. She whispers to Lady Capulet

D. She hands her a letter

Key: B (She tells Juliet a husband waits at the Friar's cell)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "O, she is lame! love's heralds should be thoughts, Which ten times faster glide than the sun's beams, Driving back shadows over louring hills: Therefore do nimble-pinion'd doves draw love, And therefore hath the…", what does "heralds" most nearly mean?

A. messengers who announce news

B. stopped (crying)

C. deserving pity; pitiful

D. going along with a crowd

Key: A (messengers who announce news)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Is thy news good, or bad? answer to that; Say either, and I'll stay the circumstance: Let me be satisfied, is't good or bad?", what does "circumstance" most nearly mean?

A. details; the full particulars

B. risen up to

C. a marriage settlement for a bride

D. a person who keeps changing his mind

Key: A (details; the full particulars)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “O, she is lame! love’s heralds should be thoughts, Which ten times faster glide than the sun’s beams, Driving back shadows over louring hills: Therefore do nimble-pinion’d doves draw love, And therefore hath the…”, what does “louring” most nearly mean?

   A. an enclosed garden of fruit trees

   B. dark and threatening

   C. changeable; not faithful

   D. dealers; here, people who traffic in fashion

   Key: B (dark and threatening)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene V, Juliet: “Is thy news good, or bad? _____ to that”

   Key: answer

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does the Nurse delay?

    Sample answer: Partly teasing, partly tired, enjoying her power over Juliet.

11. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Is thy news good, or bad? answer to that” (Act II, Scene V, Juliet) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Juliet's impatience.

12. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “love’s heralds should be thoughts, / Which ten times faster glide than the sun’s beams” (Act II, Scene V, Juliet) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Love wants instant messages.

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act II, Scene V”?

    A. Juliet waits for the Nurse

    B. The street brawl and lovesick Romeo

    C. Wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan

    D. Juliet, her mother and the Nurse

    Key: A (Juliet waits for the Nurse)

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act II, Scene V”? The Nurse delays the news to tease Juliet, building comic suspense.

    A. Characterization

    B. Structure

    C. Metaphor

    D. Hyperbole

    Key: B (Structure)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Then hie you hence to Friar Laurence’ cell; / There stays a husband to make you a wife” (Act II, Scene V, Nurse). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: The Nurse delivers the news.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Is thy news good, or bad? answer to that” (Act II, Scene V, Juliet) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Juliet's impatience.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene V, Juliet: “love’s heralds should be _____, / Which ten times faster glide than the sun’s beams”

    Key: thoughts

18. [short · recall · DOK 1] When did Juliet send the Nurse?

    Sample answer: At nine o'clock.

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene V, Nurse: “Then hie you hence to Friar _____’ cell; / There stays a husband to make you a wife”

    Key: Laurence

20. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “love’s heralds should be thoughts, / Which ten times faster glide than the sun’s beams” (Act II, Scene V, Juliet)

    A. Love wants instant messages.

    B. Tybalt's tie to Lady Capulet explains her later grief and demand for revenge.

    C. Mercutio's dying curse on the feud.

    D. Capulet now assumes obedience.

    Key: A (Love wants instant messages.)

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Then hie you hence to Friar Laurence’ cell; / There stays a husband to make you a wife” (Act II, Scene V, Nurse)

    A. Capulet's lament.

    B. Tybalt's tie to Lady Capulet explains her later grief and demand for revenge.

    C. Benvolio predicts Romeo will find someone more beautiful than Rosaline.

    D. The Nurse delivers the news.

    Key: D (The Nurse delivers the news.)

22. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Is thy news good, or bad? answer to that” (Act II, Scene V, Juliet).

    Sample answer: She wishes "Love's heralds should be thoughts, / Which ten times faster glide than the sun's beams" and demands "Is thy news good, or bad?"

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act II, Scene V”? Juliet's impatience with the slow Nurse is comic and touching.

    A. Allusion

    B. Characterization

    C. Symbolism

    D. Foreshadowing

    Key: B (Characterization)

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Is thy news good, or bad? answer to that” (Act II, Scene V, Juliet)

    A. Juliet's impatience.

    B. Benvolio predicts Romeo will find someone more beautiful than Rosaline.

    C. Passion overcomes obstacles.

    D. Mercutio is pleased Romeo is witty again.

Key: A (Juliet's impatience.)

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: She wishes "Love's heralds should be thoughts, / Which ten times faster glide than the sun's beams" and demands "Is thy news good, or bad?"

26. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Juliet wish love's heralds were?
    A. Thoughts
    B. Bells
    C. Birds
    D. Horses

    Key: A (Thoughts)

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How long has the Nurse been away?
    A. Three hours
    B. One hour
    C. Ten minutes
    D. A day

    Key: A (Three hours)

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Juliet counts the hours ("from nine till twelve / Is three long hours").
    A. Violence and the feud
    B. Love and desire
    C. Time and haste
    D. Fate and choice

    Key: C (Time and haste)

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is the Nurse a good messenger? Evaluate her role.
    Sample answer: Weighing her affection and her unreliability.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “love’s heralds should be thoughts, / Which ten times faster glide than the sun’s beams” (Act II, Scene V, Juliet) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Love wants instant messages.

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how time and haste develops from an earlier scene to “Act II, Scene V”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Juliet counts the hours ("from nine till twelve / Is three long hours").

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	8, 17, 3, 6, 18, 4, 19, 2, 20, 21, 11, 13, 22, 23, 15, 16	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	4, 1, 9, 5, 3, 17, 12, 10, 11, 20, 24, 23, 14, 15, 25, 16	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2

HS Junior	6, 26, 17, 4, 27, 24, 12, 20, 13, 21, 23, 14, 22, 28, 16, 29	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	26, 18, 17, 4, 11, 12, 10, 21, 13, 14, 23, 28, 15, 30, 29, 16	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	19, 4, 18, 10, 11, 20, 12, 23, 15, 22, 14, 28, 25, 16, 30, 31	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	4, 17, 27, 13, 20, 10, 11, 14, 15, 23, 22, 28, 30, 31, 29, 16	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	4, 17, 21, 13, 12, 24, 22, 28, 15, 14, 23, 29, 16, 25, 30, 31	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	4, 17, 20, 21, 10, 11, 14, 15, 28, 23, 22, 25, 30, 16, 29, 31	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Senior	4, 17, 21, 24, 11, 20, 15, 22, 28, 23, 14, 25, 29, 30, 16, 31	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	4, 17, 24, 13, 10, 11, 22, 23, 15, 14, 28, 30, 25, 31, 16, 29	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act II, Scene V,” how does Shakespeare show Juliet waits for the Nurse? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act II, Scene V, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Juliet waits for the Nurse? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act II, Scene V develops the idea of Juliet waits for the Nurse. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and structure shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act II, Scene V (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Juliet waits for the Nurse. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act II, Scene V suggests about Juliet waits for the Nurse. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and structure), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act II, Scene V to complicate the reader's understanding of Juliet waits for the Nurse. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act II, Scene V within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Juliet waits for the Nurse responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act II, Scene V alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Juliet waits for the Nurse follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act II, Scene V and its treatment of Juliet waits for the Nurse. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and structure, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act II, Scene V as evidence for a larger claim about Juliet waits for the Nurse in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act II, Scene V as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Juliet waits for the Nurse. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

SAT-style questions

1. *O, she is lame! love's heralds should be thoughts, Which ten times faster glide than the sun's beams, Driving back shadows over louring hills: Therefore do nimble-pinion'd doves draw love, And therefore hath the wind-swift Cupid wings.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "louring" most nearly mean?

   A. messengers who announce news

   B. details; the full particulars

   C. polite and respectful

   D. dark and threatening

2. *The clock struck nine when I did send the nurse; In half an hour she promised to return. Perchance she cannot meet him: that's not so. O, she is lame! love's heralds should be thoughts, Which ten times faster glide than the sun's beams, Driving back shadows over louring hills: Therefore do nimble-pinion'd doves draw love, And therefore hath the wind-swift Cupid wings. Now is the sun upon the highmost hill Of this day's journey, and*

from nine till twelve Is three long hours, yet she is not come. Had she affections and warm youthful blood, She would be as swift in motion as a ball; My words would bandy her to my sweet love, And his to me: But old folks, many feign as they were dead; Unwieldy, slow, heavy and pale as lead. O God, she comes!

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act II, Scene V"?

A. The divided world of Verona

B. Love at first sight at the Capulet feast

C. Juliet waits for the Nurse

D. Juliet drinks the potion

SAT key: 1. D (dark and threatening); 2. C (Juliet waits for the Nurse)

Lesson 15: Act II, Scene VI

Focus: the secret wedding

Objective: Students will analyze how foreshadowing develops in "Act II, Scene VI" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (suicide (mentioned in lesson text)): This lesson mentions suicide or self-harm. Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol.
Student preview: This lesson mentions suicide.
Suggested language:
Safe messaging: Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this chapter is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

Friar Laurence warns Romeo that violent delights have violent ends and urges moderate love. Juliet arrives; the lovers exchange expressions of joy, and the Friar leads them off to be married.

Background: Marriage required vows before a priest; secret marriages were valid but scandalous.

Significance: The warnings before the wedding foreshadow the deaths.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What is the difference between intense love and lasting love? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to time and haste because.... If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.
Prompt: What is the difference between intense love and lasting love?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to time and haste because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the Friar again urges moderation even as he marries them within a day of meeting.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: bestride — stand or walk astride; gossamer — fine spider threads floating in the air; ornament — decoration; incorporate — join into one body; confessor — a priest who hears confession. “ornament”: Origin: Old French ornement; earlier Latin ornamentum (“equipment”). “incorporate”: Origin: Late Latin incorporātus. “confessor”: Origin: Anglo-Norman confessour; earlier Latin cōnfessor.
Words: bestride: stand or walk astride · gossamer: fine spider threads floating in the air · ornament: decoration · incorporate: join into one body · confessor: a priest who hears confession

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Marriage required vows before a priest; secret marriages were valid but scandalous. The warnings before the wedding foreshadow the deaths. Foreshadowing: The Friar warns "These violent delights have violent ends." Imagery: Fire and powder: the lovers' joy will "consume" "as they kiss." Characterization: Juliet's love is beyond words: "I cannot sum up sum of half my wealth." Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “Here comes the lady: O, so light a foot / Will ne’er wear out the everlasting flint: / A lover” (Act II, Scene VI).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read “These violent delights have violent ends” slowly and put it in my own words: Just before marrying the couple, the Friar warns that violent delights have violent ends. Next, craft. I notice the repetition of "violent," which links great joy directly to destruction. The strongest word is “violent”: it suggests a passion so intense that it burns itself out. Then, effect. What does the Friar warn before the wedding? My answer: Before the wedding, the Friar warns that violent delights have violent ends, because love this sudden cannot last; his warning foreshadows the tragic end, as the lovers' haste leads to their deaths within days.

> *These violent delights have violent ends* (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read “These violent delights have violent ends” slowly and put it in my own words: Just before marrying the couple, the Friar warns that violent delights have violent ends. Next, craft. I notice the repetition of "violent," which links great joy directly to destruction. The strongest word is “violent”: it suggests a passion so intense that it burns itself out. Then, effect. What does the Friar warn before the wedding? My answer: Before the wedding, the Friar warns that violent delights have violent ends, because love this sudden cannot last; his warning foreshadows the tragic end, as the lovers' haste leads to their deaths within days.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Moderation as the key to lasting love. Look at the craft: Fire and powder: the lovers' joy will "consume" "as they kiss." Ask: How does this line connect to time and haste? Expected: The Friar again urges moderation even as he marries them within a day of meeting. (Moderation as the key to lasting love.)

> *Therefore love moderately; long love doth so (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Moderation as the key to lasting love. Look at the craft: Fire and powder: the lovers' joy will "consume" "as they kiss."
Ask: How does this line connect to time and haste?
Expected answer: The Friar again urges moderation even as he marries them within a day of meeting. (Moderation as the key to lasting love.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for foreshadowing, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the secret wedding? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene VI develops the idea of the secret wedding. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of destruction. When the text says “These violent delights have violent ends” (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence), it shows this directly. Before the ceremony the Friar says "These violent delights have violent ends" and urges "love moderately; long love doth so," a counsel the lovers cannot follow.
Task: Annotate the scene for foreshadowing, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the secret wedding? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene VI develops the idea of the secret wedding. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of destruction. When the text says “These violent delights have violent ends” (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence), it shows this directly. Before the ceremony the Friar says "These violent delights have violent ends" and urges "love moderately; long love doth so," a counsel the lovers cannot follow.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What is the difference between intense love and lasting love? Why does Shakespeare keep the wedding itself offstage?
Anchor question: What is the difference between intense love and lasting love?
Facilitation: Why does Shakespeare keep the wedding itself offstage?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the secret wedding? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of destruction. ("These violent delights have violent ends", Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the secret wedding? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of destruction. ("These violent delights have violent ends", Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how foreshadowing shapes the secret wedding. Key takeaway: the Friar again urges moderation even as he marries them within a day of meeting.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Foreshadowing:** The Friar warns "These violent delights have violent ends."
- **Imagery:** Fire and powder: the lovers' joy will "consume" "as they kiss."
- **Characterization:** Juliet's love is beyond words: "I cannot sum up sum of half my wealth."

Themes and how they develop

- **time and haste:** the Friar again urges moderation even as he marries them within a day of meeting.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "Here comes the lady: O, so light a foot / Will ne'er wear out the everlasting flint: / A lover" (Act II, Scene VI).
- **fate and the stars:** From "star-cross'd" in the Prologue to Romeo's "I defy you, stars," the lovers feel steered by fortune, while the plot shows human choices and accidents. In this scene: "So smile the heavens upon this holy act, / That after hours with sorrow chide us" (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "These violent delights have violent ends" (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence) The Friar's warning.
- "Therefore love moderately; long love doth so" (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence) Moderation as the key to lasting love.
- "I cannot sum up sum of half my wealth" (Act II, Scene VI, Juliet) Juliet's love exceeds counting.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of destruction.
Evidence: “These violent delights have violent ends” (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence)
Reasoning: Before the ceremony the Friar says "These violent delights have violent ends" and urges "love moderately; long love doth so," a counsel the lovers cannot follow.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
bestride (verb)	stand or walk astride	*Here comes the lady: O, so light a foot Will ne'er wear out the everlasting flint: A lover may bestride the gossamer That idles in the wanton summer air, And yet not fall; so light is vanity.*	
gossamer (noun)	fine spider threads floating in the air	*Here comes the lady: O, so light a foot Will ne'er wear out the everlasting flint: A lover may bestride the gossamer That idles in the wanton summer air, And yet not fall; so light is vanity.*	
ornament (noun)	decoration	*Conceit, more rich in matter than in words, Brags of his substance, not of ornament: They are but beggars that can count their worth; But my true love is grown to such excess I cannot sum up sum of half my wealth.*	“ornament”: Origin: Old French ornement; earlier Latin ornamentum (“equipment”). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/ornament#Etymology)
incorporate (verb)	join into one body	*Come, come with me, and we will make short work; For, by your leaves, you shall not stay alone Till holy church incorporate two in one.*	“incorporate”: Origin: Late Latin incorporātus. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/incorporate#Etymology)
confessor (noun)	a priest who hears confession	*Good even to my ghostly confessor.*	“confessor”: Origin: Anglo-Norman confessour; earlier Latin cōnfessor. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/confessor#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. What is the difference between intense love and lasting love?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with youth and age?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Romeo say he does not care about if he can call Juliet his? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Love-devouring death may do what he dare.
2. What does the Friar warn? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Violent delights have violent ends
3. How does the Friar describe Juliet's step? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: So light a foot
4. What does the Friar advise? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Love moderately
5. Where does the wedding take place? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Offstage
6. What does Juliet say she cannot sum up? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Half her wealth
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act II, Scene VI" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Friar Laurence warns Romeo that violent delights have violent ends and urges moderate love. Juliet arrives; the lovers exchange expressions of joy, and the Friar leads them off to be married.
8. Who is on stage in "Act II, Scene VI", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act II, Scene VI" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Here comes the lady: O, so light a foot Will ne'er wear out the everlasting flint: A lover may bestride the gossamer That idles in the wanton summer air, And yet not fall; so light is vanity." What does "bestride" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: bestride: stand or walk astride.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does the Friar compare the lovers' joy to fire and powder? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Both explode and are consumed in the moment they meet.
2. What does "Act II, Scene VI" suggest about the secret wedding? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The warnings before the wedding foreshadow the deaths.

3. Find one example of foreshadowing in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
4. How does the imagery in this scene shape what we understand about the secret wedding? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of destruction. Useful evidence: “These violent delights have violent ends” (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence): The Friar's warning. On imagery: Fire and powder: the lovers' joy will "consume" "as they kiss." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Conceit, more rich in matter than in words, Brags of his substance, not of ornament: They are but beggars that can count their worth; But my true love is grown to such excess I…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act II, Scene VI”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Friar Laurence warns Romeo that violent delights have violent ends and urges moderate love. Juliet arrives; the lovers exchange expressions of joy, and the Friar leads them off to be married.
7. How does “Act II, Scene VI” build on “Act II, Scene V”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of destruction. Useful evidence: “Therefore love moderately; long love doth so” (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence): Moderation as the key to lasting love. Theme link: the Friar again urges moderation even as he marries them within a day of meeting. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of destruction. Useful evidence: “I cannot sum up sum of half my wealth” (Act II, Scene VI, Juliet): Juliet's love exceeds counting. On characterization: Juliet's love is beyond words: "I cannot sum up sum of half my wealth." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “What is the difference between intense love and lasting love?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with youth and age? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of

destruction. Useful evidence: “These violent delights have violent ends” (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence): The Friar's warning. On characterization: Juliet's love is beyond words: "I cannot sum up sum of half my wealth." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is the Friar responsible for what follows? Use this scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of his warnings and actions.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of destruction. Useful evidence: “Therefore love moderately; long love doth so” (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence): Moderation as the key to lasting love. Theme link: the Friar again urges moderation even as he marries them within a day of meeting. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The warnings before the wedding foreshadow the deaths.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of destruction. Useful evidence: “I cannot sum up sum of half my wealth” (Act II, Scene VI, Juliet): Juliet's love exceeds counting. Theme link: the Friar again urges moderation even as he marries them within a day of meeting. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of destruction. Useful evidence: “These violent delights have violent ends” (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence): The Friar's warning. On characterization: Juliet's love is beyond words: "I cannot sum up sum of half my wealth." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act II, Scene VI”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the secret wedding. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of destruction. Useful evidence: “Therefore love moderately; long love doth so” (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence): Moderation as the key to lasting love. Theme link: the Friar again urges moderation even as he marries them within a day of meeting. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act II, Scene VI”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of destruction. Useful evidence: “I cannot sum up sum of half my wealth” (Act II, Scene VI, Juliet): Juliet's love exceeds counting. Theme link: the Friar again urges moderation even as he marries them within a day of

meeting. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to time and haste: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of destruction. Useful evidence: “These violent delights have violent ends” (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence): The Friar's warning. Theme link: the Friar again urges moderation even as he marries them within a day of meeting. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the foreshadowing in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of destruction. Useful evidence: “Therefore love moderately; long love doth so” (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence): Moderation as the key to lasting love. On foreshadowing: The Friar warns "These violent delights have violent ends." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act II, Scene VI” treats the secret wedding with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of destruction. Useful evidence: “I cannot sum up sum of half my wealth” (Act II, Scene VI, Juliet): Juliet's love exceeds counting. Theme link: the Friar again urges moderation even as he marries them within a day of meeting. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act III, Scene I” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of destruction. Useful evidence: “These violent delights have violent ends” (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence): The Friar's warning. On foreshadowing: The Friar warns "These violent delights have violent ends." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the secret wedding? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of destruction. Useful evidence: “Therefore love moderately; long love doth so” (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence): Moderation as the key to lasting love. Theme link: the Friar again urges moderation even as he marries them within a day of meeting. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Come, come with me, and we will make short work; For, by your leaves, you shall not stay alone Till holy church incorporate two in one.", what does "incorporate" most nearly mean?
   A. a state of urgent crisis
   B. waves (a weapon) about in a showy way
   C. join into one body
   D. a wooden plate

   Key: C (join into one body)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does the Friar warn?
   A. Time is short
   B. Marry in haste
   C. Love conquers all
   D. Violent delights have violent ends

   Key: D (Violent delights have violent ends)
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence: "These violent _____ have violent ends"
   Key: delights
4. [short · recall · DOK 1] What does Romeo say he does not care about if he can call Juliet his?
   Sample answer: Love-devouring death may do what he dare.
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where does the wedding take place?
   A. Offstage
   B. In the street
   C. On stage at the Capulet house
   D. At the feast

   Key: A (Offstage)
6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does the Friar describe Juliet's step?
   A. So light a foot
   B. Slow
   C. Heavy
   D. Uncertain

   Key: A (So light a foot)
7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does the Friar advise?
   A. Elope to Mantua

B. Love moderately

C. Tell the parents

D. Wait a year

Key: B (Love moderately)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Here comes the lady: O, so light a foot Will ne’er wear out the everlasting flint: A lover may bestride the gossamer That idles in the wanton summer air, And yet not fall; so light is vanity.”, what does “bestride” most nearly mean?

   A. delay; neglect

   B. damp; also moody, ruled by humours

   C. a wooden plate

   D. stand or walk astride

   Key: D (stand or walk astride)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene VI, Juliet: “I _____ sum up sum of half my wealth”

   Key: cannot

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act II, Scene VI”?

    A. Juliet hears the news

    B. The secret wedding

    C. The divided world of Verona

    D. Wedding preparations

    Key: B (The secret wedding)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “These violent delights have violent ends” (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The Friar's warning.

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Therefore love moderately; long love doth so” (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence)

    A. Lady Capulet's book metaphor for a husband.

    B. Moderation as the key to lasting love.

    C. The Friar's doubt about Romeo's love.

    D. The potion's effect.

    Key: B (Moderation as the key to lasting love.)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I cannot sum up sum of half my wealth” (Act II, Scene VI, Juliet)

    A. For Romeo, exile is the end of the world.

    B. Tybalt's first speech: hatred for its own sake.

    C. Juliet's love exceeds counting.

    D. Household detail.

    Key: C (Juliet's love exceeds counting.)

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act II, Scene VI”? Fire and powder: the lovers' joy will "consume" "as they kiss."

    A. Theme

    B. Imagery

    C. Characterization

    D. Simile

    Key: B (Imagery)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “I cannot sum up sum of half my wealth” (Act II, Scene VI, Juliet). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Juliet's love exceeds counting.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Therefore love moderately; long love doth so” (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Moderation as the key to lasting love.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence: “Therefore love _____; long love doth so”

    Key: moderately

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Here comes the lady: O, so light a foot Will ne’er wear out the everlasting flint: A lover may bestride the gossamer That idles in the wanton summer air, And yet not fall; so light is vanity.”, what does “gossamer” most nearly mean?

    A. ask earnestly

    B. annoying; troublesome

    C. fine spider threads floating in the air

    D. a soft dressing applied to soothe pain

    Key: C (fine spider threads floating in the air)

19. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does the Friar compare the lovers' joy to fire and powder?

    Sample answer: Both explode and are consumed in the moment they meet.

20. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “These violent delights have violent ends” (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence)

    A. Haste again.

    B. Romeo blames love for softening him.

    C. Romeo's last words.

    D. The Friar's warning.

    Key: D (The Friar's warning.)

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? The Friar again urges moderation even as he marries them within a day of meeting.

    A. Violence and the feud

    B. Fate and choice

    C. Time and haste

    D. Love and desire

    Key: C (Time and haste)

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act II, Scene VI”? The Friar warns "These violent delights have violent ends."

    A. Foreshadowing

    B. Alliteration

    C. Allusion

    D. Conflict

    Key: A (Foreshadowing)

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of destruction. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “These violent delights have violent ends” (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence).
    Sample answer: Before the ceremony the Friar says "These violent delights have violent ends" and urges "love moderately; long love doth so," a counsel the lovers cannot follow.

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of destruction.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: Before the ceremony the Friar says "These violent delights have violent ends" and urges "love moderately; long love doth so," a counsel the lovers cannot follow.

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Conceit, more rich in matter than in words, Brags of his substance, not of ornament: They are but beggars that can count their worth; But my true love is grown to such excess I cannot sum up sum of half my wealth.”, what does “ornament” most nearly mean?

    A. dangerous; alarming

    B. dealers; here, people who traffic in fashion

    C. a state of urgent crisis

    D. decoration

    Key: D (decoration)

26. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Therefore love moderately; long love doth so” (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Moderation as the key to lasting love.

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “These violent delights have violent ends” (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: The Friar's warning.

28. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Good even to my ghostly _____.”
    Word bank: ornament, bestride, gossamer, confessor
    Key: confessor

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is the Friar responsible for what follows? Use this scene.
    Sample answer: A judgment of his warnings and actions.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how time and haste develops from an earlier scene to “Act II, Scene VI”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: the Friar again urges moderation even as he marries them within a day of meeting.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1

HS Freshman	2, 9, 17, 3, 18, 8, 7, 6, 10, 13, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	7, 8, 3, 9, 25, 4, 20, 19, 10, 12, 13, 22, 15, 23, 24, 16	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	18, 2, 1, 3, 17, 26, 10, 20, 11, 13, 22, 21, 14, 15, 24, 27	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	28, 5, 25, 17, 10, 20, 11, 13, 19, 23, 15, 14, 22, 29, 24, 16	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	3, 28, 4, 19, 20, 11, 12, 14, 15, 22, 23, 21, 30, 29, 16, 24	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	28, 3, 2, 19, 13, 11, 10, 23, 15, 21, 22, 14, 29, 27, 30, 24	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	28, 3, 19, 11, 12, 13, 22, 23, 15, 21, 14, 29, 30, 16, 27, 24	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	28, 3, 10, 26, 20, 19, 15, 22, 21, 23, 14, 30, 24, 29, 16, 27	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Senior	28, 3, 13, 10, 20, 12, 14, 23, 22, 15, 21, 24, 29, 30, 16, 27	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	17, 28, 13, 26, 20, 12, 22, 15, 23, 14, 21, 29, 24, 30, 16, 27	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act II, Scene VI,” how does Shakespeare show the secret wedding? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In Act II, Scene VI, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the secret wedding? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act II, Scene VI develops the idea of the secret wedding. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act II, Scene VI (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of the secret wedding. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act II, Scene VI suggests about the secret wedding. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's foreshadowing and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses foreshadowing in Act II, Scene VI to complicate the reader's understanding of the secret wedding. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act II, Scene VI within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the secret wedding responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act II, Scene VI alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the secret wedding follows or bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act II, Scene VI and its treatment of the secret wedding. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's foreshadowing and imagery, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act II, Scene VI as evidence for a larger claim about the secret wedding in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act II, Scene VI as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the secret wedding. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

SAT-style questions

1. *Here comes the lady: O, so light a foot Will ne'er wear out the everlasting flint: A lover may bestride the gossamer That idles in the wanton summer air, And yet not fall; so light is vanity.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "bestride" most nearly mean?

   A. a priest who hears confession

   B. stand or walk astride

   C. decoration

   D. join into one body

2. *Conceit, more rich in matter than in words, Brags of his substance, not of ornament: They are but beggars that can count their worth; But my true love is grown to such excess I cannot sum up sum of half my wealth.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act II, Scene VI"?

A. The tomb

B. Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation

C. The secret wedding

D. Friar Laurence agrees to marry them

SAT key: 1. B (stand or walk astride); 2. C (The secret wedding)

Lesson 16: Act III, Scene I

Focus: Mercutio's death and Tybalt's

Objective: Students will analyze how plot develops in “Act III, Scene I” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Critical voice: “It is observed that in Italy almost all assassinations are committed during the heat of summer.” (Samuel Johnson, critic and lexicographer, *Notes to Romeo and Juliet, The Plays of William Shakespeare (1765), in Preface to Shakespeare, together with selected notes on some of the plays, note on Act III, Scene i ("The day is hot")*; public domain). Setting as cause: list every reference to heat or "hot blood" in III.i. *Objective:* Analyze how setting (heat, the street) drives Mercutio's and Tybalt's deaths. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.3, RL.11-12.5

Content note (street violence, death of a friend, alcohol): Mercutio is fatally wounded and Romeo kills Tybalt on stage. Focus on choices and the honour code, not the swordplay. Alcohol: period drinking appears as social custom (wine at feasts, toasts or 'healths') and as a restorative (aqua vitae, i.e. brandy or spirits). Name it plainly; don't glamorize it. Mercutio mocks a brawler who picks fights 'by the operation of the second cup'.
Student preview: This scene shows two deaths in a street fight. A joke links drinking and fighting.
Suggested language: “What choices led to these deaths?”

Teacher only · spoilers

In the hot afternoon Tybalt seeks Romeo. Romeo, newly married to Tybalt's cousin, refuses to fight. Mercutio fights Tybalt; Romeo steps between them and Tybalt wounds Mercutio under Romeo's arm. Mercutio dies cursing both houses. Romeo kills Tybalt and flees. The Prince banishes Romeo.

Background: Duels and honour codes required a man to answer insults; refusing could be seen as cowardice. Banishment was a common punishment.

Significance: The turning point: comedy dies with Mercutio and tragedy begins.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
When is it right to fight for a friend? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to violence and the feud because.... Content note before we start: This scene shows two deaths in a street fight. A joke links drinking and fighting.
Prompt: When is it right to fight for a friend?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to violence and the feud because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Mercutio curses both houses as he dies.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: bandying — exchanging blows or words; peppered — finished; done for; discords — harsh, clashing sounds; quarrels; minstrels — wandering musicians; appertaining — belonging; appropriate. "bandying": Origin of "bandy": French bander ("to bandy at tennis"). "discords": Origin of "discord": Old French descort; earlier Latin discordia. "appertaining": Origin of "appertain": Old French apartenir; earlier Late Latin appertinēre.
Words: bandying: exchanging blows or words · peppered: finished; done for · discords: harsh, clashing sounds; quarrels · minstrels: wandering musicians · appertaining: belonging; appropriate

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Duels and honour codes required a man to answer insults; refusing could be seen as cowardice. Banishment was a common punishment. The turning point: comedy dies with Mercutio and tragedy begins. Plot: The turning point: Mercutio is killed under Romeo's arm; Romeo kills Tybalt and is banished. Characterization: Romeo tries peace ("I do protest, I never injured thee") then turns to fury. Irony: Romeo's attempt to stop the fight lets Tybalt's thrust reach Mercutio. Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "I pray thee, good Mercutio, let's retire: / The day is hot, the Capulets abroad, / And, if we meet, we shall" (Act III, Scene I, Benvolio).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "A plague o' both your houses" slowly and put it in my own words: Dying from Tybalt's blow, Mercutio curses both families, wishing a plague on both their houses. Next, craft. I notice the curse is repeated three times, so it sounds like a prophecy rather than a passing complaint. The strongest word is "plague": it is a deadly epidemic disease, which he wishes on Montagues and Capulets alike. Then, effect. What does Mercutio's curse mean? My answer: Mercutio blames the feud, not just Tybalt, for his death; his curse seems to come true, as the plague later even stops the Friar's letter reaching Romeo.

> *A plague o' both your houses* (Act III, Scene I, Mercutio)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "A plague o' both your houses" slowly and put it in my own words: Dying from Tybalt's blow, Mercutio curses both families, wishing a plague on both their houses. Next, craft. I notice the curse is repeated three times, so it sounds like a prophecy rather than a passing complaint. The strongest word is "plague": it is a deadly epidemic disease, which he wishes on Montagues and Capulets alike. Then, effect. What does Mercutio's curse mean? My answer: Mercutio blames the feud, not just Tybalt, for his death; his curse seems to come true, as the plague later even stops the Friar's letter reaching Romeo.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Romeo sees himself as fortune's plaything. Expected link: fate and choice: students should weigh his choice to fight against bad luck. Ask: How does this line connect to violence and the feud? Expected: Mercutio curses both houses as he dies. (Romeo blames fortune.)

> *O, I am fortune's fool (Act III, Scene I, Romeo)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Romeo sees himself as fortune's plaything. Expected link: fate and choice: students should weigh his choice to fight against bad luck.
Ask: How does this line connect to violence and the feud?
Expected answer: Mercutio curses both houses as he dies. (Romeo blames fortune.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for plot, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Mercutio's death and Tybalt's? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene I develops the idea of Mercutio's death and Tybalt's. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune. When the text says "O sweet Juliet, / Thy beauty hath made me effeminate" (Act III, Scene I, Romeo), it shows this directly. He says Juliet's beauty "hath made me effeminate," kills Tybalt, then cries "O, I am fortune's fool," while Mercutio's "A plague o' both your houses" blames the feud itself.
Task: Annotate the scene for plot, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Mercutio's death and Tybalt's? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene I develops the idea of Mercutio's death and Tybalt's. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune. When the text says "O sweet Juliet, / Thy beauty hath made me effeminate" (Act III, Scene I, Romeo), it shows this directly. He says Juliet's beauty "hath made me effeminate," kills Tybalt, then cries "O, I am fortune's fool," while Mercutio's "A plague o' both your houses" blames the feud itself.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: When is it right to fight for a friend? Ask: who is to blame for Mercutio's death? For Tybalt's?
Anchor question: When is it right to fight for a friend?
Facilitation: Ask: who is to blame for Mercutio's death? For Tybalt's?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Mercutio's death and Tybalt's? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune. ("O sweet Juliet, / Thy beauty hath made me effeminate", Act III, Scene I, Romeo). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Mercutio's death and Tybalt's? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune. ("O sweet Juliet, / Thy beauty hath made me effeminate", Act III, Scene I, Romeo). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how plot shapes Mercutio's death and Tybalt's. Key takeaway: Mercutio curses both houses as he dies.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Plot:** The turning point: Mercutio is killed under Romeo's arm; Romeo kills Tybalt and is banished.
- **Characterization:** Romeo tries peace ("I do protest, I never injured thee") then turns to fury.
- **Irony:** Romeo's attempt to stop the fight lets Tybalt's thrust reach Mercutio.

Themes and how they develop

- **violence and the feud:** Mercutio curses both houses as he dies.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "I pray thee, good Mercutio, let's retire: / The day is hot, the Capulets abroad, / And, if we meet, we shall" (Act III, Scene I, Benvolio).
- **fate and the stars:** From "star-cross'd" in the Prologue to Romeo's "I defy you, stars," the lovers feel steered by fortune, while the plot shows human choices and accidents. In this scene: "This day's black fate on more days doth depend; / This but begins the woe others" (Act III, Scene I, Romeo).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "A plague o' both your houses" (Act III, Scene I, Mercutio) Mercutio's dying curse on the feud.
- "O sweet Juliet, / Thy beauty hath made me effeminate" (Act III, Scene I, Romeo) Romeo blames love for softening him.
- "O, I am fortune's fool" (Act III, Scene I, Romeo) Romeo blames fortune.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune.
Evidence: "O sweet Juliet, / Thy beauty hath made me effeminate" (Act III, Scene I, Romeo)
Reasoning: He says Juliet's beauty "hath made me effeminate," kills Tybalt, then cries "O, I am fortune's fool," while Mercutio's "A plague o' both your houses" blames the feud itself.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
bandying (noun)	exchanging blows or words	*Tybalt, Mercutio, the prince expressly hath Forbidden bandying in Verona streets: Hold, Tybalt! good Mercutio!*	"bandying": Origin of "bandy": French bander ("to bandy at tennis"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/bandy#Etymology)
peppered (adjective)	finished; done for	*I am peppered, I warrant, for this world.*	
discords (noun)	harsh, clashing sounds; quarrels	*Consort! what, dost thou make us minstrels? an thou make minstrels of us, look to hear nothing but discords: here's my fiddlestick; here's that shall make you dance. 'Zounds, consort!*	"discords": Origin of "discord": Old French descort; earlier Latin discordia. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/discord#Etymology)
minstrels (noun)	wandering musicians	*Consort! what, dost thou make us minstrels? an thou make minstrels of us, look to hear nothing but discords: here's my fiddlestick; here's that shall make you dance. 'Zounds, consort!*	
appertaining (adjective)	belonging; appropriate	*Tybalt, the reason that I have to love thee Doth much excuse the appertaining rage To such a greeting: villain am I none; Therefore farewell; I see thou know'st me not.*	"appertaining": Origin of "appertain": Old French apartenir; earlier Late Latin appertinēre. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/appertain#Etymology)
aspired (verb)	risen up to	*That gallant spirit hath aspired the clouds, Which too untimely here did scorn the earth.*	"aspired": Origin of "aspire": Old French aspirer; earlier Latin aspīrō ("breathe on"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/aspire#Etymology)
slander (noun)	a false and damaging statement	*This gentleman, the prince's near ally, My very friend, hath got his mortal hurt In my behalf; my reputation stain'd With Tybalt's slander— Tybalt, that an hour Hath been my kinsman!*	

beginners (noun)	those who start something	*Where are the vile beginners of this fray?*	
braggart (noun)	a boaster	*A plague o' both your houses! 'Zounds, a dog, a rat, a mouse, a cat, to scratch a man to death! a braggart, a rogue, a villain, that fights by the book of arithmetic!*	"braggart": Origin: Middle French bragard ("bragging"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/braggart#Etymology)
follower (noun)	a servant or retainer	*But I'll be hang'd, sir, if he wear your livery: Marry, go before to field, he'll be your follower; Your worship in that sense may call him "man."*	

Discussion questions

1. When is it right to fight for a friend?
2. Where does plot appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with time and haste?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Mercutio call his wound? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A scratch, but enough; 'ask for me to-morrow, and you shall find me a grave man.'
2. Why does Romeo refuse to fight Tybalt? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He is now Tybalt's kinsman by marriage
3. How is Mercutio wounded? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Under Romeo's arm
4. What does Mercutio curse? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Both houses
5. What is Romeo's punishment? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Banishment
6. What does Romeo call himself? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Fortune's fool
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act III, Scene I" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: In the hot afternoon Tybalt seeks Romeo. Romeo, newly married to Tybalt's cousin, refuses to fight. Mercutio fights Tybalt; Romeo steps between them and Tybalt wounds

Mercutio under Romeo's arm. Mercutio dies cursing both houses. Romeo kills Tybalt and flees. The Prince banishes Romeo.

8. Who is on stage in “Act III, Scene I”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act III, Scene I” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “Tybalt, Mercutio, the prince expressly hath Forbidden bandying in Verona streets: Hold, Tybalt! good Mercutio!” What does “bandying” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: bandying: exchanging blows or words.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does the Prince banish rather than execute Romeo? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Tybalt killed Mercutio first; Romeo's act ended what the law would have.
2. What does “Act III, Scene I” suggest about Mercutio's death and Tybalt's? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The turning point: comedy dies with Mercutio and tragedy begins.
3. Find one example of plot in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for key events and the causes linking them.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about Mercutio's death and Tybalt's? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune. Useful evidence: “A plague o’ both your houses” (Act III, Scene I, Mercutio): Mercutio's dying curse on the feud. On characterization: Romeo tries peace ("I do protest, I never injured thee") then turns to fury. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “No, ’tis not so deep as a well, nor so wide as a church-door; but ’tis enough, ’twill serve: ask for me to-morrow, and you shall find me a grave man.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act III, Scene I”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: In the hot afternoon Tybalt seeks Romeo. Romeo, newly married to Tybalt's cousin, refuses to fight. Mercutio fights Tybalt; Romeo steps between them and Tybalt wounds Mercutio under Romeo's arm. Mercutio dies cursing both houses. Romeo kills Tybalt and flees. The Prince banishes Romeo.
7. How does “Act III, Scene I” build on “Act II, Scene VI”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune. Useful evidence: “O sweet Juliet, / Thy beauty hath made me effeminate” (Act III, Scene I, Romeo): Romeo blames love for softening him. Theme link: Mercutio curses

both houses as he dies. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune. Useful evidence: “O, I am fortune’s fool” (Act III, Scene I, Romeo): Romeo blames fortune. On characterization: Romeo tries peace ("I do protest, I never injured thee") then turns to fury. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “When is it right to fight for a friend?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does irony appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with time and haste? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune. Useful evidence: “A plague o’ both your houses” (Act III, Scene I, Mercutio): Mercutio's dying curse on the feud. On irony: Romeo's attempt to stop the fight lets Tybalt's thrust reach Mercutio. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Romeo a murderer, an avenger or a victim? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned argument using the scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune. Useful evidence: “O sweet Juliet, / Thy beauty hath made me effeminate” (Act III, Scene I, Romeo): Romeo blames love for softening him. Theme link: Mercutio curses both houses as he dies. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The turning point: comedy dies with Mercutio and tragedy begins.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune. Useful evidence: “O, I am fortune’s fool” (Act III, Scene I, Romeo): Romeo blames fortune. Theme link: Mercutio curses both houses as he dies. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune. Useful evidence: “A plague o’ both your houses” (Act III, Scene I, Mercutio): Mercutio's dying curse on the feud. On characterization: Romeo tries peace ("I do protest, I

never injured thee") then turns to fury. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act III, Scene I”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Mercutio's death and Tybalt's. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune. Useful evidence: “O sweet Juliet, / Thy beauty hath made me effeminate” (Act III, Scene I, Romeo): Romeo blames love for softening him. Theme link: Mercutio curses both houses as he dies. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act III, Scene I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune. Useful evidence: “O, I am fortune’s fool” (Act III, Scene I, Romeo): Romeo blames fortune. Theme link: Mercutio curses both houses as he dies. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to love and desire: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune. Useful evidence: “A plague o’ both your houses” (Act III, Scene I, Mercutio): Mercutio's dying curse on the feud. Theme link: Mercutio curses both houses as he dies. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the plot in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune. Useful evidence: “O sweet Juliet, / Thy beauty hath made me effeminate” (Act III, Scene I, Romeo): Romeo blames love for softening him. On plot: The turning point: Mercutio is killed under Romeo's arm; Romeo kills Tybalt and is banished. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act III, Scene I” treats Mercutio's death and Tybalt's with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune. Useful evidence: “O, I am fortune’s fool” (Act III, Scene I, Romeo): Romeo blames fortune. Theme link: Mercutio curses both houses as he dies. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act III, Scene II” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune. Useful evidence: "A plague o' both your houses" (Act III, Scene I, Mercutio): Mercutio's dying curse on the feud. Theme link: Mercutio curses both houses as he dies. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Mercutio's death and Tybalt's? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune. Useful evidence: "O sweet Juliet, / Thy beauty hath made me effeminate" (Act III, Scene I, Romeo): Romeo blames love for softening him. Theme link: Mercutio curses both houses as he dies. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Plot:** look for key events and the causes linking them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Consort! what, dost thou make us minstrels? an thou make minstrels of us, look to hear nothing but discords: here's my fiddlestick; here's that shall make you dance. 'Zounds, consort!", what does "discords" most nearly mean?

    A. fills with doubt and foreboding

    B. chattering

    C. a fountain; a pipe of water

    D. harsh, clashing sounds; quarrels

    Key: D (harsh, clashing sounds; quarrels)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Mercutio curse?

    A. The Prince

    B. Romeo alone

    C. Both houses

    D. Tybalt alone

    Key: C (Both houses)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Where are the vile _____ of this fray?" Word bank: discords, peppered, beginners, bandying

    Key: beginners

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene I, Mercutio: "A _____ o' both your houses"

    Key: plague

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Tybalt, the reason that I have to love thee Doth much excuse the _____ rage To such a greeting: villain am I none; Therefore farewell; I see thou

know'st me not." Word bank: bandying, peppered, discords, appertaining

Key: appertaining

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why does Romeo refuse to fight Tybalt?

   A. He is wounded

   B. He is now Tybalt's kinsman by marriage

   C. The Prince is watching

   D. He is afraid

   Key: B (He is now Tybalt's kinsman by marriage)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How is Mercutio wounded?

   A. By accident from Benvolio

   B. By the Prince's guards

   C. In a fair fight

   D. Under Romeo's arm

   Key: D (Under Romeo's arm)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Consort! what, dost thou make us minstrels? an thou make minstrels of us, look to hear nothing but discords: here's my fiddlestick; here's that shall make you dance. 'Zounds, consort!", what does "minstrels" most nearly mean?

   A. kept company

   B. a common weed whose leaf was used to treat cuts

   C. forces

   D. wandering musicians

   Key: D (wandering musicians)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Romeo call himself?

   A. Fortune's fool

   B. A Capulet

   C. A coward

   D. A hero

   Key: A (Fortune's fool)

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? "A plague o' both your houses" (Act III, Scene I, Mercutio) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Mercutio's dying curse on the feud.

11. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does the Prince banish rather than execute Romeo?

    Sample answer: Tybalt killed Mercutio first; Romeo's act ended what the law would have.

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Act III, Scene I"?

    A. Mercutio's death and Tybalt's

    B. The tomb

    C. The Friar's desperate plan

    D. The undelivered letter

    Key: A (Mercutio's death and Tybalt's)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “O sweet Juliet, / Thy beauty hath made me effeminate” (Act III, Scene I, Romeo)

    A. Lady Capulet's book metaphor for a husband.

    B. Mercutio mocks dreams as the work of a fairy.

    C. Romeo blames love for softening him.

    D. Death as bridegroom.

    Key: C (Romeo blames love for softening him.)

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act III, Scene I”? Romeo tries peace ("I do protest, I never injured thee") then turns to fury.

    A. Personification

    B. Allusion

    C. Conflict

    D. Characterization

    Key: D (Characterization)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act III, Scene I”? The turning point: Mercutio is killed under Romeo's arm; Romeo kills Tybalt and is banished.

    A. Plot

    B. Theme

    C. Tone / mood

    D. Conflict

    Key: A (Plot)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is Romeo a murderer, an avenger or a victim? Argue.

    Sample answer: A reasoned argument using the scene.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “That gallant spirit hath _____ the clouds, Which too untimely here did scorn the earth.” Word bank: discords, aspired, bandying, peppered

    Key: aspired

18. [short · recall · DOK 1] What does Mercutio call his wound?

    Sample answer: A scratch, but enough; 'ask for me to-morrow, and you shall find me a grave man.'

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “I am peppered, I warrant, for this world.”, what does “peppered” most nearly mean?

    A. finished; done for

    B. hated

    C. details; the full particulars

    D. silly; obstinate

    Key: A (finished; done for)

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What is Romeo's punishment?

    A. Fine

    B. Death

    C. Prison

    D. Banishment

Key: D (Banishment)

21. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “O sweet Juliet, / Thy beauty hath made me effeminate” (Act III, Scene I, Romeo) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Romeo blames love for softening him.

22. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “O sweet Juliet, / Thy beauty hath made me effeminate” (Act III, Scene I, Romeo).
    Sample answer: He says Juliet's beauty "hath made me effeminate," kills Tybalt, then cries "O, I am fortune's fool," while Mercutio's "A plague o' both your houses" blames the feud itself.

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Mercutio curses both houses as he dies.
    A. Youth and age
    B. Love and desire
    C. Violence and the feud
    D. Fate and choice

    Key: C (Violence and the feud)

24. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Tybalt, Mercutio, the prince expressly hath Forbidden bandying in Verona streets: Hold, Tybalt! good Mercutio!”, what does “bandying” most nearly mean?
    A. draws out (as vapour)
    B. unholy
    C. high rank and standing in society
    D. exchanging blows or words

    Key: D (exchanging blows or words)

25. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “O, I am fortune’s fool” (Act III, Scene I, Romeo)
    A. Capulet's greeting.
    B. Romeo blames fortune.
    C. Wedding turns to funeral.
    D. Romeo forgets Rosaline in a line.

    Key: B (Romeo blames fortune.)

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “O, I am fortune’s fool” (Act III, Scene I, Romeo). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Romeo blames fortune.

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “O sweet Juliet, / Thy beauty hath made me effeminate” (Act III, Scene I, Romeo) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Romeo blames love for softening him.

28. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “This gentleman, the prince’s near ally, My very friend, hath got his mortal hurt In my behalf; my reputation stain’d With Tybalt’s _____— Tybalt, that an hour Hath been my kinsman!” Word bank: slander, discords, peppered, bandying
    Key: slander

29. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “A plague o’ both your houses” (Act III, Scene I, Mercutio)

    A. Mercutio's dying curse on the feud.

    B. Juliet as light in darkness.

    C. The potion's effect.

    D. Moderation as the key to lasting love.

    Key: A (Mercutio's dying curse on the feud.)

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “A plague o’ both your houses” (Act III, Scene I, Mercutio) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Mercutio's dying curse on the feud.

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene I, Romeo: “O sweet Juliet, / Thy beauty hath made me _____”

    Key: effeminate

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: He says Juliet's beauty "hath made me effeminate," kills Tybalt, then cries "O, I am fortune's fool," while Mercutio's "A plague o' both your houses" blames the feud itself.

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how violence and the feud develops from an earlier scene to “Act III, Scene I”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Mercutio curses both houses as he dies.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	1, 2, 17, 7, 4, 18, 19, 20, 13, 12, 11, 21, 22, 23, 14, 16	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	5, 8, 17, 18, 19, 24, 21, 13, 10, 11, 25, 15, 14, 26, 27, 16	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	4, 7, 8, 18, 28, 12, 13, 29, 21, 10, 15, 22, 14, 23, 30, 16	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	2, 24, 31, 5, 21, 25, 13, 29, 11, 23, 22, 26, 14, 32, 33, 16	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	20, 5, 17, 25, 12, 21, 10, 23, 15, 22, 26, 14, 16, 32, 30, 33	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	28, 5, 24, 11, 21, 10, 13, 14, 22, 23, 26, 15, 33, 30, 16, 32	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	5, 17, 29, 21, 25, 12, 15, 14, 26, 22, 23, 32, 16, 27, 30, 33	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	5, 17, 21, 29, 13, 12, 14, 23, 22, 15, 26, 16, 33, 32, 30, 27	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Senior	5, 17, 29, 10, 13, 25, 14, 23, 26, 22, 15, 27, 30, 16, 32, 33	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5

Graduate / PhD	5, 17, 21, 10, 25, 13, 15, 14, 26, 22, 23, 27, 16, 32, 30, 33	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act III, Scene I,” how does Shakespeare show Mercutio's death and Tybalt's? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the plot you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act III, Scene I, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Mercutio's death and Tybalt's? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the plot in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act III, Scene I develops the idea of Mercutio's death and Tybalt's. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act III, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its plot shape the reader's understanding of Mercutio's death and Tybalt's. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act III, Scene I suggests about Mercutio's death and Tybalt's. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's plot and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses plot in Act III, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of Mercutio's death and Tybalt's. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act III, Scene I within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Mercutio's death and Tybalt's responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act III, Scene I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Mercutio's death and Tybalt's follows or bends those conventions, using the plot as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act III, Scene I and its treatment of

Mercutio's death and Tybalt's. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's plot and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act III, Scene I as evidence for a larger claim about Mercutio's death and Tybalt's in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act III, Scene I as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Mercutio's death and Tybalt's. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

SAT-style questions

1. *Consort! what, dost thou make us minstrels? an thou make minstrels of us, look to hear nothing but discords: here's my fiddlestick; here's that shall make you dance. 'Zounds, consort!*

   As used in the text, what does the word "discords" most nearly mean?

   A. harsh, clashing sounds; quarrels

   B. those who start something

   C. a boaster

   D. a servant or retainer

2. *No, 'tis not so deep as a well, nor so wide as a church-door; but 'tis enough, 'twill serve: ask for me to-morrow, and you shall find me a grave man. I am peppered, I warrant, for this world. A plague o' both your houses! 'Zounds, a dog, a rat, a mouse, a cat, to scratch a man to death! a braggart, a rogue, a villain, that fights by the book of arithmetic! Why the devil came you between us? I was hurt under your arm.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act III, Scene I"?

   A. Mercutio's death and Tybalt's

   B. The divided world of Verona

   C. The tomb

   D. The undelivered letter

SAT key: 1. A (harsh, clashing sounds; quarrels); 2. A (Mercutio's death and Tybalt's)

Lesson 17: Act III, Scene II

Focus: Juliet hears the news

Objective: Students will analyze how irony develops in “Act III, Scene II” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Critical voice: “Such in fact is the simplicity, the truth, and the loveliness of Juliet's character, that we are not at first aware of its complexity, its depth, and its variety.” (Anna Jameson, art historian and critic, *Characteristics of Women: Moral, Poetical, and Historical (1832), "Juliet", "Juliet"*; public domain). Trace Juliet's shifts in III.ii ("Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical!") as evidence of "complexity." *Objective:* Analyze the complexity of Juliet's response to the news of Tybalt's death. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.3

Content note (suicidal thoughts, alcohol, sexual reference): Hearing of Tybalt's death and Romeo's banishment, Juliet says she will go to her wedding bed and let death take her maidenhead. Use the safe-messaging script; keep focus on her grief and on who could help her. The Nurse calls for 'aqua vitae' (brandy), used as a restorative after shock. Juliet's 'death, not Romeo, take my maidenhead' refers to her virginity and wedding night; she is thirteen. Gloss plainly.
Student preview: A character in despair speaks about dying. Support is available if this is hard to read.
Suggested language: “What news has crushed Juliet, and who comes to help?”
Safe messaging: Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this scene is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

Juliet impatiently waits for night and Romeo. The Nurse arrives lamenting; Juliet thinks Romeo is dead, then learns Tybalt is dead and Romeo banished. She briefly condemns Romeo, then defends him. The Nurse promises to bring Romeo to her.

Background: Epithalamium (wedding-night poem) traditions shape Juliet's speech.

Significance: Juliet's loyalty shifts decisively to Romeo.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How do you react when someone you love does something wrong? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to love and desire because.... Content note before we start: A character in despair speaks about dying. Support is available if this is hard to read. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.
Prompt: How do you react when someone you love does something wrong?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to love and desire because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Juliet chooses husband over cousin: "My husband lives, that Tybalt would have slain."

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: cockatrice — a mythical serpent that could kill with a look; runaways — wanderers, possibly the fleeing sun's horses; rearward — rear guard; something following behind; widowed — left without a husband; mangled — badly wounded or mutilated. "cockatrice": Origin: Old French cocatriz ("basilisk"); earlier Late Latin calcātrīx ("female trampler").
Words: cockatrice: a mythical serpent that could kill with a look · runaways: wanderers, possibly the fleeing sun's horses · rearward: rear guard; something following behind · widowed: left without a husband · mangled: badly wounded or mutilated

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Epithalamium (wedding-night poem) traditions shape Juliet's speech. Juliet's loyalty shifts decisively to Romeo. Dramatic irony: Juliet longs for night and Romeo just as the Nurse arrives with news of Tybalt's death. Diction / vocabulary: Juliet's oxymorons ("Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical!") echo Romeo's in the first scene. Imagery: "Come, night; come, Romeo; come, thou day in night." Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "would whip you to the west, / And bring in cloudy night immediately. / Spread thy close curtain, love-performing night, / That runaways' eyes may" (Act III, Scene II, Juliet).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Gallop apace, you fiery-footed steeds" slowly and put it in my own words: Juliet urges the fiery horses of the sun to gallop quickly to the west so night will come and bring Romeo. Next, craft. I notice the commands and the mythic image of the sun god's chariot racing across the sky. The strongest word is "Gallop": it shows urgency, as if she could whip time itself to go faster. Then, effect. What does Juliet's speech reveal about her longing? My answer: Juliet longs for her wedding night, not knowing Romeo has just killed Tybalt; the dramatic irony makes her joyful speech painful to hear.

> *Gallop apace, you fiery-footed steeds* (Act III, Scene II, Juliet)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Gallop apace, you fiery-footed steeds" slowly and put it in my own words: Juliet urges the fiery horses of the sun to gallop quickly to the west so night will come and bring Romeo. Next, craft. I notice the commands and the mythic image of the sun god's chariot racing across the sky. The strongest word is "Gallop": it shows urgency, as if she could whip time itself to go faster. Then, effect. What does Juliet's speech reveal about her longing? My answer: Juliet longs for her wedding night, not knowing Romeo has just killed Tybalt; the dramatic irony makes her joyful speech painful to hear.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Juliet joins opposites (beautiful and tyrant) because she cannot reconcile Romeo's face with his act. Expected link: love and the feud. Ask: How does this line connect to love and desire? Expected: Juliet chooses husband over cousin: "My husband lives, that Tybalt would have slain." (Oxymorons express shock at Romeo's act.)

> *Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical* (Act III, Scene II, Juliet)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Juliet joins opposites (beautiful and tyrant) because she cannot reconcile Romeo's face with his act. Expected link: love and the feud.
Ask: How does this line connect to love and desire?
Expected answer: Juliet chooses husband over cousin: "My husband lives, that Tybalt would have slain." (Oxymorons express shock at Romeo's act.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for dramatic irony, diction / vocabulary (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Juliet hears the news? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene II develops the idea of Juliet hears the news. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and diction / vocabulary shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has moved from family to husband. When the text says “Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet), it shows this directly. After calling Romeo "Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical!" she reasons "That villain cousin would have kill'd my husband," taking Romeo's side.

Task: Annotate the scene for dramatic irony, diction / vocabulary (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Juliet hears the news? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene II develops the idea of Juliet hears the news. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and diction / vocabulary shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has moved from family to husband. When the text says “Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet), it shows this directly. After calling Romeo "Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical!" she reasons "That villain cousin would have kill'd my husband," taking Romeo's side.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: How do you react when someone you love does something wrong? Compare Juliet's oxymorons here with Romeo's in Act I, Scene I. What has changed?

Anchor question: How do you react when someone you love does something wrong?

Facilitation: Compare Juliet's oxymorons here with Romeo's in Act I, Scene I. What has changed?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Juliet hears the news? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has moved from family to husband. (“Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical”, Act III, Scene II, Juliet). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Juliet hears the news? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has moved from family to husband. (“Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical”, Act III, Scene II, Juliet). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how dramatic irony shapes Juliet hears the news. Key takeaway: Juliet chooses husband over cousin: "My husband lives, that Tybalt would have slain."*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Dramatic irony:** Juliet longs for night and Romeo just as the Nurse arrives with news of Tybalt's death.
- **Diction / vocabulary:** Juliet's oxymorons ("Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical!") echo Romeo's in the first scene.
- **Imagery:** "Come, night; come, Romeo; come, thou day in night."

Themes and how they develop

- **love and desire:** Juliet chooses husband over cousin: "My husband lives, that Tybalt would have slain."

Symbols and motifs

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “would whip you to the west, / And bring in cloudy night immediately. / Spread thy close curtain, love-performing night, / That runaways’ eyes may” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet).
- **fate and the stars:** From "star-cross'd" in the Prologue to Romeo's "I defy you, stars," the lovers feel steered by fortune, while the plot shows human choices and accidents. In this scene: “shall die, / Take him and cut him out in little stars, / And he will make the face of heaven so fine / That” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Gallop apace, you fiery-footed steeds” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet) Juliet urges the sun's horses to bring night.
- “Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet) Oxymorons express shock at Romeo's act.
- “That villain cousin would have kill’d my husband” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet) Juliet's loyalty shifts to Romeo.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has moved from family to husband.
Evidence: “Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet)
Reasoning: After calling Romeo "Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical!" she reasons "That villain cousin would have kill'd my husband," taking Romeo's side.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
cockatrice (noun)	a mythical serpent that could kill with a look	*And that bare vowel "I" shall poison more Than the death-darting eye of cockatrice: I am not I, if there be such an I; Or those eyes shut, that make thee answer "I."*	"cockatrice": Origin: Old French cocatriz ("basilisk"); earlier Late Latin calcātrīx ("female trampler"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/cockatrice#Etymology)
runaways (noun)	wanderers, possibly the fleeing sun's horses	*Spread thy close curtain, love-performing night, That runaways' eyes may wink, and Romeo Leap to these arms, untalk'd of and unseen.*	
rearward (noun)	rear guard; something following behind	*But with a rearward following Tybalt's death, "Romeo is banished," to speak that word, Is father, mother, Tybalt, Romeo, Juliet, All slain, all dead.*	
widowed (adjective)	left without a husband	*Take up those cords: poor ropes, you are beguiled, Both you and I; for Romeo is exiled: He made you for a highway to my bed; But I, a maid, die maiden-widowed.*	
mangled (adjective)	badly wounded or mutilated	*Ah, poor my lord, what tongue shall smooth thy name, When I, thy three-hours wife, have mangled it?*	
beguiled (verb)	cheated; tricked	*Take up those cords: poor ropes, you are beguiled, Both you and I; for Romeo is exiled: He made you for a highway to my bed; But I, a maid, die maiden-widowed.*	
dissemblers (noun)	people who hide their true feelings; hypocrites	*There's no trust, No faith, no honesty in men; all perjured, All forsworn, all naught, all dissemblers.*	"dissemblers": Origin of "dissembler": an English formation from dissemble + -er. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/dissembler#Etymology)
forsworn (adjective)	having sworn to give something up	*There's no trust, No faith, no honesty in men; all perjured, All forsworn, all naught, all dissemblers.*	
tributary (adjective)	paid as a tribute; offered	*That villain cousin would have kill'd my husband: Back, foolish*	

		tears, back to your native spring; Your tributary drops belong to woe, Which you, mistaking, offer up to joy.	
perjured (adjective)	having sworn falsely	*There's no trust, No faith, no honesty in men; all perjured, All forsworn, all naught, all dissemblers.*	

Discussion questions

1. How do you react when someone you love does something wrong?
2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with love and desire?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does the Nurse promise Juliet? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: To find Romeo and bring him to comfort her.
2. What does Juliet wish for at the start? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Night to come quickly
3. What does the Nurse bring? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Cords (a rope ladder)
4. Whom does Juliet first think is dead? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Romeo
5. What phrase does Juliet use for Romeo? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Beautiful tyrant
6. What is worse to Juliet than Tybalt's death? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Romeo's banishment
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act III, Scene II" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Juliet impatiently waits for night and Romeo. The Nurse arrives lamenting; Juliet thinks Romeo is dead, then learns Tybalt is dead and Romeo banished. She briefly condemns Romeo, then defends him. The Nurse promises to bring Romeo to her.
8. Who is on stage in "Act III, Scene II", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.

9. Where and when does “Act III, Scene II” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “And that bare vowel “I” shall poison more Than the death-darting eye of cockatrice: I am not I, if there be such an I; Or those eyes shut, that make thee answer “I.”” What does “cockatrice” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: cockatrice: a mythical serpent that could kill with a look.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Juliet's speech use so many oxymorons? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: She cannot reconcile Romeo's beauty with his violence.
2. What does “Act III, Scene II” suggest about Juliet hears the news? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Juliet's loyalty shifts decisively to Romeo.
3. Find one example of irony in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
4. How does the diction / vocabulary in this scene shape what we understand about Juliet hears the news? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for precise or unusual word choices and their connotations.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has moved from family to husband. Useful evidence: “Gallop apace, you fiery-footed steeds” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet): Juliet urges the sun's horses to bring night. On diction / vocabulary: Juliet's oxymorons ("Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical!") echo Romeo's in the first scene. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “What devil art thou, that dost torment me thus?”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act III, Scene II”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Juliet impatiently waits for night and Romeo. The Nurse arrives lamenting; Juliet thinks Romeo is dead, then learns Tybalt is dead and Romeo banished. She briefly condemns Romeo, then defends him. The Nurse promises to bring Romeo to her.
7. How does “Act III, Scene II” build on “Act III, Scene I”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has moved from family to husband. Useful evidence: “Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet): Oxymorons express shock at Romeo's act. Theme link: Juliet chooses husband over cousin: "My husband lives, that Tybalt would have slain." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has

moved from family to husband. Useful evidence: “That villain cousin would have kill’d my husband” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet): Juliet's loyalty shifts to Romeo. Theme link: Juliet chooses husband over cousin: "My husband lives, that Tybalt would have slain." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “How do you react when someone you love does something wrong?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does imagery appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with love and desire? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has moved from family to husband. Useful evidence: “Gallop apace, you fiery-footed steeds” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet): Juliet urges the sun's horses to bring night. On imagery: "Come, night; come, Romeo; come, thou day in night." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Juliet right to defend Romeo? Evaluate her reasoning. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Weighing family loyalty against marriage.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has moved from family to husband. Useful evidence: “Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet): Oxymorons express shock at Romeo's act. Theme link: Juliet chooses husband over cousin: "My husband lives, that Tybalt would have slain." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Juliet's loyalty shifts decisively to Romeo.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has moved from family to husband. Useful evidence: “That villain cousin would have kill’d my husband” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet): Juliet's loyalty shifts to Romeo. Theme link: Juliet chooses husband over cousin: "My husband lives, that Tybalt would have slain." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has moved from family to husband. Useful evidence: “Gallop apace, you fiery-footed steeds” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet): Juliet urges the sun's horses to bring night. Theme link: Juliet chooses husband over cousin: "My husband lives, that Tybalt would have slain." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act III, Scene II”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Juliet hears the news. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has moved from family to husband. Useful evidence: “Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet): Oxymorons express shock at Romeo's act. Theme link: Juliet chooses husband over cousin: "My husband lives, that Tybalt would have slain." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act III, Scene II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has moved from family to husband. Useful evidence: “That villain cousin would have kill’d my husband” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet): Juliet's loyalty shifts to Romeo. Theme link: Juliet chooses husband over cousin: "My husband lives, that Tybalt would have slain." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to fate and choice: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has moved from family to husband. Useful evidence: “Gallop apace, you fiery-footed steeds” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet): Juliet urges the sun's horses to bring night. Theme link: Juliet chooses husband over cousin: "My husband lives, that Tybalt would have slain." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the irony in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has moved from family to husband. Useful evidence: “Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet): Oxymorons express shock at Romeo's act. Theme link: Juliet chooses husband over cousin: "My husband lives, that Tybalt would have slain." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act III, Scene II” treats Juliet hears the news with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has moved from family to husband. Useful evidence: “That villain cousin would have kill’d my husband” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet): Juliet's loyalty shifts to Romeo. Theme link: Juliet chooses husband over cousin: "My husband lives, that Tybalt would have slain." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act III, Scene III” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has moved from family to husband. Useful evidence: “Gallop apace, you fiery-footed steeds” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet): Juliet urges the sun's horses to bring night. Theme link: Juliet chooses husband over cousin: "My

husband lives, that Tybalt would have slain." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Juliet hears the news? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has moved from family to husband. Useful evidence: “Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet): Oxymorons express shock at Romeo's act. Theme link: Juliet chooses husband over cousin: "My husband lives, that Tybalt would have slain." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Diction / vocabulary**: precise or unusual word choices and their connotations
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “But with a rearward following Tybalt’s death, “Romeo is banished,” to speak that word, Is father, mother, Tybalt, Romeo, Juliet, All slain, all dead.”, what does “rearward” most nearly mean?
    A. rear guard; something following behind
    B. the Nurse's mistake for "sentence," a wise saying
    C. staying awake through the night
    D. a place of suffering before heaven

    Key: A (rear guard; something following behind)
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene II, Juliet: “That _____ cousin would have kill’d my husband”
    Key: villain
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Take up those cords: poor ropes, you are beguiled, Both you and I; for Romeo is exiled: He made you for a highway to my bed; But I, a maid, die maiden-widowed.”, what does “widowed” most nearly mean?
    A. attacking, here with admiring looks
    B. pilgrims who carried a palm leaf from the Holy Land
    C. stained, here with the blood of fellow citizens
    D. left without a husband

    Key: D (left without a husband)
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Juliet wish for at the start?
    A. The sun to stay
    B. Paris to arrive
    C. Tybalt to visit

D. Night to come quickly

Key: D (Night to come quickly)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Take up those cords: poor ropes, you are _____, Both you and I; for Romeo is exiled: He made you for a highway to my bed; But I, a maid, die maiden-widowed.” Word bank: rearward, beguiled, cockatrice, runaways

   Key: beguiled

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does the Nurse bring?

   A. A potion

   B. A letter

   C. Flowers

   D. Cords (a rope ladder)

   Key: D (Cords (a rope ladder))

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “There’s no trust, No faith, no honesty in men; all perjured, All forsworn, all naught, all _____.” Word bank: runaways, cockatrice, rearward, dissemblers

   Key: dissemblers

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What phrase does Juliet use for Romeo?

   A. Beautiful tyrant

   B. My lord

   C. Noble knight

   D. Foul Montague

   Key: A (Beautiful tyrant)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Whom does Juliet first think is dead?

   A. Mercutio

   B. Tybalt

   C. Her father

   D. Romeo

   Key: D (Romeo)

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does Juliet's speech use so many oxymorons?

    Sample answer: She cannot reconcile Romeo's beauty with his violence.

11. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Gallop apace, you fiery-footed steeds” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Juliet urges the sun's horses to bring night.

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet)

    A. The lovers are thwarted by the stars; "take their life" means both "are born" and "kill themselves."

    B. The apothecary's excuse.

    C. Oxymorons express shock at Romeo's act.

    D. Citizens stain their hands with the blood of fellow citizens.

    Key: C (Oxymorons express shock at Romeo's act.)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Gallop apace, you fiery-footed steeds” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet)

    A. Romeo sets the wedding plan.

    B. Juliet discovers Romeo is a Montague.

    C. Juliet urges the sun's horses to bring night.

    D. Juliet's premonition.

    Key: C (Juliet urges the sun's horses to bring night.)

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has moved from family to husband. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet).

    Sample answer: After calling Romeo "Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical!" she reasons "That villain cousin would have kill'd my husband," taking Romeo's side.

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “That villain cousin would have kill’d my husband” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Juliet's loyalty shifts to Romeo.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is Juliet right to defend Romeo? Evaluate her reasoning.

    Sample answer: Weighing family loyalty against marriage.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Ah, poor my lord, what tongue shall smooth thy name, When I, thy three-hours wife, have _____ it?” Word bank: runaways, mangled, cockatrice, rearward

    Key: mangled

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “And that bare vowel “I” shall poison more Than the death-darting eye of cockatrice: I am not I, if there be such an I; Or those eyes shut, that make thee answer “I.””, what does “cockatrice” most nearly mean?

    A. a boaster

    B. a mythical serpent that could kill with a look

    C. increase; make (grief) multiply

    D. people who grieve at a funeral

    Key: B (a mythical serpent that could kill with a look)

19. [short · recall · DOK 1] What does the Nurse promise Juliet?

    Sample answer: To find Romeo and bring him to comfort her.

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Spread thy close curtain, love-performing night, That runaways’ eyes may wink, and Romeo Leap to these arms, untalk’d of and unseen.”, what does “runaways” most nearly mean?

    A. commands

    B. a good-for-nothing girl

    C. going along with a crowd

    D. wanderers, possibly the fleeing sun's horses

    Key: D (wanderers, possibly the fleeing sun's horses)

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “That villain cousin would have kill’d my husband” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet)

    A. Romeo's defiance.

B. Romeo's love for Rosaline dies; a new one takes its place.

C. The Prince blames the feud.

D. Juliet's loyalty shifts to Romeo.

Key: D (Juliet's loyalty shifts to Romeo.)

22. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: Oxymorons express shock at Romeo's act.

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act III, Scene II”? Juliet's oxymorons ("Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical!") echo Romeo's in the first scene.

A. Alliteration

B. Diction / vocabulary

C. Plot

D. Tone / mood

Key: B (Diction / vocabulary)

24. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What is worse to Juliet than Tybalt's death?

A. The Nurse's tears

B. The plague

C. Her father's anger

D. Romeo's banishment

Key: D (Romeo's banishment)

25. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “There’s no trust, No faith, no honesty in men; all perjured, All _____, all naught, all dissemblers.” Word bank: forsworn, rearward, cockatrice, runaways
Key: forsworn

26. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act III, Scene II”?

A. Juliet hears the news

B. Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell

C. Friar Laurence agrees to marry them

D. Juliet's feigned obedience

Key: A (Juliet hears the news)

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act III, Scene II”? Juliet longs for night and Romeo just as the Nurse arrives with news of Tybalt's death.

A. Simile

B. Dramatic irony

C. Imagery

D. Plot

Key: B (Dramatic irony)

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: Oxymorons express shock at Romeo's act.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Gallop apace, you fiery-footed steeds” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Juliet urges the sun's horses to bring night.

30. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Juliet chooses husband over cousin: "My husband lives, that Tybalt would have slain."
    A. Fate and choice
    B. Youth and age
    C. Love and desire
    D. Violence and the feud
    Key: C (Love and desire)

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how love and desire develops from an earlier scene to “Act III, Scene II”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Juliet chooses husband over cousin: "My husband lives, that Tybalt would have slain."

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has moved from family to husband.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: After calling Romeo "Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical!" she reasons "That villain cousin would have kill'd my husband," taking Romeo's side.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	7, 17, 18, 9, 19, 2, 20, 8, 21, 22, 10, 11, 14, 15, 23, 16	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	1, 7, 24, 25, 3, 20, 22, 26, 12, 21, 11, 23, 27, 14, 28, 29	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	17, 18, 19, 5, 1, 22, 26, 13, 11, 12, 30, 15, 14, 27, 31, 32	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	1, 18, 5, 17, 21, 13, 22, 26, 10, 30, 27, 14, 23, 16, 28, 31	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	17, 5, 6, 26, 12, 11, 21, 14, 30, 15, 27, 23, 29, 31, 32, 16	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	17, 7, 20, 26, 13, 11, 22, 15, 30, 27, 14, 23, 32, 29, 28, 16	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	17, 5, 12, 22, 21, 10, 14, 15, 23, 30, 27, 29, 16, 28, 32, 31	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	5, 17, 13, 21, 12, 11, 30, 15, 27, 23, 14, 16, 32, 31, 29, 28	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Senior	25, 17, 10, 21, 26, 13, 15, 27, 23, 14, 30, 29, 16, 31, 32, 28	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	17, 5, 12, 11, 13, 22, 14, 15, 30, 27, 23, 31, 32, 16, 29, 28	

		recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act III, Scene II,” how does Shakespeare show Juliet hears the news? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In Act III, Scene II, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Juliet hears the news? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act III, Scene II develops the idea of Juliet hears the news. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and diction / vocabulary shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act III, Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of Juliet hears the news. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act III, Scene II suggests about Juliet hears the news. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and diction / vocabulary), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses irony in Act III, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of Juliet hears the news. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act III, Scene II within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Juliet hears the news responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act III, Scene II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Juliet hears the news follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act III, Scene II and its treatment of

Juliet hears the news. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's irony and diction / vocabulary, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act III, Scene II as evidence for a larger claim about Juliet hears the news in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act III, Scene II as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Juliet hears the news. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

SAT-style questions

1. *But with a rearward following Tybalt's death, "Romeo is banished," to speak that word, Is father, mother, Tybalt, Romeo, Juliet, All slain, all dead.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "rearward" most nearly mean?

   A. paid as a tribute; offered

   B. having sworn to give something up

   C. rear guard; something following behind

   D. having sworn falsely

2. *What devil art thou, that dost torment me thus? This torture should be roar'd in dismal hell. Hath Romeo slain himself? say thou but "I," And that bare vowel "I" shall poison more Than the death-darting eye of cockatrice: I am not I, if there be such an I; Or those eyes shut, that make thee answer "I." If he be slain, say "I"; or if not, no: Brief sounds determine of my weal or woe.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act III, Scene II"?

   A. Love at first sight at the Capulet feast

   B. Juliet drinks the potion

   C. Wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan

   D. Juliet hears the news

SAT key: 1. C (rear guard; something following behind); 2. D (Juliet hears the news)

Lesson 18: Act III, Scene III

Focus: Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in “Act III, Scene III” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Critical voice: “Romeo is Hamlet in love. There is the same rich exuberance of passion and sentiment in the one, that there is of thought and sentiment in the other. Both are absent and self-involved, both live out of themselves in a world of imagination.” (William Hazlitt, essayist and critic, *Characters of Shakespear's Plays (1817), "Romeo and Juliet"*, *"Romeo and Juliet"*; public domain). Cross-text lens (pairs with the Hamlet unit): is Romeo's self-absorption in the Friar's cell a flaw or a symptom of love? *Objective:* Compare Romeo's despair with other Shakespearean heroes. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.3

Content note (suicide (attempted), alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): Romeo draws a dagger to kill himself and the Friar stops him. Use the safe-messaging script; focus on the Friar's reasons for hope and on who Romeo could turn to. This section mentions drinking or a drug (“…meo? There on the ground, with his own tears made drunk. O, he is even in my mistress’ case, Ju…”). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: In this scene a character tries to take his own life and is stopped. Support is available if this is hard to read.
Suggested language: “What does the Friar say to give Romeo reasons to live?”
Safe messaging: Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this scene is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

Romeo hides in the Friar's cell, despairing at banishment. The Nurse arrives; Romeo draws a dagger to kill himself; the Friar stops him and lays out a plan: spend the night with Juliet, flee to Mantua, and wait until the marriage can be announced.

Background: Banishment meant losing home, livelihood and family; for an aristocrat, it was social death.

Significance: The Friar's plan shows his steady counsel and the dangers of haste.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What helps someone in despair? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to youth and age because.... Content note before we start: In this scene a character tries to take his own life and is stopped. Support is available if this is hard to read. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.
Prompt: What helps someone in despair?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to youth and age because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the Friar's reason against Romeo's passion.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: blubbering — weeping noisily; anatomy — the body; purgatory — a place of suffering before heaven; absolver — one who forgives sins; beseeming — fitting; proper. "purgatory": Origin: Old French purgatore; earlier Latin purgātōrium ("cleansing").
Words: blubbering: weeping noisily · anatomy: the body · purgatory: a place of suffering before heaven · absolver: one who forgives sins · beseeming: fitting; proper

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Banishment meant losing home, livelihood and family; for an aristocrat, it was social death. The Friar's plan shows his steady counsel and the dangers of haste. Characterization: Romeo despairs at banishment, threatens suicide; the Friar scolds him. Diction / vocabulary: "banished" repeated as a death sentence. Structure: The Friar's long speech lists Romeo's blessings and lays out a plan. Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "O Lord, I could have stay'd here all the night / To hear good counsel: O, what learning is! / My lord, I'll" (Act III, Scene III, Nurse).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Ha, banishment! be merciful, say "death" slowly and put it in my own words: Romeo tells the Friar that exile is worse than death and begs him not to call it mercy. Next, craft. I notice the emotional outburst and his pleading repetition of the hated word "banished." The strongest word is "banishment": it means exile from Verona, which separates him from Juliet. Then, effect. Why does Romeo think banishment is worse than death? My answer: Romeo thinks banishment is worse than death because exile means life without Juliet, so even a pardon from execution feels like torture; his despair shows how extreme and impulsive his emotions are.

> *Ha, banishment! be merciful, say "death* (Act III, Scene III, Romeo)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Ha, banishment! be merciful, say "death" slowly and put it in my own words: Romeo tells the Friar that exile is worse than death and begs him not to call it mercy. Next, craft. I notice the emotional outburst and his pleading repetition of the hated word "banished." The strongest word is "banishment": it means exile from Verona, which separates him from Juliet. Then, effect. Why does Romeo think banishment is worse than death? My answer: Romeo thinks banishment is worse than death because exile means life without Juliet, so even a pardon from execution feels like torture; his despair shows how extreme and impulsive his emotions are.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Romeo means life outside Verona is not life. Expected link: love and desire; youth and age. Ask: How does this line connect to youth and age? Expected: The Friar's reason against Romeo's passion. (For Romeo, exile is the end of the world.)

> *There is no world without Verona walls* (Act III, Scene III, Romeo)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Romeo means life outside Verona is not life. Expected link: love and desire; youth and age.
Ask: How does this line connect to youth and age?
Expected answer: The Friar's reason against Romeo's passion. (For Romeo, exile is the end of the world.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, diction / vocabulary (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene III develops the idea of Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and diction / vocabulary shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet. When the text says “There is no world without Verona walls” (Act III, Scene III, Romeo), it shows this directly. He cries "be merciful, say 'death'" and insists "There is no world without Verona walls," until the Friar demands "Art thou a man?"
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, diction / vocabulary (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene III develops the idea of Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and diction / vocabulary shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet. When the text says “There is no world without Verona walls” (Act III, Scene III, Romeo), it shows this directly. He cries "be merciful, say 'death'" and insists "There is no world without Verona walls," until the Friar demands "Art thou a man?"

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What helps someone in despair? Is the Friar's scolding fair? What would you say to Romeo?
Anchor question: What helps someone in despair?
Facilitation: Is the Friar's scolding fair? What would you say to Romeo?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet. (“There is no world without Verona walls”, Act III, Scene III, Romeo). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet. (“There is no world without Verona walls”, Act III, Scene III, Romeo). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell. Key takeaway: the Friar's reason against Romeo's passion.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Romeo despairs at banishment, threatens suicide; the Friar scolds him.
- **Diction / vocabulary:** "banished" repeated as a death sentence.
- **Structure:** The Friar's long speech lists Romeo's blessings and lays out a plan.

Themes and how they develop

- **youth and age:** the Friar's reason against Romeo's passion.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “O Lord, I could have stay’d here all the night / To hear good counsel: O, what learning is! / My lord, I’ll” (Act III, Scene III, Nurse).
- **fate and the stars:** From "star-cross'd" in the Prologue to Romeo's "I defy you, stars," the lovers feel steered by fortune, while the plot shows human choices and accidents. In this scene: “Tis torture, and not mercy: heaven is here, / Where Juliet lives; and every cat and dog / And” (Act III, Scene III, Romeo).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Ha, banishment! be merciful, say “death” (Act III, Scene III, Romeo) Romeo sees banishment as worse than death.
- “There is no world without Verona walls” (Act III, Scene III, Romeo) For Romeo, exile is the end of the world.
- “Art thou a man? thy form cries out thou art” (Act III, Scene III, Friar Laurence) The Friar shames Romeo.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet.
Evidence: “There is no world without Verona walls” (Act III, Scene III, Romeo)
Reasoning: He cries "be merciful, say 'death'" and insists "There is no world without Verona walls," until the Friar demands "Art thou a man?"

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
blubbering (verb)	weeping noisily	*Even so lies she, Blubbering and weeping, weeping and blubbering.*	
anatomy (noun)	the body	*O, tell me, friar, tell me, In what vile part of this anatomy Doth my name*	

		lodge? tell me, that I may sack The hateful mansion.	
purgatory (noun)	a place of suffering before heaven	*There is no world without Verona walls, But purgatory, torture, hell itself.*	"purgatory": Origin: Old French purgatore; earlier Latin purgātōrium ("cleansing"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/purgatory#Etymology)
absolver (noun)	one who forgives sins	*O friar, the damned use that word in hell; Howlings attend it: how hast thou the heart, Being a divine, a ghostly confessor, A sin-absolver, and my friend profess'd, To mangle me with that word "banished"?*	
beseeming (adjective)	fitting; proper	*Or ill-beseeming beast in seeming both!*	
womanish (adjective)	unmanly, in the period's prejudice; tearful	*Hold thy desperate hand: Art thou a man? thy form cries out thou art: Thy tears are womanish; thy wild acts denote The unreasonable fury of a beast: Unseemly woman in a seeming man!*	
banishment (noun)	forced exile	*A gentler judgment vanish'd from his lips, Not body's death, but body's banishment.*	
prevails (verb)	helps; avails	*Unless philosophy can make a Juliet, Displant a town, reverse a prince's doom, It helps not, it prevails not: talk no more.*	

Discussion questions

1. What helps someone in despair?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate and choice?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does the Friar say philosophy can do? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Comfort Romeo in banishment.
2. What does Romeo call banishment? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Death
3. What does Romeo try to do? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Kill himself
4. Who stops him? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The Friar
5. Where must Romeo go? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Mantua
6. What should Romeo do tonight? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Go to Juliet
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act III, Scene III" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Romeo hides in the Friar's cell, despairing at banishment. The Nurse arrives; Romeo draws a dagger to kill himself; the Friar stops him and lays out a plan: spend the night with Juliet, flee to Mantua, and wait until the marriage can be announced.
8. Who is on stage in "Act III, Scene III", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act III, Scene III" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Even so lies she, Blubbering and weeping, weeping and blubbering." What does "blubbering" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: blubbering: weeping noisily.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does the Friar list Romeo's blessings? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: To show that he has reasons to live.
2. What does "Act III, Scene III" suggest about Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The Friar's plan shows his steady counsel and the dangers of haste.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the diction / vocabulary in this scene shape what we understand about Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for precise or unusual word choices and their connotations.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet. Useful evidence: "Ha, banishment! be merciful, say "death" (Act III, Scene III, Romeo): Romeo sees banishment as worse than death. On diction / vocabulary: "banished" repeated as a death sentence. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “There is no world without Verona walls, But purgatory, torture, hell itself.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act III, Scene III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Romeo hides in the Friar's cell, despairing at banishment. The Nurse arrives; Romeo draws a dagger to kill himself; the Friar stops him and lays out a plan: spend the night with Juliet, flee to Mantua, and wait until the marriage can be announced.
7. How does “Act III, Scene III” build on “Act III, Scene II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet. Useful evidence: “There is no world without Verona walls” (Act III, Scene III, Romeo): For Romeo, exile is the end of the world. On structure: The Friar's long speech lists Romeo's blessings and lays out a plan. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet. Useful evidence: “Art thou a man? thy form cries out thou art” (Act III, Scene III, Friar Laurence): The Friar shames Romeo. On characterization: Romeo despairs at banishment, threatens suicide; the Friar scolds him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “What helps someone in despair?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does structure appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with fate and choice? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet. Useful evidence: “Ha, banishment! be merciful, say “death” (Act III, Scene III, Romeo): Romeo sees banishment as worse than death. On structure: The Friar's long speech lists Romeo's blessings and lays out a plan. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is the Friar's plan realistic? Evaluate. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Weighing its timing and risks.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet. Useful evidence: “There is no world without Verona walls” (Act III, Scene III, Romeo): For Romeo, exile is the end of the world. Theme link: the Friar's reason against Romeo's passion.

Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “The Friar's plan shows his steady counsel and the dangers of haste.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet. Useful evidence: “Art thou a man? thy form cries out thou art” (Act III, Scene III, Friar Laurence): The Friar shames Romeo. Theme link: the Friar's reason against Romeo's passion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet. Useful evidence: “Ha, banishment! be merciful, say “death” (Act III, Scene III, Romeo): Romeo sees banishment as worse than death. On characterization: Romeo despairs at banishment, threatens suicide; the Friar scolds him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act III, Scene III”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet. Useful evidence: “There is no world without Verona walls” (Act III, Scene III, Romeo): For Romeo, exile is the end of the world. On structure: The Friar's long speech lists Romeo's blessings and lays out a plan. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act III, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet. Useful evidence: “Art thou a man? thy form cries out thou art” (Act III, Scene III, Friar Laurence): The Friar shames Romeo. Theme link: the Friar's reason against Romeo's passion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to violence and the feud: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet. Useful evidence: “Ha, banishment! be merciful, say “death” (Act III, Scene III, Romeo): Romeo sees banishment as worse than death. Theme link: the Friar's reason against Romeo's passion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet. Useful evidence: “There is no world without Verona walls” (Act III, Scene III, Romeo): For Romeo, exile is the end of the world. On characterization: Romeo despairs at banishment, threatens suicide; the Friar scolds him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act III, Scene III” treats Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet. Useful evidence: “Art thou a man? thy form cries out thou art” (Act III, Scene III, Friar Laurence): The Friar shames Romeo. Theme link: the Friar's reason against Romeo's passion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act III, Scene IV” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet. Useful evidence: “Ha, banishment! be merciful, say “death” (Act III, Scene III, Romeo): Romeo sees banishment as worse than death. Theme link: the Friar's reason against Romeo's passion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet. Useful evidence: “There is no world without Verona walls” (Act III, Scene III, Romeo): For Romeo, exile is the end of the world. Theme link: the Friar's reason against Romeo's passion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Diction / vocabulary**: precise or unusual word choices and their connotations
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “O, tell me, friar, tell me, In what vile part of this anatomy Doth my name lodge? tell me, that I may sack The hateful mansion.”, what does “anatomy” most nearly mean?

   A. waves (a weapon) about in a showy way

B. the body

C. bursts out in alarm

D. badly wounded or mutilated

Key: B (the body)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Romeo call banishment?

A. Justice

B. Death

C. Mercy

D. A holiday

Key: B (Death)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "A gentler judgment vanish'd from his lips, Not body's death, but body's _____." Word bank: blubbering, banishment, anatomy, purgatory

Key: banishment

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Romeo try to do?

A. Kill the Friar

B. Kill himself

C. Leave Verona at once

D. Fight the Prince

Key: B (Kill himself)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "There is no world without Verona walls, But purgatory, torture, hell itself.", what does "purgatory" most nearly mean?

A. bringing to fullness

B. left without a husband

C. disasters; chaos

D. a place of suffering before heaven

Key: D (a place of suffering before heaven)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene III, Romeo: "There is no world _____ Verona walls"

Key: without

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene III, Romeo: "Ha, _____! be merciful, say "death"

Key: banishment

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "O friar, the damned use that word in hell; Howlings attend it: how hast thou the heart, Being a divine, a ghostly confessor, A sin-absolver, and my friend profess'd, To mangle me with that word "banished"?", what does "absolver" most nearly mean?

A. bringing to fullness

B. people who grieve at a funeral

C. one who forgives sins

D. risen up to

Key: C (one who forgives sins)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who stops him?

   A. Balthasar

   B. Juliet

   C. The Friar

   D. The Nurse

   Key: C (The Friar)

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “There is no world without Verona walls” (Act III, Scene III, Romeo) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: For Romeo, exile is the end of the world.

11. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does the Friar list Romeo's blessings?

    Sample answer: To show that he has reasons to live.

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “There is no world without Verona walls” (Act III, Scene III, Romeo)

    A. For Romeo, exile is the end of the world.

    B. The conflict is built into the cast list.

    C. The letter returned.

    D. Juliet as light in darkness.

    Key: A (For Romeo, exile is the end of the world.)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Ha, banishment! be merciful, say “death” (Act III, Scene III, Romeo)

    A. Romeo sees banishment as worse than death.

    B. The apothecary's excuse.

    C. Passion overcomes obstacles.

    D. Juliet as light in darkness.

    Key: A (Romeo sees banishment as worse than death.)

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act III, Scene III”? Romeo despairs at banishment, threatens suicide; the Friar scolds him.

    A. Characterization

    B. Allusion

    C. Metaphor

    D. Tone / mood

    Key: A (Characterization)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? The Friar's reason against Romeo's passion.

    A. Love and desire

    B. Fate and choice

    C. Violence and the feud

    D. Youth and age

    Key: D (Youth and age)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “There is no world without Verona walls” (Act III, Scene III, Romeo) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: For Romeo, exile is the end of the world.
17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where must Romeo go?
    A. Venice
    B. Padua
    C. Mantua
    D. Rome

    Key: C (Mantua)
18. [short · recall · DOK 1] What does the Friar say philosophy can do?
    Sample answer: Comfort Romeo in banishment.
19. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Or ill-_____ beast in seeming both!”
    Word bank: blubbering, beseeming, purgatory, anatomy
    Key: beseeming
20. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Art thou a man? thy form cries out thou art” (Act III, Scene III, Friar Laurence)
    A. Romeo's love for Rosaline dies; a new one takes its place.
    B. The letter returned.
    C. The Friar shames Romeo.
    D. The lovers are thwarted by the stars; "take their life" means both "are born" and "kill themselves."

    Key: C (The Friar shames Romeo.)
21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act III, Scene III”? "banished" repeated as a death sentence.
    A. Diction / vocabulary
    B. Alliteration
    C. Plot
    D. Foreshadowing

    Key: A (Diction / vocabulary)
22. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is the Friar's plan realistic? Evaluate.
    Sample answer: Weighing its timing and risks.
23. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Unless philosophy can make a Juliet, Displant a town, reverse a prince’s doom, It helps not, it _____ not: talk no more.” Word bank: blubbering, prevails, anatomy, purgatory
    Key: prevails
24. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Ha, banishment! be merciful, say “death” (Act III, Scene III, Romeo) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Romeo sees banishment as worse than death.
25. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “There is no world without Verona walls” (Act III, Scene III, Romeo).

Sample answer: He cries "be merciful, say 'death'" and insists "There is no world without Verona walls," until the Friar demands "Art thou a man?"

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Art thou a man? thy form cries out thou art” (Act III, Scene III, Friar Laurence). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: The Friar shames Romeo.
27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how youth and age develops from an earlier scene to “Act III, Scene III”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: the Friar's reason against Romeo's passion.
28. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act III, Scene III”?
    A. Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell
    B. Mercutio's death and Tybalt's
    C. Juliet's feigned obedience
    D. Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard
    Key: A (Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell)
29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: He cries "be merciful, say 'death'" and insists "There is no world without Verona walls," until the Friar demands "Art thou a man?"
30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Ha, banishment! be merciful, say “death” (Act III, Scene III, Romeo) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Romeo sees banishment as worse than death.
31. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Hold thy desperate hand: Art thou a man? thy form cries out thou art: Thy tears are _____; thy wild acts denote The unreasonable fury of a beast: Unseemly woman in a seeming man!” Word bank: womanish, anatomy, blubbering, purgatory
    Key: womanish

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	1, 7, 17, 6, 18, 5, 19, 8, 20, 10, 12, 13, 21, 15, 14, 22	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	19, 5, 9, 23, 18, 4, 20, 24, 13, 10, 12, 25, 26, 21, 27, 16	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	19, 6, 2, 18, 9, 11, 28, 12, 20, 13, 21, 14, 25, 15, 16, 29	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	7, 19, 4, 18, 28, 11, 10, 24, 20, 26, 15, 14, 21, 22, 30, 27	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	6, 7, 19, 28, 11, 20, 24, 25, 14, 21, 26, 15, 27, 22, 16, 29	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	19, 31, 17, 13, 20, 11, 12, 25, 21, 26, 14, 15, 16, 27, 29, 30	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4

College Sophomore	23, 19, 12, 24, 13, 10, 26, 15, 25, 21, 14, 16, 22, 27, 30, 29	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	19, 6, 20, 12, 11, 10, 21, 14, 15, 26, 25, 22, 27, 29, 30, 16	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Senior	19, 31, 13, 12, 20, 24, 26, 25, 15, 21, 14, 22, 16, 27, 29, 30	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	19, 31, 11, 20, 24, 13, 15, 26, 21, 25, 14, 27, 22, 29, 30, 16	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act III, Scene III,” how does Shakespeare show Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act III, Scene III, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act III, Scene III develops the idea of Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and diction / vocabulary shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act III, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act III, Scene III suggests about Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and diction / vocabulary), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act III, Scene III to complicate the reader's understanding of Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act III, Scene III within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act III, Scene III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act III, Scene III and its treatment of Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and diction / vocabulary, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act III, Scene III as evidence for a larger claim about Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act III, Scene III as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

SAT-style questions

1. *There is no world without Verona walls, But purgatory, torture, hell itself.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “purgatory” most nearly mean?

   A. helps; avails

   B. forced exile

   C. unmanly, in the period's prejudice; tearful

   D. a place of suffering before heaven

2. *There is no world without Verona walls, But purgatory, torture, hell itself. Hence-banished is banish’d from the world, And world’s exile is death: then banished, Is death mis-term’d: calling death banishment, Thou cutt’st my head off with a golden axe, And smilest upon the stroke that murders me.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act III, Scene III”?

   A. Juliet, her mother and the Nurse

   B. Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell

   C. Mercutio's death and Tybalt's

   D. The secret wedding

SAT key: 1. D (a place of suffering before heaven); 2. B (Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell)

Lesson 19: Act III, Scene IV

Focus: Capulet sets the wedding to Paris

Objective: Students will analyze how irony develops in “Act III, Scene IV” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

Late at night Capulet tells Paris that Juliet will marry him on Thursday, assuming her obedience.

Background: Fathers had legal power over daughters; Tybalt's death adds urgency.

Significance: Capulet's haste sets the tragedy's timeline.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How do adults decide for children? When is it fair? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to youth and age because....
Prompt: How do adults decide for children? When is it fair?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to youth and age because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Capulet decides for Juliet without asking her.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Two key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: heaviness — sadness; carelessly — without proper regard.
Words: heaviness: sadness · carelessly: without proper regard

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Fathers had legal power over daughters; Tybalt's death adds urgency. Capulet's haste sets the tragedy's timeline. Irony: Capulet promises Juliet to Paris the night she spends with Romeo. Characterization: Capulet now says "I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me." Plot: The wedding to Paris is set for Thursday. Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “times of woe afford no time to woo. / Madam, good night: commend me to your daughter” (Act III, Scene IV, Paris).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me" slowly and put it in my own words: Capulet tells Paris he is sure Juliet will be ruled by him in all respects. Next, craft. I notice his confident tone, as he promises his daughter without even asking her first. The strongest word is "ruled": it means controlled and obedient to her father's will. Then, effect. What does Capulet decide for Juliet? My answer: Capulet arranges Juliet's marriage to Paris without consulting her, reversing his earlier promise to wait for her consent; this rash decision drives the tragedy.

> *I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me" slowly and put it in my own words: Capulet tells Paris he is sure Juliet will be ruled by him in all respects. Next, craft. I notice his confident tone, as he promises his daughter without even asking her first. The strongest word is "ruled": it means controlled and obedient to her father's will. Then, effect. What does Capulet decide for Juliet? My answer: Capulet arranges Juliet's marriage to Paris without consulting her, reversing his earlier promise to wait for her consent; this rash decision drives the tragedy.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Desperate tender" means a bold or risky offer. Expected link: youth and age, and contrast with Act I, Scene II. Ask: How does this line connect to youth and age? Expected: Capulet decides for Juliet without asking her. (Capulet offers Juliet impulsively.)

> *Sir Paris, I will make a desperate tender / Of my child's love (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Desperate tender" means a bold or risky offer. Expected link: youth and age, and contrast with Act I, Scene II.
Ask: How does this line connect to youth and age?
Expected answer: Capulet decides for Juliet without asking her. (Capulet offers Juliet impulsively.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Capulet sets the wedding to Paris? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene IV develops the idea of Capulet sets the wedding to Paris. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent. When the text says "I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me" (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet), it shows this directly. He makes "a desperate tender / Of my child's love" and says "she will be ruled / In all respects by me," fixing a wedding day without her.
Task: Annotate the scene for irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Capulet sets the wedding to Paris? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene IV develops the idea of Capulet sets the wedding to Paris. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent. When the text says "I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me" (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet), it shows this directly. He makes "a desperate tender / Of my child's love" and says "she will be ruled / In all respects by me," fixing a wedding day without her.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: How do adults decide for children? When is it fair? Why might Capulet change his mind so quickly after Tybalt's death?
Anchor question: How do adults decide for children? When is it fair?
Facilitation: Why might Capulet change his mind so quickly after Tybalt's death?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Capulet sets the wedding to Paris? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent. ("I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me", Act III, Scene IV, Capulet). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Capulet sets the wedding to Paris? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent. ("I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me", Act III, Scene IV, Capulet). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how irony shapes Capulet sets the wedding to Paris. Key takeaway: Capulet decides for Juliet without asking her.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Irony:** Capulet promises Juliet to Paris the night she spends with Romeo.
- **Characterization:** Capulet now says "I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me."
- **Plot:** The wedding to Paris is set for Thursday.

Themes and how they develop

- **youth and age:** Capulet decides for Juliet without asking her.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “times of woe afford no time to woo. / Madam, good night: commend me to your daughter” (Act III, Scene IV, Paris).
- **haste and time:** Everything happens too fast: a four-day action, a marriage the day after meeting, a wedding moved up a day; Friar Laurence warns "they stumble that run fast." In this scene: “but for your company, / I would have been a-bed an hour ago” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet) Capulet now assumes obedience.
- “Sir Paris, I will make a desperate tender / Of my child’s love” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet) Capulet offers Juliet impulsively.
- “Well, Wednesday is too soon, / O’ Thursday let it be” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet) The marriage is fixed in haste.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent.
Evidence: “I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet)
Reasoning: He makes "a desperate tender / Of my child's love" and says "she will be ruled / In all respects by me," fixing a wedding day without her.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
heaviness (noun)	sadness	*I will, and know her mind early to-morrow; To-night she is mew'd up to her heaviness.*	
carelessly (adverb)	without proper regard	*We'll keep no great ado—a friend or two; For, hark you, Tybalt being slain so late, It may be thought we held him carelessly, Being our kinsman, if we revel much: Therefore we'll have some half a dozen friends, And there an end.*	

Discussion questions

1. How do adults decide for children? When is it fair?
2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with violence and the feud?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What day is it when the scene takes place? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Monday.
2. When is the wedding set? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Thursday
3. What does Capulet assume? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Juliet will be ruled by him
4. What is Juliet doing upstairs? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Spending the night with Romeo
5. Why does Capulet keep the wedding small? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Tybalt has just died
6. What does Capulet call his offer? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A desperate tender
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act III, Scene IV" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Late at night Capulet tells Paris that Juliet will marry him on Thursday, assuming her obedience.
8. Who is on stage in "Act III, Scene IV", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.

9. Where and when does “Act III, Scene IV” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “I will, and know her mind early to-morrow; To-night she is mew’d up to her heaviness.” What does “heaviness” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: heaviness: sadness.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Capulet change his mind about waiting? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Grief and urgency after Tybalt's death.
2. What does “Act III, Scene IV” suggest about Capulet sets the wedding to Paris? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Capulet's haste sets the tragedy's timeline.
3. Find one example of irony in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about Capulet sets the wedding to Paris? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent. Useful evidence: “I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet): Capulet now assumes obedience. On characterization: Capulet now says "I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Monday!”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act III, Scene IV”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Late at night Capulet tells Paris that Juliet will marry him on Thursday, assuming her obedience.
7. How does “Act III, Scene IV” build on “Act III, Scene III”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent. Useful evidence: “Sir Paris, I will make a desperate tender / Of my child’s love” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet): Capulet offers Juliet impulsively. Theme link: Capulet decides for Juliet without asking her. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent. Useful evidence: “Well, Wednesday is too soon, / O’ Thursday let it be” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet): The marriage is fixed in haste. On characterization: Capulet now says "I think she will be ruled /

In all respects by me." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “How do adults decide for children? When is it fair?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does plot appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with violence and the feud? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for key events and the causes linking them.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent. Useful evidence: “I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet): Capulet now assumes obedience. On plot: The wedding to Paris is set for Thursday. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. How does the audience's knowledge shape this scene? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Dramatic irony: Juliet is already married.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent. Useful evidence: “Sir Paris, I will make a desperate tender / Of my child’s love” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet): Capulet offers Juliet impulsively. Theme link: Capulet decides for Juliet without asking her. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Capulet's haste sets the tragedy's timeline.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent. Useful evidence: “Well, Wednesday is too soon, / O’ Thursday let it be” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet): The marriage is fixed in haste. Theme link: Capulet decides for Juliet without asking her. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent. Useful evidence: “I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet): Capulet now assumes obedience. On characterization: Capulet now says "I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act III, Scene IV”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Capulet sets the wedding to Paris. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent. Useful evidence: “Sir Paris, I will make a desperate tender / Of my child’s love” (Act III, Scene IV,

Capulet): Capulet offers Juliet impulsively. Theme link: Capulet decides for Juliet without asking her. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act III, Scene IV”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent. Useful evidence: “Well, Wednesday is too soon, / O’ Thursday let it be” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet): The marriage is fixed in haste. Theme link: Capulet decides for Juliet without asking her. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to youth and age: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent. Useful evidence: “I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet): Capulet now assumes obedience. Theme link: Capulet decides for Juliet without asking her. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the irony in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent. Useful evidence: “Sir Paris, I will make a desperate tender / Of my child’s love” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet): Capulet offers Juliet impulsively. On irony: Capulet promises Juliet to Paris the night she spends with Romeo. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act III, Scene IV” treats Capulet sets the wedding to Paris with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent. Useful evidence: “Well, Wednesday is too soon, / O’ Thursday let it be” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet): The marriage is fixed in haste. Theme link: Capulet decides for Juliet without asking her. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act III, Scene V” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent. Useful evidence: “I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet): Capulet now assumes obedience. Theme link: Capulet decides for Juliet without asking her. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Capulet sets the wedding to Paris? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent. Useful evidence: “Sir Paris, I will make a desperate tender / Of my child’s love” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet): Capulet offers Juliet impulsively. Theme link: Capulet decides for Juliet without asking her. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Plot**: key events and the causes linking them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Capulet call his offer?
    A. A bargain
    B. A gift
    C. A desperate tender
    D. A prayer

    Key: C (A desperate tender)
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I will, and know her mind early to-morrow; To-night she is mew’d up to her _____.” Word bank: carelessly, heaviness
    Key: heaviness
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “I will, and know her mind early to-morrow; To-night she is mew’d up to her heaviness.”, what does “heaviness” most nearly mean?
    A. sadness
    B. a wooden plate
    C. reach; the limit of one's ability
    D. increase; make (grief) multiply

    Key: A (sadness)
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What is Juliet doing upstairs?
    A. Sleeping
    B. Spending the night with Romeo
    C. Praying
    D. Writing

    Key: B (Spending the night with Romeo)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “We’ll keep no great ado—a friend or two; For, hark you, Tybalt being slain so late, It may be thought we held him carelessly, Being our kinsman, if we revel much: Therefore we’ll have some half a dozen friends, And…”, what does “carelessly” most nearly mean?

   A. wandering about idly

   B. a wedding

   C. without proper regard

   D. pierces; shivers

   Key: C (without proper regard)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene IV, Capulet: “I think she will be ruled / In all _____ by me”

   Key: respects

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “We’ll keep no great ado—a friend or two; For, hark you, Tybalt being slain so late, It may be thought we held him _____, Being our kinsman, if we revel much: Therefore we’ll have some half a dozen friends, And there an end.” Word bank: carelessly, heaviness

   Key: carelessly

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Capulet assume?

   A. Juliet will refuse

   B. Juliet loves Romeo

   C. Paris will withdraw

   D. Juliet will be ruled by him

   Key: D (Juliet will be ruled by him)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene IV, Capulet: “Well, _____ is too soon, / O’ Thursday let it be”

   Key: Wednesday

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does Capulet change his mind about waiting?

    Sample answer: Grief and urgency after Tybalt's death.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Sir Paris, I will make a desperate tender / Of my child’s love” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet)

    A. Capulet offers Juliet impulsively.

    B. Juliet urges the sun's horses to bring night.

    C. The Friar's image of Juliet.

    D. Mercutio stands between the Prince's family and the Montagues.

    Key: A (Capulet offers Juliet impulsively.)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet)

    A. Romeo sets the wedding plan.

    B. Capulet now assumes obedience.

    C. Lady Capulet's book metaphor for a husband.

    D. Capulet says Juliet's consent matters; compare Act III, Scene V.

Key: B (Capulet now assumes obedience.)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Well, Wednesday is too soon, / O’ Thursday let it be” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet)

    A. The marriage is fixed in haste.

    B. Both are bewitched by appearance.

    C. Juliet's love exceeds counting.

    D. Romeo's last words.

    Key: A (The marriage is fixed in haste.)

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet).

    Sample answer: He makes "a desperate tender / Of my child's love" and says "she will be ruled / In all respects by me," fixing a wedding day without her.

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act III, Scene IV”? Capulet now says "I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me."

    A. Allusion

    B. Personification

    C. Diction / vocabulary

    D. Characterization

    Key: D (Characterization)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: He makes "a desperate tender / Of my child's love" and says "she will be ruled / In all respects by me," fixing a wedding day without her.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] When is the wedding set?

    A. Thursday

    B. Wednesday

    C. Friday

    D. Next week

    Key: A (Thursday)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why does Capulet keep the wedding small?

    A. They are poor

    B. Tybalt has just died

    C. Juliet asked

    D. Paris is shy

    Key: B (Tybalt has just died)

19. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act III, Scene IV”?

    A. The street brawl and lovesick Romeo

    B. Capulet sets the wedding to Paris

    C. The undelivered letter

D. The tomb

Key: B (Capulet sets the wedding to Paris)

20. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Sir Paris, I will make a desperate tender / Of my child’s love” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Capulet offers Juliet impulsively.
21. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Well, Wednesday is too soon, / O’ Thursday let it be” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: The marriage is fixed in haste.
22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Capulet decides for Juliet without asking her.
    A. Violence and the feud
    B. Youth and age
    C. Love and desire
    D. Fate and choice

    Key: B (Youth and age)
23. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how youth and age develops from an earlier scene to “Act III, Scene IV”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Capulet decides for Juliet without asking her.
24. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Capulet now assumes obedience.
25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act III, Scene IV”? Capulet promises Juliet to Paris the night she spends with Romeo.
    A. Foreshadowing
    B. Conflict
    C. Theme
    D. Irony

    Key: D (Irony)
26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] How does the audience's knowledge shape this scene?
    Sample answer: Dramatic irony: Juliet is already married.
27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Sir Paris, I will make a desperate tender / Of my child’s love” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Capulet offers Juliet impulsively.
28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Capulet now assumes obedience.
29. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene IV, Capulet: “Sir Paris, I will make a _____ tender / Of my child’s love”
    Key: desperate

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	5, 9, 2, 4, 17, 6, 18, 8, 19, 20, 12, 13, 21, 22, 15, 23	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	2, 7, 8, 9, 4, 3, 11, 12, 24, 13, 10, 25, 14, 15, 16, 26	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	8, 18, 1, 7, 6, 20, 13, 10, 11, 12, 21, 25, 14, 15, 27, 23	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	4, 9, 6, 2, 13, 12, 19, 11, 24, 21, 15, 22, 25, 23, 28, 27	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	2, 29, 17, 10, 11, 20, 12, 25, 21, 14, 22, 15, 23, 26, 27, 28	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	1, 7, 6, 12, 13, 19, 11, 25, 15, 21, 22, 14, 26, 28, 27, 16	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	2, 29, 20, 13, 19, 11, 21, 25, 22, 15, 14, 28, 26, 27, 16, 23	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	29, 2, 24, 13, 11, 19, 15, 14, 25, 21, 22, 28, 26, 27, 16, 23	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Senior	29, 2, 10, 11, 19, 24, 22, 14, 25, 15, 21, 16, 26, 28, 23, 27	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	2, 7, 13, 12, 20, 11, 22, 21, 14, 25, 15, 27, 26, 16, 28, 23	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act III, Scene IV,” how does Shakespeare show Capulet sets the wedding to Paris? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In Act III, Scene IV, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Capulet sets the wedding to Paris? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act III, Scene IV develops the idea of Capulet sets the wedding to Paris. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act III, Scene IV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of Capulet sets the wedding to Paris. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act III, Scene IV suggests about Capulet sets the wedding to Paris. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses irony in Act III, Scene IV to complicate the reader's understanding of Capulet sets the wedding to Paris. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act III, Scene IV within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Capulet sets the wedding to Paris responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act III, Scene IV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Capulet sets the wedding to Paris follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act III, Scene IV and its treatment of Capulet sets the wedding to Paris. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's irony and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act III, Scene IV as evidence for a larger claim about Capulet sets the wedding to Paris in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act III, Scene IV as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Capulet sets the wedding to Paris. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

SAT-style questions

1. *Monday! ha, ha! Well, Wednesday is too soon, O' Thursday let it be: o' Thursday, tell her, She shall be married to this noble earl. Will you be ready? do you like this haste? We'll keep no great ado—a friend or two; For, hark you, Tybalt being slain so late, It may be thought we held him carelessly, Being our kinsman, if we revel much: Therefore we'll have some half a dozen friends, And there an end. But what say you to Thursday?*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act III, Scene IV"?

   A. The household mourns

   B. The Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold

   C. Juliet hears the news

D. Capulet sets the wedding to Paris

SAT key: 1. D (Capulet sets the wedding to Paris)

Lesson 20: Act III, Scene V

Focus: parting at dawn and Capulet's rage

Objective: Students will analyze how imagery develops in "Act III, Scene V" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (parental abuse (verbal), suicidal thoughts, age of a minor, early marriage, sexual relationship (implied)): Capulet threatens to throw Juliet into the streets and calls her names; at the end Juliet says that if all else fails she has the power to die. Use the safe-messaging script; keep discussion on power, choice and where she could turn. This is the morning after the wedding night: the marriage has been consummated, and Juliet is not yet fourteen. Name her age plainly, set it against Elizabethan norms (most English brides were in their twenties), and discuss the pressure on her to marry Paris as coercion.
Student preview: A father threatens his daughter, and she speaks of dying. Support is available if this is hard to read. A thirteen-year-old is pressured to marry after a secret marriage.
Suggested language: "What options does Juliet have, and who could help her?"
Safe messaging: Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this scene is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

At dawn the lovers argue whether it is the nightingale or the lark. Romeo leaves. Lady Capulet tells Juliet of the wedding; Juliet refuses. Capulet threatens to throw her out. The Nurse advises marrying Paris; Juliet decides to seek the Friar's help, or die.

Background: Fathers could disinherit daughters; marriage was an economic contract.

Significance: Juliet becomes isolated.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What does it feel like to be left without support? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to youth and age because.... Content note before we start: A father threatens his daughter, and she speaks of dying. Support is available if this is hard to read. A thirteen-year-old is pressured to marry after a secret marriage. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.
Prompt: What does it feel like to be left without support?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to youth and age because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Juliet is abandoned by father, mother and Nurse.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: hilding — a worthless creature; severing — parting; exhales — draws out (as vapour); dispraise — find fault with; procures — brings. "severing": Origin of "sever": Old French sevrer; earlier Latin separāre ("to separate"). "exhales": Origin of "exhale": Middle French exhaler; earlier Latin exhalare.
Words: hilding: a worthless creature · severing: parting · exhales: draws out (as vapour) · dispraise: find fault with · procures: brings

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Fathers could disinherit daughters; marriage was an economic contract. Juliet becomes isolated. Imagery: The lark and the nightingale: the lovers argue about whether it is day. Foreshadowing: Juliet sees Romeo "As one dead in the bottom of a tomb." Characterization: Capulet's rage at Juliet's refusal; the Nurse advises her to marry Paris. Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "Wilt thou be gone? it is not yet near day: / It was the nightingale, and not the lark, / That pierced the" (Act III, Scene V, Juliet).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "It was the nightingale, and not the lark" slowly and put it in my own words: At dawn, Juliet insists the bird they heard was the nightingale, not the lark, so Romeo can stay. Next, craft. I notice the contrast of bird images, the night-singing nightingale against the morning lark. The strongest word is "nightingale": it sings at night, so it would mean day has not yet come. Then, effect. Why does Juliet insist it was the nightingale? My answer: Juliet insists it was the nightingale because the night bird would mean dawn has not come, so Romeo could stay; dawn means Romeo must flee or die, and daylight brings danger to their love.

> *It was the nightingale, and not the lark* (Act III, Scene V, Juliet)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "It was the nightingale, and not the lark" slowly and put it in my own words: At dawn, Juliet insists the bird they heard was the nightingale, not the lark, so Romeo can stay. Next, craft. I notice the contrast of bird images, the night-singing nightingale against the morning lark. The strongest word is "nightingale": it sings at night, so it would mean day has not yet come. Then, effect. Why does Juliet insist it was the nightingale? My answer: Juliet insists it was the nightingale because the night bird would mean dawn has not come, so Romeo could stay; dawn means Romeo must flee or die, and daylight brings danger to their love.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Juliet's vision of Romeo in a tomb foreshadows the ending. Expected link: death as bridegroom; fate. Ask: How does this line connect to youth and age? Expected: Juliet is abandoned by father, mother and Nurse. (Juliet's premonition.)

> *Methinks I see thee, now thou art below, / As one dead in the bottom of a tomb* (Act III, Scene V, Juliet)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Juliet's vision of Romeo in a tomb foreshadows the ending. Expected link: death as bridegroom; fate.
Ask: How does this line connect to youth and age?
Expected answer: Juliet is abandoned by father, mother and Nurse. (Juliet's premonition.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for imagery, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about parting at dawn and Capulet's rage? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene V develops the idea of parting at dawn and Capulet's rage. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The scene isolates Juliet completely. When the text says “Hang thee, young baggage! disobedient wretch” (Act III, Scene V, Capulet), it shows this directly. After she sees Romeo "As one dead in the bottom of a tomb," her father calls her "young baggage! disobedient wretch," her mother refuses to help and the Nurse tells her to marry Paris.
Task: Annotate the scene for imagery, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about parting at dawn and Capulet's rage? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene V develops the idea of parting at dawn and Capulet's rage. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The scene isolates Juliet completely. When the text says “Hang thee, young baggage! disobedient wretch” (Act III, Scene V, Capulet), it shows this directly. After she sees Romeo "As one dead in the bottom of a tomb," her father calls her "young baggage! disobedient wretch," her mother refuses to help and the Nurse tells her to marry Paris.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What does it feel like to be left without support? Ask: which betrayal hurts Juliet most: her father's, her mother's or the Nurse's?
Anchor question: What does it feel like to be left without support?
Facilitation: Ask: which betrayal hurts Juliet most: her father's, her mother's or the Nurse's?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about parting at dawn and Capulet's rage? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The scene isolates Juliet completely. (“Hang thee, young baggage! disobedient wretch”, Act III, Scene V, Capulet). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about parting at dawn and Capulet's rage? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The scene isolates Juliet completely. (“Hang thee, young baggage! disobedient wretch”, Act III, Scene V, Capulet). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how imagery shapes parting at dawn and Capulet's rage. Key takeaway: Juliet is abandoned by father, mother and Nurse.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Imagery:** The lark and the nightingale: the lovers argue about whether it is day.
- **Foreshadowing:** Juliet sees Romeo "As one dead in the bottom of a tomb."
- **Characterization:** Capulet's rage at Juliet's refusal; the Nurse advises her to marry Paris.

Themes and how they develop

- **youth and age:** Juliet is abandoned by father, mother and Nurse.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “Wilt thou be gone? it is not yet near day: / It was the nightingale, and not the lark, / That pierced the” (Act III, Scene V, Juliet).
- **fate and the stars:** From "star-cross'd" in the Prologue to Romeo's "I defy you, stars," the lovers feel steered by fortune, while the plot shows human choices and accidents. In this scene: “is not the lark, whose notes do beat / The vaulty heaven so high above our heads: / I have more care to stay” (Act III, Scene V, Romeo).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “It was the nightingale, and not the lark” (Act III, Scene V, Juliet) Juliet tries to deny the morning.
- “Methinks I see thee, now thou art below, / As one dead in the bottom of a tomb” (Act III, Scene V, Juliet) Juliet's premonition.
- “Hang thee, young baggage! disobedient wretch” (Act III, Scene V, Capulet) Capulet's fury.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

> **Claim:** The scene isolates Juliet completely.
> **Evidence:** “Hang thee, young baggage! disobedient wretch” (Act III, Scene V, Capulet)
> **Reasoning:** After she sees Romeo "As one dead in the bottom of a tomb," her father calls her "young baggage! disobedient wretch," her mother refuses to help and the Nurse tells her to marry Paris.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word		In context	Word history

	Definition (in this sentence)		
hilding (noun)	a worthless creature	*Wife, we scarce thought us blest That God had lent us but this only child; But now I see this one is one too much, And that we have a curse in having her: Out on her, hilding!*	
severing (adjective)	parting	*It was the lark, the herald of the morn, No nightingale: look, love, what envious streaks Do lace the severing clouds in yonder east: Night's candles are burnt out, and jocund day Stands tiptoe on the misty mountain tops.*	"severing": Origin of "sever": Old French sevrer; earlier Latin separāre ("to separate"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/sever#Etymology)
exhales (verb)	draws out (as vapour)	*Yon light is not day-light, I know it, I: It is some meteor that the sun exhales, To be to thee this night a torch-bearer, And light thee on thy way to Mantua: Therefore stay yet; thou need'st not to be gone.*	"exhales": Origin of "exhale": Middle French exhaler; earlier Latin exhalare. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/exhale#Etymology)
dispraise (verb)	find fault with	*Is it more sin to wish me thus forsworn, Or to dispraise my lord with that same tongue Which she hath praised him with above compare So many thousand times?*	
procures (verb)	brings	*What unaccustom'd cause procures her hither?*	
conduit (noun)	a fountain; a pipe of water	*How now! a conduit, girl? what, still in tears?*	
pomegranate (noun)	a fruit tree with many seeds	*Wilt thou be gone? it is not yet near day: It was the nightingale, and not the lark, That pierced the fearful hollow of thine ear; Nightly she sings on yon pomegranate-tree: Believe me, love, it was the nightingale.*	
bridegroom (noun)	a man who is about to be married	*Is she not proud? doth she not count her blest, Unworthy as she is, that we have wrought So worthy a gentleman to be her bridegroom?*	

Discussion questions

1. What does it feel like to be left without support?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with youth and age?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Lady Capulet plan for Romeo? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: To send someone to Mantua to poison him.
2. Which bird does Juliet claim is singing? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The nightingale
3. What vision does Juliet have of Romeo? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Dead in a tomb
4. What does Capulet threaten? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: To throw her out
5. What does the Nurse advise? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Marry Paris
6. Where does Juliet decide to go? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Friar Laurence
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act III, Scene V" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: At dawn the lovers argue whether it is the nightingale or the lark. Romeo leaves. Lady Capulet tells Juliet of the wedding; Juliet refuses. Capulet threatens to throw her out. The Nurse advises marrying Paris; Juliet decides to seek the Friar's help, or die.
8. Who is on stage in "Act III, Scene V", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act III, Scene V" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Wife, we scarce thought us blest That God had lent us but this only child; But now I see this one is one too much, And that we have a curse in having her: Out on her, hilding!" What does "hilding" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: hilding: a worthless creature.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does the Nurse's advice feel like betrayal? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: She urges bigamy and ignores Juliet's love.
2. What does "Act III, Scene V" suggest about parting at dawn and Capulet's rage? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Juliet becomes isolated.

3. Find one example of imagery in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
4. How does the foreshadowing in this scene shape what we understand about parting at dawn and Capulet's rage? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene isolates Juliet completely. Useful evidence: “It was the nightingale, and not the lark” (Act III, Scene V, Juliet): Juliet tries to deny the morning. On foreshadowing: Juliet sees Romeo "As one dead in the bottom of a tomb." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “It was the lark, the herald of the morn, No nightingale: look, love, what envious streaks Do lace the severing clouds in yonder east: Night’s candles are burnt out, and jocund day…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act III, Scene V”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: At dawn the lovers argue whether it is the nightingale or the lark. Romeo leaves. Lady Capulet tells Juliet of the wedding; Juliet refuses. Capulet threatens to throw her out. The Nurse advises marrying Paris; Juliet decides to seek the Friar's help, or die.
7. How does “Act III, Scene V” build on “Act III, Scene IV”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene isolates Juliet completely. Useful evidence: “Methinks I see thee, now thou art below, / As one dead in the bottom of a tomb” (Act III, Scene V, Juliet): Juliet's premonition. Theme link: Juliet is abandoned by father, mother and Nurse. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene isolates Juliet completely. Useful evidence: “Hang thee, young baggage! disobedient wretch” (Act III, Scene V, Capulet): Capulet's fury. On characterization: Capulet's rage at Juliet's refusal; the Nurse advises her to marry Paris. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “What does it feel like to be left without support?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with youth and age? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene isolates Juliet completely. Useful evidence: “It was the nightingale, and not the lark” (Act III, Scene V, Juliet): Juliet tries to deny the morning. On characterization: Capulet's rage at Juliet's refusal; the Nurse advises her to marry Paris. Credit any position

that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Which parent is most to blame here? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Comparison of Capulet and Lady Capulet.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene isolates Juliet completely. Useful evidence: “Methinks I see thee, now thou art below, / As one dead in the bottom of a tomb” (Act III, Scene V, Juliet): Juliet's premonition. Theme link: Juliet is abandoned by father, mother and Nurse. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Juliet becomes isolated.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene isolates Juliet completely. Useful evidence: “Hang thee, young baggage! disobedient wretch” (Act III, Scene V, Capulet): Capulet's fury. Theme link: Juliet is abandoned by father, mother and Nurse. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene isolates Juliet completely. Useful evidence: “It was the nightingale, and not the lark” (Act III, Scene V, Juliet): Juliet tries to deny the morning. On characterization: Capulet's rage at Juliet's refusal; the Nurse advises her to marry Paris. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act III, Scene V”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of parting at dawn and Capulet's rage. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene isolates Juliet completely. Useful evidence: “Methinks I see thee, now thou art below, / As one dead in the bottom of a tomb” (Act III, Scene V, Juliet): Juliet's premonition. Theme link: Juliet is abandoned by father, mother and Nurse. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act III, Scene V”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene isolates Juliet completely. Useful evidence: “Hang thee, young baggage! disobedient wretch” (Act III, Scene V, Capulet): Capulet's fury. Theme link: Juliet is abandoned by father, mother and Nurse. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to time and haste: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene isolates Juliet completely. Useful evidence: “It

was the nightingale, and not the lark" (Act III, Scene V, Juliet): Juliet tries to deny the morning. Theme link: Juliet is abandoned by father, mother and Nurse. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the imagery in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene isolates Juliet completely. Useful evidence: "Methinks I see thee, now thou art below, / As one dead in the bottom of a tomb" (Act III, Scene V, Juliet): Juliet's premonition. On imagery: The lark and the nightingale: the lovers argue about whether it is day. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how "Act III, Scene V" treats parting at dawn and Capulet's rage with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene isolates Juliet completely. Useful evidence: "Hang thee, young baggage! disobedient wretch" (Act III, Scene V, Capulet): Capulet's fury. Theme link: Juliet is abandoned by father, mother and Nurse. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what "Act IV, Scene I" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene isolates Juliet completely. Useful evidence: "It was the nightingale, and not the lark" (Act III, Scene V, Juliet): Juliet tries to deny the morning. On foreshadowing: Juliet sees Romeo "As one dead in the bottom of a tomb." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about parting at dawn and Capulet's rage? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene isolates Juliet completely. Useful evidence: "Methinks I see thee, now thou art below, / As one dead in the bottom of a tomb" (Act III, Scene V, Juliet): Juliet's premonition. Theme link: Juliet is abandoned by father, mother and Nurse. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does the Nurse advise?

   A. Tell the truth

B. Marry Paris

C. Pray

D. Run away

Key: B (Marry Paris)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where does Juliet decide to go?

A. The Prince

B. Her mother

C. Mantua

D. Friar Laurence

Key: D (Friar Laurence)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Is it more sin to wish me thus forsworn, Or to dispraise my lord with that same tongue Which she hath praised him with above compare So many thousand times?", what does "dispraise" most nearly mean?

A. find fault with

B. join into one body

C. speaking affectedly

D. going along with a crowd

Key: A (find fault with)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "How now! a _____, girl? what, still in tears?" Word bank: hilding, exhales, severing, conduit

Key: conduit

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Wilt thou be gone? it is not yet near day: It was the nightingale, and not the lark, That pierced the fearful hollow of thine ear; Nightly she sings on yon _____-tree: Believe me, love, it was the nightingale." Word bank: pomegranate, hilding, severing, exhales

Key: pomegranate

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Yon light is not day-light, I know it, I: It is some meteor that the sun exhales, To be to thee this night a torch-bearer, And light thee on thy way to Mantua: Therefore stay yet; thou need'st not to be gone.", what does "exhales" most nearly mean?

A. left without a husband

B. waves (a weapon) about in a showy way

C. draws out (as vapour)

D. pleading on another's behalf

Key: C (draws out (as vapour))

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene V, Juliet: "It was the _____, and not the lark"

Key: nightingale

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Capulet threaten?

A. To banish Paris

B. To leave Verona

C. To throw her out

D. To forgive her

Key: C (To throw her out)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What vision does Juliet have of Romeo?

   A. Old

   B. Fighting

   C. Dead in a tomb

   D. Crowned

   Key: C (Dead in a tomb)

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does the Nurse's advice feel like betrayal?

    Sample answer: She urges bigamy and ignores Juliet's love.

11. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “It was the nightingale, and not the lark” (Act III, Scene V, Juliet) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Juliet tries to deny the morning.

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act III, Scene V”?

    A. The undelivered letter

    B. Parting at dawn and Capulet's rage

    C. The household mourns

    D. Love at first sight at the Capulet feast

    Key: B (Parting at dawn and Capulet's rage)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Methinks I see thee, now thou art below, / As one dead in the bottom of a tomb” (Act III, Scene V, Juliet)

    A. Juliet's premonition.

    B. Both are bewitched by appearance.

    C. Mercutio's dying curse on the feud.

    D. Love wants instant messages.

    Key: A (Juliet's premonition.)

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act III, Scene V”? Juliet sees Romeo "As one dead in the bottom of a tomb."

    A. Symbolism

    B. Tone / mood

    C. Characterization

    D. Foreshadowing

    Key: D (Foreshadowing)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The scene isolates Juliet completely. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Hang thee, young baggage! disobedient wretch” (Act III, Scene V, Capulet).

    Sample answer: After she sees Romeo "As one dead in the bottom of a tomb," her father calls her "young baggage! disobedient wretch," her mother refuses to help and the Nurse tells her to marry Paris.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Methinks I see thee, now thou art below, / As one dead in the bottom of a tomb” (Act III, Scene V, Juliet) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Juliet's premonition.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “What unaccustom’d cause _____ her hither?” Word bank: procures, severing, exhales, hilding

    Key: procures

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene V, Juliet: “_____ I see thee, now thou art below, / As one dead in the bottom of a tomb”

    Key: Methinks

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which bird does Juliet claim is singing?

    A. The crow

    B. The owl

    C. The nightingale

    D. The lark

    Key: C (The nightingale)

20. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Methinks I see thee, now thou art below, / As one dead in the bottom of a tomb” (Act III, Scene V, Juliet) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Juliet's premonition.

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Hang thee, young baggage! disobedient wretch” (Act III, Scene V, Capulet)

    A. Capulet's fury.

    B. Capulet asks Paris to wait.

    C. Juliet as light in darkness.

    D. Lady Capulet's book metaphor for a husband.

    Key: A (Capulet's fury.)

22. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “It was the nightingale, and not the lark” (Act III, Scene V, Juliet)

    A. Juliet's warning about haste.

    B. The quarantine.

    C. Juliet tries to deny the morning.

    D. Mercutio's joke: love is blind, so it suits the night.

    Key: C (Juliet tries to deny the morning.)

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Hang thee, young baggage! disobedient wretch” (Act III, Scene V, Capulet). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Capulet's fury.

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how youth and age develops from an earlier scene to “Act III, Scene V”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Juliet is abandoned by father, mother and Nurse.

25. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene V, Capulet: “Hang thee, young baggage! _____ wretch”

    Key: disobedient

26. [short · recall · DOK 1] What does Lady Capulet plan for Romeo?

    Sample answer: To send someone to Mantua to poison him.

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in "Act III, Scene V"? The lark and the nightingale: the lovers argue about whether it is day.

    A. Personification

    B. Hyperbole

    C. Imagery

    D. Theme

    Key: C (Imagery)

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Juliet is abandoned by father, mother and Nurse.

    A. Youth and age

    B. Violence and the feud

    C. Love and desire

    D. Fate and choice

    Key: A (Youth and age)

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: "The scene isolates Juliet completely." Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: After she sees Romeo "As one dead in the bottom of a tomb," her father calls her "young baggage! disobedient wretch," her mother refuses to help and the Nurse tells her to marry Paris.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Which parent is most to blame here? Argue.

    Sample answer: Comparison of Capulet and Lady Capulet.

31. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "It was the lark, the herald of the morn, No nightingale: look, love, what envious streaks Do lace the severing clouds in yonder east: Night's candles are burnt out, and jocund day Stands tiptoe on the misty mountain…", what does "severing" most nearly mean?

    A. small round shields

    B. marzipan, a sweet almond paste

    C. steering; control over a course

    D. parting

    Key: D (parting)

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "It was the nightingale, and not the lark" (Act III, Scene V, Juliet) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Juliet tries to deny the morning.

33. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Is she not proud? doth she not count her blest, Unworthy as she is, that we have wrought So worthy a gentleman to be her _____?" Word bank: bridegroom, exhales, hilding, severing

    Key: bridegroom

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 18, 2, 19, 4, 8, 1, 6, 20, 21, 10, 22, 15, 14, 23, 24	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 25, 5, 26, 7, 22, 21, 11, 12, 13, 14, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2

HS Junior	31, 7, 17, 4, 3, 11, 22, 13, 12, 10, 14, 15, 28, 27, 29, 32	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	31, 3, 33, 18, 22, 12, 11, 13, 21, 14, 15, 23, 27, 29, 24, 16	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	7, 5, 3, 10, 20, 13, 22, 15, 28, 27, 14, 23, 24, 32, 30, 29	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	17, 18, 8, 13, 10, 20, 11, 23, 28, 27, 14, 15, 29, 24, 30, 16	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	17, 7, 12, 10, 13, 11, 27, 15, 28, 14, 23, 29, 30, 16, 32, 24	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	7, 17, 10, 12, 20, 11, 15, 23, 28, 14, 27, 29, 30, 24, 32, 16	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Senior	4, 17, 12, 20, 13, 11, 23, 14, 15, 27, 28, 24, 29, 16, 32, 30	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	17, 4, 13, 10, 20, 11, 28, 15, 14, 27, 23, 24, 29, 30, 16, 32	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act III, Scene V,” how does Shakespeare show parting at dawn and Capulet's rage? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Act III, Scene V, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of parting at dawn and Capulet's rage? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act III, Scene V develops the idea of parting at dawn and Capulet's rage. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act III, Scene V (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of parting at dawn and Capulet's rage. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act III, Scene V suggests about parting at dawn and Capulet's rage. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and foreshadowing), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses imagery in Act III, Scene V to complicate the reader's understanding of parting at dawn and Capulet's rage. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act III, Scene V within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of parting at dawn and Capulet's rage responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act III, Scene V alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of parting at dawn and Capulet's rage follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act III, Scene V and its treatment of parting at dawn and Capulet's rage. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's imagery and foreshadowing, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act III, Scene V as evidence for a larger claim about parting at dawn and Capulet's rage in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act III, Scene V as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of parting at dawn and Capulet's rage. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

SAT-style questions

1. *Yon light is not day-light, I know it, I: It is some meteor that the sun exhales, To be to thee this night a torch-bearer, And light thee on thy way to Mantua: Therefore stay yet; thou need’st not to be gone.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “exhales” most nearly mean?

   A. a fountain; a pipe of water

   B. draws out (as vapour)

   C. a fruit tree with many seeds

   D. a man who is about to be married

2. *It was the lark, the herald of the morn, No nightingale: look, love, what envious streaks Do lace the severing clouds in yonder east: Night’s candles are burnt out, and jocund day Stands tiptoe on the misty mountain tops. I must be gone and live, or stay and die.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act III, Scene V”?

   A. Juliet's feigned obedience

B. The second Chorus

C. Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell

D. Parting at dawn and Capulet's rage

SAT key: 1. B (draws out (as vapour)); 2. D (Parting at dawn and Capulet's rage)

Lesson 21: Act IV, Scene I

Focus: the Friar's desperate plan

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in "Act IV, Scene I" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (suicide (threatened), drug (sleeping potion)): Juliet threatens to kill herself rather than marry Paris. Use the safe-messaging script; discuss the Friar's response and the pressure Juliet faces. The Friar's 'distilled liquor' is the sleeping potion: 'liquor' here means a liquid, not alcohol. Gloss it before reading.
Student preview: A character speaks of taking her own life. Support is available if this is hard to read. This scene involves a potion that makes Juliet appear dead.
Suggested language: "Why does Juliet feel she has no other way out?"
Safe messaging: Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this scene is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

Paris tells the Friar of the wedding. Juliet arrives and fences verbally with him. Alone with the Friar, she threatens suicide; he gives her a potion that will make her seem dead for forty-two hours and promises to send for Romeo.

Background: Herbal drugs and sleeping draughts were common in literature; the plan echoes stories of feigned death.

Significance: The plan's complexity sets up its failure.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
When is a risky plan worth trying? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and choice because.... Content note before we start: A character speaks of taking her own life. Support is available if this is hard to read. This scene involves a potion that makes Juliet appear dead. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.
Prompt: When is a risky plan worth trying?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and choice because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Juliet chooses a terrifying plan.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Two key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: pensive — thoughtful and sad; compass — reach; the limit of one's ability. “compass”: Origin: Old French compas.
Words: pensive: thoughtful and sad · compass: reach; the limit of one's ability

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Herbal drugs and sleeping draughts were common in literature; the plan echoes stories of feigned death. The plan's complexity sets up its failure. Characterization: Juliet faces Paris with cool wordplay, then threatens suicide to the Friar. Plot: The Friar's plan: a potion to make her seem dead for "two and forty hours." Foreshadowing: She would rather be shut in a charnel house than marry Paris. Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “merry, give consent / To marry Paris: Wednesday is to-morrow: / To-morrow night look that thou lie alone; / Let not thy nurse lie with” (Act IV, Scene I, Friar Laurence).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read “That is no slander, sir, which is a truth” slowly and put it in my own words: When Paris says she slanders her face by calling it tearful, Juliet replies that what is true is no slander. Next, craft. I notice her careful double meanings, which let her answer without lying or revealing her secret. The strongest word is “slander”: it means a false accusation, which she says cannot apply to truth. Then, effect. What does Juliet's reply to Paris show? My answer: Juliet avoids Paris's questions with wit and hides her marriage to Romeo; her guarded replies show how alone and clever she must now be.

> *That is no slander, sir, which is a truth* (Act IV, Scene I, Juliet)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read “That is no slander, sir, which is a truth” slowly and put it in my own words: When Paris says she slanders her face by calling it tearful, Juliet replies that what is true is no slander. Next, craft. I notice her careful double meanings, which let her answer without lying or revealing her secret. The strongest word is “slander”: it means a false accusation, which she says cannot apply to truth. Then, effect. What does Juliet's reply to Paris show? My answer: Juliet avoids Paris's questions with wit and hides her marriage to Romeo; her guarded replies show how alone and clever she must now be.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The potion will make her seem dead for 42 hours and then she will wake. Expected link: poison and medicine. Ask: How does this line connect to fate and choice? Expected: Juliet chooses a terrifying plan. (The potion's effect.)

> *Thou shalt continue two and forty hours, / And then awake as from a pleasant sleep* *(Act IV, Scene I, Friar Laurence)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The potion will make her seem dead for 42 hours and then she will wake. Expected link: poison and medicine.
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and choice?
Expected answer: Juliet chooses a terrifying plan. (The potion's effect.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, plot (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the Friar's desperate plan? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene I develops the idea of the Friar's desperate plan. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and plot shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's plan demands. When the text says “That is no slander, sir, which is a truth” (Act IV, Scene I, Juliet), it shows this directly. She answers Paris with "That is no slander, sir, which is a truth," then takes the potion's plan ("two and forty hours") crying "Give me, give me! O, tell not me of fear!"
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, plot (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the Friar's desperate plan? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene I develops the idea of the Friar's desperate plan. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and plot shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's plan demands. When the text says “That is no slander, sir, which is a truth” (Act IV, Scene I, Juliet), it shows this directly. She answers Paris with "That is no slander, sir, which is a truth," then takes the potion's plan ("two and forty hours") crying "Give me, give me! O, tell not me of fear!"

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: When is a risky plan worth trying? List what could go wrong with the Friar's plan. Which risks does he admit?
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Facilitation: List what could go wrong with the Friar's plan. Which risks does he admit?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the Friar's desperate plan? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's plan demands. (“That is no slander, sir, which is a truth”, Act IV, Scene I, Juliet). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the Friar's desperate plan? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's plan demands. (“That is no slander, sir, which is a truth”, Act IV, Scene I, Juliet). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes the Friar's desperate plan. Key takeaway: Juliet chooses a terrifying plan.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Juliet faces Paris with cool wordplay, then threatens suicide to the Friar.
- **Plot:** The Friar's plan: a potion to make her seem dead for "two and forty hours."
- **Foreshadowing:** She would rather be shut in a charnel house than marry Paris.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and choice:** Juliet chooses a terrifying plan.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “merry, give consent / To marry Paris: Wednesday is to-morrow: / To-morrow night look that thou lie alone; / Let not thy nurse lie with” (Act IV, Scene I, Friar Laurence).
- **haste and time:** Everything happens too fast: a four-day action, a marriage the day after meeting, a wedding moved up a day; Friar Laurence warns "they stumble that run fast." In this scene: “it so; / And I am nothing slow to slack his haste” (Act IV, Scene I, Paris).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “That is no slander, sir, which is a truth” (Act IV, Scene I, Juliet) Juliet's sharp answer to Paris.
- “Thou shalt continue two and forty hours, / And then awake as from a pleasant sleep” (Act IV, Scene I, Friar Laurence) The potion's effect.
- “Give me, give me! O, tell not me of fear” (Act IV, Scene I, Juliet) Juliet's courage.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's plan demands.
Evidence: “That is no slander, sir, which is a truth” (Act IV, Scene I, Juliet)
Reasoning: She answers Paris with "That is no slander, sir, which is a truth," then takes the potion's plan ("two and forty hours") crying "Give me, give me! O, tell not me of fear!"

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
pensive (adjective)	thoughtful and sad	*My leisure serves me, pensive daughter, now.*	
compass (noun)	reach; the limit of one's ability	*Ah, Juliet, I already know thy grief; It strains me past the compass of my wits: I hear thou must, and nothing may prorogue it, On Thursday next be married to this county.*	“compass”: Origin: Old French compas. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/compass#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. When is a risky plan worth trying?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with time and haste?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What will Romeo do when Juliet wakes? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Take her to Mantua.
2. How long will the potion last? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Forty-two hours
3. Where will Juliet be taken? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The Capulet vault
4. What will the Friar send? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A letter to Romeo

5. What does Juliet threaten? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: To kill herself
6. Who comes to the cell first? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Paris
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act IV, Scene I" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Paris tells the Friar of the wedding. Juliet arrives and fences verbally with him. Alone with the Friar, she threatens suicide; he gives her a potion that will make her seem dead for forty-two hours and promises to send for Romeo.
8. Who is on stage in "Act IV, Scene I", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act IV, Scene I" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "My leisure serves me, pensive daughter, now." What does "pensive" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: pensive: thoughtful and sad.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does the Friar choose such a dangerous plan? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: He fears Juliet's suicide and sees no other way.
2. What does "Act IV, Scene I" suggest about the Friar's desperate plan? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The plan's complexity sets up its failure.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the plot in this scene shape what we understand about the Friar's desperate plan? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for key events and the causes linking them.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's plan demands. Useful evidence: "That is no slander, sir, which is a truth" (Act IV, Scene I, Juliet): Juliet's sharp answer to Paris. On plot: The Friar's plan: a potion to make her seem dead for "two and forty hours." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "Immoderately she weeps for Tybalt's death, And therefore have I little talk'd of love; For Venus smiles not in a house of tears.", why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "Act IV, Scene I", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Paris tells the Friar of the wedding. Juliet arrives and fences verbally with him. Alone with the Friar, she threatens suicide; he gives her a potion that will make her seem dead for forty-two hours and promises to send for Romeo.
7. How does "Act IV, Scene I" build on "Act III, Scene V"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the

previous scene.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's plan demands. Useful evidence: “Thou shalt continue two and forty hours, / And then awake as from a pleasant sleep” (Act IV, Scene I, Friar Laurence): The potion's effect. Theme link: Juliet chooses a terrifying plan. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's plan demands. Useful evidence: “Give me, give me! O, tell not me of fear” (Act IV, Scene I, Juliet): Juliet's courage. On characterization: Juliet faces Paris with cool wordplay, then threatens suicide to the Friar. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “When is a risky plan worth trying?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

10. Where does foreshadowing appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with time and haste? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's plan demands. Useful evidence: “That is no slander, sir, which is a truth” (Act IV, Scene I, Juliet): Juliet's sharp answer to Paris. On foreshadowing: She would rather be shut in a charnel house than marry Paris. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Should Juliet trust the Friar? Evaluate. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Weighing his past help and his plan's risks.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's plan demands. Useful evidence: “Thou shalt continue two and forty hours, / And then awake as from a pleasant sleep” (Act IV, Scene I, Friar Laurence): The potion's effect. Theme link: Juliet chooses a terrifying plan. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “The plan's complexity sets up its failure.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's plan demands. Useful evidence: “Give me, give me! O, tell not me of fear” (Act IV, Scene I, Juliet): Juliet's courage. Theme link: Juliet chooses a terrifying plan. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and

evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's plan demands. Useful evidence: “That is no slander, sir, which is a truth” (Act IV, Scene I, Juliet): Juliet's sharp answer to Paris. On characterization: Juliet faces Paris with cool wordplay, then threatens suicide to the Friar. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act IV, Scene I”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the Friar's desperate plan. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's plan demands. Useful evidence: “Thou shalt continue two and forty hours, / And then awake as from a pleasant sleep” (Act IV, Scene I, Friar Laurence): The potion's effect. Theme link: Juliet chooses a terrifying plan. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act IV, Scene I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's plan demands. Useful evidence: “Give me, give me! O, tell not me of fear” (Act IV, Scene I, Juliet): Juliet's courage. Theme link: Juliet chooses a terrifying plan. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to love and desire: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's plan demands. Useful evidence: “That is no slander, sir, which is a truth” (Act IV, Scene I, Juliet): Juliet's sharp answer to Paris. Theme link: Juliet chooses a terrifying plan. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's plan demands. Useful evidence: “Thou shalt continue two and forty hours, / And then awake as from a pleasant sleep” (Act IV, Scene I, Friar Laurence): The potion's effect. On characterization: Juliet faces Paris with cool wordplay, then threatens suicide to the Friar. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act IV, Scene I” treats the Friar's desperate plan with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's plan demands. Useful evidence: “Give me, give me! O, tell not me of fear” (Act IV, Scene I, Juliet): Juliet's courage. Theme link: Juliet chooses a terrifying plan. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what "Act IV, Scene II" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's plan demands. Useful evidence: "That is no slander, sir, which is a truth" (Act IV, Scene I, Juliet): Juliet's sharp answer to Paris. On foreshadowing: She would rather be shut in a charnel house than marry Paris. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the Friar's desperate plan? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's plan demands. Useful evidence: "Thou shalt continue two and forty hours, / And then awake as from a pleasant sleep" (Act IV, Scene I, Friar Laurence): The potion's effect. Theme link: Juliet chooses a terrifying plan. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Plot**: key events and the causes linking them
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act IV, Scene I, Juliet: "That is no _____, sir, which is a truth"
   Key: slander
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Juliet threaten?
   A. To marry Paris
   B. To kill herself
   C. To run away
   D. To tell her father
   Key: B (To kill herself)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Ah, Juliet, I already know thy grief; It strains me past the compass of my wits: I hear thou must, and nothing may prorogue it, On Thursday next be married to this county.", what does "compass" most nearly mean?
   A. reach; the limit of one's ability
   B. having sworn falsely
   C. silly; obstinate
   D. wanderers, possibly the fleeing sun's horses
   Key: A (reach; the limit of one's ability)

4. [short · recall · DOK 1] What will Romeo do when Juliet wakes?
   Sample answer: Take her to Mantua.
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How long will the potion last?
   A. Forty-two hours
   B. Three days
   C. One day
   D. One hour

   Key: A (Forty-two hours)
6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act IV, Scene I, Friar Laurence: "Thou shalt _____ two and forty hours, / And then awake as from a pleasant sleep"
   Key: continue
7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What will the Friar send?
   A. A letter to Romeo
   B. Guards
   C. Money
   D. Balthasar

   Key: A (A letter to Romeo)
8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who comes to the cell first?
   A. The Nurse
   B. Paris
   C. Romeo
   D. Capulet

   Key: B (Paris)
9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "My leisure serves me, _____ daughter, now." Word bank: pensive, compass
   Key: pensive
10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? "Thou shalt continue two and forty hours, / And then awake as from a pleasant sleep" (Act IV, Scene I, Friar Laurence)
    A. Juliet's loyalty shifts to Romeo.
    B. The quarantine.
    C. The potion's effect.
    D. Romeo's last words.

    Key: C (The potion's effect.)
11. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does the Friar choose such a dangerous plan?
    Sample answer: He fears Juliet's suicide and sees no other way.
12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Act IV, Scene I"?
    A. Juliet's feigned obedience
    B. The Friar's desperate plan
    C. Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell
    D. The street brawl and lovesick Romeo

Key: B (The Friar's desperate plan)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Thou shalt continue two and forty hours, / And then awake as from a pleasant sleep” (Act IV, Scene I, Friar Laurence) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The potion's effect.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act IV, Scene I”? The Friar's plan: a potion to make her seem dead for "two and forty hours."

    A. Hyperbole

    B. Irony

    C. Plot

    D. Symbolism

    Key: C (Plot)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act IV, Scene I”? Juliet faces Paris with cool wordplay, then threatens suicide to the Friar.

    A. Setting

    B. Plot

    C. Tone / mood

    D. Characterization

    Key: D (Characterization)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “That is no slander, sir, which is a truth” (Act IV, Scene I, Juliet) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Juliet's sharp answer to Paris.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “My leisure serves me, pensive daughter, now.”, what does “pensive” most nearly mean?

    A. marzipan, a sweet almond paste

    B. one who forgives sins

    C. paid as a tribute; offered

    D. thoughtful and sad

    Key: D (thoughtful and sad)

18. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “That is no slander, sir, which is a truth” (Act IV, Scene I, Juliet)

    A. The Friar's image of Juliet.

    B. Juliet's sharp answer to Paris.

    C. The deaths end the feud: the tragedy has a purpose.

    D. Passion overcomes obstacles.

    Key: B (Juliet's sharp answer to Paris.)

19. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Juliet chooses a terrifying plan.

    A. Love and desire

    B. Youth and age

C. Violence and the feud

D. Fate and choice

Key: D (Fate and choice)

20. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's plan demands. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “That is no slander, sir, which is a truth” (Act IV, Scene I, Juliet).
Sample answer: She answers Paris with "That is no slander, sir, which is a truth," then takes the potion's plan ("two and forty hours") crying "Give me, give me! O, tell not me of fear!"

21. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Give me, give me! O, tell not me of fear” (Act IV, Scene I, Juliet). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
Sample answer: Juliet's courage.

22. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Should Juliet trust the Friar? Evaluate.
Sample answer: Weighing his past help and his plan's risks.

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where will Juliet be taken?

A. The church

B. Mantua

C. The Friar's cell

D. The Capulet vault

Key: D (The Capulet vault)

24. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Ah, Juliet, I already know thy grief; It strains me past the _____ of my wits: I hear thou must, and nothing may prorogue it, On Thursday next be married to this county.” Word bank: compass, pensive
Key: compass

25. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “That is no slander, sir, which is a truth” (Act IV, Scene I, Juliet) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: Juliet's sharp answer to Paris.

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Thou shalt continue two and forty hours, / And then awake as from a pleasant sleep” (Act IV, Scene I, Friar Laurence) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: The potion's effect.

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how fate and choice develops from an earlier scene to “Act IV, Scene I”. Use one quotation from each.
Sample answer: Juliet chooses a terrifying plan.

28. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Give me, give me! O, tell not me of fear” (Act IV, Scene I, Juliet)

A. Doubt of the Friar.

B. Tybalt's tie to Lady Capulet explains her later grief and demand for revenge.

C. The Prince's law: the next fight will cost lives.

D. Juliet's courage.

Key: D (Juliet's courage.)

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's plan demands.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates

it.

Sample answer: She answers Paris with "That is no slander, sir, which is a truth," then takes the potion's plan ("two and forty hours") crying "Give me, give me! O, tell not me of fear!"

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	3, 9, 8, 7, 4, 6, 1, 17, 18, 13, 12, 10, 19, 20, 21, 22	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	23, 24, 3, 6, 7, 9, 10, 18, 11, 12, 25, 14, 15, 19, 16, 26	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	9, 1, 23, 8, 4, 13, 11, 18, 25, 12, 14, 20, 19, 15, 22, 27	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	9, 24, 8, 3, 25, 28, 13, 11, 18, 14, 15, 19, 21, 27, 29, 22	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	9, 24, 17, 28, 10, 18, 25, 14, 20, 19, 21, 15, 16, 22, 26, 27	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	24, 1, 7, 25, 18, 10, 12, 19, 20, 21, 14, 15, 29, 26, 27, 16	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	1, 9, 11, 10, 28, 12, 19, 20, 14, 15, 21, 22, 16, 29, 26, 27	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	9, 1, 11, 10, 13, 18, 14, 21, 20, 19, 15, 26, 22, 16, 27, 29	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Senior	9, 24, 10, 25, 11, 12, 15, 21, 19, 14, 20, 16, 26, 27, 22, 29	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	9, 24, 10, 18, 11, 12, 15, 21, 14, 19, 20, 26, 22, 29, 16, 27	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act IV, Scene I,” how does Shakespeare show the Friar's desperate plan? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act IV, Scene I, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the Friar's desperate plan? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act IV, Scene I develops the idea of the Friar's desperate plan. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and plot shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act IV, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of the Friar's desperate plan. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act IV, Scene I suggests about the Friar's desperate plan. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and plot), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act IV, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of the Friar's desperate plan. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act IV, Scene I within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the Friar's desperate plan responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act IV, Scene I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the Friar's desperate plan follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act IV, Scene I and its treatment of the Friar's desperate plan. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and plot, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act IV, Scene I as evidence for a larger claim about the Friar's desperate plan in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act IV, Scene I as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the Friar's desperate plan. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

SAT-style questions

1. *Immoderately she weeps for Tybalt's death, And therefore have I little talk'd of love; For Venus smiles not in a house of tears. Now, sir, her father counts it dangerous That she doth give her sorrow so much sway, And in his wisdom hastes our marriage, To stop the inundation of her tears; Which, too much minded by herself alone, May be put from her by society: Now do you know the reason of this haste.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act IV, Scene I"?

A. Wedding preparations

B. Capulet sets the wedding to Paris

C. The Friar's desperate plan

D. The household mourns

SAT key: 1. C (The Friar's desperate plan)

Lesson 22: Act IV, Scene II

Focus: Juliet's feigned obedience

Objective: Students will analyze how irony develops in "Act IV, Scene II" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

Capulet is busy preparing the wedding. Juliet returns and says she repents; Capulet moves the wedding to Wednesday.

Background: Wedding feasts required much preparation.

Significance: The time shift endangers the plan.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What happens when plans change suddenly? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to time and haste because....
Prompt: What happens when plans change suddenly?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to time and haste because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: one day lost will prove fatal.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: behests — commands; gadding — wandering about idly; reclaim — bring back to obedience; wayward — disobedient; prostrate — lying face down in submission. "reclaim": Origin: Anglo-Norman reclamer; earlier Latin reclāmō.
Words: behests: commands · gadding: wandering about idly · reclaim: bring back to obedience · wayward: disobedient · prostrate: lying face down in submission

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Wedding feasts required much preparation. The time shift endangers the plan. Irony: Juliet pretends to submit; Capulet moves the wedding up to Wednesday. Characterization: Capulet is overjoyed and busy with the feast. Plot: The wedding change shortens the time for the Friar's letter. Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "We shall be short in our provision: / 'Tis now near night" (Act IV, Scene II, Lady Capulet).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "How now, my headstrong! where have you been gadding" slowly and put it in my own words: When Juliet returns from the Friar, Capulet greets her as headstrong and asks where she has been gadding. Next, craft. I notice his teasing tone, softened now because he expects her to obey him. The strongest word is "headstrong": it means stubborn and willful, which is what he thought she was. Then, effect. Why does Capulet call Juliet headstrong? My answer: Juliet pretends to agree to marry Paris; delighted, Capulet moves the wedding a day earlier, which shortens the time for the Friar's plan to work.

> *How now, my headstrong! where have you been gadding* (Act IV, Scene II, Capulet)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "How now, my headstrong! where have you been gadding" slowly and put it in my own words: When Juliet returns from the Friar, Capulet greets her as headstrong and asks where she has been gadding. Next, craft. I notice his teasing tone, softened now because he expects her to obey him. The strongest word is "headstrong": it means stubborn and willful, which is what he thought she was. Then, effect. Why does Capulet call Juliet headstrong? My answer: Juliet pretends to agree to marry Paris; delighted, Capulet moves the wedding a day earlier, which shortens the time for the Friar's plan to work.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Juliet's feigned repentance. Look at the craft: Capulet is overjoyed and busy with the feast. Ask: How does this line connect to time and haste? Expected: One day lost will prove fatal. (Juliet's feigned repentance.)

> *Where I have learn'd me to repent the sin / Of disobedient opposition* (Act IV, Scene II, Juliet)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Juliet's feigned repentance. Look at the craft: Capulet is overjoyed and busy with the feast.
Ask: How does this line connect to time and haste?
Expected answer: One day lost will prove fatal. (Juliet's feigned repentance.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Juliet's feigned obedience? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene II develops the idea of Juliet's feigned obedience. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger. When the text says "Where I have learn'd me to repent the sin / Of disobedient opposition" (Act IV, Scene II, Juliet), it shows this directly. She claims to "repent the sin / Of disobedient opposition," and Capulet, delighted, announces "We'll to church to-morrow," a day sooner.
Task: Annotate the scene for irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Juliet's feigned obedience? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene II develops the idea of Juliet's feigned obedience. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger. When the text says "Where I have learn'd me to repent the sin / Of disobedient opposition" (Act IV, Scene II, Juliet), it shows this directly. She claims to "repent the sin / Of disobedient opposition," and Capulet, delighted, announces "We'll to church to-morrow," a day sooner.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What happens when plans change suddenly? Is Juliet's deception justified?
Anchor question: What happens when plans change suddenly?
Facilitation: Is Juliet's deception justified?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Juliet's feigned obedience? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger. ("Where I have learn'd me to repent the sin / Of disobedient opposition", Act IV, Scene II, Juliet). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Juliet's feigned obedience? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger. ("Where I have learn'd me to repent the sin / Of disobedient opposition", Act IV, Scene II, Juliet). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how irony shapes Juliet's feigned obedience. Key takeaway: one day lost will prove fatal.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Irony:** Juliet pretends to submit; Capulet moves the wedding up to Wednesday.
- **Characterization:** Capulet is overjoyed and busy with the feast.
- **Plot:** The wedding change shortens the time for the Friar's letter.

Themes and how they develop

- **time and haste:** one day lost will prove fatal.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “We shall be short in our provision: / ’Tis now near night” (Act IV, Scene II, Lady Capulet).
- **haste and time:** Everything happens too fast: a four-day action, a marriage the day after meeting, a wedding moved up a day; Friar Laurence warns "they stumble that run fast." In this scene: “tell him of this: / I’ll have this knot knit up to-morrow morning” (Act IV, Scene II, Capulet).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “How now, my headstrong! where have you been gadding” (Act IV, Scene II, Capulet) Capulet's greeting.
- “Where I have learn’d me to repent the sin / Of disobedient opposition” (Act IV, Scene II, Juliet) Juliet's feigned repentance.
- “we’ll to church to-morrow” (Act IV, Scene II, Capulet) The wedding moved up.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger.
Evidence: “Where I have learn’d me to repent the sin / Of disobedient opposition” (Act IV, Scene II, Juliet)
Reasoning: She claims to "repent the sin / Of disobedient opposition," and Capulet, delighted, announces "We'll to church to-morrow," a day sooner.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
behests (noun)	commands	*Where I have learn’d me to repent the sin Of disobedient opposition To you and your behests, and am enjoin’d By holy Laurence to fall prostrate here, And beg your pardon: pardon, I beseech you!*	

gadding (verb)	wandering about idly	*How now, my headstrong! where have you been gadding?*	
reclaim (verb)	bring back to obedience	*Well, I will walk myself To County Paris, to prepare him up Against to-morrow: my heart is wondrous light, Since this same wayward girl is so reclaim'd.*	"reclaim": Origin: Anglo-Norman reclamer; earlier Latin reclāmō. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/reclaim#Etymology)
wayward (adjective)	disobedient	*Well, I will walk myself To County Paris, to prepare him up Against to-morrow: my heart is wondrous light, Since this same wayward girl is so reclaim'd.*	
prostrate (adjective)	lying face down in submission	*Where I have learn'd me to repent the sin Of disobedient opposition To you and your behests, and am enjoin'd By holy Laurence to fall prostrate here, And beg your pardon: pardon, I beseech you!*	
harlotry (noun)	a good-for-nothing girl	*Well, he may chance to do some good on her: A peevish self-will'd harlotry it is.*	
headstrong (noun)	a stubborn, willful person	*How now, my headstrong! where have you been gadding?*	
peevish (adjective)	silly; obstinate	*Well, he may chance to do some good on her: A peevish self-will'd harlotry it is.*	
provision (noun)	supplies of food and drink	*We shall be short in our provision: 'Tis now near night.*	

Discussion questions

1. What happens when plans change suddenly?
2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with love and desire?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Who will Capulet tell of the change? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Paris.

2. What does Juliet claim? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: She repents
3. What does Capulet do? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Moves the wedding up
4. Where has Juliet been? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: At Friar Laurence's cell
5. How many cooks does Capulet want? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Twenty
6. What does Capulet call Juliet? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Headstrong
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act IV, Scene II" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Capulet is busy preparing the wedding. Juliet returns and says she repents; Capulet moves the wedding to Wednesday.
8. Who is on stage in "Act IV, Scene II", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act IV, Scene II" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Where I have learn'd me to repent the sin Of disobedient opposition To you and your behests, and am enjoin'd By holy Laurence to fall prostrate here, And beg your pardon: pardon, I beseech you!" What does "behests" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: behests: commands.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why is moving the wedding fatal? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: It shortens the time for Romeo to receive the letter.
2. What does "Act IV, Scene II" suggest about Juliet's feigned obedience? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The time shift endangers the plan.
3. Find one example of irony in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about Juliet's feigned obedience? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger. Useful evidence: "How now, my headstrong! where have you been gadding" (Act IV, Scene II, Capulet): Capulet's greeting. On characterization: Capulet is overjoyed and busy with the feast. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "Where I have learn'd me to repent the sin Of disobedient opposition To you and your behests, and am enjoin'd By holy Laurence to fall prostrate here, And beg your pardon: pardon,…", why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their

connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

6. What causes the main turn in “Act IV, Scene II”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Capulet is busy preparing the wedding. Juliet returns and says she repents; Capulet moves the wedding to Wednesday.
7. How does “Act IV, Scene II” build on “Act IV, Scene I”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger. Useful evidence: “Where I have learn’d me to repent the sin / Of disobedient opposition” (Act IV, Scene II, Juliet): Juliet's feigned repentance. Theme link: one day lost will prove fatal. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger. Useful evidence: “we’ll to church to-morrow” (Act IV, Scene II, Capulet): The wedding moved up. On characterization: Capulet is overjoyed and busy with the feast. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “What happens when plans change suddenly?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does plot appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with love and desire? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for key events and the causes linking them.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger. Useful evidence: “How now, my headstrong! where have you been gadding” (Act IV, Scene II, Capulet): Capulet's greeting. On plot: The wedding change shortens the time for the Friar's letter. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Juliet's lie justified? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Weighing deception against her situation.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger. Useful evidence: “Where I have learn’d me to repent the sin / Of disobedient opposition” (Act IV, Scene II, Juliet): Juliet's feigned repentance. Theme link: one day lost will prove fatal. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The time shift endangers the plan.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger. Useful evidence: “we’ll to church to-morrow” (Act IV, Scene II, Capulet): The wedding moved up. Theme

link: one day lost will prove fatal. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger. Useful evidence: “How now, my headstrong! where have you been gadding” (Act IV, Scene II, Capulet): Capulet's greeting. On characterization: Capulet is overjoyed and busy with the feast. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act IV, Scene II”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Juliet's feigned obedience. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger. Useful evidence: “Where I have learn’d me to repent the sin / Of disobedient opposition” (Act IV, Scene II, Juliet): Juliet's feigned repentance. Theme link: one day lost will prove fatal. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act IV, Scene II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger. Useful evidence: “we’ll to church to-morrow” (Act IV, Scene II, Capulet): The wedding moved up. Theme link: one day lost will prove fatal. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to fate and choice: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger. Useful evidence: “How now, my headstrong! where have you been gadding” (Act IV, Scene II, Capulet): Capulet's greeting. Theme link: one day lost will prove fatal. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the irony in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger. Useful evidence: “Where I have learn’d me to repent the sin / Of disobedient opposition” (Act IV, Scene II, Juliet): Juliet's feigned repentance. On irony: Juliet pretends to submit; Capulet moves the wedding up to Wednesday. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act IV, Scene II” treats Juliet's feigned obedience with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger.

Useful evidence: “we’ll to church to-morrow” (Act IV, Scene II, Capulet): The wedding moved up. Theme link: one day lost will prove fatal. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act IV, Scene III” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger. Useful evidence: “How now, my headstrong! where have you been gadding” (Act IV, Scene II, Capulet): Capulet's greeting. Theme link: one day lost will prove fatal. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Juliet's feigned obedience? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger. Useful evidence: “Where I have learn’d me to repent the sin / Of disobedient opposition” (Act IV, Scene II, Juliet): Juliet's feigned repentance. Theme link: one day lost will prove fatal. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Plot**: key events and the causes linking them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act IV, Scene II, Juliet: “Where I have learn’d me to repent the sin / Of _____ opposition”
   Key: disobedient
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Well, he may chance to do some good on her: A peevish self-will’d _____ it is.” Word bank: behests, harlotry, reclaim, gadding
   Key: harlotry
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Capulet do?
   A. Invites Romeo
   B. Moves the wedding up
   C. Cancels it
   D. Leaves for Mantua

   Key: B (Moves the wedding up)
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Juliet claim?
   A. She is ill
   B. She wants to wait
   C. She repents

D. She loves Paris

Key: C (She repents)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Capulet call Juliet?

   A. Gentle

   B. Wise

   C. Headstrong

   D. Sweet

   Key: C (Headstrong)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Where I have learn’d me to repent the sin Of disobedient opposition To you and your behests, and am enjoin’d By holy Laurence to fall _____ here, And beg your pardon: pardon, I beseech you!” Word bank: reclaim, behests, gadding, prostrate

   Key: prostrate

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Well, I will walk myself To County Paris, to prepare him up Against to-morrow: my heart is wondrous light, Since this same wayward girl is so reclaim’d.”, what does “reclaim” most nearly mean?

   A. bring back to obedience

   B. pilgrims who carried a palm leaf from the Holy Land

   C. hard yellow fruits used in pastry

   D. unmanly, in the period's prejudice; tearful

   Key: A (bring back to obedience)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act IV, Scene II, Capulet: “How now, my _____! where have you been gadding”

   Key: headstrong

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Where I have learn’d me to repent the sin Of disobedient opposition To you and your behests, and am enjoin’d By holy Laurence to fall prostrate here, And beg your pardon: pardon, I beseech you!”, what does “behests” most nearly mean?

   A. commands

   B. delay; neglect

   C. thoughtful and sad

   D. puzzling; speaking in riddles

   Key: A (commands)

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Where I have learn’d me to repent the sin / Of disobedient opposition” (Act IV, Scene II, Juliet)

    A. Juliet drinks to Romeo.

    B. The Prince blames the feud.

    C. Romeo's premonition.

    D. Juliet's feigned repentance.

    Key: D (Juliet's feigned repentance.)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why is moving the wedding fatal?

    Sample answer: It shortens the time for Romeo to receive the letter.

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Act IV, Scene II"?
    A. The divided world of Verona
    B. Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation
    C. The Friar's desperate plan
    D. Juliet's feigned obedience

    Key: D (Juliet's feigned obedience)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? "How now, my headstrong! where have you been gadding" (Act IV, Scene II, Capulet) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Capulet's greeting.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in "Act IV, Scene II"? Juliet pretends to submit; Capulet moves the wedding up to Wednesday.
    A. Structure
    B. Foreshadowing
    C. Irony
    D. Imagery

    Key: C (Irony)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in "we'll to church to-morrow" (Act IV, Scene II, Capulet). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: The wedding moved up.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Where I have learn'd me to repent the sin / Of disobedient opposition" (Act IV, Scene II, Juliet) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Juliet's feigned repentance.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How many cooks does Capulet want?
    A. Ten
    B. Twenty
    C. One
    D. Two

    Key: B (Twenty)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Well, he may chance to do some good on her: A _____ self-will'd harlotry it is." Word bank: reclaim, peevish, behests, gadding
    Key: peevish

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "How now, my _____! where have you been gadding?" Word bank: reclaim, behests, headstrong, gadding
    Key: headstrong

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "How now, my headstrong! where have you been gadding?", what does "gadding" most nearly mean?
    A. dark and threatening
    B. pierces; shivers
    C. wandering about idly
    D. a servant or retainer

Key: C (wandering about idly)

21. [short · recall · DOK 1] Who will Capulet tell of the change?
    Sample answer: Paris.

22. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Well, I will walk myself To County Paris, to prepare him up Against to-morrow: my heart is wondrous light, Since this same wayward girl is so reclaim’d.”, what does “wayward” most nearly mean?
    A. disobedient
    B. a parish officer who keeps the peace
    C. caused great suffering to
    D. badly wounded or mutilated

    Key: A (disobedient)

23. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Where I have learn’d me to repent the sin / Of disobedient opposition” (Act IV, Scene II, Juliet) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Juliet's feigned repentance.

24. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Where I have learn’d me to repent the sin / Of disobedient opposition” (Act IV, Scene II, Juliet).
    Sample answer: She claims to "repent the sin / Of disobedient opposition," and Capulet, delighted, announces "We'll to church to-morrow," a day sooner.

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act IV, Scene II”? Capulet is overjoyed and busy with the feast.
    A. Allusion
    B. Characterization
    C. Plot
    D. Tone / mood

    Key: B (Characterization)

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how time and haste develops from an earlier scene to “Act IV, Scene II”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: one day lost will prove fatal.

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where has Juliet been?
    A. In Mantua
    B. At Friar Laurence's cell
    C. In the orchard
    D. At church

    Key: B (At Friar Laurence's cell)

28. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “we’ll to church to-morrow” (Act IV, Scene II, Capulet)
    A. The wedding moved up.
    B. The Nurse establishes Juliet's age.
    C. Juliet's warning about haste.
    D. Oxymorons express shock at Romeo's act.

Key: A (The wedding moved up.)

29. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “How now, my headstrong! where have you been gadding” (Act IV, Scene II, Capulet)
    A. Mercutio's dying curse on the feud.
    B. Juliet's sharp answer to Paris.
    C. Capulet's greeting.
    D. Romeo hands his course to God or fate.

    Key: C (Capulet's greeting.)

30. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? One day lost will prove fatal.
    A. Fate and choice
    B. Violence and the feud
    C. Love and desire
    D. Time and haste

    Key: D (Time and haste)

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: She claims to "repent the sin / Of disobedient opposition," and Capulet, delighted, announces "We'll to church to-morrow," a day sooner.

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “How now, my headstrong! where have you been gadding” (Act IV, Scene II, Capulet) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Capulet's greeting.

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is Juliet's lie justified?
    Sample answer: Weighing deception against her situation.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 18, 19, 20, 8, 1, 21, 22, 23, 10, 12, 11, 14, 24, 25, 26	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	6, 18, 3, 7, 22, 27, 11, 28, 23, 10, 29, 24, 14, 30, 31, 16	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	6, 22, 19, 7, 20, 28, 11, 29, 13, 23, 24, 15, 30, 25, 32, 33	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	6, 2, 17, 5, 10, 13, 12, 29, 11, 25, 15, 24, 14, 16, 31, 33	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	18, 6, 20, 10, 11, 29, 23, 25, 15, 24, 14, 30, 26, 31, 32, 16	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	2, 3, 8, 12, 13, 23, 11, 30, 14, 24, 15, 25, 26, 33, 32, 16	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
	6, 2, 11, 23, 12, 10, 30, 24, 25, 14, 15, 32, 16, 31, 33, 26	

College Sophomore		recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	18, 6, 28, 23, 10, 11, 24, 30, 25, 14, 15, 32, 26, 33, 16, 31	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Senior	6, 2, 13, 11, 29, 10, 30, 14, 15, 24, 25, 31, 16, 26, 33, 32	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	6, 2, 10, 12, 23, 13, 15, 14, 30, 25, 24, 26, 33, 32, 16, 31	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act IV, Scene II,” how does Shakespeare show Juliet's feigned obedience? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In Act IV, Scene II, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Juliet's feigned obedience? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act IV, Scene II develops the idea of Juliet's feigned obedience. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act IV, Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of Juliet's feigned obedience. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act IV, Scene II suggests about Juliet's feigned obedience. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses irony in Act IV, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of Juliet's feigned obedience. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act IV, Scene II within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Juliet's feigned obedience responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act IV, Scene II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Juliet's feigned obedience follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act IV, Scene II and its treatment of Juliet's feigned obedience. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's irony and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act IV, Scene II as evidence for a larger claim about Juliet's feigned obedience in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act IV, Scene II as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Juliet's feigned obedience. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

SAT-style questions

1. *Well, I will walk myself To County Paris, to prepare him up Against to-morrow: my heart is wondrous light, Since this same wayward girl is so reclaim'd.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “reclaim” most nearly mean?

   A. bring back to obedience

   B. silly; obstinate

   C. supplies of food and drink

   D. a stubborn, willful person

2. *Where I have learn'd me to repent the sin Of disobedient opposition To you and your behests, and am enjoin'd By holy Laurence to fall prostrate here, And beg your pardon: pardon, I beseech you! Henceforward I am ever ruled by you.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act IV, Scene II”?

   A. Juliet's feigned obedience

   B. Juliet waits for the Nurse

   C. Friar Laurence agrees to marry them

   D. The second Chorus

SAT key: 1. A (bring back to obedience); 2. A (Juliet's feigned obedience)

Lesson 23: Act IV, Scene III

Focus: Juliet drinks the potion

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in "Act IV, Scene III" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Critical voice: "In the scene where she drinks the sleeping potion, although her spirit does not quail, nor her determination falter for an instant, her vivid fancy conjures up one terrible apprehension after another, till gradually, and most naturally in such a mind once thrown off its poise, the horror rises to frenzy--her imagination realizes its own hideous creations, and she _sees_ her cousin Tybalt's ghost." (Anna Jameson, art historian and critic, *Characteristics of Women: Moral, Poetical, and Historical (1832), "Juliet", "Juliet"*; public domain). Pair with Johnson's note below. Courage or hypocrisy? Students take a side using IV.iii. *Objective:* Analyze Juliet's potion soliloquy and her imagination under pressure. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.3

Critical voice: "Juliet plays most of her pranks under the appearance of religion: perhaps Shakespeare meant to punish her hypocrisy." (Samuel Johnson, critic and lexicographer, *Notes to Romeo and Juliet, The Plays of William Shakespeare (1765), in Preface to Shakespeare, together with selected notes on some of the plays, note on Act IV, Scene iii ("For I have need of many orisons")*; public domain). Seminar: the 18th-century moralist vs. the 19th-century admirer (Jameson). Whose reading does the text support? *Objective:* Evaluate Juliet's deceptions of her family. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.3, SL.11-12.1

Content note (suicidal thoughts, fear of death, sleeping potion (a drug)): Before drinking the potion Juliet lays a dagger beside her in case it fails, and imagines waking in the tomb. Use the safe-messaging script; discuss her fear and isolation, not methods. Juliet drinks the Friar's sleeping potion ('this do I drink to thee'); name it as a drug in the plot and note the danger she accepts.
Student preview: A character prepares for the possibility of death. Support is available if this is hard to read.
Suggested language: "What does Juliet fear, and why is she so alone at this moment?"
Safe messaging: Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this scene is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

Juliet sends her mother and the Nurse away and, alone, imagines all that could go wrong: the potion might be poison, she might wake before Romeo, she might go mad among the bones. She drinks to Romeo.

Background: Family vaults held generations of bones; fear of being buried alive was common.

Significance: Juliet's courage peaks.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What gives people courage when they are afraid? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to death as bridegroom because.... Content note before we start: A character prepares for the possibility of death. Support is available if this is hard to read. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.
Prompt: What gives people courage when they are afraid?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to death as bridegroom because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Juliet drinks to Romeo as she enters a deathlike sleep.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: forefather — ancestor; methinks — it seems to me; thrills — pierces; shivers; orisons — prayers; stifled — smothered.
Words: forefather: ancestor · methinks: it seems to me · thrills: pierces; shivers · orisons: prayers · stifled: smothered

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Family vaults held generations of bones; fear of being buried alive was common. Juliet's courage peaks. Characterization: Alone, Juliet imagines every horror of the tomb, then drinks. Imagery: Gothic images of bones, Tybalt "festering in his shroud." Structure: A soliloquy of mounting fear. Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "me now be left alone, / And let the nurse this night sit up with you; / For, I am sure, you have your" (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "What if it be a poison, which the friar / Subtly hath minister'd to have me dead" slowly and put it in my own words: Alone, Juliet wonders whether the Friar has given her poison to kill her and hide his part in her marriage. Next, craft. I notice the string of anxious questions, as she imagines every way the plan could go wrong. The strongest word is "poison": it is her worst fear, that her trusted helper might betray her. Then, effect. What does Juliet fear before taking the potion? My answer: Juliet's doubts and terrors show her real courage, because she drinks the potion anyway; she chooses faith in Romeo over safety.

> *What if it be a poison, which the friar / Subtly hath minister'd to have me dead* (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "What if it be a poison, which the friar / Subtly hath minister'd to have me dead" slowly and put it in my own words: Alone, Juliet wonders whether the Friar has given her poison to kill her and hide his part in her marriage. Next, craft. I notice the string of anxious questions, as she imagines every way the plan could go wrong. The strongest word is "poison": it is her worst fear, that her trusted helper might betray her. Then, effect. What does Juliet fear before taking the potion? My answer: Juliet's doubts and terrors show her real courage, because she drinks the potion anyway; she chooses faith in Romeo over safety.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Juliet sees her action as a scene in a play she must perform alone. Expected link: fate and choice. Ask: How does this line connect to death as bridegroom? Expected: Juliet drinks to Romeo as she enters a deathlike sleep. (Juliet's solitude.)

> *My dismal scene I needs must act alone* (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Juliet sees her action as a scene in a play she must perform alone. Expected link: fate and choice.
Ask: How does this line connect to death as bridegroom?
Expected answer: Juliet drinks to Romeo as she enters a deathlike sleep. (Juliet's solitude.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Juliet drinks the potion? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene III develops the idea of Juliet drinks the potion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes. When the text says “My dismal scene I needs must act alone” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet), it shows this directly. She knows "My dismal scene I needs must act alone," doubts "What if it be a poison," imagines the tomb, and still says "Romeo, I come! this do I drink to thee."
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Juliet drinks the potion? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene III develops the idea of Juliet drinks the potion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes. When the text says “My dismal scene I needs must act alone” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet), it shows this directly. She knows "My dismal scene I needs must act alone," doubts "What if it be a poison," imagines the tomb, and still says "Romeo, I come! this do I drink to thee."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What gives people courage when they are afraid? What are Juliet's fears? Rank them from most to least rational.
Anchor question: What gives people courage when they are afraid?
Facilitation: What are Juliet's fears? Rank them from most to least rational.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Juliet drinks the potion? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes. (“My dismal scene I needs must act alone”, Act IV, Scene III, Juliet). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Juliet drinks the potion? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes. (“My dismal scene I needs must act alone”, Act IV, Scene III, Juliet). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes Juliet drinks the potion. Key takeaway: Juliet drinks to Romeo as she enters a deathlike sleep.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Alone, Juliet imagines every horror of the tomb, then drinks.
- **Imagery:** Gothic images of bones, Tybalt "festering in his shroud."
- **Structure:** A soliloquy of mounting fear.

Themes and how they develop

- **death as bridegroom:** Juliet drinks to Romeo as she enters a deathlike sleep.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “me now be left alone, / And let the nurse this night sit up with you; / For, I am sure, you have your” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet).
- **fate and the stars:** From "star-cross'd" in the Prologue to Romeo's "I defy you, stars," the lovers feel steered by fortune, while the plot shows human choices and accidents. In this scene: “For I have need of many orisons / To move the heavens to smile upon my state, / Which, well thou know’st, is cross” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “My dismal scene I needs must act alone” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet) Juliet's solitude.
- “What if it be a poison, which the friar / Subtly hath minister’d to have me dead” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet) Doubt of the Friar.
- “Romeo, I come! this do I drink to thee” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet) Juliet drinks to Romeo.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

> **Claim:** Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes.
> **Evidence:** “My dismal scene I needs must act alone” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet)
> **Reasoning:** She knows "My dismal scene I needs must act alone," doubts "What if it be a poison," imagines the tomb, and still says "Romeo, I come! this do I drink to thee."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history

forefather (noun)	ancestor	*And madly play with my forefather's joints?*	
methinks (verb)	it seems to me	*I fear it is: and yet, methinks, it should not, For he hath still been tried a holy man.*	
thrills (verb)	pierces; shivers	*I have a faint cold fear thrills through my veins, That almost freezes up the heat of life: I'll call them back again to comfort me: Nurse!*	
orisons (noun)	prayers	*Ay, those attires are best: but, gentle nurse, I pray thee, leave me to myself to-night; For I have need of many orisons To move the heavens to smile upon my state, Which, well thou know'st, is cross and full of sin.*	
stifled (verb)	smothered	*Shall I not, then, be stifled in the vault, To whose foul mouth no healthsome air breathes in, And there die strangled ere my Romeo comes?*	

Discussion questions

1. What gives people courage when they are afraid?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate and choice?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Why does Juliet keep a dagger? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: In case the potion fails.
2. What does Juliet keep by her? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A dagger
3. What does she fear the potion might be? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Poison
4. Whom does she imagine in the vault? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Tybalt
5. To whom does she drink? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Romeo
6. Is anyone with her? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: No
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act IV, Scene III" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Juliet sends her mother and the Nurse away and, alone, imagines all that could go wrong: the potion might be poison, she might wake before Romeo, she might go mad among the bones. She drinks to Romeo.

8. Who is on stage in “Act IV, Scene III”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act IV, Scene III” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “And madly play with my forefather’s joints?” What does “forefather” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: forefather: ancestor.

Inferential / analytical

1. How does the soliloquy build tension? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Fears escalate toward madness.
2. What does “Act IV, Scene III” suggest about Juliet drinks the potion? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Juliet's courage peaks.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the imagery in this scene shape what we understand about Juliet drinks the potion? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes. Useful evidence: “My dismal scene I needs must act alone” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet): Juliet's solitude. On imagery: Gothic images of bones, Tybalt "festering in his shroud." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Ay, those attires are best: but, gentle nurse, I pray thee, leave me to myself to-night; For I have need of many orisons To move the heavens to smile upon my state, Which, well…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act IV, Scene III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Juliet sends her mother and the Nurse away and, alone, imagines all that could go wrong: the potion might be poison, she might wake before Romeo, she might go mad among the bones. She drinks to Romeo.
7. How does “Act IV, Scene III” build on “Act IV, Scene II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes. Useful evidence: “What if it be a poison, which the friar / Subtly hath minister’d to have me dead” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet): Doubt of the Friar. On structure: A soliloquy of mounting fear. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a

quoted line.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes. Useful evidence: “Romeo, I come! this do I drink to thee” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet): Juliet drinks to Romeo. On characterization: Alone, Juliet imagines every horror of the tomb, then drinks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “What gives people courage when they are afraid?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does structure appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with fate and choice? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes. Useful evidence: “My dismal scene I needs must act alone” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet): Juliet's solitude. On structure: A soliloquy of mounting fear. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Juliet brave or reckless? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Judgment based on her reasoning.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes. Useful evidence: “What if it be a poison, which the friar / Subtly hath minister’d to have me dead” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet): Doubt of the Friar. Theme link: Juliet drinks to Romeo as she enters a deathlike sleep. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Juliet's courage peaks.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes. Useful evidence: “Romeo, I come! this do I drink to thee” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet): Juliet drinks to Romeo. Theme link: Juliet drinks to Romeo as she enters a deathlike sleep. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes. Useful evidence: “My dismal scene I needs must act alone” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet): Juliet's solitude. On characterization: Alone, Juliet imagines every horror of the tomb, then drinks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act IV, Scene III”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Juliet drinks the potion. [DOK 4 ·

thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes. Useful evidence: “What if it be a poison, which the friar / Subtly hath minister’d to have me dead” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet): Doubt of the Friar. On structure: A soliloquy of mounting fear. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act IV, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes. Useful evidence: “Romeo, I come! this do I drink to thee” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet): Juliet drinks to Romeo. Theme link: Juliet drinks to Romeo as she enters a deathlike sleep. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to violence and the feud: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes. Useful evidence: “My dismal scene I needs must act alone” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet): Juliet's solitude. Theme link: Juliet drinks to Romeo as she enters a deathlike sleep. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes. Useful evidence: “What if it be a poison, which the friar / Subtly hath minister’d to have me dead” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet): Doubt of the Friar. On characterization: Alone, Juliet imagines every horror of the tomb, then drinks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act IV, Scene III” treats Juliet drinks the potion with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes. Useful evidence: “Romeo, I come! this do I drink to thee” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet): Juliet drinks to Romeo. Theme link: Juliet drinks to Romeo as she enters a deathlike sleep. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act IV, Scene IV” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes. Useful evidence: “My dismal scene I needs must act alone” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet):

Juliet's solitude. Theme link: Juliet drinks to Romeo as she enters a deathlike sleep. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Juliet drinks the potion? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes. Useful evidence: “What if it be a poison, which the friar / Subtly hath minister’d to have me dead” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet): Doubt of the Friar. Theme link: Juliet drinks to Romeo as she enters a deathlike sleep. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [short · recall · DOK 1] Why does Juliet keep a dagger?
    Sample answer: In case the potion fails.
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act IV, Scene III, Juliet: “My _____ scene I needs must act alone”
    Key: dismal
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Ay, those attires are best: but, gentle nurse, I pray thee, leave me to myself to-night; For I have need of many orisons To move the heavens to smile upon my state, Which, well thou know’st, is cross and full of sin.”, what does “orisons” most nearly mean?
    A. a fruit tree with many seeds
    B. the Nurse's mistake for "sentence," a wise saying
    C. a marriage settlement for a bride
    D. prayers
    Key: D (prayers)
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Shall I not, then, be _____ in the vault, To whose foul mouth no healthsome air breathes in, And there die strangled ere my Romeo comes?”
    Word bank: forefather, stifled, methinks, thrills
    Key: stifled
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Juliet keep by her?
    A. A ring
    B. A rosary
    C. A dagger
    D. A letter
    Key: C (A dagger)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “I fear it is: and yet, methinks, it should not, For he hath still been tried a holy man.”, what does “methinks” most nearly mean?

   A. silly; obstinate

   B. disasters; chaos

   C. it seems to me

   D. a reviving drink; medicine for the heart

   Key: C (it seems to me)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “And madly play with my forefather’s joints?”, what does “forefather” most nearly mean?

   A. a state of quarrel or disagreement

   B. having sworn falsely

   C. ancestor

   D. trip; make a mistake

   Key: C (ancestor)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Whom does she imagine in the vault?

   A. Romeo

   B. Tybalt

   C. Mercutio

   D. Paris

   Key: B (Tybalt)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act IV, Scene III, Juliet: “What if it be a poison, which the friar / Subtly hath _____’d to have me dead”

   Key: minister

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “What if it be a poison, which the friar / Subtly hath minister’d to have me dead” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Doubt of the Friar.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Romeo, I come! this do I drink to thee” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet)

    A. Juliet drinks to Romeo.

    B. The wedding moved up.

    C. Tybalt's first speech: hatred for its own sake.

    D. Names do not change essence.

    Key: A (Juliet drinks to Romeo.)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act IV, Scene III”?

    A. The Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold

    B. Juliet's feigned obedience

    C. Juliet drinks the potion

    D. Love at first sight at the Capulet feast

    Key: C (Juliet drinks the potion)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “My dismal scene I needs must act alone” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Juliet's solitude.
14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act IV, Scene III”? Gothic images of bones, Tybalt "festering in his shroud."
    A. Characterization
    B. Imagery
    C. Symbolism
    D. Alliteration
    Key: B (Imagery)
15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “My dismal scene I needs must act alone” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet).
    Sample answer: She knows "My dismal scene I needs must act alone," doubts "What if it be a poison," imagines the tomb, and still says "Romeo, I come! this do I drink to thee."
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “My dismal scene I needs must act alone” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Juliet's solitude.
17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “I have a faint cold fear thrills through my veins, That almost freezes up the heat of life: I’ll call them back again to comfort me: Nurse!”, what does “thrills” most nearly mean?
    A. full of grief; woeful
    B. a marriage settlement for a bride
    C. pierces; shivers
    D. stopped (crying)
    Key: C (pierces; shivers)
18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Is anyone with her?
    A. The Nurse
    B. Her mother
    C. No
    D. The Friar
    Key: C (No)
19. [short · inference · DOK 2] How does the soliloquy build tension?
    Sample answer: Fears escalate toward madness.
20. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act IV, Scene III”? Alone, Juliet imagines every horror of the tomb, then drinks.
    A. Metaphor
    B. Allusion
    C. Theme
    D. Characterization
    Key: D (Characterization)

21. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how death as bridegroom develops from an earlier scene to “Act IV, Scene III”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Juliet drinks to Romeo as she enters a deathlike sleep.

22. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does she fear the potion might be?

    A. Water

    B. Wine

    C. Medicine

    D. Poison

    Key: D (Poison)

23. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “My dismal scene I needs must act alone” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet)

    A. Romeo blames fortune.

    B. Capulet's greeting.

    C. Passion overcomes obstacles.

    D. Juliet's solitude.

    Key: D (Juliet's solitude.)

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “What if it be a poison, which the friar / Subtly hath minister’d to have me dead” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet)

    A. Benvolio predicts Romeo will find someone more beautiful than Rosaline.

    B. Romeo hands his course to God or fate.

    C. The Friar shames Romeo.

    D. Doubt of the Friar.

    Key: D (Doubt of the Friar.)

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: She knows "My dismal scene I needs must act alone," doubts "What if it be a poison," imagines the tomb, and still says "Romeo, I come! this do I drink to thee."

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Romeo, I come! this do I drink to thee” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Juliet drinks to Romeo.

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “What if it be a poison, which the friar / Subtly hath minister’d to have me dead” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Doubt of the Friar.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is Juliet brave or reckless?

    Sample answer: Judgment based on her reasoning.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	3, 2, 17, 5, 1, 8, 18, 9, 19, 12, 13, 10, 14, 20, 15, 21	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1

HS Sophomore	22, 4, 17, 3, 9, 6, 11, 10, 12, 23, 24, 20, 14, 15, 25, 21	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	4, 2, 1, 7, 3, 11, 10, 24, 19, 12, 15, 20, 14, 26, 21, 25	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	4, 6, 2, 1, 23, 19, 13, 24, 12, 14, 20, 26, 15, 21, 25, 16	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	4, 7, 9, 19, 23, 11, 24, 26, 15, 20, 14, 27, 28, 16, 25, 21	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Freshman	4, 2, 6, 19, 13, 12, 24, 14, 20, 15, 26, 16, 21, 25, 27, 28	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	2, 4, 24, 10, 19, 12, 11, 20, 26, 15, 14, 25, 28, 21, 16, 27	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Junior	2, 4, 23, 13, 19, 11, 12, 26, 14, 20, 15, 27, 25, 16, 21, 28	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Senior	4, 2, 13, 19, 23, 24, 12, 26, 20, 15, 14, 21, 16, 27, 28, 25	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	4, 2, 13, 10, 19, 12, 24, 26, 20, 14, 15, 21, 16, 28, 25, 27	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act IV, Scene III,” how does Shakespeare show Juliet drinks the potion? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act IV, Scene III, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Juliet drinks the potion? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act IV, Scene III develops the idea of Juliet drinks the potion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act IV, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Juliet drinks the potion. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act IV, Scene III suggests about Juliet drinks the potion. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act IV, Scene III to complicate the reader's understanding of Juliet drinks the potion. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act IV, Scene III within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Juliet drinks the potion responds to that

context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act IV, Scene III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Juliet drinks the potion follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act IV, Scene III and its treatment of Juliet drinks the potion. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and imagery, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act IV, Scene III as evidence for a larger claim about Juliet drinks the potion in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act IV, Scene III as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Juliet drinks the potion. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

SAT-style questions

1. *And madly play with my forefather's joints?*

   As used in the text, what does the word "forefather" most nearly mean?

   A. ancestor

   B. smothered

   C. prayers

   D. pierces; shivers

2. *Ay, those attires are best: but, gentle nurse, I pray thee, leave me to myself to-night; For I have need of many orisons To move the heavens to smile upon my state, Which, well thou know'st, is cross and full of sin.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act IV, Scene III"?

   A. Love at first sight at the Capulet feast

   B. The divided world of Verona

   C. Juliet drinks the potion

   D. Romeo hears of Juliet's death

SAT key: 1. A (ancestor); 2. C (Juliet drinks the potion)

Lesson 24: Act IV, Scene IV

Focus: wedding preparations

Objective: Students will summarize what happens in Act IV, Scene IV (wedding preparations) in 2 sentences and, in a 3-sentence warm-up response, explain how one quoted line from the scene sets up the scene that follows.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1

Teacher only · spoilers

At dawn the Capulet household bustles. Capulet jokes with servants and sends the Nurse to wake Juliet.

Background: Servants prepared feasts through the night.

Significance: The calm before discovery.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why might a writer insert comedy before tragedy? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to time and haste because....
Prompt: Why might a writer insert comedy before tragedy?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to time and haste because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: "Make haste, make haste" echoes through the house.

8–16 min · Background and context · I do (8 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Servants prepared feasts through the night. The calm before discovery. Irony: The household bustles with wedding preparations while Juliet lies "dead." Characterization: Capulet jokes with servants, busy and happy. Structure: A short comic scene before tragedy. Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "you to bed; faith, You'll be sick to-morrow / For this night's watching" (Act IV, Scene IV, Nurse).

16–20 min · Closure · I do (4 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how irony shapes wedding preparations. Key takeaway: "Make haste, make haste" echoes through the house.

Total: 20 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Irony:** The household bustles with wedding preparations while Juliet lies "dead."
- **Characterization:** Capulet jokes with servants, busy and happy.
- **Structure:** A short comic scene before tragedy.

Themes and how they develop

- **time and haste:** "Make haste, make haste" echoes through the house.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “you to bed; faith, You’ll be sick to-morrow / For this night’s watching” (Act IV, Scene IV, Nurse).
- **haste and time:** Everything happens too fast: a four-day action, a marriage the day after meeting, a wedding moved up a day; Friar Laurence warns "they stumble that run fast." In this scene: “cot-quean, go, / Get you to bed; faith, You’ll be sick to-morrow / For this night’s watching” (Act IV, Scene IV, Nurse).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “They call for dates and quinces in the pastry” (Act IV, Scene IV, Nurse) Household detail.
- “Make haste, I say” (Act IV, Scene IV) Haste again.
- “Go waken Juliet, go and trim her up” (Act IV, Scene IV) Capulet sends the Nurse to Juliet.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The comic bustle increases the dramatic irony of the next scene.
Evidence: “Go waken Juliet, go and trim her up” (Act IV, Scene IV)
Reasoning: The servants hear "Make haste, I say" and Capulet orders "Go waken Juliet, go and trim her up," while the audience knows she lies drugged.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
quinces (noun)	hard yellow fruits used in pastry	*They call for dates and quinces in the pastry.*	
watching (noun)	staying awake through the night	*Go, you cot-quean, go, Get you to bed; faith, You’ll be sick to-morrow For this night’s watching.*	

Discussion questions

1. Why might a writer insert comedy before tragedy?

2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with violence and the feud?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Capulet send for? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Drier logs.
2. What fruit is called for? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Dates and quinces
3. Who is sent to wake Juliet? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The Nurse
4. What time is it? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Early morning
5. What is Capulet's mood? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Cheerful and busy
6. Who is coming with music? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Paris
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act IV, Scene IV" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: At dawn the Capulet household bustles. Capulet jokes with servants and sends the Nurse to wake Juliet.
8. Who is on stage in "Act IV, Scene IV", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act IV, Scene IV" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "They call for dates and quinces in the pastry." What does "quinces" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: quinces: hard yellow fruits used in pastry.

Inferential / analytical

1. What is ironic about the joy? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Juliet lies seemingly dead upstairs.
2. What does "Act IV, Scene IV" suggest about wedding preparations? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The calm before discovery.
3. Find one example of irony in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about wedding preparations? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The comic bustle increases the dramatic irony of the next scene. Useful evidence: “They call for dates and quinces in the pastry” (Act IV, Scene IV, Nurse): Household detail. On characterization: Capulet jokes with servants, busy and happy. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Mass, and well said; a merry whoreson, ha!”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act IV, Scene IV”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: At dawn the Capulet household bustles. Capulet jokes with servants and sends the Nurse to wake Juliet.
7. How does “Act IV, Scene IV” build on “Act IV, Scene III”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The comic bustle increases the dramatic irony of the next scene. Useful evidence: “Make haste, I say” (Act IV, Scene IV): Haste again. On structure: A short comic scene before tragedy. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The comic bustle increases the dramatic irony of the next scene. Useful evidence: “Go waken Juliet, go and trim her up” (Act IV, Scene IV): Capulet sends the Nurse to Juliet. On characterization: Capulet jokes with servants, busy and happy. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Why might a writer insert comedy before tragedy?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does structure appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with violence and the feud? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The comic bustle increases the dramatic irony of the next scene. Useful evidence: “They call for dates and quinces in the pastry” (Act IV, Scene IV, Nurse): Household detail. On structure: A short comic scene before tragedy. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Does this scene deepen or delay the tragedy? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: An evaluation of pacing.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The comic bustle increases the dramatic irony of the

next scene. Useful evidence: “Make haste, I say” (Act IV, Scene IV): Haste again. Theme link: "Make haste, make haste" echoes through the house. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “The calm before discovery.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The comic bustle increases the dramatic irony of the next scene. Useful evidence: “Go waken Juliet, go and trim her up” (Act IV, Scene IV): Capulet sends the Nurse to Juliet. Theme link: "Make haste, make haste" echoes through the house. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The comic bustle increases the dramatic irony of the next scene. Useful evidence: “They call for dates and quinces in the pastry” (Act IV, Scene IV, Nurse): Household detail. On characterization: Capulet jokes with servants, busy and happy. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act IV, Scene IV”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of wedding preparations. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The comic bustle increases the dramatic irony of the next scene. Useful evidence: “Make haste, I say” (Act IV, Scene IV): Haste again. On structure: A short comic scene before tragedy. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act IV, Scene IV”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The comic bustle increases the dramatic irony of the next scene. Useful evidence: “Go waken Juliet, go and trim her up” (Act IV, Scene IV): Capulet sends the Nurse to Juliet. Theme link: "Make haste, make haste" echoes through the house. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to youth and age: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The comic bustle increases the dramatic irony of the next scene. Useful evidence: “They call for dates and quinces in the pastry” (Act IV, Scene IV, Nurse): Household detail. Theme link: "Make haste, make haste" echoes through the house. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the irony in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The comic bustle increases the dramatic irony of the next scene. Useful evidence: “Make haste, I say” (Act IV, Scene IV): Haste again. On irony: The household bustles with wedding preparations while Juliet lies "dead." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act IV, Scene IV” treats wedding preparations with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The comic bustle increases the dramatic irony of the next scene. Useful evidence: “Go waken Juliet, go and trim her up” (Act IV, Scene IV): Capulet sends the Nurse to Juliet. Theme link: "Make haste, make haste" echoes through the house. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act IV, Scene V” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The comic bustle increases the dramatic irony of the next scene. Useful evidence: “They call for dates and quinces in the pastry” (Act IV, Scene IV, Nurse): Household detail. Theme link: "Make haste, make haste" echoes through the house. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about wedding preparations? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The comic bustle increases the dramatic irony of the next scene. Useful evidence: “Make haste, I say” (Act IV, Scene IV): Haste again. Theme link: "Make haste, make haste" echoes through the house. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What time is it?
   A. Midnight
   B. Evening
   C. Noon
   D. Early morning

   Key: D (Early morning)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What fruit is called for?
   A. Dates and quinces

B. Apples and pears

C. Oranges

D. Grapes

Key: A (Dates and quinces)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “They call for dates and _____ in the pastry.” Word bank: quinces, watching

   Key: quinces

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “They call for dates and quinces in the pastry.”, what does “quinces” most nearly mean?

   A. bringing to fullness

   B. hard yellow fruits used in pastry

   C. downfalls; ruinous defeats

   D. fine spider threads floating in the air

   Key: B (hard yellow fruits used in pastry)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Go, you cot-quean, go, Get you to bed; faith, You’ll be sick to-morrow For this night’s _____.” Word bank: watching, quinces

   Key: watching

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act IV, Scene IV, Nurse: “They call for dates and _____ in the pastry”

   Key: quinces

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who is sent to wake Juliet?

   A. The Nurse

   B. Paris

   C. Peter

   D. Lady Capulet

   Key: A (The Nurse)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who is coming with music?

   A. Paris

   B. Romeo

   C. The Prince

   D. Tybalt

   Key: A (Paris)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What is Capulet's mood?

   A. Sad

   B. Angry

   C. Fearful

   D. Cheerful and busy

   Key: D (Cheerful and busy)

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act IV, Scene IV”?

    A. Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition

B. Wedding preparations

C. Wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan

D. The undelivered letter

Key: B (Wedding preparations)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “They call for dates and quinces in the pastry” (Act IV, Scene IV, Nurse) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Household detail.
12. [short · inference · DOK 2] What is ironic about the joy?
    Sample answer: Juliet lies seemingly dead upstairs.
13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “They call for dates and quinces in the pastry” (Act IV, Scene IV, Nurse)

    A. Household detail.

    B. The Friar's warning.

    C. Juliet's courage.

    D. Juliet drinks to Romeo.

    Key: A (Household detail.)
14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The comic bustle increases the dramatic irony of the next scene. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Go waken Juliet, go and trim her up” (Act IV, Scene IV).
    Sample answer: The servants hear "Make haste, I say" and Capulet orders "Go waken Juliet, go and trim her up," while the audience knows she lies drugged.
15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Go waken Juliet, go and trim her up” (Act IV, Scene IV). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Capulet sends the Nurse to Juliet.
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Does this scene deepen or delay the tragedy?
    Sample answer: An evaluation of pacing.
17. [short · recall · DOK 1] What does Capulet send for?
    Sample answer: Drier logs.
18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Go, you cot-quean, go, Get you to bed; faith, You’ll be sick to-morrow For this night’s watching.”, what does “watching” most nearly mean?

    A. thoughtful and sad

    B. call up (a spirit) by a magic spell

    C. without proper regard

    D. staying awake through the night

    Key: D (staying awake through the night)
19. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Go waken Juliet, go and trim her up” (Act IV, Scene IV)

    A. The apothecary's excuse.

    B. Capulet sends the Nurse to Juliet.

    C. Love wants instant messages.

    D. Romeo forgets Rosaline in a line.

Key: B (Capulet sends the Nurse to Juliet.)

20. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Make haste, I say” (Act IV, Scene IV) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Haste again.
21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? "Make haste, make haste" echoes through the house.
    A. Time and haste
    B. Love and desire
    C. Violence and the feud
    D. Fate and choice

    Key: A (Time and haste)
22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act IV, Scene IV”? The household bustles with wedding preparations while Juliet lies "dead."
    A. Metaphor
    B. Irony
    C. Plot
    D. Allusion

    Key: B (Irony)
23. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Make haste, I say” (Act IV, Scene IV) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Haste again.
24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act IV, Scene IV”? Capulet jokes with servants, busy and happy.
    A. Structure
    B. Metaphor
    C. Tone / mood
    D. Characterization

    Key: D (Characterization)
25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The comic bustle increases the dramatic irony of the next scene.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: The servants hear "Make haste, I say" and Capulet orders "Go waken Juliet, go and trim her up," while the audience knows she lies drugged.
26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how time and haste develops from an earlier scene to “Act IV, Scene IV”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: "Make haste, make haste" echoes through the house.
27. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act IV, Scene IV: “Go waken _____, go and trim her up”
    Key: Juliet
28. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Make haste, I say” (Act IV, Scene IV)
    A. For Romeo, exile is the end of the world.
    B. Juliet's warning about haste.
    C. Juliet discovers Romeo is a Montague.

D. Haste again.

Key: D (Haste again.)

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "They call for dates and quinces in the pastry" (Act IV, Scene IV, Nurse) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: Household detail.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 6, 18, 7, 2, 1, 5, 8, 11, 19, 10, 20, 21, 22, 14, 23	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	3, 5, 17, 2, 7, 1, 12, 10, 11, 20, 19, 15, 24, 22, 25, 26	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	27, 6, 8, 7, 4, 28, 11, 10, 20, 12, 14, 22, 15, 24, 23, 29	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	5, 4, 7, 3, 10, 13, 12, 20, 11, 21, 22, 14, 24, 23, 25, 16	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	3, 5, 8, 13, 11, 10, 20, 15, 21, 22, 14, 24, 26, 25, 16, 23	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	3, 5, 8, 20, 12, 11, 10, 24, 15, 14, 21, 22, 26, 23, 29, 25	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	3, 6, 11, 13, 28, 19, 24, 14, 22, 15, 21, 16, 26, 23, 25, 29	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	3, 5, 20, 11, 19, 12, 15, 22, 24, 14, 21, 23, 26, 16, 29, 25	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Senior	5, 3, 20, 19, 12, 11, 22, 14, 24, 15, 21, 16, 26, 25, 29, 23	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	3, 5, 12, 11, 28, 13, 21, 15, 14, 24, 22, 29, 25, 23, 16, 26	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act IV, Scene IV," how does Shakespeare show wedding preparations? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In Act IV, Scene IV, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of wedding preparations? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act IV, Scene IV develops the idea of wedding preparations. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act IV, Scene IV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of wedding preparations. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act IV, Scene IV suggests about wedding preparations. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses irony in Act IV, Scene IV to complicate the reader's understanding of wedding preparations. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act IV, Scene IV within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of wedding preparations responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act IV, Scene IV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of wedding preparations follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act IV, Scene IV and its treatment of wedding preparations. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's irony and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act IV, Scene IV as evidence for a larger claim about wedding preparations in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act IV, Scene IV as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of wedding preparations. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

SAT-style questions

1. *Mass, and well said; a merry whoreson, ha! Thou shalt be logger-head. Good faith, 'tis day: The county will be here with music straight, For so he said he would: I hear him near. Music within. Nurse! Wife! What, ho! What, nurse, I say!*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act IV, Scene IV"?

   A. The Friar's desperate plan

   B. Wedding preparations

   C. The Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold

   D. Mercutio's death and Tybalt's

SAT key: 1. B (Wedding preparations)

Lesson 25: Act IV, Scene V

Focus: the household mourns

Objective: Students will analyze how imagery develops in "Act IV, Scene V" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Critical voice: "As the audience know that Juliet is not dead, this scene is, perhaps, excusable. But it is a strong warning to minor dramatists not to introduce at one time many separate characters agitated by one and the same circumstance. It is difficult to understand what effect, whether that of pity or of laughter, Shakspeare meant to produce;--the occasion and the characteristic speeches are so little in harmony! For example, what the Nurse says is excellently suited to the Nurse's character, but grotesquely unsuited to the occasion." (Samuel Taylor Coleridge, poet and critic, *Notes on Romeo and Juliet, in The Literary Remains of Samuel Taylor Coleridge, Vol. 2 (1836), note on Act IV, Scene v*; public domain). Staging question: play IV.v for pity or for laughter? Students block it both ways and justify a choice. *Objective:* Evaluate the mixed tone of the mourning scene. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.5

Content note (alcohol): The Nurse calls 'Some aqua vitae, ho!' (brandy as a restorative) when she finds Juliet apparently dead.
Student preview: Heads-up: this section includes alcohol.
Suggested language: "What does this language show about the speaker?"

Teacher only · spoilers

The Nurse finds Juliet apparently dead. The family and Paris lament. The Friar urges them to carry her to church. Musicians joke with Peter.

Background: Funeral rites included rosemary and flowers.

Significance: Death becomes Juliet's bridegroom.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How do people express grief differently? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to death as bridegroom because.... Content note before we start: Heads-up: this section includes alcohol.
Prompt: How do people express grief differently?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to death as bridegroom because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Capulet's image makes the motif explicit.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: crotchets — whims; also quarter notes in music; confusions — disasters; chaos; griping — gripping painfully; pestilent — annoying; troublesome; mourners — people who grieve at a funeral. "confusions": Origin of "confusion": Old French confusion; earlier Latin confusio. "mourners": Origin of "mourner": an English formation from mourn + -er.
Words: crotchets: whims; also quarter notes in music · confusions: disasters; chaos · griping: gripping painfully · pestilent: annoying; troublesome · mourners: people who grieve at a funeral

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Funeral rites included rosemary and flowers. Death becomes Juliet's bridegroom. Imagery: Death as Juliet's bridegroom: "Death is my son-in-law." Characterization: The family's laments; the Friar's consoling speech hides his knowledge. Structure: The musicians' jokes after the laments. Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "your pennyworths now; / Sleep for a week; for the next night, I warrant, / The County Paris hath set up his rest, / That" (Act IV, Scene V, Nurse).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Death lies on her like an untimely frost" slowly and put it in my own words: Finding Juliet seemingly dead, Capulet says death lies on her like an untimely frost on the sweetest flower. Next, craft. I notice the image of an early frost killing a flower before it has fully bloomed. The strongest word is "frost": it suggests death that comes too early, ending a young life in spring. Then, effect. How does Capulet describe Juliet's apparent death? My answer: Capulet grieves deeply for the daughter he threatened days earlier; the audience knows she lives, so his grief is dramatic irony that foreshadows her real death.

> *Death lies on her like an untimely frost* (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Death lies on her like an untimely frost" slowly and put it in my own words: Finding Juliet seemingly dead, Capulet says death lies on her like an untimely frost on the sweetest flower. Next, craft. I notice the image of an early frost killing a flower before it has fully bloomed. The strongest word is "frost": it suggests death that comes too early, ending a young life in spring. Then, effect. How does Capulet describe Juliet's apparent death? My answer: Capulet grieves deeply for the daughter he threatened days earlier; the audience knows she lives, so his grief is dramatic irony that foreshadows her real death.

40–50 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (10 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Every wedding item is used for a funeral instead. Expected link: death as bridegroom. Ask: How does this line connect to death as bridegroom? Expected: Capulet's image makes the motif explicit. (Death as bridegroom.)

> *Death is my son-in-law, Death is my heir* (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Every wedding item is used for a funeral instead. Expected link: death as bridegroom.
Ask: How does this line connect to death as bridegroom?
Expected answer: Capulet's image makes the motif explicit. (Death as bridegroom.)

50–55 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (5 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for imagery, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the household mourns? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene V develops the idea of the household mourns. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language and action. When the text says "All things that we ordained festival, / Turn from their office to black funeral" (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet), it shows this directly. Capulet says "Death is my son-in-law" and "All things that we ordained festival, / Turn from their office to black funeral."
Task: Annotate the scene for imagery, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the household mourns? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene V develops the idea of the household mourns. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language and action. When the text says "All things that we ordained festival, / Turn from their office to black funeral" (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet), it shows this directly. Capulet says "Death is my son-in-law" and "All things that we ordained festival, / Turn from their office to black funeral."

55–60 min · Discussion · We do (5 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: How do people express grief differently? Are the family's grief and the Friar's speech sincere? How should it be staged?
Anchor question: How do people express grief differently?
Facilitation: Are the family's grief and the Friar's speech sincere? How should it be staged?

60–67 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the household mourns? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language and action. ("All things that we ordained festival, / Turn from their office to black funeral", Act IV, Scene V, Capulet). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the household mourns? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language and action. ("All things that we ordained festival, / Turn from their office to black funeral", Act IV, Scene V, Capulet). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

67–70 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how imagery shapes the household mourns. Key takeaway: Capulet's image makes the motif explicit.

Total: 70 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Imagery:** Death as Juliet's bridegroom: "Death is my son-in-law."
- **Characterization:** The family's laments; the Friar's consoling speech hides his knowledge.
- **Structure:** The musicians' jokes after the laments.

Themes and how they develop

- **death as bridegroom:** Capulet's image makes the motif explicit.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "your pennyworths now; / Sleep for a week; for the next night, I warrant, / The County Paris hath set up his rest, / That" (Act IV, Scene V, Nurse).
- **fate and the stars:** From "star-cross'd" in the Prologue to Romeo's "I defy you, stars," the lovers feel steered by fortune, while the plot shows human choices and accidents. In this scene: "ho, for shame! confusion's cure lives not / In these confusions. Heaven and yourself / Had part in this fair maid; now heaven hath" (Act IV, Scene V, Friar Laurence).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Death lies on her like an untimely frost" (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet) Capulet's lament.
- "Death is my son-in-law, Death is my heir" (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet) Death as bridegroom.

- "All things that we ordained festival, / Turn from their office to black funeral" (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet) Wedding turns to funeral.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language and action.
Evidence: "All things that we ordained festival, / Turn from their office to black funeral" (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet)
Reasoning: Capulet says "Death is my son-in-law" and "All things that we ordained festival, / Turn from their office to black funeral."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
crotchets (noun)	whims; also quarter notes in music	*I will carry no crotchets: I'll re you, I'll fa you; do you note me?*	
confusions (noun)	disasters; chaos	*Peace, ho, for shame! confusion's cure lives not In these confusions.*	"confusions": Origin of "confusion": Old French confusion; earlier Latin confusio. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/confusion#Etymology)
griping (adjective)	gripping painfully	*Answer me like men: "When griping grief the heart doth wound, And doleful dumps the mind oppress, Then music with her silver sound"— why "silver sound"? why "music with her silver sound"?*	
pestilent (adjective)	annoying; troublesome	*What a pestilent knave is this same!*	
mourners (noun)	people who grieve at a funeral	*Come, we'll in here; tarry for the mourners, and stay dinner.*	"mourners": Origin of "mourner": an English formation from mourn + -er. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/mourner#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. How do people express grief differently?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with youth and age?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded

support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What herb does the Friar mention? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Rosemary.
2. Who finds Juliet? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The Nurse
3. What does Capulet call Death? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: His son-in-law
4. What does the Friar urge? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Take her to church
5. Who jokes afterward? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The musicians and Peter
6. What turns into funeral items? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Wedding preparations
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act IV, Scene V" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The Nurse finds Juliet apparently dead. The family and Paris lament. The Friar urges them to carry her to church. Musicians joke with Peter.
8. Who is on stage in "Act IV, Scene V", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act IV, Scene V" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "I will carry no crotchets: I'll re you, I'll fa you; do you note me?" What does "crotchets" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: crotchets: whims; also quarter notes in music.

Inferential / analytical

1. Is the Friar's speech hypocritical? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: He consoles grief he knows is unnecessary.
2. What does "Act IV, Scene V" suggest about the household mourns? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Death becomes Juliet's bridegroom.
3. Find one example of imagery in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the household mourns? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language and action. Useful evidence: “Death lies on her like an untimely frost” (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet): Capulet's lament. On characterization: The family's laments; the Friar's consoling speech hides his knowledge. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “Then have at you with my wit!”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act IV, Scene V”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: The Nurse finds Juliet apparently dead. The family and Paris lament. The Friar urges them to carry her to church. Musicians joke with Peter.
7. How does “Act IV, Scene V” build on “Act IV, Scene IV”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language and action. Useful evidence: “Death is my son-in-law, Death is my heir” (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet): Death as bridegroom. On structure: The musicians' jokes after the laments. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language and action. Useful evidence: “All things that we ordained festival, / Turn from their office to black funeral” (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet): Wedding turns to funeral. On characterization: The family's laments; the Friar's consoling speech hides his knowledge. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “How do people express grief differently?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does structure appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with youth and age? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language and action. Useful evidence: “Death lies on her like an untimely frost” (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet): Capulet's lament. On structure: The musicians' jokes after the laments. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Why include comic musicians? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Relief and realism.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language and action. Useful evidence: “Death is my son-in-law, Death is my heir” (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet): Death

as bridegroom. Theme link: Capulet's image makes the motif explicit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “Death becomes Juliet's bridegroom.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language and action. Useful evidence: “All things that we ordained festival, / Turn from their office to black funeral” (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet): Wedding turns to funeral. Theme link: Capulet's image makes the motif explicit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language and action. Useful evidence: “Death lies on her like an untimely frost” (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet): Capulet's lament. On characterization: The family's laments; the Friar's consoling speech hides his knowledge. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act IV, Scene V”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the household mourns. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language and action. Useful evidence: “Death is my son-in-law, Death is my heir” (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet): Death as bridegroom. On structure: The musicians' jokes after the laments. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act IV, Scene V”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language and action. Useful evidence: “All things that we ordained festival, / Turn from their office to black funeral” (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet): Wedding turns to funeral. Theme link: Capulet's image makes the motif explicit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to time and haste: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language and action. Useful evidence: “Death lies on her like an untimely frost” (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet): Capulet's lament. Theme link: Capulet's image makes the motif explicit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the imagery in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language and action. Useful evidence: “Death is my son-in-law, Death is my heir” (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet): Death as bridegroom. On imagery: Death as Juliet's bridegroom: "Death is my son-in-law." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act IV, Scene V” treats the household mourns with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language and action. Useful evidence: “All things that we ordained festival, / Turn from their office to black funeral” (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet): Wedding turns to funeral. Theme link: Capulet's image makes the motif explicit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act V, Scene I” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language and action. Useful evidence: “Death lies on her like an untimely frost” (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet): Capulet's lament. Theme link: Capulet's image makes the motif explicit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the household mourns? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language and action. Useful evidence: “Death is my son-in-law, Death is my heir” (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet): Death as bridegroom. Theme link: Capulet's image makes the motif explicit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act IV, Scene V, Capulet: “All things that we _____ festival, / Turn from their office to black funeral”
   Key: ordained
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does the Friar urge?
   A. Take her to church
   B. Wait
   C. Tell Romeo

D. Call a doctor

Key: A (Take her to church)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “What a pestilent knave is this same!”, what does “pestilent” most nearly mean?

   A. waves (a weapon) about in a showy way

   B. speaking affectedly

   C. annoying; troublesome

   D. coal-sellers, a byword for dirty, insulted men

   Key: C (annoying; troublesome)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who finds Juliet?

   A. Paris

   B. The Friar

   C. The Nurse

   D. Capulet

   Key: C (The Nurse)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What turns into funeral items?

   A. Letters

   B. Feasts

   C. Swords

   D. Wedding preparations

   Key: D (Wedding preparations)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “I will carry no crotchets: I’ll re you, I’ll fa you; do you note me?”, what does “crotchets” most nearly mean?

   A. a common weed whose leaf was used to treat cuts

   B. marzipan, a sweet almond paste

   C. whims; also quarter notes in music

   D. reach; the limit of one's ability

   Key: C (whims; also quarter notes in music)

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Come, we’ll in here; tarry for the _____, and stay dinner.” Word bank: crotchets, griping, confusions, mourners

   Key: mourners

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Answer me like men: “When griping grief the heart doth wound, And doleful dumps the mind oppress, Then music with her silver sound”— why “silver sound”? why “music with her silver sound”?”, what does “griping” most nearly mean?

   A. a parish officer who keeps the peace

   B. call up (a spirit) by a magic spell

   C. pierces; shivers

   D. gripping painfully

   Key: D (gripping painfully)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Capulet call Death?

   A. A thief

   B. His enemy

   C. His son-in-law

   D. A friend

   Key: C (His son-in-law)

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “All things that we ordained festival, / Turn from their office to black funeral” (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet)

    A. The Friar's doubt about Romeo's love.

    B. Capulet now assumes obedience.

    C. Lady Capulet's book metaphor for a husband.

    D. Wedding turns to funeral.

    Key: D (Wedding turns to funeral.)

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Death is my son-in-law, Death is my heir” (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet)

    A. Death as bridegroom.

    B. The letter returned.

    C. Love wants instant messages.

    D. Juliet as the sun.

    Key: A (Death as bridegroom.)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Death lies on her like an untimely frost” (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet)

    A. Capulet's lament.

    B. Mercutio's mock spell.

    C. Mercutio's dying curse on the feud.

    D. Capulet asks Paris to wait.

    Key: A (Capulet's lament.)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Death lies on her like an untimely frost” (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Capulet's lament.

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language and action. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “All things that we ordained festival, / Turn from their office to black funeral” (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet).

    Sample answer: Capulet says "Death is my son-in-law" and "All things that we ordained festival, / Turn from their office to black funeral."

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “All things that we ordained festival, / Turn from their office to black funeral” (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Wedding turns to funeral.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language and action.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: Capulet says "Death is my son-in-law" and "All things that we ordained festival, / Turn from their office to black funeral."

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act IV, Scene V, Capulet: “Death lies on her like an _____ frost”

    Key: untimely

18. [short · recall · DOK 1] What herb does the Friar mention?

    Sample answer: Rosemary.

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Peace, ho, for shame! confusion’s cure lives not In these confusions.”, what does “confusions” most nearly mean?

    A. a man of noble rank

    B. kept company

    C. deny under oath; take back

    D. disasters; chaos

    Key: D (disasters; chaos)

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who jokes afterward?

    A. Tybalt

    B. Paris

    C. Capulet

    D. The musicians and Peter

    Key: D (The musicians and Peter)

21. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Death is my son-in-law, Death is my heir” (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Death as bridegroom.

22. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act IV, Scene V”?

    A. Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation

    B. The household mourns

    C. Juliet waits for the Nurse

    D. Capulet sets the wedding to Paris

    Key: B (The household mourns)

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act IV, Scene V”? Death as Juliet's bridegroom: "Death is my son-in-law."

    A. Setting

    B. Simile

    C. Hyperbole

    D. Imagery

    Key: D (Imagery)

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Why include comic musicians?

    Sample answer: Relief and realism.

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Death is my son-in-law, Death is my heir" (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Death as bridegroom.
26. [short · inference · DOK 2] Is the Friar's speech hypocritical?
    Sample answer: He consoles grief he knows is unnecessary.
27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in "Act IV, Scene V"? The family's laments; the Friar's consoling speech hides his knowledge.
    A. Conflict
    B. Theme
    C. Simile
    D. Characterization
    Key: D (Characterization)
28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how death as bridegroom develops from an earlier scene to "Act IV, Scene V". Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Capulet's image makes the motif explicit.
29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Death lies on her like an untimely frost" (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Capulet's lament.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 18, 4, 19, 2, 20, 7, 5, 21, 10, 13, 22, 15, 14, 23, 16	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	17, 20, 8, 6, 3, 7, 22, 10, 12, 11, 13, 14, 23, 15, 24, 25	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	6, 7, 8, 18, 17, 26, 10, 11, 13, 12, 15, 27, 14, 23, 28, 25	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	7, 2, 9, 1, 12, 22, 10, 13, 26, 23, 15, 14, 27, 29, 25, 28	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	7, 17, 19, 12, 22, 10, 26, 27, 15, 23, 14, 28, 16, 25, 24, 29	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Freshman	17, 18, 7, 21, 10, 26, 11, 15, 23, 14, 27, 16, 24, 29, 28, 25	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	7, 17, 10, 22, 12, 11, 21, 23, 14, 27, 15, 28, 24, 29, 16, 25	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Junior	7, 17, 22, 13, 11, 26, 21, 27, 23, 15, 14, 29, 16, 25, 28, 24	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Senior	1, 7, 22, 10, 21, 12, 26, 23, 14, 27, 15, 25, 29, 28, 24, 16	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	7, 17, 11, 12, 26, 13, 21, 15, 27, 14, 23, 16, 24, 28, 29, 25	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act IV, Scene V,” how does Shakespeare show the household mourns? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Act IV, Scene V, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the household mourns? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act IV, Scene V develops the idea of the household mourns. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act IV, Scene V (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of the household mourns. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act IV, Scene V suggests about the household mourns. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses imagery in Act IV, Scene V to complicate the reader's understanding of the household mourns. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act IV, Scene V within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the household mourns responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act IV, Scene V alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the household mourns follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act IV, Scene V and its treatment of the household mourns. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's imagery and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act IV, Scene V as evidence for a larger claim about the household mourns in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act IV, Scene V as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the household mourns. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

SAT-style questions

1. *I will carry no crotchets: I'll re you, I'll fa you; do you note me?*

   As used in the text, what does the word "crotchets" most nearly mean?

   A. people who grieve at a funeral

   B. annoying; troublesome

   C. whims; also quarter notes in music

   D. gripping painfully

2. *Then have at you with my wit! I will dry-beat you with an iron wit, and put up my iron dagger. Answer me like men: "When griping grief the heart doth wound, And doleful dumps the mind oppress, Then music with her silver sound"— why "silver sound"? why "music with her silver sound"? What say you, Simon Catling?*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act IV, Scene V"?

   A. Juliet hears the news

   B. Wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan

   C. Juliet's feigned obedience

   D. The household mourns

SAT key: 1. C (whims; also quarter notes in music); 2. D (The household mourns)

Lesson 26: Act V, Scene I

Focus: Romeo hears of Juliet's death

Objective: Students will analyze how irony develops in “Act V, Scene I” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Critical voice: “But why does Shakespeare give Romeo this involuntary cheerfulness just before the extremity of unhappiness? Perhaps to shew the vanity of trusting to those uncertain and casual exaltations or depressions, which many consider as certain foretokens of good and evil.” (Samuel Johnson, critic and lexicographer, *Notes to Romeo and Juliet, The Plays of William Shakespeare (1765), in Preface to Shakespeare, together with selected notes on some of the plays, note on Act V, Scene i ("My bosom's Lord sits lightly on this throne")*; public domain). Irony check: list every omen in the play. Which come true, and which mislead? *Objective:* Analyze dramatic irony in Romeo's dream before the news. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.4

Content note (suicide (planned), poison, alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): Believing Juliet dead, Romeo buys poison from the apothecary to die beside her. Use the safe-messaging script; focus on misinformation and haste, not the method. This section mentions drinking or a drug (“…will. Put this in any liquid thing you will, And drink it off; and, if you had the strength Of…”). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: A character decides to take his own life after false news. Support is available if this is hard to read.
Suggested language: “What mistake drives Romeo's decision, and how might it have been prevented?”
Safe messaging: Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this scene is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

In Mantua Romeo dreams happily. Balthasar arrives saying Juliet is dead. Romeo resolves to die beside her and buys poison from a poor apothecary.

Background: Selling poison was illegal and punishable by death.

Significance: Romeo acts instantly.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What is the danger of acting on first news? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and choice because.... Content note before we start: A character decides to take his own life after false news. Support is available if this is hard to read. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.
Prompt: What is the danger of acting on first news?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and choice because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Romeo defies the stars, but in doing so fulfils the Prologue.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: forerun — come before; anticipate; compounds — mixtures; drugs; presage — foretell; dispatch — kill quickly; cordial — a reviving drink; medicine for the heart. "cordial": Origin: Old French cordial.
Words: forerun: come before; anticipate · compounds: mixtures; drugs · presage: foretell · dispatch: kill quickly · cordial: a reviving drink; medicine for the heart

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Selling poison was illegal and punishable by death. Romeo acts instantly. Dramatic irony: Romeo dreams that Juliet found him dead and revived him; then hears she is dead. Characterization: Romeo's decision is instant: "Then I defy you, stars!" Imagery: The apothecary's shop of poverty. Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "bosom's lord sits lightly in his throne; / And all this day an unaccustom'd spirit / Lifts me above the ground with cheerful thoughts" (Act V, Scene I, Romeo).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Is it even so? then I defy you, stars" slowly and put it in my own words: Hearing that Juliet is dead, Romeo cries that he defies the stars and plans to leave at once. Next, craft. I notice the short, abrupt cry, which shows he makes his decision instantly without thinking. The strongest word is "defy": it means to challenge or resist openly, here the fate written in the stars. Then, effect. What does Romeo mean when he defies the stars? My answer: When Romeo defies the stars, he means he rejects the fate that took Juliet and will choose his own end by dying with her; ironically his rash defiance fulfils the Prologue's star-crossed prophecy.

> *Is it even so? then I defy you, stars* (Act V, Scene I, Romeo)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Is it even so? then I defy you, stars" slowly and put it in my own words: Hearing that Juliet is dead, Romeo cries that he defies the stars and plans to leave at once. Next, craft. I notice the short, abrupt cry, which shows he makes his decision instantly without thinking. The strongest word is "defy": it means to challenge or resist openly, here the fate written in the stars. Then, effect. What does Romeo mean when he defies the stars? My answer: When Romeo defies the stars, he means he rejects the fate that took Juliet and will choose his own end by dying with her; ironically his rash defiance fulfils the Prologue's star-crossed prophecy.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Romeo means he will challenge fate itself. Expected link: fate and choice. Ask: How does this line connect to fate and choice? Expected: Romeo defies the stars, but in doing so fulfils the Prologue. (Romeo resolves to die.)

> *Well, Juliet, I will lie with thee to-night* (Act V, Scene I, Romeo)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Romeo means he will challenge fate itself. Expected link: fate and choice.
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and choice?
Expected answer: Romeo defies the stars, but in doing so fulfils the Prologue. (Romeo resolves to die.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for dramatic irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Romeo hears of Juliet's death? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene I develops the idea of Romeo hears of Juliet's death. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it. When the text says "Well, Juliet, I will lie with thee to-night" (Act V, Scene I, Romeo), it shows this directly. He cries "then I defy you, stars!" and resolves "Juliet, I will lie with thee to-night," buying poison from a man whose "poverty, but not my will, consents."
Task: Annotate the scene for dramatic irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Romeo hears of Juliet's death? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene I develops the idea of Romeo hears of Juliet's death. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it. When the text says "Well, Juliet, I will lie with thee to-night" (Act V, Scene I, Romeo), it shows this directly. He cries "then I defy you, stars!" and resolves "Juliet, I will lie with thee to-night," buying poison from a man whose "poverty, but not my will, consents."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What is the danger of acting on first news? Is the apothecary guilty? What does his line about poverty show?
Anchor question: What is the danger of acting on first news?
Facilitation: Is the apothecary guilty? What does his line about poverty show?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Romeo hears of Juliet's death? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it. ("Well, Juliet, I will lie with thee to-night", Act V, Scene I, Romeo). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Romeo hears of Juliet's death? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it. ("Well, Juliet, I will lie with thee to-night", Act V, Scene I, Romeo). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how dramatic irony shapes Romeo hears of Juliet's death. Key takeaway: Romeo defies the stars, but in doing so fulfils the Prologue.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Dramatic irony:** Romeo dreams that Juliet found him dead and revived him; then hears she is dead.
- **Characterization:** Romeo's decision is instant: "Then I defy you, stars!"
- **Imagery:** The apothecary's shop of poverty.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and choice:** Romeo defies the stars, but in doing so fulfils the Prologue.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “bosom’s lord sits lightly in his throne; / And all this day an unaccustom’d spirit / Lifts me above the ground with cheerful thoughts” (Act V, Scene I, Romeo).
- **fate and the stars:** From "star-cross'd" in the Prologue to Romeo's "I defy you, stars," the lovers feel steered by fortune, while the plot shows human choices and accidents. In this scene: “Is it even so? then I defy you, stars! / Thou know’st my lodging: get me ink and paper, / And hire” (Act V, Scene I, Romeo).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Is it even so? then I defy you, stars” (Act V, Scene I, Romeo) Romeo's defiance.
- “Well, Juliet, I will lie with thee to-night” (Act V, Scene I, Romeo) Romeo resolves to die.
- “My poverty, but not my will, consents” (Act V, Scene I, Apothecary) The apothecary's excuse.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it.
Evidence: “Well, Juliet, I will lie with thee to-night” (Act V, Scene I, Romeo)
Reasoning: He cries "then I defy you, stars!" and resolves "Juliet, I will lie with thee to-night," buying poison from a man whose "poverty, but not my will, consents."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
forerun (verb)	come before; anticipate	*O, this same thought did but forerun my need; And this same needy man must sell it me.*	
compounds (noun)	mixtures; drugs	*There is thy gold, worse poison to men’s souls, Doing more murders in this*	

		loathsome world, Than these poor compounds that thou mayst not sell.	
presage (verb)	foretell	*If I may trust the flattering truth of sleep, My dreams presage some joyful news at hand: My bosom's lord sits lightly in his throne; And all this day an unaccustom'd spirit Lifts me above the ground with cheerful thoughts.*	
dispatch (verb)	kill quickly	*Put this in any liquid thing you will, And drink it off; and, if you had the strength Of twenty men, it would dispatch you straight.*	
cordial (noun)	a reviving drink; medicine for the heart	*Come, cordial and not poison, go with me To Juliet's grave; for there must I use thee.*	"cordial": Origin: Old French cordial. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/cordial#Etymology)
caitiff (adjective)	wretched; miserable	*Noting this penury, to myself I said "An if a man did need a poison now, Whose sale is present death in Mantua, Here lives a caitiff wretch would sell it him."*	
misadventure (noun)	bad luck; a disastrous accident	*I do beseech you, sir, have patience: Your looks are pale and wild, and do import Some misadventure.*	"misadventure": Origin: Old French mesaventure. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/misadventure#Etymology)
loathsome (adjective)	disgusting	*There is thy gold, worse poison to men's souls, Doing more murders in this loathsome world, Than these poor compounds that thou mayst not sell.*	

Discussion questions

1. What is the danger of acting on first news?
2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with time and haste?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What is the apothecary's shop like? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Poor and bare.
2. Who brings the news? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Balthasar
3. What does Romeo buy? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Poison
4. Why does the apothecary sell? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Poverty
5. What does Romeo say to the stars? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: I defy you
6. What did Romeo dream? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Juliet revived him with kisses
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act V, Scene I" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: In Mantua Romeo dreams happily. Balthasar arrives saying Juliet is dead. Romeo resolves to die beside her and buys poison from a poor apothecary.
8. Who is on stage in "Act V, Scene I", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act V, Scene I" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "O, this same thought did but forerun my need; And this same needy man must sell it me." What does "forerun" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: forerun: come before; anticipate.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Romeo call gold worse poison? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Money corrupts more than drugs.
2. What does "Act V, Scene I" suggest about Romeo hears of Juliet's death? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Romeo acts instantly.
3. Find one example of irony in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about Romeo hears of Juliet's death? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it. Useful evidence: "Is it even so? then I defy you, stars" (Act V, Scene I, Romeo): Romeo's defiance. On characterization: Romeo's decision is instant: "Then I defy you, stars!" Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "If I may trust the flattering truth of sleep, My dreams presage some joyful news at hand: My bosom's lord sits lightly in his throne; And all this day an unaccustom'd spirit Lifts…", why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

6. What causes the main turn in “Act V, Scene I”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: In Mantua Romeo dreams happily. Balthasar arrives saying Juliet is dead. Romeo resolves to die beside her and buys poison from a poor apothecary.
7. How does “Act V, Scene I” build on “Act IV, Scene V”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it. Useful evidence: “Well, Juliet, I will lie with thee to-night” (Act V, Scene I, Romeo): Romeo resolves to die. Theme link: Romeo defies the stars, but in doing so fulfils the Prologue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it. Useful evidence: “My poverty, but not my will, consents” (Act V, Scene I, Apothecary): The apothecary's excuse. On characterization: Romeo's decision is instant: "Then I defy you, stars!" Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “What is the danger of acting on first news?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does imagery appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with time and haste? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it. Useful evidence: “Is it even so? then I defy you, stars” (Act V, Scene I, Romeo): Romeo's defiance. On imagery: The apothecary's shop of poverty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Was Romeo's decision avoidable? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Weighing haste and information.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it. Useful evidence: “Well, Juliet, I will lie with thee to-night” (Act V, Scene I, Romeo): Romeo resolves to die. Theme link: Romeo defies the stars, but in doing so fulfils the Prologue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Romeo acts instantly.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it. Useful evidence: “My poverty, but not my will, consents” (Act V, Scene I, Apothecary): The apothecary's excuse. Theme link: Romeo defies the stars, but in doing so fulfils the Prologue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it. Useful evidence: “Is it even so? then I defy you, stars” (Act V, Scene I, Romeo): Romeo's defiance. On characterization: Romeo's decision is instant: "Then I defy you, stars!" Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act V, Scene I”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Romeo hears of Juliet's death. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it. Useful evidence: “Well, Juliet, I will lie with thee to-night” (Act V, Scene I, Romeo): Romeo resolves to die. Theme link: Romeo defies the stars, but in doing so fulfils the Prologue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act V, Scene I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it. Useful evidence: “My poverty, but not my will, consents” (Act V, Scene I, Apothecary): The apothecary's excuse. Theme link: Romeo defies the stars, but in doing so fulfils the Prologue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to love and desire: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it. Useful evidence: “Is it even so? then I defy you, stars” (Act V, Scene I, Romeo): Romeo's defiance. Theme link: Romeo defies the stars, but in doing so fulfils the Prologue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the irony in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it. Useful evidence: “Well, Juliet, I will lie with thee to-night” (Act V, Scene I, Romeo): Romeo resolves to die. Theme link: Romeo defies the stars, but in doing so fulfils the Prologue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act V, Scene I” treats Romeo hears of Juliet's death with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it. Useful evidence: “My poverty, but not my will, consents” (Act V, Scene I, Apothecary): The apothecary's excuse. Theme link: Romeo defies the stars, but in doing so fulfils the Prologue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act V, Scene II” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it. Useful evidence: “Is it even so? then I defy you, stars” (Act V, Scene I, Romeo): Romeo's defiance. Theme link: Romeo defies the stars, but in doing so fulfils the Prologue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Romeo hears of Juliet's death? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it. Useful evidence: “Well, Juliet, I will lie with thee to-night” (Act V, Scene I, Romeo): Romeo resolves to die. Theme link: Romeo defies the stars, but in doing so fulfils the Prologue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “There is thy gold, worse poison to men’s souls, Doing more murders in this loathsome world, Than these poor compounds that thou mayst not sell.”, what does “compounds” most nearly mean?
   A. happening too soon; premature
   B. mixtures; drugs
   C. puzzling; speaking in riddles
   D. a soft dressing applied to soothe pain

   Key: B (mixtures; drugs)
2. [short · recall · DOK 1] What is the apothecary's shop like?
   Sample answer: Poor and bare.
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “If I may trust the flattering truth of sleep, My dreams presage some joyful news at hand: My bosom’s lord sits lightly in his throne; And all this day an unaccustom’d spirit Lifts me above the ground with cheerful…”, what does “presage” most nearly mean?
   A. decoration
   B. it seems to me
   C. foretell
   D. speaking affectedly

   Key: C (foretell)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene I, Apothecary: “My poverty, but not my will, _____”

   Key: consents

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Romeo say to the stars?

   A. Guide me

   B. I thank you

   C. I defy you

   D. Forgive me

   Key: C (I defy you)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “There is thy gold, worse poison to men’s souls, Doing more murders in this _____ world, Than these poor compounds that thou mayst not sell.” Word bank: compounds, loathsome, forerun, presage

   Key: loathsome

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Come, _____ and not poison, go with me To Juliet’s grave; for there must I use thee.” Word bank: compounds, cordial, forerun, presage

   Key: cordial

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Put this in any liquid thing you will, And drink it off; and, if you had the strength Of twenty men, it would dispatch you straight.”, what does “dispatch” most nearly mean?

   A. dark and threatening

   B. kill quickly

   C. a marriage settlement for a bride

   D. families, including their servants and dependents

   Key: B (kill quickly)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene I, Romeo: “Well, _____, I will lie with thee to-night”

   Key: Juliet

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act V, Scene I”?

    A. Wedding preparations

    B. Juliet drinks the potion

    C. Romeo hears of Juliet's death

    D. Juliet, her mother and the Nurse

    Key: C (Romeo hears of Juliet's death)

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Well, Juliet, I will lie with thee to-night” (Act V, Scene I, Romeo)

    A. Passion overcomes obstacles.

    B. Romeo resolves to die.

    C. The Nurse establishes Juliet's age.

    D. Both are bewitched by appearance.

    Key: B (Romeo resolves to die.)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “My poverty, but not my will, consents” (Act V, Scene I, Apothecary)
    A. The Prince's law: the next fight will cost lives.
    B. The Prince blames the feud.
    C. The apothecary's excuse.
    D. Romeo blames love for softening him.

    Key: C (The apothecary's excuse.)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Is it even so? then I defy you, stars” (Act V, Scene I, Romeo) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Romeo's defiance.

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Well, Juliet, I will lie with thee to-night” (Act V, Scene I, Romeo).
    Sample answer: He cries "then I defy you, stars!" and resolves "Juliet, I will lie with thee to-night," buying poison from a man whose "poverty, but not my will, consents."

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “My poverty, but not my will, consents” (Act V, Scene I, Apothecary). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: The apothecary's excuse.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how fate and choice develops from an earlier scene to “Act V, Scene I”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Romeo defies the stars, but in doing so fulfils the Prologue.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “O, this same thought did but forerun my need; And this same needy man must sell it me.”, what does “forerun” most nearly mean?
    A. come before; anticipate
    B. people who abandon the true faith; here, eyes that betray their first love
    C. full of grief; woeful
    D. bring back to obedience

    Key: A (come before; anticipate)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Romeo buy?
    A. A letter
    B. A horse
    C. Poison
    D. A sword

    Key: C (Poison)

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why does the apothecary sell?
    A. Poverty
    B. Fear
    C. Friendship
    D. Greed alone

    Key: A (Poverty)

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who brings the news?

    A. The Nurse

    B. Balthasar

    C. Paris

    D. Friar John

    Key: B (Balthasar)

21. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Well, Juliet, I will lie with thee to-night” (Act V, Scene I, Romeo) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Romeo resolves to die.

22. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does Romeo call gold worse poison?

    Sample answer: Money corrupts more than drugs.

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act V, Scene I”? Romeo dreams that Juliet found him dead and revived him; then hears she is dead.

    A. Structure

    B. Symbolism

    C. Diction / vocabulary

    D. Dramatic irony

    Key: D (Dramatic irony)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Romeo defies the stars, but in doing so fulfils the Prologue.

    A. Love and desire

    B. Youth and age

    C. Fate and choice

    D. Violence and the feud

    Key: C (Fate and choice)

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Is it even so? then I defy you, stars” (Act V, Scene I, Romeo) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Romeo's defiance.

26. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Is it even so? then I defy you, stars” (Act V, Scene I, Romeo)

    A. The lovers are thwarted by the stars; "take their life" means both "are born" and "kill themselves."

    B. Romeo's defiance.

    C. The deaths end the feud: the tragedy has a purpose.

    D. Romeo forgets Rosaline in a line.

    Key: B (Romeo's defiance.)

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act V, Scene I”? Romeo's decision is instant: "Then I defy you, stars!"

    A. Alliteration

    B. Characterization

    C. Structure

D. Allusion

Key: B (Characterization)

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Well, Juliet, I will lie with thee to-night" (Act V, Scene I, Romeo) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Romeo resolves to die.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Was Romeo's decision avoidable?
    Sample answer: Weighing haste and information.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: "Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it." Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: He cries "then I defy you, stars!" and resolves "Juliet, I will lie with thee to-night," buying poison from a man whose "poverty, but not my will, consents."

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Noting this penury, to myself I said "An if a man did need a poison now, Whose sale is present death in Mantua, Here lives a _____ wretch would sell it him."" Word bank: presage, compounds, forerun, caitiff
    Key: caitiff

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 2, 3, 18, 19, 20, 7, 9, 21, 11, 22, 12, 23, 14, 24, 25	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	7, 2, 8, 9, 1, 20, 12, 13, 21, 10, 26, 24, 14, 27, 28, 25	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	8, 3, 6, 20, 7, 10, 22, 26, 12, 11, 23, 27, 14, 15, 25, 29	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	7, 9, 20, 17, 22, 21, 11, 10, 13, 24, 14, 23, 15, 25, 30, 29	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	7, 18, 9, 11, 13, 22, 21, 27, 15, 14, 23, 24, 28, 30, 29, 16	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	7, 1, 4, 13, 10, 11, 12, 15, 23, 27, 14, 24, 25, 16, 30, 28	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	7, 31, 26, 13, 10, 12, 27, 23, 15, 14, 24, 28, 30, 25, 16, 29	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	7, 9, 11, 12, 21, 13, 27, 23, 15, 14, 24, 28, 30, 29, 16, 25	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Senior	7, 31, 11, 10, 21, 26, 27, 23, 14, 24, 15, 25, 16, 29, 28, 30	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	7, 31, 11, 10, 22, 21, 24, 14, 23, 27, 15, 16, 28, 30, 29, 25	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act V, Scene I,” how does Shakespeare show Romeo hears of Juliet's death? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In Act V, Scene I, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Romeo hears of Juliet's death? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene I develops the idea of Romeo hears of Juliet's death. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of Romeo hears of Juliet's death. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene I suggests about Romeo hears of Juliet's death. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses irony in Act V, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of Romeo hears of Juliet's death. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act V, Scene I within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Romeo hears of Juliet's death responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act V, Scene I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Romeo hears of Juliet's death follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act V, Scene I and its treatment of Romeo hears of Juliet's death. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's irony and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act V, Scene I as evidence for a larger claim about Romeo hears of Juliet's death in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act V, Scene I as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Romeo hears of Juliet's death. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

SAT-style questions

1. *If I may trust the flattering truth of sleep, My dreams presage some joyful news at hand: My bosom's lord sits lightly in his throne; And all this day an unaccustom'd spirit Lifts me above the ground with cheerful thoughts.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "presage" most nearly mean?

   A. foretell

   B. disgusting

   C. bad luck; a disastrous accident

   D. wretched; miserable

2. *If I may trust the flattering truth of sleep, My dreams presage some joyful news at hand: My bosom's lord sits lightly in his throne; And all this day an unaccustom'd spirit Lifts me above the ground with cheerful thoughts. I dreamt my lady came and found me dead— Strange dream, that gives a dead man leave to think! — And breathed such life with kisses in my lips, That I revived, and was an emperor. Ah me! how sweet is love itself possess'd, When but love's shadows are so rich in joy!*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act V, Scene I"?

   A. The street brawl and lovesick Romeo

   B. Juliet hears the news

   C. The second Chorus

   D. Romeo hears of Juliet's death

SAT key: 1. A (foretell); 2. D (Romeo hears of Juliet's death)

Lesson 27: Act V, Scene II

Focus: the undelivered letter

Objective: Students will summarize what happens in Act V, Scene II (the undelivered letter) in 2 sentences and, in a 3-sentence warm-up response, explain how one quoted line from the scene sets up the scene that follows.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.3

Teacher only · spoilers

Friar John tells Friar Laurence that he was quarantined and could not deliver the letter. Friar Laurence hurries to the tomb.

Background: Plague quarantines sealed houses.

Significance: Chance undoes the plan.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How do small accidents change big outcomes? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and choice because....
Prompt: How do small accidents change big outcomes?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and choice because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: accident and plague intervene.

8–16 min · Background and context · I do (8 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Plague quarantines sealed houses. Chance undoes the plan. Plot: Friar John was quarantined and could not deliver the letter. Irony: A plague, not a person, stops the message. Characterization: Friar Laurence's urgency and plan to go to the tomb alone. Watch for fate and the stars: From "star-cross'd" in the Prologue to Romeo's "I defy you, stars," the lovers feel steered by fortune, while the plot shows human choices and accidents. In this scene: "Unhappy fortune! by my brotherhood, / The letter was not nice but full of" (Act V, Scene II, Friar Laurence).

16–20 min · Closure · I do (4 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how plot shapes the undelivered letter. Key takeaway: accident and plague intervene.

Total: 20 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Plot:** Friar John was quarantined and could not deliver the letter.
- **Irony:** A plague, not a person, stops the message.
- **Characterization:** Friar Laurence's urgency and plan to go to the tomb alone.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and choice:** accident and plague intervene.

Symbols and motifs

- **fate and the stars:** From "star-cross'd" in the Prologue to Romeo's "I defy you, stars," the lovers feel steered by fortune, while the plot shows human choices and accidents. In this scene: “Unhappy fortune! by my brotherhood, / The letter was not nice but full of” (Act V, Scene II, Friar Laurence).
- **haste and time:** Everything happens too fast: a four-day action, a marriage the day after meeting, a wedding moved up a day; Friar Laurence warns "they stumble that run fast." In this scene: “doors, and would not let us forth; / So that my speed to Mantua there was stay’d” (Act V, Scene II, Friar John).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Where the infectious pestilence did reign, / Seal’d up the doors” (Act V, Scene II, Friar John) The quarantine.
- “I could not send it—here it is again” (Act V, Scene II, Friar John) The letter returned.
- “Poor living corse, closed in a dead man’s tomb” (Act V, Scene II, Friar Laurence) The Friar's image of Juliet.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The tragedy turns on an accident outside anyone's control.
Evidence: “Where the infectious pestilence did reign, / Seal’d up the doors” (Act V, Scene II, Friar John)
Reasoning: Friar John's house was sealed "Where the infectious pestilence did reign," and he says "I could not send it —here it is again."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
neglecting (noun)	delay; neglect	*Unhappy fortune! by my brotherhood, The letter was not nice but full of charge Of dear import, and the neglecting it May do much danger.*	
brotherhood (noun)	religious order of friars	*Unhappy fortune! by my brotherhood, The letter was not nice but full of charge Of dear import, and the neglecting it May do much danger.*	

Discussion questions

1. How do small accidents change big outcomes?
2. Where does plot appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with love and desire?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What will the Friar do with Juliet? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Keep her in his cell.
2. Why was the letter not delivered? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Plague quarantine
3. Who was to deliver it? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Friar John
4. Where does the Friar go? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The tomb
5. How long until Juliet wakes? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Three hours
6. What tool does he ask for? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: An iron crow
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act V, Scene II" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Friar John tells Friar Laurence that he was quarantined and could not deliver the letter. Friar Laurence hurries to the tomb.
8. Who is on stage in "Act V, Scene II", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act V, Scene II" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Unhappy fortune! by my brotherhood, The letter was not nice but full of charge Of dear import, and the neglecting it May do much danger." What does "neglecting" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: neglecting: delay; neglect.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why is the plague important? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Chance blocks communication.
2. What does "Act V, Scene II" suggest about the undelivered letter? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Chance undoes the plan.

3. Find one example of plot in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for key events and the causes linking them.
4. How does the irony in this scene shape what we understand about the undelivered letter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tragedy turns on an accident outside anyone's control. Useful evidence: “Where the infectious pestilence did reign, / Seal’d up the doors” (Act V, Scene II, Friar John): The quarantine. On irony: A plague, not a person, stops the message. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Unhappy fortune!”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act V, Scene II”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Friar John tells Friar Laurence that he was quarantined and could not deliver the letter. Friar Laurence hurries to the tomb.
7. How does “Act V, Scene II” build on “Act V, Scene I”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tragedy turns on an accident outside anyone's control. Useful evidence: “I could not send it—here it is again” (Act V, Scene II, Friar John): The letter returned. Theme link: accident and plague intervene. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tragedy turns on an accident outside anyone's control. Useful evidence: “Poor living corse, closed in a dead man’s tomb” (Act V, Scene II, Friar Laurence): The Friar's image of Juliet. On characterization: Friar Laurence's urgency and plan to go to the tomb alone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “How do small accidents change big outcomes?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with love and desire? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tragedy turns on an accident outside anyone's control. Useful evidence: “Where the infectious pestilence did reign, / Seal’d up the doors” (Act V, Scene II, Friar John): The quarantine. On characterization: Friar Laurence's urgency and plan to go to the tomb alone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is the Friar culpable? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Judgment of his choices.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tragedy turns on an accident outside anyone's control. Useful evidence: “I could not send it—here it is again” (Act V, Scene II, Friar John): The letter returned. Theme link: accident and plague intervene. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Chance undoes the plan.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tragedy turns on an accident outside anyone's control. Useful evidence: “Poor living corse, closed in a dead man’s tomb” (Act V, Scene II, Friar Laurence): The Friar's image of Juliet. Theme link: accident and plague intervene. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tragedy turns on an accident outside anyone's control. Useful evidence: “Where the infectious pestilence did reign, / Seal’d up the doors” (Act V, Scene II, Friar John): The quarantine. On characterization: Friar Laurence's urgency and plan to go to the tomb alone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act V, Scene II”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the undelivered letter. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tragedy turns on an accident outside anyone's control. Useful evidence: “I could not send it—here it is again” (Act V, Scene II, Friar John): The letter returned. Theme link: accident and plague intervene. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act V, Scene II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tragedy turns on an accident outside anyone's control. Useful evidence: “Poor living corse, closed in a dead man’s tomb” (Act V, Scene II, Friar Laurence): The Friar's image of Juliet. Theme link: accident and plague intervene. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to fate and choice: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tragedy turns on an accident outside anyone's control. Useful evidence: “Where the infectious pestilence did reign, / Seal’d up the doors” (Act V, Scene II, Friar John): The quarantine. Theme link: accident and plague intervene. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the plot in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tragedy turns on an accident outside anyone's control. Useful evidence: “I could not send it—here it is again” (Act V, Scene II, Friar John): The letter returned. On plot: Friar John was quarantined and could not deliver the letter. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act V, Scene II” treats the undelivered letter with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tragedy turns on an accident outside anyone's control. Useful evidence: “Poor living corse, closed in a dead man’s tomb” (Act V, Scene II, Friar Laurence): The Friar's image of Juliet. Theme link: accident and plague intervene. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act V, Scene III” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tragedy turns on an accident outside anyone's control. Useful evidence: “Where the infectious pestilence did reign, / Seal’d up the doors” (Act V, Scene II, Friar John): The quarantine. Theme link: accident and plague intervene. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the undelivered letter? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tragedy turns on an accident outside anyone's control. Useful evidence: “I could not send it—here it is again” (Act V, Scene II, Friar John): The letter returned. Theme link: accident and plague intervene. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Plot:** look for key events and the causes linking them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene II, Friar John: “Where the _____ pestilence did reign, / Seal’d up the doors”
   Key: infectious
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How long until Juliet wakes?
   A. Ten minutes
   B. A day
   C. Three hours

D. One hour

Key: C (Three hours)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Unhappy fortune! by my brotherhood, The letter was not nice but full of charge Of dear import, and the _____ it May do much danger." Word bank: brotherhood, neglecting

   Key: neglecting

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why was the letter not delivered?

   A. Forgotten

   B. Stolen

   C. Lost

   D. Plague quarantine

   Key: D (Plague quarantine)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who was to deliver it?

   A. Friar John

   B. Balthasar

   C. The Nurse

   D. Peter

   Key: A (Friar John)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene II, Friar Laurence: "Poor _____ corse, closed in a dead man's tomb"

   Key: living

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Unhappy fortune! by my brotherhood, The letter was not nice but full of charge Of dear import, and the neglecting it May do much danger.", what does "neglecting" most nearly mean?

   A. delay; neglect

   B. bad luck; a disastrous accident

   C. call up (a spirit) by a magic spell

   D. a false and damaging statement

   Key: A (delay; neglect)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Unhappy fortune! by my _____, The letter was not nice but full of charge Of dear import, and the neglecting it May do much danger." Word bank: brotherhood, neglecting

   Key: brotherhood

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where does the Friar go?

   A. Mantua

   B. The tomb

   C. Capulet

   D. The Prince

   Key: B (The tomb)

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “I could not send it—here it is again” (Act V, Scene II, Friar John) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The letter returned.
11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act V, Scene II”?
    A. The street brawl and lovesick Romeo
    B. The undelivered letter
    C. Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell
    D. The divided world of Verona

    Key: B (The undelivered letter)
12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I could not send it—here it is again” (Act V, Scene II, Friar John)
    A. The letter returned.
    B. Wedding turns to funeral.
    C. The Prince blames the feud.
    D. Juliet's solitude.

    Key: A (The letter returned.)
13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Where the infectious pestilence did reign, / Seal’d up the doors” (Act V, Scene II, Friar John) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The quarantine.
14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Poor living corse, closed in a dead man’s tomb” (Act V, Scene II, Friar Laurence). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: The Friar's image of Juliet.
15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act V, Scene II”? Friar John was quarantined and could not deliver the letter.
    A. Plot
    B. Allusion
    C. Hyperbole
    D. Irony

    Key: A (Plot)
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is the Friar culpable?
    Sample answer: Judgment of his choices.
17. [short · recall · DOK 1] What will the Friar do with Juliet?
    Sample answer: Keep her in his cell.
18. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why is the plague important?
    Sample answer: Chance blocks communication.
19. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Where the infectious pestilence did reign, / Seal’d up the doors” (Act V, Scene II, Friar John)
    A. Mercutio's nickname for Tybalt (Tybalt is a cat's name in fables).
    B. Names do not change essence.
    C. Romeo's defiance.

D. The quarantine.

Key: D (The quarantine.)

20. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act V, Scene II”? A plague, not a person, stops the message.

A. Diction / vocabulary

B. Personification

C. Theme

D. Irony

Key: D (Irony)

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Unhappy fortune! by my brotherhood, The letter was not nice but full of charge Of dear import, and the neglecting it May do much danger.”, what does “brotherhood” most nearly mean?

A. religious order of friars

B. it seems to me

C. disobedient

D. changeable; not faithful

Key: A (religious order of friars)

22. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What tool does he ask for?

A. A sword

B. A torch only

C. A rope

D. An iron crow

Key: D (An iron crow)

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Accident and plague intervene.

A. Fate and choice

B. Youth and age

C. Love and desire

D. Violence and the feud

Key: A (Fate and choice)

24. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The tragedy turns on an accident outside anyone's control. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Where the infectious pestilence did reign, / Seal’d up the doors” (Act V, Scene II, Friar John).

Sample answer: Friar John's house was sealed "Where the infectious pestilence did reign," and he says "I could not send it—here it is again."

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I could not send it—here it is again” (Act V, Scene II, Friar John) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: The letter returned.

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The tragedy turns on an accident outside anyone's control.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: Friar John's house was sealed "Where the infectious pestilence did reign," and he says "I could not send it—here it is again."

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Where the infectious pestilence did reign, / Seal’d up the doors” (Act V, Scene II, Friar John) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The quarantine.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how fate and choice develops from an earlier scene to “Act V, Scene II”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: accident and plague intervene.

29. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Poor living corse, closed in a dead man’s tomb” (Act V, Scene II, Friar Laurence)

    A. The quarantine.

    B. The Friar's image of Juliet.

    C. The letter returned.

    D. Juliet's careful, obedient answer.

    Key: B (The Friar's image of Juliet.)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	3, 4, 9, 7, 2, 6, 5, 17, 18, 11, 13, 19, 20, 14, 15, 16	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	8, 21, 22, 7, 17, 3, 11, 12, 10, 19, 13, 23, 20, 24, 25, 16	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	3, 8, 9, 21, 2, 18, 13, 10, 19, 11, 20, 24, 15, 14, 26, 25	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	3, 1, 9, 5, 18, 19, 11, 10, 13, 14, 20, 15, 24, 25, 26, 27	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	3, 8, 5, 12, 18, 19, 10, 23, 14, 15, 20, 24, 28, 27, 16, 26	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	9, 6, 3, 11, 18, 10, 12, 23, 15, 20, 14, 24, 27, 16, 25, 26	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	3, 6, 13, 12, 29, 10, 20, 23, 14, 15, 24, 27, 28, 25, 26, 16	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	3, 8, 18, 13, 29, 10, 14, 20, 23, 15, 24, 25, 28, 26, 27, 16	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Senior	1, 3, 12, 18, 19, 11, 14, 20, 23, 15, 24, 27, 16, 26, 28, 25	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	3, 8, 10, 12, 13, 18, 23, 20, 24, 14, 15, 26, 27, 25, 16, 28	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act V, Scene II,” how does Shakespeare show the undelivered letter? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the plot you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act V, Scene II, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the undelivered letter? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the plot in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene II develops the idea of the undelivered letter. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its plot shape the reader's understanding of the undelivered letter. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene II suggests about the undelivered letter. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's plot and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses plot in Act V, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of the undelivered letter. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act V, Scene II within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the undelivered letter responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act V, Scene II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the undelivered letter follows or bends those conventions, using the plot as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act V, Scene II and its treatment of the undelivered letter. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's plot and irony, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act V, Scene II as evidence for a larger claim about the undelivered letter in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act V, Scene II as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the undelivered letter. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

SAT-style questions

1. *Unhappy fortune! by my brotherhood, The letter was not nice but full of charge Of dear import, and the neglecting it May do much danger. Friar John, go hence; Get me an iron crow, and bring it straight Unto my cell.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act V, Scene II"?

   A. Capulet sets the wedding to Paris

   B. Wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan

   C. Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation

   D. The undelivered letter

SAT key: 1. D (The undelivered letter)

Lesson 28: Act V, Scene III

Focus: the tomb

Objective: Students will analyze how irony develops in “Act V, Scene III” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Critical voice: “Under his handling, it has become a glorious song of praise on that inexpressible feeling which ennobles the soul and gives to it its highest sublimity, and which elevates even the senses into soul, while at the same time it is a melancholy elegy on its inherent and imparted frailty; it is at once the apotheosis and the obsequies of love.” (August Wilhelm Schlegel, critic and translator of Shakespeare, *Lectures on Dramatic Art and Literature (1809-11), trans. John Black, Lecture XXV, Lecture XXV*; public domain). Exit ticket: "apotheosis and obsequies," celebration and funeral. Which does the ending of V.iii stress more? *Objective:* Determine the tragedy's final meaning at the tomb. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.2

Content note (suicide, death, alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): Romeo dies by poison and Juliet by a dagger; Paris is killed. Use the safe-messaging script; discuss the Prince's verdict and the waste of young lives, not methods. This section mentions drinking or a drug (“…ison, I see, hath been his timeless end: O churl! drunk all, and left no friendly drop To help…”). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: The ending shows three deaths, two by suicide. Support is available if this is hard to read.
Suggested language: “Who does the Prince say is responsible, and do you agree?”
Safe messaging: Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this scene is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

Paris mourns at the tomb; Romeo arrives, kills him, and drinks poison beside Juliet. The Friar arrives as Juliet wakes; she refuses to leave and stabs herself. The watch gathers; the Friar confesses; Montague and Capulet reconcile.

Background: Tombs were family vaults; the watch kept order.

Significance: The tragedy's resolution.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Can tragedy bring peace? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and choice because.... Content note before we start: The ending shows three deaths, two by suicide. Support is available if this is hard to read. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.
Prompt: Can tragedy bring peace?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and choice because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: The Prince blames the families: "all are punish'd."

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: conjurations — solemn appeals; timeless — untimely; premature; conspires — plots; works together; startles — bursts out in alarm; mattock — a digging tool like a pickaxe. "conjurations": Origin of "conjuration": Middle French conjuration; earlier Old French conjuracion. "conspires": Origin of "conspire": Old French conspirer; earlier Latin conspirare.
Words: conjurations: solemn appeals · timeless: untimely; premature · conspires: plots; works together · startles: bursts out in alarm · mattock: a digging tool like a pickaxe

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Tombs were family vaults; the watch kept order. The tragedy's resolution. Dramatic irony: Romeo notices Juliet's colour returning yet still drinks. Plot: Paris dies, Romeo dies, Juliet wakes and dies; the Friar confesses and the families reconcile. Imagery: Light in the tomb: Juliet's beauty "makes / This vault a feasting presence full of light." Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "Enter Paris, and his Page bearing flowers and a torch" (Act V, Scene III).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Thus with a kiss I die" slowly and put it in my own words: In the tomb, having drunk the poison, Romeo dies saying that thus, with a kiss, he dies. Next, craft. I notice the simple, quiet words and the pairing of the kiss with his death. The strongest word is "kiss": it joins love and death in one final act. Then, effect. What do Romeo's last words show? My answer: Romeo's last words show that he dies loving Juliet, joining a kiss and death, while believing she is dead only moments before she wakes; his final act completes the play's link between passion and death.

> *Thus with a kiss I die* *(Act V, Scene III, Romeo)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Thus with a kiss I die" slowly and put it in my own words: In the tomb, having drunk the poison, Romeo dies saying that thus, with a kiss, he dies. Next, craft. I notice the simple, quiet words and the pairing of the kiss with his death. The strongest word is "kiss": it joins love and death in one final act. Then, effect. What do Romeo's last words show? My answer: Romeo's last words show that he dies loving Juliet, joining a kiss and death, while believing she is dead only moments before she wakes; his final act completes the play's link between passion and death.

40–50 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (10 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The Prince means the deaths are a punishment for their hate. Expected link: violence and the feud. Ask: How does this line connect to fate and choice? Expected: The Prince blames the families: "all are punish'd." (The Prince blames the feud.)

> *See, what a scourge is laid upon your hate* *(Act V, Scene III, Prince)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The Prince means the deaths are a punishment for their hate. Expected link: violence and the feud.
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and choice?
Expected answer: The Prince blames the families: "all are punish'd." (The Prince blames the feud.)

50–55 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (5 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for dramatic irony, plot (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the tomb? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene III develops the idea of the tomb. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and plot shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate. When the text says "See, what a scourge is laid upon your hate" (Act V, Scene III, Prince), it shows this directly. After "Thus with a kiss I die" and "O happy dagger!" the Prince tells the fathers "See, what a scourge is laid upon your hate."
Task: Annotate the scene for dramatic irony, plot (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the tomb? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene III develops the idea of the tomb. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and plot shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate. When the text says "See, what a scourge is laid upon your hate" (Act V, Scene III, Prince), it shows this directly. After "Thus with a kiss I die" and "O happy dagger!" the Prince tells the fathers "See, what a scourge is laid upon your hate."

55–60 min · Discussion · We do (5 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Can tragedy bring peace? Does the reconciliation make the deaths meaningful?
Anchor question: Can tragedy bring peace?
Facilitation: Does the reconciliation make the deaths meaningful?

60–67 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the tomb? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate. ("See, what a scourge is laid upon your hate", Act V, Scene III, Prince). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the tomb? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate. ("See, what a scourge is laid upon your hate", Act V, Scene III, Prince). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

67–70 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how dramatic irony shapes the tomb. Key takeaway: The Prince blames the families: "all are punish'd."

Total: 70 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Dramatic irony:** Romeo notices Juliet's colour returning yet still drinks.
- **Plot:** Paris dies, Romeo dies, Juliet wakes and dies; the Friar confesses and the families reconcile.
- **Imagery:** Light in the tomb: Juliet's beauty "makes / This vault a feasting presence full of light."

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and choice:** The Prince blames the families: "all are punish'd."

Symbols and motifs

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “Enter Paris, and his Page bearing flowers and a torch” (Act V, Scene III).
- **fate and the stars:** From "star-cross'd" in the Prologue to Romeo's "I defy you, stars," the lovers feel steered by fortune, while the plot shows human choices and accidents. In this scene: “pry / In what I further shall intend to do, / By heaven, I will tear thee joint by joint / And strew this hungry” (Act V, Scene III, Romeo).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Thus with a kiss I die” (Act V, Scene III, Romeo) Romeo's last words.
- “O happy dagger … This is thy sheath” (Act V, Scene III, Juliet) Juliet's death.
- “See, what a scourge is laid upon your hate” (Act V, Scene III, Prince) The Prince blames the feud.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate.
Evidence: “See, what a scourge is laid upon your hate” (Act V, Scene III, Prince)
Reasoning: After "Thus with a kiss I die" and "O happy dagger!" the Prince tells the fathers "See, what a scourge is laid upon your hate."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
conjurations (noun)	solemn appeals	*I do defy thy conjurations, And apprehend thee for a felon here.*	“conjurations”: Origin of “conjuration”: Middle French conjuration; earlier Old French conjuracion. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/conjuration#Etymology)

timeless (adjective)	untimely; premature	*Poison, I see, hath been his timeless end: O churl! drunk all, and left no friendly drop To help me after?*	
conspires (verb)	plots; works together	*Alas, my liege, my wife is dead to-night; Grief of my son's exile hath stopp'd her breath: What further woe conspires against mine age?*	"conspires": Origin of "conspire": Old French conspirer; earlier Latin conspirare. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/conspire#Etymology)
startles (verb)	bursts out in alarm	*What fear is this which startles in our ears?*	
mattock (noun)	a digging tool like a pickaxe	*Enter Romeo and Balthasar, with a torch, mattock, etc.*	
masterless (adjective)	without an owner	*What mean these masterless and gory swords To lie discolour'd by this place of peace?*	
unhallow (adjective)	unholy	*Stop thy unhallow'd toil, vile Montague!*	
jointure (noun)	a marriage settlement for a bride	*O brother Montague, give me thy hand: This is my daughter's jointure, for no more Can I demand.*	
impeach (verb)	accuse	*I am the greatest, able to do least, Yet most suspected, as the time and place Doth make against me, of this direful murder; And here I stand, both to impeach and purge Myself condemned and myself excused.*	"impeach": Origin: Middle English empechen; earlier Anglo-Norman empecher. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/impeach#Etymology)
restorative (noun)	a medicine that restores	*I will kiss thy lips; Haply some poison yet doth hang on them, To make die with a restorative.*	

Discussion questions

1. Can tragedy bring peace?
2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate and choice?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Who has died besides the lovers? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Paris and Lady Montague.
2. Who does Romeo kill at the tomb? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Paris
3. How does Romeo die? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Poison
4. How does Juliet die? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Romeo's dagger
5. What do the fathers promise? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Golden statues
6. Who confesses? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Friar Laurence
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act V, Scene III" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Paris mourns at the tomb; Romeo arrives, kills him, and drinks poison beside Juliet. The Friar arrives as Juliet wakes; she refuses to leave and stabs herself. The watch gathers; the Friar confesses; Montague and Capulet reconcile.
8. Who is on stage in "Act V, Scene III", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act V, Scene III" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "I do defy thy conjurations, And apprehend thee for a felon here." What does "conjurations" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: conjurations: solemn appeals.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Juliet refuse to leave? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: She will not live without Romeo.
2. What does "Act V, Scene III" suggest about the tomb? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The tragedy's resolution.
3. Find one example of irony in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
4. How does the plot in this scene shape what we understand about the tomb? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for key events and the causes linking them.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate. Useful evidence: "Thus with a kiss I die" (Act V, Scene III, Romeo): Romeo's last words. On plot: Paris dies, Romeo dies, Juliet wakes and dies; the Friar confesses and the families reconcile. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "This is that banish'd haughty Montague, That murder'd my love's cousin, with which grief, It is supposed, the fair creature died; And here is come to do some villainous shame To…", why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations.

[DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

6. What causes the main turn in “Act V, Scene III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Paris mourns at the tomb; Romeo arrives, kills him, and drinks poison beside Juliet. The Friar arrives as Juliet wakes; she refuses to leave and stabs herself. The watch gathers; the Friar confesses; Montague and Capulet reconcile.
7. How does “Act V, Scene III” build on “Act V, Scene II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate. Useful evidence: “O happy dagger … This is thy sheath” (Act V, Scene III, Juliet): Juliet's death. Theme link: The Prince blames the families: "all are punish'd." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate. Useful evidence: “See, what a scourge is laid upon your hate” (Act V, Scene III, Prince): The Prince blames the feud. Theme link: The Prince blames the families: "all are punish'd." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Can tragedy bring peace?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does imagery appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with fate and choice? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate. Useful evidence: “Thus with a kiss I die” (Act V, Scene III, Romeo): Romeo's last words. On imagery: Light in the tomb: Juliet's beauty "makes / This vault a feasting presence full of light." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Who is most to blame? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned judgment.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate. Useful evidence: “O happy dagger … This is thy sheath” (Act V, Scene III, Juliet): Juliet's death. Theme link: The Prince blames the families: "all are punish'd." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The tragedy's resolution.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate. Useful evidence: “See, what a scourge is laid upon your hate” (Act V, Scene III, Prince): The Prince blames the feud. Theme link: The Prince blames the families: "all are punish'd." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate. Useful evidence: “Thus with a kiss I die” (Act V, Scene III, Romeo): Romeo's last words. Theme link: The Prince blames the families: "all are punish'd." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act V, Scene III”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the tomb. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate. Useful evidence: “O happy dagger … This is thy sheath” (Act V, Scene III, Juliet): Juliet's death. Theme link: The Prince blames the families: "all are punish'd." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act V, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate. Useful evidence: “See, what a scourge is laid upon your hate” (Act V, Scene III, Prince): The Prince blames the feud. Theme link: The Prince blames the families: "all are punish'd." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to violence and the feud: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate. Useful evidence: “Thus with a kiss I die” (Act V, Scene III, Romeo): Romeo's last words. Theme link: The Prince blames the families: "all are punish'd." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the irony in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate. Useful evidence: “O happy dagger … This is thy sheath” (Act V, Scene III, Juliet): Juliet's death. Theme link: The Prince blames the families: "all are punish'd." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act V, Scene III” treats the tomb with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2,

SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate. Useful evidence: “See, what a scourge is laid upon your hate” (Act V, Scene III, Prince): The Prince blames the feud. Theme link: The Prince blames the families: "all are punish'd." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. As the final scene, does this ending resolve fate and choice? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate. Useful evidence: “Thus with a kiss I die” (Act V, Scene III, Romeo): Romeo's last words. Theme link: The Prince blames the families: "all are punish'd." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the tomb? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate. Useful evidence: “O happy dagger … This is thy sheath” (Act V, Scene III, Juliet): Juliet's death. Theme link: The Prince blames the families: "all are punish'd." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Plot**: key events and the causes linking them
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Poison, I see, hath been his timeless end: O churl! drunk all, and left no friendly drop To help me after?”, what does “timeless” most nearly mean?

   A. brave; courageous

   B. untimely; premature

   C. lands; domains

   D. supplies of food and drink

   Key: B (untimely; premature)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does Romeo die?

   A. Fall

   B. Dagger

   C. Poison

   D. Sword

   Key: C (Poison)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does Juliet die?

   A. Romeo's dagger

   B. Poison

   C. Grief

   D. A fall

   Key: A (Romeo's dagger)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What do the fathers promise?

   A. Banishment

   B. A feast

   C. A duel

   D. Golden statues

   Key: D (Golden statues)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene III, Juliet: "O happy _____ … This is thy sheath"

   Key: dagger

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "O brother Montague, give me thy hand: This is my daughter's _____, for no more Can I demand." Word bank: jointure, timeless, conspires, conjurations

   Key: jointure

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "I do defy thy conjurations, And apprehend thee for a felon here.", what does "conjurations" most nearly mean?

   A. helps; avails

   B. smothered

   C. solemn appeals

   D. going along with a crowd

   Key: C (solemn appeals)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "What mean these _____ and gory swords To lie discolour'd by this place of peace?" Word bank: timeless, masterless, conjurations, conspires

   Key: masterless

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who confesses?

   A. Paris

   B. The Nurse

   C. Friar Laurence

   D. Balthasar

   Key: C (Friar Laurence)

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does Juliet refuse to leave?

    Sample answer: She will not live without Romeo.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? "Thus with a kiss I die" (Act V, Scene III, Romeo)

    A. Capulet says Juliet's consent matters; compare Act III, Scene V.

B. Romeo's last words.

C. Death as bridegroom.

D. Love wants instant messages.

Key: B (Romeo's last words.)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act V, Scene III”?

A. The Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold

B. The tomb

C. The balcony scene

D. Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition

Key: B (The tomb)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “See, what a scourge is laid upon your hate” (Act V, Scene III, Prince)

A. The Prince blames the feud.

B. Household detail.

C. The Friar's doubt about Romeo's love.

D. Juliet's careful, obedient answer.

Key: A (The Prince blames the feud.)

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? The Prince blames the families: "all are punish'd."

A. Violence and the feud

B. Fate and choice

C. Youth and age

D. Love and desire

Key: B (Fate and choice)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “See, what a scourge is laid upon your hate” (Act V, Scene III, Prince).

Sample answer: After "Thus with a kiss I die" and "O happy dagger!" the Prince tells the fathers "See, what a scourge is laid upon your hate."

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: After "Thus with a kiss I die" and "O happy dagger!" the Prince tells the fathers "See, what a scourge is laid upon your hate."

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Alas, my liege, my wife is dead to-night; Grief of my son’s exile hath stopp’d her breath: What further woe conspires against mine age?”, what does “conspires” most nearly mean?

A. wanderers, possibly the fleeing sun's horses

B. badly wounded or mutilated

C. plots; works together

D. without careful thought; rash

Key: C (plots; works together)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “What fear is this which startles in our ears?”, what does “startles” most nearly mean?

    A. beg; ask earnestly

    B. downfalls; ruinous defeats

    C. bursts out in alarm

    D. a low bed on wheels kept under a larger one

    Key: C (bursts out in alarm)

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Stop thy _____’d toil, vile Montague!” Word bank: timeless, unhallow, conjurations, conspires

    Key: unhallow

20. [short · recall · DOK 1] Who has died besides the lovers?

    Sample answer: Paris and Lady Montague.

21. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “O happy dagger … This is thy sheath” (Act V, Scene III, Juliet) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Juliet's death.

22. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “See, what a scourge is laid upon your hate” (Act V, Scene III, Prince). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: The Prince blames the feud.

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act V, Scene III”? Paris dies, Romeo dies, Juliet wakes and dies; the Friar confesses and the families reconcile.

    A. Plot

    B. Metaphor

    C. Diction / vocabulary

    D. Symbolism

    Key: A (Plot)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act V, Scene III”? Romeo notices Juliet's colour returning yet still drinks.

    A. Characterization

    B. Dramatic irony

    C. Tone / mood

    D. Allusion

    Key: B (Dramatic irony)

25. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Enter Romeo and Balthasar, with a torch, _____, etc.” Word bank: conspires, conjurations, timeless, mattock

    Key: mattock

26. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Thus with a kiss I die” (Act V, Scene III, Romeo) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Romeo's last words.

27. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “O happy dagger … This is thy sheath” (Act V, Scene III, Juliet)

    A. Juliet's death.

B. Oxymorons express shock at Romeo's act.

C. Capulet asks Paris to wait.

D. Mercutio's mock spell.

Key: A (Juliet's death.)

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Who is most to blame?
    Sample answer: A reasoned judgment.
29. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who does Romeo kill at the tomb?

    A. Balthasar

    B. Paris

    C. Tybalt

    D. The Friar

    Key: B (Paris)
30. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene III, Prince: “See, what a _____ is laid upon your hate”
    Key: scourge
31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Thus with a kiss I die” (Act V, Scene III, Romeo) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Romeo's last words.
32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how fate and choice develops from an earlier scene to “Act V, Scene III”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: The Prince blames the families: "all are punish'd."
33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “O happy dagger … This is thy sheath” (Act V, Scene III, Juliet) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Juliet's death.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	7, 17, 2, 1, 18, 19, 5, 20, 12, 13, 21, 11, 22, 23, 24, 16	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	5, 25, 4, 2, 1, 8, 12, 26, 27, 10, 13, 24, 22, 14, 28, 16	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	2, 25, 9, 29, 30, 26, 21, 12, 27, 13, 14, 15, 23, 22, 16, 28	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	25, 1, 19, 3, 12, 26, 11, 21, 27, 23, 14, 22, 15, 31, 28, 32	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	5, 20, 8, 27, 12, 10, 11, 22, 14, 15, 23, 24, 32, 16, 31, 28	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	17, 30, 25, 21, 13, 10, 27, 22, 15, 24, 14, 23, 16, 33, 32, 28	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
	6, 25, 11, 12, 10, 27, 15, 23, 24, 22, 14, 16, 31, 32, 28, 33	

College Sophomore		recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	5, 25, 13, 11, 27, 10, 23, 15, 24, 14, 22, 33, 28, 31, 32, 16	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Senior	25, 8, 21, 10, 26, 27, 24, 15, 23, 22, 14, 32, 31, 28, 16, 33	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	25, 8, 10, 11, 21, 12, 24, 22, 23, 15, 14, 28, 32, 31, 16, 33	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act V, Scene III,” how does Shakespeare show the tomb? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In Act V, Scene III, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the tomb? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene III develops the idea of the tomb. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and plot shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of the tomb. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene III suggests about the tomb. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and plot), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses irony in Act V, Scene III to complicate the reader's understanding of the tomb. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act V, Scene III within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the tomb responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act V, Scene III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the tomb follows or bends those

conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act V, Scene III and its treatment of the tomb. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's irony and plot, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act V, Scene III as evidence for a larger claim about the tomb in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act V, Scene III as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the tomb. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

SAT-style questions

1. *Alas, my liege, my wife is dead to-night; Grief of my son's exile hath stopp'd her breath: What further woe conspires against mine age?*

   As used in the text, what does the word "conspires" most nearly mean?

   A. a medicine that restores

   B. accuse

   C. a marriage settlement for a bride

   D. plots; works together

2. *This is that banish'd haughty Montague, That murder'd my love's cousin, with which grief, It is supposed, the fair creature died; And here is come to do some villainous shame To the dead bodies: I will apprehend him. Comes forward. Stop thy unhallow'd toil, vile Montague! Can vengeance be pursued further than death? Condemned villain, I do apprehend thee: Obey, and go with me; for thou must die.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act V, Scene III"?

   A. Juliet waits for the Nurse

   B. The divided world of Verona

   C. The tomb

   D. Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell

SAT key: 1. D (plots; works together); 2. C (The tomb)

Unit test

Romeo and Juliet: unit test · 90 minutes · 50 questions per rigor version (multiple choice, fill in the blank, short answer). The class rigor level picks the version; student auto-adjust applies.

Short-answer scoring guides

Scaffolded support and HS Freshman (2 points): correct answer in a complete sentence with a detail from the text. HS Sophomore to HS Senior (3 points): claim, one accurate quotation, one sentence of explanation. AP to College Sophomore (4 points): precise claim, two embedded quotations, commentary on word choice or structure, link to theme. College Junior to Graduate (5 points): nuanced thesis, close reading of two passages, synthesis across sections, a competing reading answered. Each item lists a sample answer; partial credit is described in the app.

Unit test: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Dramatis Personae: "_____, kinsman to the prince, and friend to Romeo"

   Key: Mercutio

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who is the prince of Verona?

   A. Escalus
   B. Paris
   C. Capulet
   D. Mercutio

   Key: A (Escalus)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Paris, a young nobleman, kinsman to the prince", what does "nobleman" most nearly mean?

   A. families, including their servants and dependents
   B. weeping noisily
   C. having sworn to give something up
   D. a man of noble rank

   Key: D (a man of noble rank)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Whose son is Romeo?

   A. Capulet's
   B. Montague's
   C. The Prince's
   D. Friar Laurence's

   Key: B (Montague's)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Dramatis Personae: "_____ and Capulet, heads of houses at variance with each other"

   Key: Montague

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What is Mercutio's relation to the Prince?

   A. Enemy

   B. Son

   C. Kinsman

   D. Servant

   Key: C (Kinsman)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In which two places is the play set?

   A. Verona and Florence

   B. Padua and Milan

   C. Verona and Mantua

   D. Venice and Rome

   Key: C (Verona and Mantua)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Paris, a young nobleman, kinsman to the prince”, what does “kinsman” most nearly mean?

   A. fine spider threads floating in the air

   B. a male relative

   C. exchanging blows or words

   D. join into one body

   Key: B (a male relative)

9. [short · recall · DOK 1] Which characters belong to neither the Montague nor the Capulet house?

   Sample answer: Escalus, Paris, Mercutio, the two friars, the apothecary and the citizens.

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Citizens of Verona; several men and women, relations to both houses; maskers, guards, watchmen, and attendants”, what does “maskers” most nearly mean?

    A. prayers

    B. people in masks and costume who join a party

    C. it seems to me

    D. fitting; proper

    Key: B (people in masks and costume who join a party)

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who carries Juliet's message?

    A. Peter only

    B. Friar John

    C. The Nurse

    D. Balthasar

    Key: C (The Nurse)

12. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Ah, mocker! that’s the dog’s name; R is for the—No; I know it begins with some other letter:—and she hath the prettiest _____ of it, of you and rosemary, that it would do you good to hear it.” Word bank: prating, constrains, sententious, rosemary

    Key: sententious

13. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where are Romeo and Juliet to marry?

    A. At the Capulet house

B. In Mantua

C. At St. Peter's Church

D. At Friar Laurence's cell

Key: D (At Friar Laurence's cell)

14. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene IV, Romeo: “Bid her devise / Some means to come to shrift this _____”

Key: afternoon

15. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “The pox of such antic, lisping, affecting fantasticoes; these new tuners of accents!”, what does “lisping” most nearly mean?

A. speaking affectedly

B. kill quickly

C. cheated; tricked

D. the body

Key: A (speaking affectedly)

16. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Doth not rosemary and Romeo begin both with a letter?”, what does “rosemary” most nearly mean?

A. pleading on another's behalf

B. a reviving drink; medicine for the heart

C. left without a husband

D. an herb symbolizing remembrance, used at weddings and funerals

Key: D (an herb symbolizing remembrance, used at weddings and funerals)

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Nurse, _____ me to thy lady and mistress.” Word bank: prating, commend, rosemary, constrains

Key: commend

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio: “More than _____ of cats, I can tell you”

Key: prince

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What has Tybalt sent Romeo?

A. A challenge

B. An apology

C. A warning from the Prince

D. A gift

Key: A (A challenge)

20. [short · recall · DOK 1] What will Romeo's man bring the Nurse?

Sample answer: A rope ladder so Romeo can climb to Juliet that night.

21. [short · recall · DOK 1] What does Capulet send for?

Sample answer: Drier logs.

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act IV, Scene IV: “Go waken _____, go and trim her up”

Key: Juliet

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What time is it?

    A. Midnight

    B. Evening

    C. Noon

    D. Early morning

    Key: D (Early morning)

24. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who is sent to wake Juliet?

    A. The Nurse

    B. Paris

    C. Peter

    D. Lady Capulet

    Key: A (The Nurse)

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Go, you cot-quean, go, Get you to bed; faith, You'll be sick to-morrow For this night's watching.", what does "watching" most nearly mean?

    A. thoughtful and sad

    B. call up (a spirit) by a magic spell

    C. without proper regard

    D. staying awake through the night

    Key: D (staying awake through the night)

26. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "They call for dates and quinces in the pastry.", what does "quinces" most nearly mean?

    A. bringing to fullness

    B. hard yellow fruits used in pastry

    C. downfalls; ruinous defeats

    D. fine spider threads floating in the air

    Key: B (hard yellow fruits used in pastry)

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who is coming with music?

    A. Paris

    B. Romeo

    C. The Prince

    D. Tybalt

    Key: A (Paris)

28. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "They call for dates and _____ in the pastry." Word bank: quinces, watching

    Key: quinces

29. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What fruit is called for?

    A. Dates and quinces

    B. Apples and pears

    C. Oranges

D. Grapes

Key: A (Dates and quinces)

30. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Dramatis Personae"?

A. The secret wedding

B. The divided world of Verona

C. Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation

D. The undelivered letter

Key: B (The divided world of Verona)

31. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? "Mercutio, kinsman to the prince, and friend to Romeo" (Dramatis Personae) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Mercutio stands between the Prince's family and the Montagues.

32. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? "Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at variance with each other" (Dramatis Personae) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The conflict is built into the cast list.

33. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why might it matter that Mercutio and Paris are related to the Prince?

Sample answer: They are outsiders to the feud, so their deaths implicate the Prince's family and the city.

34. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? "Why, is not this better now than groaning for love" (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Mercutio is pleased Romeo is witty again.

35. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? "More than prince of cats, I can tell you" (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Mercutio's nickname for Tybalt (Tybalt is a cat's name in fables).

36. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? "Bid her devise / Some means to come to shrift this afternoon" (Act II, Scene IV, Romeo)

A. Juliet as light in darkness.

B. Passion overcomes obstacles.

C. Romeo sets the wedding plan.

D. Mercutio's mock spell.

Key: C (Romeo sets the wedding plan.)

37. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Act II, Scene IV"?

A. Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition

B. Juliet hears the news

C. Wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan

D. The household mourns

Key: C (Wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan)

38. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? "They call for dates and quinces in the pastry" (Act IV, Scene IV, Nurse) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Household detail.

39. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “They call for dates and quinces in the pastry” (Act IV, Scene IV, Nurse)

    A. Household detail.

    B. The Friar's warning.

    C. Juliet's courage.

    D. Juliet drinks to Romeo.

    Key: A (Household detail.)

40. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Go waken Juliet, go and trim her up” (Act IV, Scene IV)

    A. The apothecary's excuse.

    B. Capulet sends the Nurse to Juliet.

    C. Love wants instant messages.

    D. Romeo forgets Rosaline in a line.

    Key: B (Capulet sends the Nurse to Juliet.)

41. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Make haste, I say” (Act IV, Scene IV) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Haste again.

42. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Dramatis Personae”? The list sorts Verona into the Prince's family (Escalus, Paris, Mercutio), the Montagues and the Capulets. Mercutio and Paris belong to neither house, which matters when the fighting starts.

    A. Point of view

    B. Characterization

    C. Simile

    D. Structure

    Key: B (Characterization)

43. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Servants are listed by house; the quarrel reaches down to every household member.

    A. Love and desire

    B. Violence and the feud

    C. Fate and choice

    D. Youth and age

    Key: B (Violence and the feud)

44. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Bid her devise / Some means to come to shrift this afternoon” (Act II, Scene IV, Romeo). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Romeo sets the wedding plan.

45. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act II, Scene IV”? Mercutio mocks Tybalt as "prince of cats" and a master of duelling rules; he and Romeo trade puns.

    A. Structure

    B. Alliteration

    C. Characterization

D. Theme

Key: C (Characterization)

46. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? "Make haste, make haste" echoes through the house.

A. Time and haste

B. Love and desire

C. Violence and the feud

D. Fate and choice

Key: A (Time and haste)

47. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The comic bustle increases the dramatic irony of the next scene. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Go waken Juliet, go and trim her up” (Act IV, Scene IV).

Sample answer: The servants hear "Make haste, I say" and Capulet orders "Go waken Juliet, go and trim her up," while the audience knows she lies drugged.

48. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Mercutio, kinsman to the prince, and friend to Romeo” (Dramatis Personae) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Mercutio stands between the Prince's family and the Montagues.

49. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] How does the Nurse's behavior in this scene complicate her role as Juliet's protector?

Sample answer: Her bawdy delight and warnings to Romeo show both care and foolishness.

50. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how time and haste develops from an earlier scene to “Act IV, Scene IV”. Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: "Make haste, make haste" echoes through the house.

51. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Whose nephew is Tybalt?

A. Montague's

B. The Prince's

C. Lady Capulet's

D. Lady Montague's

Key: C (Lady Capulet's)

52. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Citizens of Verona; several men and women, relations to both houses; maskers, guards, watchmen, and attendants”, what does “attendants” most nearly mean?

A. commands

B. bringing to fullness

C. servants who wait on a person of rank

D. lying; being untrue

Key: C (servants who wait on a person of rank)

53. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio: “Why, is not this better now than _____ for love”

Key: groaning

54. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “That’s as much as to say, such a case as yours constrains a man to bow in the hams.”, what does “constrains” most nearly mean?

    A. supplies of food and drink

    B. grandfather; an old man

    C. forces

    D. a low bed on wheels kept under a larger one

    Key: C (forces)

55. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Why, is not this a lamentable thing, grandsire, that we should be thus afflicted with these strange flies, these fashion-_____, these perdona-mi’s, who stand so much on the new form, that they cannot sit at ease on the old bench?” Word bank: prating, constrains, mongers, rosemary

    Key: mongers

56. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Well, sir; my mistress is the sweetest lady—Lord, Lord! when ’twas a little prating thing:—O, there is a nobleman in town, one Paris, that would fain lay knife aboard; but she, good soul, had as lief see a toad, a very…”, what does “prating” most nearly mean?

    A. increase; make (grief) multiply

    B. chattering

    C. an enclosed garden of fruit trees

    D. carefree, playful people

    Key: B (chattering)

57. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Go, you cot-quean, go, Get you to bed; faith, You’ll be sick to-morrow For this night’s _____.” Word bank: watching, quinces

    Key: watching

58. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act IV, Scene IV, Nurse: “They call for dates and _____ in the pastry”

    Key: quinces

59. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Tybalt, nephew to Lady Capulet” (Dramatis Personae)

    A. Juliet urges the sun's horses to bring night.

    B. Benvolio predicts Romeo will find someone more beautiful than Rosaline.

    C. Household detail.

    D. Tybalt's tie to Lady Capulet explains her later grief and demand for revenge.

    Key: D (Tybalt's tie to Lady Capulet explains her later grief and demand for revenge.)

60. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Mercutio, kinsman to the prince, and friend to Romeo” (Dramatis Personae)

    A. The potion's effect.

    B. Juliet's solitude.

    C. Mercutio stands between the Prince's family and the Montagues.

    D. Capulet asks Paris to wait.

    Key: C (Mercutio stands between the Prince's family and the Montagues.)

61. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “More than prince of cats, I can tell you” (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio)

    A. Romeo blames fortune.

    B. Mercutio's nickname for Tybalt (Tybalt is a cat's name in fables).

    C. The potion's effect.

    D. Juliet's impatience.

    Key: B (Mercutio's nickname for Tybalt (Tybalt is a cat's name in fables).)

62. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why is Mercutio pleased with Romeo in this scene?

    Sample answer: Romeo is sociable and witty again, not groaning for love.

63. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Make haste, I say” (Act IV, Scene IV)

    A. For Romeo, exile is the end of the world.

    B. Juliet's warning about haste.

    C. Juliet discovers Romeo is a Montague.

    D. Haste again.

    Key: D (Haste again.)

64. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act IV, Scene IV”?

    A. Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition

    B. Wedding preparations

    C. Wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan

    D. The undelivered letter

    Key: B (Wedding preparations)

65. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The cast list shows a city divided into camps, with only the Prince's kin standing outside the feud. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at variance with each other” (Dramatis Personae).

    Sample answer: "Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at variance" are paired as enemies, while Mercutio is "kinsman to the prince, and friend to Romeo": a neutral who will be pulled into the fight.

66. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? “Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at variance with each other”

    A. Act V, Scene II

    B. Act II, Scene III

    C. Dramatis Personae

    D. Act III, Scene III

    Key: C (Dramatis Personae)

67. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Tybalt, nephew to Lady Capulet” (Dramatis Personae). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Tybalt's tie to Lady Capulet explains her later grief and demand for revenge.

68. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Tybalt has sent Romeo a challenge; the comedy is shadowed by the coming duel.

    A. Fate and choice

    B. Violence and the feud

C. Love and desire

D. Youth and age

Key: B (Violence and the feud)

69. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Bid her devise / Some means to come to shrift this afternoon” (Act II, Scene IV, Romeo).

Sample answer: Mercutio's mockery of Tybalt as "prince of cats" follows news of Tybalt's challenge, and Romeo plans the marriage ("Some means to come to shrift this afternoon") without knowing the challenge waits for him.

70. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act IV, Scene IV”? The household bustles with wedding preparations while Juliet lies "dead."

A. Metaphor

B. Irony

C. Plot

D. Allusion

Key: B (Irony)

71. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? “They call for dates and quinces in the pastry”

A. Act IV, Scene I

B. Act I, Scene III

C. Act II, Scene IV

D. Act IV, Scene IV

Key: D (Act IV, Scene IV)

72. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act IV, Scene IV”? Capulet jokes with servants, busy and happy.

A. Structure

B. Metaphor

C. Tone / mood

D. Characterization

Key: D (Characterization)

73. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how violence and the feud develops from an earlier scene to “Dramatis Personae”. Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: servants are listed by house; the quarrel reaches down to every household member.

74. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “They call for dates and quinces in the pastry” (Act IV, Scene IV, Nurse) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Household detail.

75. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at variance with each other” (Dramatis Personae)

A. Romeo resolves to die.

B. Romeo's oxymorons link love and the feud in one phrase.

C. Romeo's defiance.

D. The conflict is built into the cast list.

Key: D (The conflict is built into the cast list.)

76. [short · inference · DOK 2] What is ironic about the joy?
Sample answer: Juliet lies seemingly dead upstairs.

77. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act II, Scene IV”? The scene is a contest of wit; Romeo is himself again, "sociable" in his friends' eyes.
A. Foreshadowing
B. Structure
C. Alliteration
D. Diction / vocabulary
Key: D (Diction / vocabulary)

78. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at variance with each other” (Dramatis Personae) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: The conflict is built into the cast list.

79. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
Sample answer: Mercutio's mockery of Tybalt as "prince of cats" follows news of Tybalt's challenge, and Romeo plans the marriage ("Some means to come to shrift this afternoon") without knowing the challenge waits for him.

80. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “More than prince of cats, I can tell you” (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: Mercutio's nickname for Tybalt (Tybalt is a cat's name in fables).

81. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The comic bustle increases the dramatic irony of the next scene.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
Sample answer: The servants hear "Make haste, I say" and Capulet orders "Go waken Juliet, go and trim her up," while the audience knows she lies drugged.

82. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at _____ with each other” Word bank: variance, kinsman, maskers, nobleman
Key: variance

83. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? “More than prince of cats, I can tell you”
A. Act V, Scene II
B. Act II, Scene IV
C. Act II, Prologue
D. Act I, Scene I
Key: B (Act II, Scene IV)

84. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Why, is not this better now than groaning for love” (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio)
A. The Nurse delivers the news.
B. The potion's effect.
C. Romeo hands his course to God or fate.

D. Mercutio is pleased Romeo is witty again.

Key: D (Mercutio is pleased Romeo is witty again.)

85. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Dramatis Personae”? "Verona; Mantua": the city of the feud and the city of exile.

A. Setting

B. Allusion

C. Simile

D. Foreshadowing

Key: A (Setting)

86. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Go waken Juliet, go and trim her up” (Act IV, Scene IV). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: Capulet sends the Nurse to Juliet.

87. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The cast list shows a city divided into camps, with only the Prince's kin standing outside the feud.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: "Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at variance" are paired as enemies, while Mercutio is "kinsman to the prince, and friend to Romeo": a neutral who will be pulled into the fight.

88. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is it fair that servants are drawn into their masters' feud? What does the cast list suggest about loyalty?

Sample answer: Servants are defined by 'servant to'; their loyalty is assigned, not chosen.

89. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how violence and the feud develops from an earlier scene to “Act II, Scene IV”. Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: Tybalt has sent Romeo a challenge; the comedy is shadowed by the coming duel.

90. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Make haste, I say” (Act IV, Scene IV) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Haste again.

91. [mc · recall · DOK 1] When are they to marry?

A. Thursday

B. That afternoon

C. At midnight

D. Next week

Key: B (That afternoon)

92. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “O, he is the courageous captain of _____.” Word bank: complements, prating, rosemary, constrains

Key: complements

93. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What is Capulet's mood?

A. Sad

B. Angry

C. Fearful

D. Cheerful and busy

Key: D (Cheerful and busy)

94. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Why, is not this better now than groaning for love” (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Mercutio is pleased Romeo is witty again.
95. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Does this scene deepen or delay the tragedy?
    Sample answer: An evaluation of pacing.
96. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how fate and choice develops from an earlier scene to “Act I, Scene IV”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Romeo senses fate but goes anyway, trusting "He, that hath the steerage of my course."
97. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Mercutio call Tybalt?
    A. A rat
    B. King of dogs
    C. Lord of swords
    D. Prince of cats
    Key: D (Prince of cats)
98. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Does Romeo's premonition make him more or less responsible for what follows?
    Sample answer: A judgment weighing foreknowledge and choice.
99. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Some consequence yet hanging in the stars / Shall bitterly begin his fearful date / With this night’s revels” (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Romeo's premonition.
100. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how youth and age develops from an earlier scene to “Act III, Scene III”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: the Friar's reason against Romeo's passion.
101. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: She knows "My dismal scene I needs must act alone," doubts "What if it be a poison," imagines the tomb, and still says "Romeo, I come! this do I drink to thee."
102. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but chooses to go on.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: He fears "Some consequence yet hanging in the stars" will begin "With this night's revels," yet he says "He, that hath the steerage of my course, / Direct my sail" and follows his friends.
103. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: He cries "be merciful, say 'death'" and insists "There is no world without Verona walls," until the Friar demands "Art thou a man?"
104. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is Juliet brave or reckless?
    Sample answer: Judgment based on her reasoning.

105. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how death as bridegroom develops from an earlier scene to "Act IV, Scene III". Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Juliet drinks to Romeo as she enters a deathlike sleep.

106. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "There is no world without Verona walls" (Act III, Scene III, Romeo) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: For Romeo, exile is the end of the world.

107. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Ha, banishment! be merciful, say "death" (Act III, Scene III, Romeo) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Romeo sees banishment as worse than death.

108. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "What if it be a poison, which the friar / Subtly hath minister'd to have me dead" (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Doubt of the Friar.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30, 31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40, 41, 42, 43, 44, 45, 46, 47, 48, 49, 50	recall 29, inference 12, analysis 6, synthesis 3
HS Freshman	51, 52, 8, 5, 7, 10, 1, 6, 9, 53, 11, 54, 55, 20, 19, 12, 56, 18, 24, 28, 26, 21, 57, 58, 22, 27, 30, 59, 33, 60, 36, 61, 35, 62, 63, 39, 64, 38, 65, 66, 67, 68, 69, 45, 70, 71, 72, 73, 49, 74	recall 26, inference 12, analysis 9, synthesis 3
HS Sophomore	3, 5, 2, 7, 8, 10, 6, 11, 54, 56, 20, 14, 15, 57, 28, 29, 22, 23, 24, 32, 31, 75, 59, 60, 33, 37, 35, 61, 36, 62, 38, 41, 76, 64, 39, 65, 42, 67, 77, 69, 45, 70, 47, 71, 73, 78, 79, 80, 74, 81	recall 19, inference 16, analysis 9, synthesis 6
HS Junior	7, 1, 9, 3, 4, 82, 18, 53, 56, 19, 83, 57, 27, 58, 26, 21, 60, 32, 30, 33, 31, 59, 36, 35, 37, 84, 34, 41, 38, 64, 63, 40, 85, 67, 66, 42, 77, 69, 44, 68, 70, 46, 72, 86, 87, 88, 89, 79, 90, 50	recall 16, inference 16, analysis 12, synthesis 6
HS Senior	5, 10, 6, 82, 8, 91, 92, 15, 18, 58, 93, 29, 24, 59, 60, 75, 33, 32, 31, 62, 84, 37, 35, 36, 38, 63, 39, 76, 64, 66, 67, 43, 65, 77, 45, 44, 68, 47, 72, 46, 70, 87, 73, 78, 94, 89, 79, 95, 74, 90	recall 13, inference 16, analysis 12, synthesis 9
AP	82, 3, 2, 56, 83, 14, 24, 93, 26, 31, 33, 30, 32, 84, 35, 36, 61, 76, 64, 39, 40, 66, 67, 42, 43, 85, 65, 44, 45, 69, 77, 68, 47, 46, 72, 71, 86, 48, 73, 88, 87, 78, 89, 80, 94, 79, 90, 50, 95, 81	recall 9, inference 12, analysis 16, synthesis 13
College Freshman	52, 3, 9, 83, 15, 92, 22, 26, 27, 30, 60, 59, 32, 34, 36, 62, 37, 64, 76, 63, 39, 43, 42, 85, 66, 65, 67, 45, 69, 68, 77, 44, 47, 46, 86, 72, 70, 48, 73, 88, 87, 78, 80, 94, 89, 49, 81, 95, 90, 50	recall 9, inference 12, analysis 16, synthesis 13
College Sophomore	6, 7, 56, 18, 93, 57, 32, 59, 30, 60, 62, 36, 35, 34, 40, 63, 64, 39, 43, 65, 85, 66, 67, 42, 45, 69, 68, 44, 77, 71, 72, 47, 86, 70, 78, 48, 87, 88, 73, 96, 89, 79, 49, 94, 80, 50, 81, 95, 74, 90	recall 6, inference 12, analysis 16, synthesis 16
College Junior		

	82, 9, 20, 97, 26, 28, 32, 31, 60, 36, 37, 35, 64, 40, 63, 42, 67, 43, 65, 66, 85, 68, 69, 77, 45, 44, 72, 46, 47, 86, 71, 87, 78, 48, 88, 73, 98, 99, 79, 94, 49, 89, 80, 100, 101, 95, 81, 50, 90, 74	recall 6, inference 9, analysis 16, synthesis 19
College Senior	82, 5, 23, 31, 32, 60, 35, 34, 37, 41, 40, 38, 43, 67, 66, 42, 65, 85, 45, 44, 68, 77, 69, 70, 71, 46, 86, 72, 88, 48, 73, 78, 87, 102, 96, 98, 80, 89, 79, 94, 49, 103, 100, 104, 105, 90, 50, 95, 74, 81	recall 3, inference 9, analysis 16, synthesis 22
Graduate / PhD	5, 82, 21, 59, 75, 36, 84, 41, 38, 43, 66, 42, 65, 85, 67, 45, 68, 44, 77, 69, 46, 71, 47, 72, 86, 88, 78, 48, 73, 87, 99, 102, 96, 98, 94, 79, 80, 49, 89, 103, 106, 107, 101, 108, 104, 90, 74, 95, 81, 50	recall 3, inference 6, analysis 16, synthesis 25

Final paper

Romeo and Juliet: final paper (formal literary analysis). Choose one prompt.

1. Analyze how William Shakespeare develops love and desire across Romeo and Juliet. Trace the idea through at least three moments (beginning, middle and end) and argue what the ending finally suggests.
2. Choose one recurring symbol, image or motif in Romeo and Juliet and argue how its meaning changes over the play and why that change matters to fate and choice.
3. Analyze a central character's choices in Romeo and Juliet. Argue whether the play judges that character, and how its structure or point of view shapes your answer.
4. Two readers disagree about whether Romeo and Juliet finally endorses or criticizes its society's view of violence and the feud. Weigh both readings and argue for one, answering the strongest objection.

Length: Scaffolded support 500-700 words; HS Freshman 700-900 words; HS Sophomore 900-1,100 words; HS Junior 1,000-1,300 words; HS Senior 1,200-1,500 words; AP 1,300-1,600 words; College Freshman 1,500-2,000 words; College Sophomore 2,000-2,500 words; College Junior 2,500-3,000 words; College Senior 3,000-4,000 words; Graduate / PhD 4,000-6,000 words

Evidence requirement: at least 6 quotations from at least three sections, from the beginning, middle and end. Quote the reading text exactly and cite the act, scene and line (MLA style). HS Senior and above: one scholarly or historical source; College Sophomore and above: two, cited in MLA.

Criterion	Points	Descriptor
Thesis	20	A specific, arguable claim that answers the prompt and organizes the paper.
Evidence	25	Well-chosen, accurately quoted and cited passages from across the work, meeting the evidence requirement.
Analysis	30	Explains how language, structure and literary elements create meaning; goes beyond summary.
Organization	15	Logical progression, clear topic sentences and transitions; introduction and conclusion frame the argument.
Style and conventions	10	Formal academic voice, present tense for literature, correct grammar and MLA format.

Critical voice: "Under his handling, it has become a glorious song of praise on that inexpressible feeling which ennobles the soul and gives to it its highest sublimity, and which elevates even the senses into soul, while at the same time it is a melancholy elegy on its inherent and imparted frailty; it is at once the apotheosis and the obsequies of love." (August Wilhelm Schlegel, critic and translator of Shakespeare, *Lectures on Dramatic Art and Literature (1809-11), trans. John Black, Lecture XXV, Lecture XXV*; public domain). Final paper: Schlegel calls the play "at once the apotheosis and the obsequies of love." Test that claim against the whole play: where does it celebrate love, where does it mourn it, and which wins? *Objective:* Final paper *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.2

Essay assignments

Essay: Love and desire

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Romeo and Juliet teaches about love and desire. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how William Shakespeare develops love and desire in Romeo and Juliet. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops love and desire across Romeo and Juliet. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Romeo and Juliet (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of love and desire. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of love and desire in Romeo and Juliet. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Romeo and Juliet (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of love and desire, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Romeo and Juliet's treatment of love and desire in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on love and desire in Romeo and Juliet that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on love and desire in Romeo and Juliet. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about love and desire in Romeo and Juliet, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on love and desire in Romeo and Juliet, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Fate and choice

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Romeo and Juliet teaches about fate and choice. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how William Shakespeare develops fate and choice in Romeo and Juliet. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops fate and choice across Romeo and Juliet. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Romeo and Juliet (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of fate and choice. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of fate and choice in Romeo and Juliet. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Romeo and Juliet (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of fate and choice, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Romeo and Juliet's treatment of fate and choice in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on fate and choice in Romeo and Juliet that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on fate and choice in Romeo and Juliet. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about fate and choice in Romeo and Juliet, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on fate and choice in Romeo and Juliet, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Violence and the feud

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Romeo and Juliet teaches about violence and the feud. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how William Shakespeare develops violence and the feud in Romeo and Juliet. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops violence and the feud across Romeo and Juliet. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Romeo and Juliet (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of violence and the feud. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of violence and the feud in Romeo and Juliet. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Romeo and Juliet (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of violence and the feud, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Romeo and Juliet's treatment of violence and the feud in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on violence and the feud in Romeo and Juliet that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on violence and the feud in Romeo and Juliet. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about violence and the feud in Romeo and Juliet, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on violence and the feud in Romeo and Juliet, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Youth and age

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Romeo and Juliet teaches about youth and age. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how William Shakespeare develops youth and age in Romeo and Juliet. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops youth and age across Romeo and Juliet. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Romeo and Juliet (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of youth and age. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of youth and age in Romeo and Juliet. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Romeo and Juliet (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of youth and age, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Romeo and Juliet's treatment of youth and age in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on youth and age in Romeo and Juliet that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on youth and age in Romeo and Juliet. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about youth and age in Romeo and Juliet, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on youth and age in Romeo and Juliet, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Time and haste

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Romeo and Juliet teaches about time and haste. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how William Shakespeare develops time and haste in Romeo and Juliet. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops time and haste across Romeo and Juliet. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Romeo and Juliet (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of time and haste. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of time and haste in Romeo and Juliet. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Romeo and Juliet (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of time and haste, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Romeo and Juliet's treatment of time and haste in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on time and haste in Romeo and Juliet that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

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Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on time and haste in Romeo and Juliet, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

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